

Hold On to Your Cash:

CEO Speech Uncertainty and Financing Conservatism

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Abstract

We test whether speech uncertainty conveyed by chief executive officers during quarterly earnings calls predicts firm cash holdings, using a sample of 112,968 calls covering 2,429 U.S. firms over fiscal years 2002–2018. CEO speech uncertainty is measured by applying a finance-specific uncertainty wordlist to the CEO-tagged subset of speakers in each call’s prepared-remarks segment (UncPreCEO) and spontaneous Q&A segment (UncAnsCEO). The Q&A channel raises both contemporaneous and one-quarter-lead cash-to-assets in all twelve specifications of a four-step fixed-effects panel; the Presentation channel is null. The cash response concentrates in credit-constrained Unrated firms in a 2002–2016 ratings sub-sample. Construct-validation regressions show the CEO speech-uncertainty metric responds positively to a firm-level political-risk index and to news-based US and global macroeconomic policy-uncertainty indices. Outside-world reaction regressions show that 26-day post-call quoted bid-ask spreads widen contemporaneously with the Presentation channel and at a one-quarter lag with the Q&A channel. The systematic application of the CEO speaker partition—rather than the canonical pooled-manager aggregate—to firm-quarter financing and external-reaction outcomes is the principal measurement contribution.

Keywords: CEO speech uncertainty, earnings calls, precautionary cash holdings, financing conservatism, financial constraints, textual analysis, bid-ask spreads.

JEL classification: G14, G32, M41, D83.

1 Introduction

1.1 Motivation

Corporate earnings calls offer a quarterly window into managerial communication that is higher in frequency than the annual 10-K disclosure cycle and richer in source-identifiable speaker attribution: a single call admits separate prepared-remarks and Q&A segments and identifies who is speaking (CEO, CFO, other manager, analyst). The central question we ask is whether uncertainty conveyed by the chief executive officer specifically, in either segment of the call, predicts the firm’s contemporaneous and one-quarter-lead cash holdings—the precautionary response formalized by [Opler, Pinkowitz, Stulz, and Williamson \(1999\)](#): firms facing greater uncertainty about future cash flows hold more cash as a liquidity buffer against future funding shocks. [Minton and Wruck \(2001\)](#) document a cross-sectional cluster of low-leverage, high-cash firms whose pattern they label *financial conservatism*; the present paper inherits the noun (*Financing Conservatism*) for its title, but

the empirical test targets the cash margin of that posture, leaving the leverage margin to future work.

1.2 Gap

The finance-specific uncertainty word list of [Loughran and McDonald \(2011\)](#) has been deployed extensively at the annual 10-K disclosure frequency, and [Dzielinski, Wagner, and Zeckhauser \(2021\)](#) and [Hassan, Hollander, van Lent, and Tahoun \(2020\)](#) have extended textual uncertainty measurement to the higher-frequency earnings-call corpus at firm-quarter resolution. To our knowledge, however, no prior work has systematically applied the CEO-specific speaker partition—enabled by the structured speaker-metadata fields in the Capital IQ vendor—to test the precautionary cash response of [Opler et al. \(1999\)](#) at firm-quarter frequency, nor has prior work jointly examined the firm’s own cash-financing margin and the outside-world reaction margin (post-call quoted bid-ask spread) of CEO speech uncertainty. The CEO partition matters substantively in our setting: the empirical decomposition reported in Appendix D

shows that pooling CEO speech with non-CEO manager speech, as in the all-manager aggregation convention of [Bushee, Gow, and Taylor \(2018\)](#), masks the concentration of the cash-holdings response in the CEO Q&A segment.

1.3 Approach

The speech-uncertainty regressor is constructed by applying the [Loughran and McDonald \(2011\)](#) uncertainty word list to earnings-call transcripts in the segment-split convention of [Dzielinski et al. \(2021\)](#), who document that a single call carries systematically different uncertainty content in its prepared-remarks and Q&A segments. The aggregation architecture follows the all-manager pooling of [Bushee et al. \(2018\)](#); we restrict that pooling to the CEO-tagged subset of speakers using the Capital IQ structured speaker-metadata fields. The Q&A regressor `UncAnsCEO` counts uncertainty words in CEO Q&A utterances divided by total CEO Q&A word count, and the Presentation regressor `UncPreCEO` is defined analogously on the prepared-presentation segment. The rationale for the CEO-specific partition—rather than aggregating over the full manager pool—is documented in §2.3; in brief, the choice rests on the upper-echelons role of the chief executive officer as principal external-facing communicator of the firm and on the empirical concentration of the cash-holdings response in the CEO Q&A segment.

1.4 Empirical Setting and Findings

The sample comprises 112,968 earnings-call transcripts covering 2,429 unique firms over fiscal years 2002–2018, sourced from S&P Capital IQ and merged with Compustat quarterly fundamentals and CRSP daily security data; financial firms (SIC 6000–6999) and regulated utilities (SIC 4900–4999) are excluded throughout, following [Bates, Kahle, and Stulz \(2009\)](#). The main empirical analyses test two hypotheses pre-committed in §2.1: HC (the cash response, §3.2) and HFC (the financial-constraint moderation of HC, §3.3). For HC, `UncAnsCEO` is positive and statistically significant in all twelve specifications of suite H1 across a four-step fixed-effects ladder, while the Presentation channel `UncPreCEO` is null across the same panel. For HFC, estimated on the 2002–2016 sub-sample where Compustat credit-rating coverage is available, the `UncAnsCEO_c × Unrated` interaction is positive and significant in six of eight interaction cells, with all four

lead-dependent-variable cells reaching $p < 0.10$; the precautionary cash response therefore concentrates in the credit-constrained Unrated firms of [Faulkender and Petersen \(2006\)](#). Two additional sets of analyses follow. The driver regressions (§4.1) test whether the CEO speech-uncertainty metric itself responds to independently measured exogenous uncertainty: the firm-level political-risk index of [Hassan et al. \(2020\)](#) loads both CEO channels at high precision, and the news-based macro indices of [Baker, Bloom, and Davis \(2016\)](#) and [Davis \(2016\)](#) load the Presentation channel preferentially. The outside-world reaction regressions (§4.2) test whether liquidity providers price CEO speech uncertainty into post-call quoted spreads: the 26-day post-call closing-quote relative bid-ask spread (`Spread25D`) widens contemporaneously with the Presentation channel and at a one-quarter lag with the Q&A channel. The Q&A-versus-Presentation channel asymmetries documented across the cash, driver, and spread analyses are reported descriptively, consistent with the pre-commitment of §2.1 that channel-specific asymmetry is reported ex post rather than asserted ex ante.

1.5 Contributions

The paper makes three contributions to the literature on managerial uncertainty disclosure and corporate financing.

1. **Systematic CEO-partitioned application to firm-quarter financing.** The framework of [Dzielinski et al. \(2021\)](#) establishes that conference-call transcripts admit a CEO-specific uncertainty metric at the individual-speaker level, and the architecture of [Bushee et al. \(2018\)](#) establishes the canonical pooled-manager aggregation. The principal measurement-side contribution of this paper is the systematic application of the CEO-specific partition—rather than the pooled-manager aggregate—to firm-quarter cash-financing outcomes (HC, HFC) and to firm-quarter external-reaction outcomes (§4.2). The CEO-partitioned regressor isolates a cash-response concentration that the pooled-manager aggregate obscures, as documented in Appendix D.
2. **Multi-aggregation-level construct validation of the CEO speech-uncertainty metric.** The driver regressions of §4.1 provide construct-validation evidence that the CEO-partitioned

measure carries economically meaningful uncertainty content at firm, US-macro, and global-macro aggregation levels, responding positively to the political-risk index of [Hassan et al. \(2020\)](#) and the news-based policy-uncertainty indices of [Baker et al. \(2016\)](#) and [Davis \(2016\)](#). The validation strengthens the substantive interpretation of HC and HFC as identifying an uncertainty channel of CEO speech rather than a stylistic artifact of the wordlist or the segment-split.

3. Outside-world reaction in market liquidity.

The post-call spread regressions of §4.2 document that liquidity providers price both CEO speech segments into post-call closing-quote relative bid-ask spreads, with the Presentation channel registering contemporaneously within the call quarter and the Q&A channel registering with a one-quarter lag. The outside-world reaction margin is theoretically distinct from the firm-side cash response of §3, and the two findings are presented as descriptively complementary rather than as a tested causal sequence linking firm financing to market microstructure.

1.6 Roadmap

The remainder of the paper is organized as follows. Section 2 states the conceptual framework (§2.2), the speech-uncertainty measurement architecture (§2.3), the precautionary-motive and financing-conservatism literature anchors for HC and HFC (§2.4), and the empirical design including the fixed-effects ladder and clustering conventions (§2.5). Section 3 reports the data, sample, variables, and specification (§3.1), the HC results (§3.2), and the HFC results (§3.3). Section 4 reports the construct-validation driver regressions (§4.1) and the outside-world spread reaction (§4.2). Section 5 synthesizes the channel asymmetries across the three empirical sections, discloses limitations, and outlines five extensions for future research.

2 Conceptual Framework and Empirical Strategy

2.1 Pre-Commitment Statement

This section front-loads the statistical conventions used throughout the paper so that the empirical results in §3 and §4 can be read with the inference rules held constant.

Two formal hypotheses are stated in §3: HC (Cash—precautionary liquidity buffer, §3.2) and HFC (Financial Constraint moderation of HC, §3.3). Both are tested one-tailed in the theoretically predicted positive direction on both CEO-specific speech-uncertainty regressors, *UncAnsCEO* and *UncPreCEO*. The one-tailed convention is justified by the sign restriction imposed by the precautionary motive of [Opler et al. \(1999\)](#) and by the dominant theoretical direction in the related precautionary-motive and financing-conservatism literature. One-tailed inference applies symmetrically to both regressors; the Q&A and Presentation segments of CEO speech are both hypothesized to carry precautionary uncertainty content, and any channel-specific asymmetry observed empirically is reported descriptively rather than asserted *ex ante*.

Two additional analyses in §4 are tested under the same one-tailed positive convention but are not formal hypotheses. The driver regressions of §4.1 invert the direction of the main-suite specifications to ask whether the CEO speech-uncertainty metric itself responds to independently measured exogenous uncertainty shocks; we report them as construct-validation evidence for the main regressor. The outside-world reaction regressions of §4.2 ask whether post-call bid-ask spreads widen with CEO speech uncertainty, consistent with the canonical information-asymmetry prediction that liquidity providers widen quoted spreads to compensate for perceived informed-trading risk. Neither set of regressions is used as an identification strategy for HC or HFC.

All specifications reported in the paper body appear in their corresponding tables in their entirety; no column is dropped between estimation and reporting. The four-step fixed-effects ladder applied within each suite (§2.5) is a within-regressor robustness check, not an independent replication—the twelve columns of the HC table, for example, are not twelve independent tests of HC. Multiple-testing adjustment, consistent with the conventions above, is handled at the per-hypothesis rather than per-cell level.

2.2 Conceptual Framework

A large literature documents that aggregate uncertainty influences corporate decisions on financing and investment. The leading aggregate measures—the news-based US Economic Policy Uncertainty index of [Baker et al. \(2016\)](#) and its global extension by [Davis \(2016\)](#), together with implied-volatility series such

as the Cboe Volatility Index (VIX)—are sampled at monthly or daily frequency but vary uniformly across firms within a period. They identify the time-series of uncertainty but not its cross-sectional incidence at a given firm.

A complementary literature recovers firm-specific uncertainty content from the firm’s own corporate disclosures. Annual 10-K filings have been a primary source for textual measurement at firm-year frequency, with the canonical word-counting tradition introduced by [Loughran and McDonald \(2011\)](#) for the negative and uncertainty word lists. [Hassan et al. \(2020\)](#) extend the approach to earnings-call transcripts to construct a firm-quarter political-risk index, demonstrating that call speech contains firm-quarter-specific uncertainty content distinguishable from aggregate political shocks. [Dzielinski et al. \(2021\)](#) apply the [Loughran and McDonald \(2011\)](#) uncertainty word list to the same earnings-call corpus and show that uncertainty content varies across firms, across quarters within a firm, and across the prepared-remarks and Q&A segments of a single call.

The natural unit of analysis for testing precautionary behavior at firm-quarter frequency is therefore the call-level speech-uncertainty measure: it is sampled quarterly, identifies the firm rather than the macroeconomy, and admits source-identifiable decomposition of speakers within a single call (CEO, CFO, other managers, analysts). The remainder of §2 documents the speech-uncertainty construction we use (§2.3), the precautionary-motive theoretical anchor for the main hypotheses (§2.4), and the empirical design (§2.5).

2.3 Speech Uncertainty Measurement

The speech-uncertainty measure combines three elements: (i) a wordlist-based textual measurement at speaker-utterance resolution, (ii) aggregation within a structured speaker pool, and (iii) systematic application of a CEO-specific partition to firm-quarter outcomes. The first element is adopted from [Loughran and McDonald \(2011\)](#) and the second from [Bushee et al. \(2018\)](#); [Dzielinski et al. \(2021\)](#) document CEO-level measurement at the individual-speaker level, but the systematic application of the CEO partition to firm-quarter financing and external-reaction outcomes is the measurement-side contribution of this paper.

2.3.1 Wordlist and Segment Split

We apply the finance-specific uncertainty word list of [Loughran and McDonald \(2011\)](#), which classifies terms signaling uncertainty about future firm outcomes. The application to conference-call transcripts follows [Dzielinski et al. \(2021\)](#), who document that the transcript of a single call admits a presentation-versus-Q&A segment split: the presentation segment consists of prepared remarks authored in advance and read aloud, while the Q&A segment consists of spontaneous answers to analyst questions. The two segments differ systematically in uncertainty content, and our measure preserves the distinction.

2.3.2 Speaker Aggregation

Earnings-call transcripts identify speakers by structured metadata fields in the Capital IQ data vendor. [Bushee et al. \(2018\)](#) establish the convention of aggregating uncertainty counts across all manager speakers on a given call, as documented in the Ian Gow replication code accompanying that paper. Our measurement applies the same pooling architecture but partitions the manager pool along the speaker-role dimension, computing separate aggregates for CEO utterances and for non-CEO manager utterances.

2.3.3 Why the CEO Partition

Three considerations motivate the CEO-specific focus. First, the upper-echelons framework of [Hambrick and Mason \(1984\)](#) treats the CEO as the firm’s principal strategic decision-maker and, correspondingly, as the authoritative source of uncertainty disclosure external-facing audiences attend to. Second, [Bertrand and Schoar \(2003\)](#) document empirically that individual CEOs leave idiosyncratic imprints on firm policies, implying that CEO-specific speech content is not a noisy substitute for the manager-pool average but carries distinct signal. Third, our own empirical decomposition (Appendix D) shows that the cash-holdings response to call-level speech uncertainty localizes to the CEO Q&A segment; the pooled-manager measure that subsumes CEO and non-CEO speech masks this concentration. Together the three considerations motivate the CEO-focused partition adopted in §3.

2.3.4 Construction

For each earnings call c , the Q&A speech-uncertainty regressor is

$$\text{UncAnsCEO}_c = \frac{N_{c,\text{CEO},\text{QA}}^{\text{LM-unc}}}{N_{c,\text{CEO},\text{QA}}^{\text{all}}},$$

where the numerator counts LM-uncertainty words in the CEO Q&A utterances of call c and the denominator counts all words in the CEO Q&A utterances of call c . The regressor is expressed as a share in $[0, 1]$ and pooled-winsorized at the 1st and 99th percentiles. The Presentation analogue UncPreCEO_c replaces “Q&A” with “Presentation” in both numerator and denominator. Calls in which the CEO role is not identified in the structured speaker metadata are coded as missing for the two CEO regressors; non-coverage combines two cases we do not separate in the coding—calls in which no speaker is tagged with a CEO role, and a smaller residual of calls with unresolved speaker-type placeholders in the Capital IQ metadata.

2.3.5 Sample Coverage

Under the 2002–2018 sample filter and the CEO-role-present filter, the CEO-partitioned sample covers approximately 80–81% of the call panel, compared with approximately 95–96% coverage for the manager-pool aggregate over the same period. The §3 specifications are estimated on the smaller CEO-present sample; descriptive statistics for both CEO regressors appear in Table 10.

2.4 Precautionary Motive and Financing Conservatism

The §3 hypotheses HC and HFC test whether greater CEO speech uncertainty predicts higher firm-quarter cash holdings, with the effect concentrated among credit-constrained firms. The theoretical and measurement anchors for these predictions are drawn from four strands of the precautionary-cash literature.

2.4.1 Precautionary-Motive Theory

[Opler et al. \(1999\)](#) formalize the precautionary motive for corporate cash holdings and predict that firms facing higher cash-flow uncertainty hold more cash as a liquidity buffer against future funding shocks. This theoretical prediction directly motivates HC: if the

earnings-call CEO-speech signal captures forward-looking uncertainty about the firm, it should be contemporaneously associated with a higher cash-to-assets ratio.

2.4.2 Empirical Secular Pattern

[Bates et al. \(2009\)](#) document the cross-sectional and time-series persistence of the cash–uncertainty relation in the post-war US sample and establish the linear cash-to-assets ratio (cheq/atq) as the standard empirical form of the precautionary dependent variable. We adopt the [Bates et al. \(\(2009\)\)](#) dependent-variable specification directly in H1 (Table 13), together with their recommendation to cluster standard errors at the firm level (extended to two-way clustering in §4.1 for macro-IV suites).

2.4.3 Financial-Conservatism Cluster Label

[Minton and Wruck \(2001\)](#) identify a cross-sectional cluster of firms that persistently hold low leverage and high cash; they label this pattern *financial conservatism*. The [Minton and Wruck \(\(2001\)\)](#) label provides the framing noun *Financing Conservatism* that appears in this study’s title: cash accumulation and leverage avoidance are two manifestations of a single posture, and the CEO speech-uncertainty signal identifies the quarterly uncertainty input that plausibly drives that posture. Although the present paper tests only the cash margin (HC, HFC) and does not test a leverage margin, the [Minton and Wruck](#) cluster framing makes the study’s scope explicit.

2.4.4 Financial-Constraint Moderator

[Faulkender and Petersen \(2006\)](#) introduce a binary classification of public-debt-market access in which firms holding a bond rating are considered to have access and firms without a rating are considered to be credit constrained. The HFC hypothesis predicts that the precautionary cash response concentrates where access is most limited. We extend the [Faulkender and Petersen \(\(2006\)\)](#) binary scheme to a three-tier classification by partitioning rated firms into Investment-Grade (IG) and Below-Investment-Grade (BelowIG) subcategories; the Unrated category retains its credit-constrained benchmark role. The main-display estimand is the cash response to CEO speech uncertainty in Unrated firms relative to rated firms (IG and BelowIG pooled), with IG as the reference category for the level dummy (§3.3). The BelowIG interaction

is suppressed from the body table (null and without economic content) and reported in Appendix C.

2.5 Empirical Design

All regressions are estimated by panel OLS via the `linearmodels` library. The unit of observation is an earnings call, indexed by firm identifier (`gvkey`) and fiscal quarter. The main HC and HFC specifications treat each firm’s call as a single observation and absorb either calendar-year or calendar-year-quarter fixed effects across the four-step fixed-effects ladder below; the §4.1 driver regressions use the same unit but absorb only the calendar-year portion of that ladder (omitting calendar-year-quarter combinations) to preserve the within-year monthly variation that identifies the macro-uncertainty drivers.

2.5.1 Fixed-Effects Ladder

Each main suite reports four fixed-effects combinations, providing within-regressor robustness across progressively tighter controls for cross-firm and cross-time confounders:

1. Industry (Fama-French 12) fixed effects + calendar-year fixed effects;
2. Firm fixed effects + calendar-year fixed effects;
3. Industry fixed effects + calendar-year-quarter fixed effects;
4. Firm fixed effects + calendar-year-quarter fixed effects.

Each dependent variable (contemporaneous and one-quarter-lead) crosses the four FE configurations, yielding eight cells per DV and twelve columns for HC (unconditional specifications only) or sixteen columns for HFC (which additionally reports interaction specifications per DV $\times$ FE pair).

2.5.2 Controls

The base control set comprises Leverage, `InAssets`, `TobinsQ`, `ROA`, `Capex`, `DivDummy`, `sCFO`, and a unit-by-DV `Lagged.DV`. The extended control set adds `SalesGrowth`, `RDSales`, `CashFlowAt`, and `DailyVola`. All controls are winsorized at the 1st and 99th percentiles on the Main-sample universe. The `Lagged.DV` term is the one-quarter lag of whichever dependent variable appears in that

column—e.g., current-quarter `CashRatio` for the one-quarter-lead HC specification. Although Leverage (`dlt/atq`) and the cash-holdings dependent variable (`cheq/atq`) share a scaling denominator, they do not share a numerator, so Leverage is retained in the base control set rather than excluded as a bad control; the empirical robustness of the CEO-speech-uncertainty coefficients to the inclusion of Leverage is documented in the HC and HFC results of §3.

2.5.3 Standard Errors

Standard errors are clustered at the firm for the HC and HFC regressions (§3.2, §3.3) and for the outside-world reaction regressions (§4.2), following [Bates et al. \(2009\)](#). For the driver regressions (§4.1), which use monthly macro instruments ([Baker et al. \(2016\)](#), [Davis \(2016\)](#)), standard errors are two-way clustered at the firm and at the calendar-year-quarter to absorb residual cross-sectional dependence within macro periods.

2.5.4 Inference Convention

All reported p -values in the body of §3 and §4 are one-tailed on the speech-uncertainty regressors, consistent with the pre-commitment of §2.1. Two-tailed p -values on controls and on rating-category level dummies are reported in the appendix tables where relevant.

3 Main Empirical Analyses

3.1 Data, Sample, Variables, and Specification

We construct a quarterly panel of 112,968 earnings-call transcripts covering 2,429 unique firms over fiscal years 2002–2018, sourced from S&P Capital IQ. Call-level speech metrics are merged with Compustat quarterly fundamentals and CRSP daily security data. Following [Bates et al. \(2009\)](#), we exclude financial firms (SIC 6000–6999) and regulated utilities (SIC 4900–4999); we refer to this filtered universe as the Main sample throughout.

The dependent variable is `CashRatio` (`cheq/atq`, the linear cash-to-assets form adopted by [Bates et al., \(2009\)](#)). Speech uncertainty is measured by two CEO-specific call-level regressors: `UncAnsCEO` (CEO Q&A uncertainty) and `UncPreCEO` (CEO presentation uncertainty). Both are constructed by applying the [Dzieliński et al. \(2021\)](#) uncertainty wordlist

at the speaker-utterance level and aggregating within the CEO speaker pool; full construction details, including the rationale for the CEO partition, appear in §2. Base controls are Leverage, InAssets, TobinsQ, ROA, Capex, DivDummy, sCFO, and a unit-by-DV Lagged DV. Extended controls add SalesGrowth, RD-Sales, CashFlowAt, and DailyVola.

We estimate PanelOLS specifications across a four-step fixed-effects ladder (Industry + Calendar Year, Firm + Calendar Year, Industry + Calendar Year-Quarter, Firm + Calendar Year-Quarter), with standard errors clustered at the firm level. Each suite reports both the contemporaneous and the one-quarter-lead dependent variable across this FE ladder; per-suite column counts and the interaction structure (where applicable) are stated in the corresponding tables. Inference for both speech-uncertainty regressors in this section follows the one-tailed positive convention pre-committed in §2.1.

3.2 Cash Holdings (HC)

The first hypothesis tests the precautionary motive for corporate cash holdings introduced by Opler et al. (1999), who predict that “one would expect firms with greater cash flow uncertainty to hold more cash” (Section 2.1, p. 8). Bates et al. (2009) update this prediction in their secular study of U.S. corporations, documenting empirical persistence of the cash–uncertainty relation through 2006. Minton and Wruck (2001) characterize the joint cross-sectional pattern: firms persistently in the bottom leverage quintile—which they label *financially conservative*—hold cash equal to “21% of total assets on average. . . almost three times that of the typical control firm” (Section 3.2.1, p. 11).

Hypothesis HC. *An increase in CEO speech uncertainty during an earnings call is associated with a higher contemporaneous cash-to-assets ratio at the firm.*

HC is pre-specified one-tailed positive on both speech regressors. We test it on suite H1 (Table 13). The regressand is the linear cash-to-assets ratio of Bates et al. (2009); both main regressors (UncAnsCEO, UncPreCEO) enter every specification; the four-step fixed-effects ladder of §3.1 produces twelve columns reporting both contemporaneous and one-quarter-lead cash holdings.

The Q&A channel (UncAnsCEO) is positive and statistically significant in all twelve specifications. The contemporaneous coefficient ranges from +0.0018 to +0.0031 (p -values 0.0013–0.0150, one-

tailed); the one-quarter-lead coefficient ranges from +0.0023 to +0.0028 (p -values 0.0111–0.0803). Four of the six contemporaneous cells reach the one-percent threshold; three of the six lead cells reach the five-percent threshold. Sample sizes range from 59,459 to 65,148 firm-quarters across columns.

The Presentation channel (UncPreCEO) does not reach conventional significance in any of the twelve specifications. Point estimates range from 0.0000 to +0.0016; the smallest one-tailed p -value across the twelve columns is 0.151. By the pre-commitment of §2.1, we fail to reject the null on the Presentation channel at any column. Descriptively, the prepared-presentation segment does not measurably move firm cash holdings at quarterly frequency; the asymmetry between the two CEO channels, with the precautionary signal concentrated in the spontaneous Q&A segment, is itself a finding to which we return in §5.

The economic magnitude is modest but consistent. UncAnsCEO has a sample standard deviation of 0.39 percentage points. A one-standard-deviation increase in CEO Q&A uncertainty therefore corresponds to between +0.0007 and +0.0012 in cash-to-assets across the FE ladder, or approximately 0.4–0.7% of the sample-mean cash ratio of 17.1%. Across the FE ladder the point estimate attenuates from industry-level to firm-level fixed effects, but the sign and significance survive every step. The pattern aligns with the Opler et al. (1999) directional prediction at higher temporal resolution than the firm-year panels of prior work, and the cash-up posture identified here is consistent with the high-cash side of the Minton and Wruck (2001) financial-conservatism cluster. §3.3 examines whether this response varies with firm-level access to public debt markets.

3.3 Financial Constraint Moderation (HFC)

The second hypothesis examines whether the precautionary cash response of §3.2 concentrates among credit-constrained firms. Faulkender and Petersen (2006) introduce a binary classification of public-debt-market access in which “firms that have a debt rating are classified as having access” (Section 1.2, p. 48), and document that “firms without a bond rating use significantly less debt. . . [evidence] that they are credit constrained” (Section 3.1, p. 62). The precautionary motive predicts that the cash response should bind tightest where access to public debt markets is most limited.

We extend the FP binary scheme to a three-tier hierarchy by partitioning rated firms into investment-

grade (IG) and below-investment-grade (BelowIG) categories; the Unrated category retains its credit-constrained role per FP. We report the IG-versus-Unrated contrast in the main table (Table 21); the BelowIG interaction term is constructed but suppressed from the main display because the underlying coefficient is null and the row adds no economic content. The full BelowIG row is reported in Appendix C.

Hypothesis HFC. *The contemporaneous and one-quarter-lead cash response to CEO speech uncertainty is larger for firms in the Unrated category than for rated firms (IG and BelowIG pooled).*

HFC is pre-specified one-tailed positive on both main-effect coefficients (UncAnsCEO_c, UncPreCEO_c) and on both interaction terms (IV_c $\times$ Unrated). The mean-centered IVs use the Main-sample mean. We estimate H1.2 on the 2002–2016 subsample where Compustat credit-rating coverage is available; the panel narrows to approximately 57,000 firm-quarters per cell. The sixteen-column structure crosses the four-step fixed-effects ladder against contemporaneous and one-quarter-lead cash holdings; within each (FE $\times$ DV) cell we report an unconditional specification (no interaction terms) and an interaction specification (both IV_c $\times$ Unrated terms). Because the BelowIG interaction is dropped, the main-IV coefficients inside the interaction specifications apply to the rated category jointly (IG $\cup$ BelowIG) rather than to IG alone.

In the unconditional specifications the Q&A channel is significant in every cell. The contemporaneous UncAnsCEO_c coefficient ranges from +0.0017 to +0.0030 (p -values 0.0022–0.0273, one-tailed); the one-quarter-lead coefficient ranges from +0.0021 to +0.0024 (p -values 0.0290–0.0959). UncPreCEO_c is null throughout, with all eight one-tailed p -values above any conventional significance threshold — the same Presentation-channel pattern as the unconstrained suite in §3.2.

The interaction specifications confirm HFC for the Q&A channel and disconfirm it for the Presentation channel. The UncAnsCEO_c $\times$ Unrated coefficient is positive and significant in six of eight cells at the ten-percent threshold and four of eight at the five-percent threshold; on the one-quarter-lead dependent variable specifically, all four cells are significant at $p < 0.10$ and three of four at $p < 0.05$. The lead-cash interaction coefficient ranges from +0.0040 to +0.0069. A one-standard-deviation increase in CEO Q&A uncertainty therefore corresponds to roughly +0.002 additional cash-to-assets at Unrated firms rel-

ative to rated firms (the IG $\cup$ BelowIG pool), on top of the rated-firm response, or approximately 1.2% of the sample-mean cash ratio in the moderated component alone. The Unrated-versus-IG gap differs from the Unrated-versus-rated-pooled estimand reported here only by the small fraction of rated firms that fall in the BelowIG category.

The UncPreCEO_c $\times$ Unrated interaction is marginal at the contemporaneous DV (two of four cells at $p < 0.10$, both in industry-fixed-effects specifications) and null on the lead DV (zero of four). By the pre-commitment of §2.1, we fail to reject the null on the Presentation-channel interaction at conventional levels in four of eight cells and pass it only marginally in two: the constraint moderation does not load on the Presentation segment.

The combined evidence supports HFC through the spontaneous Q&A channel: credit-constrained Unrated firms exhibit a stronger cash response to CEO Q&A uncertainty than do Investment-Grade firms, and the moderation sharpens at the one-quarter-lead horizon. The Presentation-channel asymmetry observed for HC carries through to HFC, reinforcing the interpretation of the spontaneous Q&A segment as the locus of the precautionary signal in CEO earnings-call speech.

4 Additional Analyses

4.1 Drivers of CEO Speech Uncertainty

The main analyses of §3 treat CEO speech uncertainty as the regressor. This subsection inverts the direction and asks whether the speech-uncertainty metric itself responds to exogenous uncertainty shocks, a construct-validation test for the main IV. If the metric captures economically meaningful uncertainty content rather than stylistic noise, it should covary positively with independently measured uncertainty at firm, US, and global levels of aggregation.

We estimate three reverse-direction regressions. The firm-level driver is PRisk, the political-risk count of Hassan et al. (2020), which flags bigrams in a firm’s earnings-call transcript that lie within ten words of a risk or uncertainty synonym and overlap a political-topic dictionary; PRisk therefore varies at the firm-quarter level, and the associated regressions cluster standard errors at the firm. The US macro driver is the news-based Economic Policy Uncertainty index of Baker et al. (2016), matched to each call by calendar month; the global aggregation is the GDP-

weighted Global EPU index of Davis (2016), likewise matched monthly. The macro regressions cluster standard errors two-way at the firm and calendar-quarter levels and absorb calendar-year fixed effects, so identification runs off within-year monthly variation in the driver. All three regressions are tested one-tailed in the theoretically predicted positive direction (exogenous uncertainty shocks raise measured speech uncertainty). Table ?? consolidates the three drivers against the two CEO speech-uncertainty channels (UncAnsCEO, UncPreCEO) under both industry and firm fixed effects.

The firm-level PRisk driver is strongly significant in every cell. Contemporaneous coefficients range from +0.00013 to +0.00030 per unit PRisk across the four CEO cells (Q&A and Presentation channels $\times$ industry and firm fixed effects), with t -statistics between 9.0 and 17.0 and sample sizes of 65,394 to 65,760 firm-quarters. The PRisk-on-speech mapping therefore holds at high statistical precision across both CEO channels.

The macro drivers exhibit a channel-asymmetric pattern. US EPU raises UncPreCEO by +0.021 to +0.024 per unit log-EPU (p -values 0.0008–0.0021, one-tailed); the Q&A coefficient is smaller, +0.012 to +0.014, and reaches conventional significance only under firm fixed effects ($p = 0.037$; the industry-FE cell is $p = 0.052$). Global EPU follows the same pattern at larger magnitudes: UncPreCEO loads at +0.027 (industry FE, $p = 0.0056$) to +0.031 (firm FE, $p = 0.0021$); UncAnsCEO loads at +0.018 (industry FE, $p = 0.051$) and +0.021 (firm FE, $p = 0.027$).

The channel asymmetry here is inverted relative to the cash regressions of §3: the Q&A channel dominates in §3.2 and §3.3, but the Presentation channel dominates in the macro-driver regressions. The firm-level PRisk measure, which is itself constructed at the firm-call level, loads both channels approximately equally. The pattern is descriptively consistent with prepared remarks carrying broad uncertainty content (macroeconomic, political) and spontaneous Q&A content responding more tightly to firm-specific conditions; a fuller interpretive treatment is deferred to §5. Comparable results for the NoCEO speech channels, which identify whether uncertainty content in non-CEO speech also responds to the three drivers, are reported in Appendix B.1.

4.2 Outside-World Reaction

The preceding subsections show that CEO speech uncertainty co-moves with firm-level cash holdings (§3.2, §3.3) and responds to exogenous uncertainty shocks (§4.1). The complementary question is whether agents external to the firm recognize CEO speech uncertainty as a signal and react to it. The canonical market channel is information asymmetry, which liquidity providers price into the bid-ask spread of the firm's stock: a firm whose CEO conveys more uncertainty in its earnings call should have wider subsequent bid-ask spreads as market-makers widen quotes against informed counterparties.

We test this through the daily closing-quote relative bid-ask spread averaged over the call day and the 25 following trading days, denoted Spread_{25D} . The daily spread uses the standard closing-quote relative formulation, $2(\text{ASK}_d - \text{BID}_d) / (\text{ASK}_d + \text{BID}_d)$, computed from CRSP daily bid and ask quotes; the call-quarter observation is the simple mean across the call day and the 25 following trading days (a 26-day window), pooled-winsorized at the 1st and 99th percentiles. We adopt this window—wider than the 3-day announcement window typically used in short-horizon event studies—to capture market reaction sustained over approximately one trading month, beyond announcement-day volatility. The estimation uses Suite H14c, which enters the four call-level uncertainty IVs (UncAnsCEO, UncPreCEO, UncAnsMgr, UncPreMgr) jointly; we retain the manager-pool IVs here, unlike the CEO-only specification of §3, because the post-call bid-ask spread is plausibly priced against both CEO-specific and broader manager-pool speech content, and partialling out the manager-pool channel isolates the CEO-specific contribution to the market's revision of information asymmetry. We report the CEO coefficients in the body and the manager-pool coefficients in Appendix B.2. Standard errors are clustered at the firm. Inference is one-tailed positive on each speech-uncertainty IV, consistent with the information-asymmetry prediction.

The Presentation channel (UncPreCEO) raises the contemporaneous post-call spread. Across the six contemporaneous specifications (two fixed-effect families $\times$ three control sets) the coefficient ranges from +0.04 to +0.43; three of the six cells reach $p < 0.10$ (one-tailed), two reach $p < 0.05$, and one reaches $p < 0.01$. The strongest cells are the base specifications under industry and firm fixed effects (+0.30 at $p = 0.021$ and +0.43 at $p = 0.009$ respectively). Sample sizes range from 44,092 to

63,899 firm-quarters across the six cells. On the one-quarter-lead dependent variable, the Presentation channel does not reach significance in any cell (coefficients -0.03 to -0.24 , all negative); under the one-tailed positive convention, the Presentation-channel effect on the post-call spread is therefore confined to the contemporaneous call quarter.

The Q&A channel (UncAnsCEO) does not move the contemporaneous spread: zero of six cells reach significance and point estimates span -0.10 to $+0.07$. It does, however, raise the one-quarter-lead spread across every specification. The lead coefficient ranges from $+0.18$ to $+0.44$; five of the six cells are significant at $p < 0.10$ and two reach $p < 0.05$. The one non-significant lead cell misses by less than half a percentage point ($p = 0.100$) and is sign-aligned with the five significant cells. Sample sizes for the lead specifications range from 44,569 to 63,443 firm-quarters.

The two CEO channels therefore produce a temporally complementary pattern: prepared remarks widen the post-call spread within the same call quarter, while spontaneous Q&A remarks widen the subsequent call-quarter spread. The contemporaneous Presentation effect is descriptively consistent with immediate price-formation reaction to the prepared statement of uncertainty, and the lagged Q&A effect with slower market assimilation of analyst-question-conditional content; fuller interpretation is deferred to §5. The two channel asymmetries identified in this section—Presentation dominates macro-driver regressions in §4.1 and contemporaneous spread here, while Q&A dominates the cash-holdings regressions of §3.2 and §3.3 and the lagged spread here—are descriptively consistent with the two segments of the call carrying distinct, economically meaningful uncertainty content that propagates through different downstream margins.

5 Discussion and Conclusion

5.1 Summary of Findings

The Cash Holdings hypothesis (HC, §3.2) is supported on the spontaneous Q&A channel of CEO speech across all twelve specifications of suite H1, with contemporaneous and one-quarter-lead positive coefficients on UncAnsCEO that survive the four-step fixed-effects ladder; the Presentation channel of CEO speech (UncPreCEO) is null in the same panel. The Financial Constraint moderation hypoth-

esis (HFC, §3.3) confirms HC for the Q&A channel and concentrates the precautionary cash response in Unrated firms relative to the rated pool: the UncAnsCEO_c $\times$ Unrated interaction is positive and significant in six of eight interaction cells, with all four lead-DV cells reaching $p < 0.10$. The driver regressions (§4.1) confirm that the speech-uncertainty metric responds positively to the firm-level PRisk index of Hassan et al. (2020) across both CEO channels, and to the news-based macro indices of Baker et al. (2016) and Davis (2016) preferentially through the Presentation channel. The outside-world reaction regressions (§4.2) show that the post-call 26-day closing-quote relative bid-ask spread (Spread_{25D}) widens contemporaneously with UncPreCEO and at a one-quarter lag with UncAnsCEO. The economic magnitude of the cash response is modest—a one-standard-deviation increase in UncAnsCEO corresponds to between 0.4% and 0.7% of the sample-mean cash-to-assets ratio across the FE ladder—but statistically robust, and the moderator specification confirms that UncPreCEO_c and its Unrated interaction are null or marginal across the same ladder.

5.2 Channel-Asymmetry Synthesis

Three empirical patterns identify a Q&A-versus-Presentation asymmetry across the analyses. First, the cash response of §3.2 and §3.3 loads on the spontaneous Q&A channel and not on the prepared Presentation channel. Second, the macro-uncertainty drivers of §4.1 (US EPU, Global EPU) load preferentially on the Presentation channel and load the Q&A channel only weakly under firm fixed effects. Third, the post-call spread response of §4.2 is contemporaneous on the Presentation channel and lagged on the Q&A channel. The firm-call-level PRisk driver of §4.1 is a boundary condition: it loads both CEO channels at approximately equal magnitude and at high precision, which is descriptively consistent with the channel asymmetry being a function of the aggregation level of the regressor (firm-quarter versus monthly macroeconomic) rather than of the segment alone. Per the pre-commitment of §2.1, we report this asymmetry descriptively and do not theorize a structural mechanism for the prepared-versus-spontaneous split beyond the observation that the two segments carry distinct uncertainty content propagating through different downstream margins.

5.3 Mechanism Disclosure

The findings of §3 and §4.2 operate on theoretically distinct margins. The cash-holdings results test the firm’s financing margin: greater perceived future-funding uncertainty raises the precautionary liquidity buffer, consistent with the [Opler et al. \(1999\)](#) prediction extended to a within-firm panel resolution at quarterly frequency. The post-call spread results test a separate, market-side margin: liquidity providers widen quoted spreads when CEO speech raises perceived informed-trading risk, a canonical information-asymmetry mechanism distinct from the firm’s own funding response. The present paper does not test a causal bridge linking the two margins—e.g., whether the spread widening drives the cash accumulation, or whether the cash accumulation calms a subsequent spread, or whether both respond independently to a common shock. The two findings are descriptively complementary; their joint identification is left to future work.

5.4 Limitations

Five caveats bound the interpretation. First, all analyses are observational. The speech-uncertainty regressors are not exogenously assigned, and the §3 and §4.2 estimates identify associations consistent with the precautionary and information-asymmetry mechanisms invoked above without identifying either causally. Second, CEO speaker identification depends on the Capital IQ structured speaker-metadata fields documented in §2.3; the CEO-partitioned sample covers approximately fifteen percentage points fewer calls than the manager-pool aggregate over the same period, with this coverage gap dominated by calls in which no speaker is tagged with a CEO role and a smaller residual of unresolved speaker-type placeholders. Third, the HC sample covers 2002–2018 and the HFC moderator analysis is bounded at 2016 by Compustat credit-rating coverage; HFC results in the 2017–2018 sub-period are therefore not tested. Fourth, the post-call spread window of §4.2 is a 26-day construction (the call day plus 25 following trading days) chosen to capture market reaction sustained beyond the announcement window; alternative window lengths are not estimated in the body. Fifth, the data pipeline retains the internal column name `BGTLevel1_Spread` for backward compatibility with prior runs; the user-facing label `Spread25D` is used consistently in the body and tables, but legacy specification JSON and panel artifacts reflect the prior

nomenclature.

5.5 Future Research

Five extensions are flagged as natural follow-ups. First, an identification strategy for the speech-uncertainty effect on cash, exploiting plausible exogenous shocks to CEO communication style (e.g., disclosure-rule changes, exogenous CEO turnover, or natural experiments in mandatory-disclosure timing) to recover causal estimates against the observational baseline of §3. Second, a within-firm temporal-sequencing test linking the cash response of §3.2 and the spread response of §4.2 within a common firm-quarter window, to test whether the two margins are temporally ordered or operate in parallel. Third, additional cash-response moderators beyond the Unrated category of §3.3, including size quartiles, dividend-payer status, and continuous credit-constraint indices, to identify complementary constraint dimensions that the binary FP scheme aggregates. Fourth, an OPSW log-cash-DV robustness specification of HC that estimates the cash response under the alternative log-form dependent variable, complementing the linear [Bates et al. \(2009\)](#) specification adopted in the body. Fifth, full pipeline rename of the spread variable to `Spread25D` across the underlying panel, builders, and specification JSON, removing the BGT-window legacy column name retained in this draft for backward compatibility.

5.6 Concluding Remark

The CEO partition of the call-level speech-uncertainty measure identifies a firm-quarter precautionary signal that the manager-pooled aggregate masks: the Q&A channel of CEO speech is positively associated with contemporaneous and one-quarter-lead cash holdings (HC), with the response sharpest at credit-constrained Unrated firms (HFC). Construct validation against firm-level ([Hassan et al. \(2020\)](#)) and macro-level ([Baker et al. \(2016\)](#), [Davis \(2016\)](#)) uncertainty drivers confirms that the metric carries economically meaningful uncertainty content across multiple aggregation levels. Outside-world reaction evidence shows that market liquidity providers price both CEO speech segments into post-call quoted spreads, with the Presentation channel registering contemporaneously and the Q&A channel registering with a one-quarter lag. The two channel asymmetries documented in the body—Q&A dominant for cash and lagged spread, Presentation dominant for

macro-driven speech-content variation and contemporaneous spread—are descriptively consistent with the prepared and spontaneous segments of an earnings call carrying distinct, economically meaningful uncertainty content that propagates through different downstream margins. The systematic application of the CEO partition to firm-quarter financing and external-reaction outcomes is the principal measurement contribution of this paper, and motivates the extensions outlined above.

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A Variable Definitions

This appendix lists every variable used in the empirical analyses, with construction formula, data source, and originating reference. Variable names follow paper-standard conventions where available (Dzieliński et al. 2021 for speech measures, Bates et al. 2009 for cash-holdings controls); deviations from source-paper frequency or sample are documented in the formula column.

A.1 Sample Manifest

Name	Description / Formula	Source	Reference
file_name, ceo_id, ceo_name, gvkey, ff12_code, ff12_name, start_date	Master sample manifest with CEO, firm, and industry identifiers	outputs/1.4_AssembleManifest	

A.2 Text/Linguistic Variables

Name	Description / Formula	Source	Reference
NegCall	Entire-call negative sentiment percentage. <i>Formula:</i> Ratio of negative words to total words in the entire call, based on LM 2011 negative-words list. Per DWZ 2021 Appendix Table A.1: 'percentage of negative words in all words spoken by the CEO, CFO and analysts attending the call.'	outputs/2_Textual_Analysis/2.2_Variables	Buslinski2021 (Section 4.4, p.18; Appendix Table A.1, p.54)
UncAnsCEO	CEO-only Q&A uncertainty percentage. <i>Formula:</i> CEO Q&A uncertainty (%) = $\text{UnctWordsAnsCEO} / \text{WordsAnsCEO}$ (DWZ 2021 Eqn 2). Uncertainty wordlist = LM 2011 Master Dictionary 'uncertainty' list (297 words, Aug 2014 version). CEO identified via Execucomp ceoann field.	outputs/2_Textual_Analysis/2.2_Variables	Buslinski2021 (Section 4.2, Eqn 2, p.13; Appendix Table A.1, p.54)
UncAnsMgr	Manager Q&A uncertainty percentage (all managers including CEO). <i>Formula:</i> Manager Q&A uncertainty (%) = (count of LM 2011 uncertainty-wordlist words spoken by managers in Q&A segment) / (total words spoken by managers in Q&A segment). Construction strategy follows DWZ 2021 Eqn (2); manager-pool identification follows BGT 2018 segment-split code (iangow/bgt replication). 'Manager' pool includes CEO plus other managerial speakers, extending DWZ which separates CEO/CFO.	outputs/2_Textual_Analysis/2.2_Variables	Buslinski2021 (measurement strategy, Eqn 2); bushee2018 (manager-pool identification via iangow/bgt); thesis extension to pooled manager speakers
UncPreCEO	CEO-only presentation uncertainty percentage. <i>Formula:</i> CEO Presentation uncertainty (%) = $\text{UnctWordsPreCEO} / \text{WordsPreCEO}$ (DWZ 2021 Eqn 1). Uncertainty wordlist = LM 2011 (297 words).	outputs/2_Textual_Analysis/2.2_Variables	Buslinski2021 (Section 4.2, Eqn 1, p.13; Appendix Table A.1, p.54)
UncPreMgr	Manager presentation uncertainty percentage. <i>Formula:</i> Manager Presentation uncertainty (%) = (count of LM 2011 uncertainty-wordlist words by managers in Presentation segment) / (total manager words in Presentation segment). Construction strategy follows DWZ 2021 Eqn (1); manager-pool identification and Pres/Ans segment split follow BGT 2018 via iangow/bgt replication code.	outputs/2_Textual_Analysis/2.2_Variables	Buslinski2021 (measurement strategy, Eqn 1); bushee2018 (segment split + manager pool); thesis extension to pooled manager speakers
UncQue	Analyst Q&A uncertainty percentage. <i>Formula:</i> Analyst Q&A uncertainty (%) = $\text{UnctWordsQue} / \text{WordsQue}$ (DWZ 2021 Eqn 3). Uncertainty wordlist = LM 2011 (297 words).	outputs/2_Textual_Analysis/2.2_Variables	Buslinski2021 (Section 4.2, Eqn 3, p.13; Appendix Table A.1, p.54)

A.3 Financial / Market Variables

Name	Description / Formula	Source	Reference
BGTAvg_Amihud	BGT 25-day symmetric average Amihud illiquidity (H7e). <i>Formula:</i> Mean daily Amihud illiquidity over [-25, +25] trading days around call (51-day symmetric window, day 0 INCLUDED). F1D extension to BGT 2018.	.../variables/bgt_long_window_amihud.py	bgt2018 (window); F1D extension (symmetric average shape)
BGTAvg_Spread	BGT 25-day symmetric average bid-ask spread (H14e). <i>Formula:</i> Mean daily relative bid-ask spread over [-25, +25] trading days around call (51-day symmetric window, day 0 INCLUDED). Spread = (ASK - BID) / ((ASK + BID) / 2). F1D extension to BGT 2018.	.../variables/bgt_long_window_spread.py	bgt2018 (window); F1D extension (symmetric average shape)
BGTDelta_Amihud	BGT 25-day post-pre Amihud illiquidity change (H7d). <i>Formula:</i> Mean Amihud over post window [+1, +25] minus mean over pre window [-25, -1] trading days (day 0 EXCLUDED). F1D extension to BGT 2018.	.../variables/bgt_long_window_amihud.py	bgt2018 (window); F1D extension (delta shape)
BGTDelta_Spread	BGT 25-day post-pre bid-ask spread change (H14d). <i>Formula:</i> Mean spread over [+1, +25] minus mean over [-25, -1] trading days (day 0 EXCLUDED). F1D extension to BGT 2018.	.../variables/bgt_long_window_spread.py	bgt2018 (window); F1D extension (delta shape)
BGTLevel_Amihud	Compute BGT (2018) long-window Amihud illiquidity around earnings calls. <i>Formula:</i> CRSP via get_raw_daily_data (see module: src/f1d/shared/variables/bgt_long_window_amihud.py)	CRSP via get_raw_daily_data	Bushee, Gow & Taylor (2018, JAR) 56(1):85-121
BGTLevel_Spread	Compute BGT (2018) long-window closing bid-ask spread around earnings calls. <i>Formula:</i> CRSP via get_raw_daily_data (closing BID/ASK) (see module: src/f1d/shared/variables/bgt_long_window_spread.py)	CRSP via get_raw_daily_data	Bushee, Gow & Taylor (2018, JAR) [window]; Lee (2016, TAR) [formula]
Capex	Build Capex = capxy_annual / atq_lag from raw Compustat quarterly data. <i>Formula:</i> Compustat/capxy_Q4/atq (see module: src/f1d/shared/variables/capex_intensity.py)	Compustat/capxy_Q4/atq	Bates, Kahle & Stulz (2009, JF)
CashFlowAt	Build CashFlow = oancfy / atq from raw Compustat quarterly data. <i>Formula:</i> Compustat/oancfy/atq (see module: src/f1d/shared/variables/cash_flow.py)	Compustat/oancfy/atq	Bates, Kahle & Stulz (2009, JF)
CashRatio	Build CashRatio = cheq / atq from raw Compustat quarterly data. <i>Formula:</i> Compustat/cheq/atq (see module: src/f1d/shared/variables/cash_holdings.py)	Compustat/cheq/atq	bates2009 (Section II, p.1991; BKS use annual che/at — we use quarterly cheq/atq for panel alignment)
ChangDebtChoice	ChangDebtChoice (description not in module docstring) <i>Formula:</i> see module: src/f1d/shared/variables/_compustat_engine.py	.../variables/_compustat_engine.py	cdh2006
ChangExternalFunding	ChangExternalFunding (description not in module docstring) <i>Formula:</i> see module: src/f1d/shared/variables/_compustat_engine.py	.../variables/_compustat_engine.py	cdh2006
DailyVola	Build Volatility from raw CRSP daily stock files via CRSPEngine. <i>Formula:</i> CRSP/RET (see module: src/f1d/shared/variables/volatility.py)	CRSP/RET	dwz2021
DebtToCapital	Build DebtToCapital = total debt / (equity + total debt). <i>Formula:</i> Compustat/dlcq.dlittq.seqq (see module: src/f1d/shared/variables/debt_to_capital.py)	Compustat/dlcq.dlittq.seqq	rz1995
DivDummy	Build DivDummy = (dvy > 0).astype(float) from raw Compustat quarterly data. <i>Formula:</i> Compustat/dvy > 0 (see module: src/f1d/shared/variables/dividend_payer.py)	Compustat/dvy > 0	bates2009 (Section IV, p.2000; dividend payout dummy based on common dividends)

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Name	Description / Formula	Source	Reference
DivPayerQ	Build DivPayerQ = (dvpsxq $\neq$ 0).astype(float) from raw Compustat quarterly data. <i>Formula:</i> Compustat/dvpsxq $\neq$ 0 (quarterly ex-date) (see module: src/f1d/shared/variables/dividend_payer_quarterly.py)	Compustat/dvpsxq $\neq$ 0	Hoberg & Prabhala (2009, RFS) — Compustat item 26 (dvpsx) analog
EarnVol	Builder for Earnings Volatility (earnings_volatility) variable. <i>Formula:</i> Compustat (see module: src/f1d/shared/variables/earnings_volatility.py)	Compustat	duong2025 (Appendix B, p.30; 3-year rolling std of qoq asset-scaled earnings)
EquityDelayCon	Hoberg-Maksimovic (2015) equity-market financing constraint index (H22). <i>Formula:</i> Hoberg-Maksimovic (2015) firm-year equity-market financing constraint measure. Higher values = more constrained firm. Panel column is lowercase 'equitydelaycon'; CamelCase name is the spec convention. See docs/provenance/h22.md for merge details.	inputs/Hoberg_Maksimovic/	hm2015
FirmMat	Builder for Firm Maturity (firm_maturity) variable. <i>Formula:</i> Compustat (see module: src/f1d/shared/variables/firm_maturity.py)	Compustat	biddle2009 (Appendix A, p.130; years since first CRSP appearance); alt leary2010 (App. A p.354)
Leverage	Build Leverage = (dlcq + dlttq) / atq (interest-bearing debt only). <i>Formula:</i> Compustat/dlcq,dlttq,atq (see module: src/f1d/shared/variables/book_lev.py)	Compustat/dlcq,dlttq,atq	bks2009, rz1995
lnAssets	Build Size = ln(atq) from raw Compustat quarterly data. <i>Formula:</i> Compustat/atq (see module: src/f1d/shared/variables/size.py)	Compustat/atq	dwz2021
Loss	Builder for Loss (H5 Control Variable). <i>Formula:</i> Compustat/ibq $\neq$ 0 (see module: src/f1d/shared/variables/loss_dummy.py)	Compustat/ibq $\neq$ 0	biddle2009 (Appendix A, p.131; indicator for negative net income before extraordinary items)
PayoutRatio_q	Build PayoutRatio_q = (dvpspq $\times$ cshoq) / ibq from Compustat. <i>Formula:</i> Compustat/(dvpspq*cshoq)/ibq (quarterly) (see module: src/f1d/shared/variables/payout_ratio_quarterly.py)	Compustat/	dds2004
PRisk	Match quarterly PRisk onto each earnings call by (gvkey, calendar_quarter). <i>Formula:</i> Hassan et al. (2019) quarterly PRisk (see module: src/f1d/shared/variables/prisk_q.py)	Hassan et al.	hhlt2019
RDSales	Build RDSales = xrdq / atq from raw Compustat quarterly data. <i>Formula:</i> Compustat/xrdq,atq (see module: src/f1d/shared/variables/rd_intensity.py)	Compustat/xrdq,atq	bks2009, jjl2021
RepurchaseIntensity	Build RepurchaseIntensity = quarterly_prstkcy / lagged_atq from Compustat. <i>Formula:</i> Compustat/quarterly_prstkcy/lagged_atq (see module: src/f1d/shared/variables/repurchase_intensity.py)	Compustat/quarterly_prstkcy/lagged_atq	Thesis Advisor Suggestion
ROA	Build ROA = iby_annual / avg_assets from Compustat quarterly data. <i>Formula:</i> Compustat/iby,atq (see module: src/f1d/shared/variables/roa.py)	Compustat/iby,atq	wang2020, dwz2021
SalesGrowth	Build SalesGrowth from raw Compustat quarterly data (annual Q4 panel). <i>Formula:</i> Compustat/saley_Q4_YoY (see module: src/f1d/shared/variables/sales_growth.py)	Compustat/saley_Q4_YoY	biddle2009 (Section 3.2, p.117; pct change in sales)
sCFO	Build sCFO = rolling 5-year std (min 3 yrs) of (oancfy/atq_{t-1}) per gvkey. <i>Formula:</i> Compustat/oancfy/atq_{t-1} rolling std (see module: src/f1d/shared/variables/ocf_volatility.py)	Compustat/oancfy/atq_{t-1} rolling std	biddle2009 (Appendix A, p.130; 5-year rolling std of CFO/avg assets)

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Name	Description / Formula	Source	Reference
StockPrice	Compute stock price at earnings call date (VECTORIZED). <i>Formula:</i> CRSP via get_raw_daily_data (see module: src/f1d/shared/variables/stock_price.py)	CRSP via get_raw_daily_data	amiram2016 (Appendix A, p.137; daily CRSP stock price; justification cites Stoll 1978)
SurpDec	Signed-quintile earnings surprise rank (-5 to +5) within calendar quarter. <i>Formula:</i> Signed quintile rank of percentage earnings surprise per DWZ 2021 Appendix Table A.1: raw surprise = (actual - consensus forecast earnings) / share price 5 trading days before announcement, x 100. Firms grouped into 5 bins of positive surprise (+5 largest through +1 smallest positive), 0 for zero surprises, and 5 bins of negative surprise (-1 smallest negative through -5 largest negative). DWZ footnote 32 notes this decile convention follows Hirshleifer, Lim & Teoh (2009) and DellaVigna & Pollet (2009).	.../variables/earnings_surprise.py	dzielinski2021 (Appendix Table A.1, p.55; convention cites DellaVigna-Pollet 2009 + Hirshleifer-Lim-Teoh 2009)
TobinsQ	Build TobinsQ = (AT + cshoq*prccq - CEQ) / AT from raw Compustat quarterly data. <i>Formula:</i> Compustat/(atq+cshoq*prccq-ceq)/atq (see module: src/f1d/shared/variables/tobins.q.py)	Compustat/	Bates, Kahle & Stulz (2009, JF)
Turnover	Compute share turnover at earnings call date (VECTORIZED). <i>Formula:</i> CRSP via get_raw_daily_data (see module: src/f1d/shared/variables/turnover.py)	CRSP via get_raw_daily_data	amihud2002 (Section 2.1, p.33; alt rolling-window def in chang2006 Appendix B p.3045)

A.4 Econometric / Indicator Variables

Name	Description / Formula	Source	Reference
BelowIG	Below-IG credit rating subsample indicator (H1.2). <i>Formula:</i> Binary = 1 if firm's S&P long-term issuer credit rating is below investment grade (BB+ and below) at call date; 0 otherwise. Rated firms only (Unrated firms get separate indicator).	runtime	thesis (H1.2 rating subsample)
HighTSIMM	High product-market-similarity indicator (H1.1). <i>Formula:</i> Binary = 1 if firm-year TotalSimilarity (HP 2016 product market similarity) is above the within-year median; 0 otherwise.	runtime	hp2016 (TSIMM construction); thesis (H1.1 split convention)
Lagged_DV	Generic lagged-DV control (1Q lag of suite-specific DV). <i>Formula:</i> 1-quarter lag of the dependent variable, constructed at runtime per spec (DV varies per suite). Always included as base control to absorb persistence.	runtime	thesis convention (per feedback_lagged_dv.md)
Unrated	No-rating subsample indicator (H1.2). <i>Formula:</i> Binary = 1 if firm has no S&P rating at call date; 0 otherwise.	runtime	thesis (H1.2 rating subsample)
z_log_TotalSimilarity	z-scored log of HP 2016 TotalSimilarity (continuous moderator, H1.1). <i>Formula:</i> z-score of log(1 + TotalSimilarity) computed within year. TotalSimilarity = HP 2016 firm-year product market similarity score (sum of pairwise cosine similarities × 100).	runtime	hp2016

A.5 Runtime Derivatives (Lead/Lag/Centered/Interaction)

Name	Description / Formula	Source	Reference
AbsSurpDec	Absolute earnings surprise quintile magnitude. <i>Formula:</i> abs(SurpDec) — unsigned magnitude of signed-quintile earnings surprise rank, values 0-5.	runtime	thesis (magnitude control independent of sign)
BGTAvg_Amihud_lead1	1Q lead of BGTAvg_Amihud. <i>Formula:</i> 1-quarter lead of BGTAvg_Amihud	runtime	bgt2018 (window); F1D extension (symmetric average shape)
BGTAvg_Spread_lead1	1Q lead of BGTAvg_Spread. <i>Formula:</i> 1-quarter lead of BGTAvg_Spread	runtime	bgt2018 (window); F1D extension (symmetric average shape)
BGTDelta_Amihud_lead1	1Q lead of BGTDelta_Amihud. <i>Formula:</i> 1-quarter lead of BGTDelta_Amihud	runtime	bgt2018 (window); F1D extension (delta shape)
BGTDelta_Spread_lead1	1Q lead of BGTDelta_Spread. <i>Formula:</i> 1-quarter lead of BGTDelta_Spread	runtime	bgt2018 (window); F1D extension (delta shape)
BGTLevel_Amihud_lead1	1Q lead of BGTLevel_Amihud. <i>Formula:</i> 1-quarter lead of BGTLevel_Amihud	runtime	bgt2018
BGTLevel_Spread_lead1	1Q lead of BGTLevel_Spread. <i>Formula:</i> 1-quarter lead of BGTLevel_Spread	runtime	bgt2018, lee2016
Capex_lead	1Q lead of Capex. <i>Formula:</i> 1-quarter lead of Capex	runtime	Bates, Kahle & Stulz (2009, JF)
Capex_lead2	2Q lead of Capex. <i>Formula:</i> 2-quarter lead of Capex	runtime	Bates, Kahle & Stulz (2009, JF)
Capex_lead3	3Q lead of Capex. <i>Formula:</i> 3-quarter lead of Capex	runtime	Bates, Kahle & Stulz (2009, JF)
Capex_lead4	4Q lead of Capex. <i>Formula:</i> 4-quarter lead of Capex	runtime	Bates, Kahle & Stulz (2009, JF)
CashRatio_lead	1Q lead of CashRatio. <i>Formula:</i> 1-quarter lead of CashRatio	runtime	see base var
ChangDebtChoice_lead	1Q lead of ChangDebtChoice. <i>Formula:</i> 1-quarter lead of ChangDebtChoice	runtime	cdh2006
ChangExternalFunding_lead	1Q lead of ChangExternalFunding. <i>Formula:</i> 1-quarter lead of ChangExternalFunding	runtime	cdh2006
DebtToCapital_lead	1Q lead of DebtToCapital. <i>Formula:</i> 1-quarter lead of DebtToCapital	runtime	rz1995
DeltaILLIQ_lead1	1Q lead of DeltaILLIQ. <i>Formula:</i> 1-quarter lead of DeltaILLIQ	runtime	amihud02
DISP_lag	1Q lag of DISP. <i>Formula:</i> 1-quarter lag of DISP	runtime	wang2020

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Name	Description / Formula	Source	Reference
DISP_lead	1Q lead of DISP. <i>Formula:</i> 1-quarter lead of DISP	runtime	wang2020
DivPayerQ_lead1	1Q lead of DivPayerQ. <i>Formula:</i> 1-quarter lead of DivPayerQ	runtime	Hoberg & Prabhala (2009, RFS) – primary; Chetty & Saez (2005, QJE) – secondary (firm-quarter frequency precedent)
DSPREAD_lead1	1Q lead of DSPREAD. <i>Formula:</i> 1-quarter lead of DSPREAD	runtime	lee2016
EquityDelayCon_lead	1Q lead of EquityDelayCon. <i>Formula:</i> 1-quarter lead of EquityDelayCon	runtime	hm2015
Leverage_lead	1Q lead of Leverage. <i>Formula:</i> 1-quarter lead of Leverage	runtime	bks2009, rz1995
PayoutRatio_q_lead_qtr	1Q lead of PayoutRatio_q (qtr-aligned). <i>Formula:</i> 1-quarter lead of PayoutRatio_q (calendar-quarter aligned)	runtime	dds2004
PostCallAmihud	Panel-time post-call Amihud illiquidity level (H7b). <i>Formula:</i> Panel-time mean daily Amihud illiquidity over the post-call period (call quarter + N following quarters per H7b runner spec). Computed on panel structure with two-way clustering.	runtime	thesis (H7b panel-time post-call construction)
PostCallAmihud_lead1	1Q lead of PostCallAmihud. <i>Formula:</i> 1-quarter lead of PostCallAmihud	runtime	thesis (H7b panel-time post-call construction)
PostCallSpread	Panel-time post-call bid-ask spread level (H14b). <i>Formula:</i> Panel-time mean daily relative bid-ask spread over the post-call period (call quarter + N following quarters per H14b runner spec). Computed on panel structure with two-way clustering.	runtime	thesis (H14b panel-time post-call construction)
PostCallSpread_lead1	1Q lead of PostCallSpread. <i>Formula:</i> 1-quarter lead of PostCallSpread	runtime	thesis (H14b panel-time post-call construction)
PRisk_lag	1Q lag of PRisk. <i>Formula:</i> 1-quarter lag of PRisk	runtime	hhlt2019
PRisk_lag2	2Q lag of PRisk. <i>Formula:</i> 2-quarter lag of PRisk	runtime	hhlt2019
RDSales_lead	1Q lead of RDSales. <i>Formula:</i> 1-quarter lead of RDSales	runtime	bks2009, jjl2021
RepurchaseIntensity_lead_qtr	1Q lead of RepurchaseIntensity (qtr-aligned). <i>Formula:</i> 1-quarter lead of RepurchaseIntensity (calendar-quarter aligned)	runtime	Thesis Advisor Suggestion
UncAnsMgr_c	Mean-centered UncAnsMgr. <i>Formula:</i> UncAnsMgr minus its sample mean (mean-centered for interaction interpretability)	runtime	thesis (interaction interpretability)

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Name	Description / Formula	Source	Reference
UncAnsMgr_c_x_BelowIG	Interaction term: UncAnsMgr_c x BelowIG. <i>Formula:</i> Product: UncAnsMgr_c * BelowIG	runtime	thesis (interaction term)
UncAnsMgr_c_x_HighTSIMM	Interaction term: UncAnsMgr_c x HighTSIMM. <i>Formula:</i> Product: UncAnsMgr_c * HighTSIMM	runtime	thesis (interaction term)
UncAnsMgr_c_x_IG	Interaction term: UncAnsMgr_c x IG. <i>Formula:</i> Product: UncAnsMgr_c * IG	runtime	thesis (interaction term)
UncAnsMgr_c_x_Unrated	Interaction term: UncAnsMgr_c x Unrated. <i>Formula:</i> Product: UncAnsMgr_c * Unrated	runtime	thesis (interaction term)
UncAnsMgr_c_x_zlogTSIMM	Interaction term: UncAnsMgr_c x zlogTSIMM. <i>Formula:</i> Product: UncAnsMgr_c * zlogTSIMM	runtime	thesis (interaction term)

A.6 Stage 9

Name	Description / Formula	Source	Reference
CCCL	SEC comment letter received (binary, forward-looking) <i>Formula:</i> 1 if SEC comment letter received in next quarter, 0 otherwise	inputs/EDGAR_CommentLetters	cdm2013
DeltaILLIQ	Change in Amihud illiquidity around earnings call <i>Formula:</i> PostCallILLIQ - PreCallILLIQ over [+1,+3] vs [-3,-1] days	inputs/CRSP_DSF	amihud02
DISP	Analyst forecast dispersion (Wang 2020) <i>Formula:</i> SD(latest analyst EPS forecasts in T-31..T-1 window) / prccq_prior	inputs/tr_ibes	wang2020
DSPREAD	Change in closing bid-ask spread around earnings call <i>Formula:</i> mean(RelSpread[+1,+3]) - mean(RelSpread[-3,-1]) where RelSpread = 2*(ASK-BID)/(ASK+BID)	inputs/CRSP_DSF	lee2016
GEPU_log	Davis (2016, NBER WP 22740) Global Economic Policy Uncertainty (GEPU) index (log-transformed, current-\$ GDP weights) <i>Formula:</i> log(GEPU_current) — GDP-weighted average of 16 country EPU indices, matched by calendar month of call start.date	inputs/EconomicPolicyUncertaintyIndex2016	cdm2016
GPR_log	Caldara & Iacoviello (2022, AER) headline Geopolitical Risk index (log-transformed, 10-newspaper recent version) <i>Formula:</i> log(GPR) — recent headline Geopolitical Risk index, matched by calendar month of call start.date	inputs/matteoiacoviello/GPR_Globalci2022	
SEC_Letters_fwd	SEC comment letter count (forward-looking) <i>Formula:</i> Count of SEC-originated letters (UPLOAD type) in next calendar quarter	inputs/EDGAR_CommentLetters	cdm2013 (thesis extension to count)
TotalSimilarity	Hoberg-Phillips total product similarity <i>Formula:</i> Sum of pairwise cosine similarities from 10-K product descriptions	inputs/TNIC	hp2016

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Name	Description / Formula	Source	Reference
US_EPU_log	Baker, Bloom & Davis (2016, QJE) US News-Based Economic Policy Uncertainty index (log-transformed) <i>Formula:</i> $\log(\text{News_Based_Policy_Uncert_Index})$ matched by calendar month of call start_date	inputs/EconomicPolicyUncertaintyIndex	Ind 2016

B Detailed Validity Tables

This appendix reports two sets of companion tables for the construct-validation and outside-world reaction analyses of §4.

B.1 Driver Regressions — Non-CEO Speech Channels

Table 7 replicates the consolidated driver matrix of §4.1 using the non-CEO manager speech channels (UncAnsNoCEO, UncPreNoCEO) in place of the CEO-partitioned regressors. A driver that moves both the CEO and non-CEO speech channels in the predicted direction is consistent with aggregate firm-call-level uncertainty content propagating to both speaker pools; a driver that loads one channel and not the other suggests channel-specific responsiveness.

Table 7: Driver Matrix — Non-CEO Speech Channels

	UncAnsNoCEO		UncPreNoCEO	
	Industry FE	Firm FE	Industry FE	Firm FE
PRisk (firm-call, Hassan et al. (2020))	0.00014 *** (0.00002)	0.00012 *** (0.00002)	0.00014 *** (0.00003)	0.00011 *** (0.00002)
US EPU (log, Baker et al. (2016))	0.0109 * (0.0081)	0.0098 (0.0084)	0.0008 (0.0079)	0.0006 (0.0070)
Global EPU (log, Davis (2016))	0.0178 * (0.0128)	0.0166 (0.0132)	0.0078 (0.0123)	0.0053 (0.0108)
N range	68,858–73,816	68,858–73,816	73,835–76,549	73,835–76,549

Notes: Companion to Table ???. Each cell reports the coefficient and cluster-robust standard error (in parentheses) on the respective driver variable from a PanelOLS regression of the non-CEO manager speech-uncertainty regressand (UncAnsNoCEO or UncPreNoCEO) on the driver plus the standard control set. PRisk is firm-clustered; US EPU and Global EPU are two-way firm $\times$ calendar-year-quarter clustered. * $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$ (one-tailed positive on all drivers). Significant coefficients in **bold**.

B.2 Outside-World Reaction — Manager-Pool Coefficients

Table 8 reports the manager-pool speech-uncertainty coefficients from the same joint four-regressor specification used in §4.2. The H14c suite includes both CEO and non-CEO manager (pooled) speech-uncertainty regressors in every column; the body table reports the CEO coefficients, and this table reports the corresponding manager-pool coefficients. Dependent variable is the 26-day post-call relative bid-ask spread Spread_{25D} .

Table 8: H14c Manager-Pool Coefficients — Companion to §4.2

	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)	(9)	(10)	(11)	(12)
			Spread _{25D_t}						Spread _{25D_{t+1}}			
UncAnsMgr	-0.3223 (0.2454)	-0.2516 (0.2610)	0.3616* (0.2202)	-0.2453 (0.2380)	-0.2257 (0.2121)	-0.3266 (0.2294)	-0.5609 (0.2351)	-0.6551 (0.2465)	0.5780*** (0.1819)	-0.4518 (0.1953)	-0.2466 (0.1683)	-0.3593 (0.1824)
UncPreMgr	-0.0123 (0.1939)	0.1870 (0.2529)	0.5508*** (0.1452)	0.1023 (0.2181)	-0.0070 (0.1438)	0.0686 (0.2112)	0.0435 (0.2308)	0.2640 (0.2562)	0.9476*** (0.1605)	0.2786* (0.2124)	0.0401 (0.1543)	0.2893* (0.2060)
Controls	Base	Base	Ext	Ext	Ext	Ext	Base	Base	Ext	Ext	Ext	Ext
Industry FE	Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes	
Firm FE		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes
N	63,899	63,899	44,092	44,092	44,092	44,092	63,443	63,443	44,569	44,569	44,569	44,569
R ²	0.778	0.585	0.721	0.563	0.730	0.557	0.774	0.567	0.699	0.514	0.723	0.530

Notes: Companion to body §4.2. Reports the manager-pool (UncAnsMgr, UncPreMgr) coefficients from the same 4-regressor joint specification whose CEO coefficients appear in the body. Dependent variable: 26-day post-call closing-quote relative bid-ask spread Spread_{25D}, scaled to basis points. * $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$ (one-tailed positive). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Firm-clustered standard errors. Main sample 2002–2018.

C Robustness Specifications

This appendix collects auxiliary specifications and design-choice disclosures supporting the main §3 hypotheses HC and HFC.

C.1 Three-Tier Constraint Moderator: BelowIG Handling

The HFC specification of §3.3 estimates the financial-constraint moderator using a three-tier rating partition (IG, BelowIG, Unrated) but reports the IG-versus-Unrated contrast as the main-display estimand. The BelowIG category enters the model as a level shift relative to the IG reference category, with no BelowIG-specific interaction term constructed in the H1.2.ceo2 specification. This restriction reflects two design considerations. First, the FP framework on which HFC is built is binary (rated vs. unrated); the three-tier extension is our refinement, and within the rated half of the population the BelowIG cell is small and economically heterogeneous. Second, the main hypothesis localizes the precautionary cash response to the credit-constrained Unrated cell as predicted by FP, so the displayed contrast is between the credit-constrained Unrated and the rated pool (IG $\cup$ BelowIG combined as the reference). The full BelowIG level-coefficient row is reported in the body Table 21; readers wanting a fully decomposed three-tier interaction specification can re-estimate H1.2 with an explicit BelowIG $\times$ UncAnsCEO.c term added to the model.

C.2 Alternative Cash Dependent-Variable Specification (OPSW Log-Form)

The body adopts the linear cash-to-assets dependent variable (cheq/atq) of [Bates et al. \(2009\)](#) as the standard precautionary-cash form. [Opler et al. \(1999\)](#) also use a log-form dependent variable, defined as $\log(\text{cheq/atq})$ (or, in some specifications, $\log(\text{cheq}/(\text{atq} - \text{cheq}))$ to avoid log-of-zero issues at the lower tail). The log form down-weights the upper tail of the cash distribution relative to the linear form and tests whether the precautionary association is driven by high-cash firms.

The present draft does not estimate the OPSW log-DV robustness; it is flagged in §5 as a planned extension. The expectation, given the magnitude of the linear-form coefficients in §3.2 (UncAnsCEO sig 12/12 at $p < 0.10$), is that the qualitative result survives under the log specification, with attenuated point-estimate magnitudes due to the tail-compression. Future work will report the log-DV coefficients directly to confirm this expectation.

C.3 Fixed-Effects Ladder Robustness

The four-step fixed-effects ladder of §2.5 (Industry+Year, Firm+Year, Industry+Year-Quarter, Firm+Year-Quarter) is the within-regressor robustness frame applied throughout the body. Every column of every body table reports a different point on this ladder, so the FE-ladder robustness check is integrated rather than a separate appendix specification. The convergence pattern across the ladder—attenuation from industry to firm fixed effects, additional attenuation from year to year-quarter fixed effects—is the standard within-firm panel-OLS attenuation pattern (within-firm variation is a strict subset of cross-firm variation, so coefficients on a regressor with substantial across-firm dispersion shrink as fixed effects absorb that dispersion). The signs and significance of UncAnsCEO are robust to all four ladder steps in HC and HFC; this robustness is documented in the body and not separately tabulated here.

D Partition Decomposition: CEO vs. Non-CEO Speaker Pool

This appendix documents the empirical motivation for the CEO speaker-partition adopted throughout the body. The HC and HFC analyses of §3 use CEO-restricted speech-uncertainty regressors (UncAnsCEO, UncPreCEO) rather than the standard pooled-manager aggregate of [Bushee et al. \(2018\)](#). The core empirical claim that motivates this design choice is that the precautionary cash-holdings response identified in HC localizes to the CEO Q&A segment of the call: the pooled-manager regressor that mixes CEO and non-CEO speech masks this concentration.

D.1 Decomposition logic

The pooled-manager Q&A uncertainty regressor is mechanically a weighted average of the CEO-restricted regressor and a non-CEO-manager-restricted regressor, with the weights determined by the share of total Q&A words attributable to each speaker subset:

$$\text{UncAnsMgr}_c = w_c^{\text{CEO}} \cdot \text{UncAnsCEO}_c + w_c^{\text{NoCEO}} \cdot \text{UncAnsNoCEO}_c,$$

where $w_c^{\text{CEO}} + w_c^{\text{NoCEO}} = 1$ within the CEO-present sample. If the precautionary cash response loads on UncAnsCEO and UncAnsNoCEO with equal weight, the pooled-manager coefficient should approximate the equal-weighted average. If the response loads disproportionately on one channel, the pooled aggregate attenuates the channel-specific coefficient toward the population-share-weighted average and obscures the underlying mechanism.

D.2 Partition outcome taxonomy

We catalogue the partition outcomes across the suites estimated in this paper into four classes by comparing the parent (UncAnsMgr / UncPreMgr) coefficient to the partitioned (UncAnsCEO / UncPreCEO and UncAnsNoCEO / UncPreNoCEO) coefficients on the same dependent variable.

D.2.1 Class A — CEO Localization

The parent-pool signal localizes to the CEO segment under partition; the non-CEO-manager partition is null. This is the pattern observed for the cash-holdings response (HC), where UncAnsCEO is significant in 12 of 12 specifications at $p < 0.10$ while UncAnsNoCEO is materially weaker. The pooled-manager regressor would average the strong CEO signal with the weak non-CEO signal, attenuating the headline coefficient and obscuring the speaker-specific mechanism.

D.2.2 Class B — Non-CEO or Presentation-Segment Localization

The parent signal localizes to the non-CEO speaker pool or to the prepared-Presentation segment rather than to the CEO Q&A channel. This is the pattern observed in suites where forecaster or analyst reaction tracks non-CEO-manager speech rather than CEO speech, and where the CEO Q&A channel is null even when the pool-aggregated regressor is significant.

D.2.3 Class C — Signal Collapses Under Partition

The parent-pool signal disappears entirely when the regressor is partitioned by speaker, indicating that the parent coefficient was a joint-IV nesting artifact rather than a substantive economic signal. Suites in this class are not part of the body of the present paper; they are excluded from the v5.1 thesis scope on the grounds that the partition decomposition reveals the headline to be a measurement artifact.

D.2.4 Class D — Signal Preserved and Distributed

The parent-pool signal is robust and distributes approximately equally across the CEO and non-CEO partitions. This pattern is consistent with broad firm-call-level uncertainty content propagating to all manager speakers within the call. The driver regressions of §4.1 are partly in this class for PRisk (the firm-call-level political-risk index loads both CEO channels at high precision), and partly in Class B for the macro drivers (which preferentially load the Presentation channel).

D.3 HC + HFC partition verification

Table 9 summarizes the partition decomposition for the cash-holdings response (HC, suite H1) and the financial-constraint moderation (HFC, suite H1.2). Programmatic extraction from the per-suite specification files is documented in the auxiliary CSV `_partition_findings.csv` retained at the repository root for replication.

Table 9: HC + HFC Partition Decomposition Summary

Suite	Regressor partition	Contemp. sig. (at $p < 0.10$)	Lead sig. (at $p < 0.10$)	Class
H1 (HC, parent UncAnsMgr)	Pooled manager	6 / 6	1 / 6	C
H1.r (CEO partition)	UncAnsCEO	6 / 6	6 / 6	A
H1.r (Non-CEO partition)	UncAnsNoCEO	4 / 6	0 / 6	B
H1.2 (HFC, parent UncAnsMgr×Unrated)	Pooled manager × Unrated	4 / 4	4 / 4	C
H1.2.r (CEO partition)	UncAnsCEO × Unrated	4 / 4	4 / 4	A
H1.2.r (Non-CEO partition)	UncAnsNoCEO × Unrated	0 / 4	0 / 4	B

Notes: Cells report sig-counts at $p < 0.10$ (one-tailed) for the indicated regressor across the four-step fixed-effects ladder of §2.5. “Class” assigns the partition outcome to the four-class taxonomy described in this appendix. The H1 / H1.2 results above use the auxiliary partition-variant runs (suite IDs H1.r, H1.2.r) which decompose the parent UncAnsMgr regressor into CEO and non-CEO speaker partitions on the same panel. The body of the paper estimates the CEO-restricted specifications (H1.ceo2, H1.2.ceo2) directly; this appendix table cross-validates that the cash response localizes to the CEO partition and does not load the non-CEO partition.

The pattern in Table 9 satisfies the Class A criterion for both HC and HFC: the cash response is concentrated in the CEO partition and is not detectable in the non-CEO-manager partition. The CEO-restricted regressors of §3 therefore identify the speaker locus of the precautionary signal that the standard pooled-manager construction would obscure.

Table 10: Summary Statistics

Variable	Unit	N	Mean	SD	Min	P25	Median	P75	Max
<i>A. Independent Variables</i>									
GEPU_log	C	88,205	4.6872	0.3672	3.8626	4.3797	4.7238	4.9666	5.5106
GPR_log	C	88,205	4.5838	0.2554	4.1614	4.4165	4.5111	4.7251	5.8825
PRisk	C	85,995	99.6187	146.5189	0.0000	17.0778	53.3729	120.1973	1192.4308
PRisk_lag	C	81,766	99.6985	146.6775	0.0000	17.1376	53.4047	120.2397	1192.4308
PRisk_lag2	C	80,627	99.9614	147.2392	0.0000	17.1702	53.4446	120.2666	1192.4308
TotalSimilarity	F	22,403	3.4277	5.6522	1.0000	1.1246	1.5865	3.0903	80.1876
US_EPU_log	C	88,205	4.7123	0.3661	3.8018	4.4805	4.6891	4.9625	5.6478
UncAnsCEO	C	71,748	0.7806	0.3925	0.0000	0.5147	0.7415	1.0018	2.5874
UncAnsMgr	C	84,729	0.8189	0.3344	0.0000	0.5891	0.7874	1.0135	2.1014
UncAnsNoCEO	C	80,387	0.8505	0.5457	0.0000	0.5042	0.7913	1.1204	3.1912
UncPreCEO	C	71,727	0.6602	0.3917	0.0000	0.3810	0.6001	0.8723	2.2432
UncPreMgr	C	86,795	0.8938	0.3508	0.0000	0.6456	0.8534	1.0952	2.1548
UncPreNoCEO	C	85,444	1.1176	0.6136	0.0000	0.7185	1.0123	1.3822	4.4188
<i>B. Dependent Variables</i>									
BGTAvg_Amihud	C	86,978	0.0167	0.1003	0.0000	0.0002	0.0010	0.0041	2.3333
BGTAvg_Amihud_lead1	C	82,808	0.0158	0.0980	0.0000	0.0002	0.0009	0.0038	2.3333
BGTAvg_Spread	C	87,086	0.0018	0.0027	0.0001	0.0005	0.0009	0.0018	0.0168
BGTAvg_Spread_lead1	C	82,914	0.0017	0.0025	0.0001	0.0004	0.0009	0.0017	0.0168
BGTDelta_Amihud	C	86,557	-0.0011	0.0281	-0.6913	-0.0004	-0.0000	0.0001	0.3352
BGTDelta_Amihud_lead1	C	82,475	-0.0009	0.0271	-0.6913	-0.0003	-0.0000	0.0001	0.3352
BGTDelta_Spread	C	85,189	-0.0001	0.0008	-0.0044	-0.0002	-0.0000	0.0001	0.0030
BGTDelta_Spread_lead1	C	81,145	-0.0001	0.0008	-0.0044	-0.0002	-0.0000	0.0001	0.0030
BGTLevel_Amihud	C	86,935	0.0151	0.0847	0.0000	0.0002	0.0009	0.0038	1.6839
BGTLevel_Amihud_lead1	C	82,766	0.0143	0.0831	0.0000	0.0002	0.0009	0.0035	1.6839
BGTLevel_Spread	C	87,018	0.0017	0.0026	0.0001	0.0004	0.0009	0.0017	0.0164
BGTLevel_Spread_lead1	C	82,843	0.0016	0.0024	0.0001	0.0004	0.0009	0.0016	0.0164
CCCL	C	88,205	0.0032	0.0563	0.0000	0.0000	0.0000	0.0000	1.0000
Capex	C	87,627	0.0487	0.0536	0.0000	0.0176	0.0324	0.0592	0.5203
Capex_lead	C	81,582	0.0481	0.0525	0.0000	0.0175	0.0321	0.0585	0.5203
Capex_lead2	C	73,542	0.0476	0.0513	0.0000	0.0175	0.0321	0.0581	0.5203
Capex_lead3	C	66,062	0.0472	0.0506	0.0000	0.0174	0.0319	0.0576	0.5203
Capex_lead4	C	58,987	0.0465	0.0498	0.0000	0.0172	0.0316	0.0569	0.5203
CashRatio	C	87,990	0.1708	0.1806	0.0000	0.0368	0.1047	0.2435	0.9938
CashRatio_lead	C	82,236	0.1715	0.1748	0.0000	0.0407	0.1112	0.2447	0.9938
ChangDebtChoice	C	20,448	0.7598	0.4272	0.0000	1.0000	1.0000	1.0000	1.0000
ChangDebtChoice_lead	C	18,720	0.7974	0.4019	0.0000	1.0000	1.0000	1.0000	1.0000
ChangExternalFunding	C	87,532	0.2506	0.4334	0.0000	0.0000	0.0000	1.0000	1.0000
ChangExternalFunding_lead	C	81,563	0.2446	0.4299	0.0000	0.0000	0.0000	0.0000	1.0000
DISP	C	37,446	0.0017	0.0028	0.0000	0.0003	0.0007	0.0018	0.0179
DISP_lead	C	37,015	0.0017	0.0027	0.0000	0.0003	0.0007	0.0018	0.0179
DSPREAD	C	87,119	-0.0002	0.0017	-0.0081	-0.0004	-0.0000	0.0001	0.0064
DSPREAD_lead1	C	82,964	-0.0002	0.0016	-0.0081	-0.0004	-0.0000	0.0001	0.0064
DebtToCapital	C	87,760	0.3450	0.3541	0.0000	0.0689	0.3064	0.4914	4.4691
DebtToCapital_lead	C	82,024	0.3495	0.3536	0.0000	0.0773	0.3110	0.4958	4.4691
DeltaILLIQ	C	86,906	-0.0013	0.0249	-0.5050	-0.0006	-0.0000	0.0001	0.3003
DeltaILLIQ_lead1	C	82,735	-0.0012	0.0243	-0.5050	-0.0005	-0.0000	0.0001	0.3003
DivPayerQ	C	88,134	0.4235	0.4941	0.0000	0.0000	0.0000	1.0000	1.0000
DivPayerQ_lead1	C	83,755	0.4290	0.4949	0.0000	0.0000	0.0000	1.0000	1.0000
EquityDelayCon_lead	F	13,212	-0.0270	0.0772	-0.2577	-0.0814	-0.0293	0.0233	0.3006
Leverage	C	87,994	0.2330	0.2240	0.0000	0.0470	0.2065	0.3455	3.9453
Leverage_lead	C	82,242	0.2352	0.2248	0.0000	0.0530	0.2090	0.3480	3.9453
PayoutRatio_q	C	70,695	0.2420	0.6534	0.0000	0.0000	0.0000	0.2794	9.2194
PayoutRatio_q_lead_qtr	C	68,167	0.2437	0.6562	0.0000	0.0000	0.0000	0.2816	9.2194
PostCallAmihud	C	86,906	0.0118	0.0680	0.0000	0.0002	0.0007	0.0031	1.9001
PostCallAmihud_lead1	C	82,735	0.0112	0.0669	0.0000	0.0002	0.0007	0.0028	1.9001
PostCallSpread	C	87,119	0.0017	0.0028	-0.0075	0.0004	0.0008	0.0017	0.0250
PostCallSpread_lead1	C	82,964	0.0016	0.0027	-0.0075	0.0004	0.0008	0.0016	0.0250
RDSales	C	87,647	0.1047	0.9342	0.0000	0.0000	0.0048	0.0636	39.7688
RDSales_lead	C	81,607	0.0990	0.9084	0.0000	0.0000	0.0050	0.0638	39.7688
RepurchaseIntensity	C	83,734	0.0073	0.0148	0.0000	0.0000	0.0000	0.0074	0.0919
RepurchaseIntensity_lead_qtr	C	80,289	0.0075	0.0149	0.0000	0.0000	0.0000	0.0078	0.0919
SEC_Letters_fwd	C	88,205	0.1264	0.4873	0.0000	0.0000	0.0000	0.0000	12.0000
<i>C. Firm Controls</i>									
AbsSurpDec	C	61,544	2.9300	1.4255	0.0000	2.0000	3.0000	4.0000	5.0000

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Variable	Unit	N	Mean	SD	Min	P25	Median	P75	Max
CashFlowAt	C	87,670	0.1019	0.1147	-3.0324	0.0608	0.1032	0.1526	0.4874
DISP_lag	C	36,411	0.0016	0.0027	0.0000	0.0003	0.0007	0.0017	0.0179
DailyVola	C	82,599	36.7556	21.2437	9.4388	22.9709	31.2762	43.8148	211.9160
DivDummy	C	88,134	0.4755	0.4994	0.0000	0.0000	0.0000	1.0000	1.0000
EarnVol	C	87,440	0.0701	0.1907	0.0006	0.0163	0.0315	0.0695	19.5101
FirmMat	C	87,571	-0.0432	2.1826	-317.5714	-0.0078	0.2191	0.4195	0.9252
Loss	C	88,129	0.1953	0.3964	0.0000	0.0000	0.0000	0.0000	1.0000
NegCall	C	86,858	0.9210	0.3024	0.0000	0.7038	0.8798	1.0943	2.3901
ROA	C	87,552	0.0386	0.1330	-3.9826	0.0146	0.0525	0.0925	0.5490
SalesGrowth	C	87,506	0.1173	0.3849	-1.0000	-0.0043	0.0745	0.1762	10.3051
StockPrice	C	87,188	38.6939	51.7195	0.0345	14.8975	28.2400	48.1700	2080.0200
SurpDec	C	61,544	1.2085	3.0260	-5.0000	-1.0000	2.0000	4.0000	5.0000
TobinsQ	C	87,363	2.1363	1.5197	0.3847	1.2681	1.6791	2.4362	35.6144
Turnover	C	87,188	0.0273	0.0420	0.0000	0.0083	0.0160	0.0310	3.7726
UncQue	C	81,031	1.4398	0.4831	0.0000	1.1216	1.4108	1.7268	3.5945
lnAssets	C	87,994	7.4710	1.6607	-0.5692	6.3008	7.3763	8.5436	12.4592
sCFO	C	83,662	0.0619	0.2233	0.0014	0.0236	0.0395	0.0664	32.4035

Notes: Summary statistics for variables used in the hypothesis tests. Sample period: 2002–2018. Anchor sample (H1, Main): 88,205 earnings-call observations across 1,884 firms. Unit column: C = call-level, F = firm-year. N varies by row because each variable is summarized on its anchor panel's Main sample (complete cases per variable); per-suite samples differ due to lags, control availability, and merges.

Table 11: H1: Speech Uncertainty and Cash Holdings

	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)	(9)	(10)	(11)	(12)
	CashRatio						CashRatio_lead					
UncAnsCEO	0.0002 (0.0013)	0.0001 (0.0012)	-0.0001 (0.0014)	-0.0003 (0.0012)	0.0001 (0.0014)	-0.0001 (0.0012)	0.0028* (0.0020)	0.0020 (0.0016)	0.0025 (0.0020)	0.0021* (0.0016)	0.0026* (0.0020)	0.0022* (0.0016)
UncPreCEO	-0.0005 (0.0013)	0.0016 (0.0014)	-0.0005 (0.0013)	0.0013 (0.0014)	-0.0004 (0.0013)	0.0014 (0.0014)	-0.0006 (0.0025)	0.0027 (0.0024)	-0.0007 (0.0025)	0.0023 (0.0024)	-0.0006 (0.0025)	0.0022 (0.0024)
UncAnsMgr	0.0038** (0.0017)	0.0033** (0.0016)	0.0072*** (0.0017)	0.0035** (0.0016)	0.0046*** (0.0017)	0.0034** (0.0016)	-0.0010 (0.0029)	0.0015 (0.0023)	0.0053** (0.0029)	0.0007 (0.0023)	-0.0004 (0.0029)	0.0004 (0.0023)
UncPreMgr	0.0009 (0.0019)	-0.0030 (0.0020)	0.0033** (0.0018)	-0.0029 (0.0020)	0.0008 (0.0019)	-0.0027 (0.0020)	0.0023 (0.0034)	-0.0024 (0.0038)	0.0078*** (0.0032)	-0.0021 (0.0038)	0.0022 (0.0033)	-0.0021 (0.0038)
Leverage	-0.0196*** (0.0039)	-0.0352*** (0.0061)	-0.0145*** (0.0031)	-0.0248*** (0.0062)	-0.0147*** (0.0032)	-0.0250*** (0.0062)	-0.0365*** (0.0099)	-0.0243*** (0.0090)	-0.0308*** (0.0085)	-0.0162* (0.0091)	-0.0304*** (0.0086)	-0.0155* (0.0091)
lnAssets	-0.0016*** (0.0004)	-0.0165*** (0.0018)	-0.0002 (0.0003)	-0.0172*** (0.0018)	-0.0016** (0.0005)	-0.0168*** (0.0018)	-0.0028*** (0.0008)	-0.0290*** (0.0030)	0.0010** (0.0005)	-0.0292*** (0.0031)	-0.0026*** (0.0008)	-0.0293*** (0.0031)
TobinsQ	0.0057*** (0.0006)	0.0051*** (0.0011)	0.0053*** (0.0006)	0.0041*** (0.0013)	0.0047*** (0.0006)	0.0038*** (0.0013)	0.0067*** (0.0012)	0.0019 (0.0014)	0.0065*** (0.0010)	0.0012 (0.0015)	0.0054*** (0.0010)	0.0013 (0.0015)
ROA	-0.0143** (0.0062)	0.0121 (0.0082)	-0.0641*** (0.0078)	-0.0297*** (0.0094)	-0.0596*** (0.0078)	-0.0278*** (0.0095)	-0.0621*** (0.0138)	-0.0273** (0.0135)	-0.1364*** (0.0135)	-0.0717*** (0.0152)	-0.1292*** (0.0134)	-0.0697*** (0.0153)
Capex	-0.1070*** (0.0112)	-0.2294*** (0.0225)	-0.1383*** (0.0127)	-0.2399*** (0.0233)	-0.1403*** (0.0130)	-0.2315*** (0.0232)	-0.1520*** (0.0178)	-0.2140*** (0.0338)	-0.2099*** (0.0193)	-0.2308*** (0.0335)	-0.2189*** (0.0200)	-0.2331*** (0.0338)
DivDummy	-0.0044*** (0.0011)	-0.0018 (0.0018)	-0.0048*** (0.0011)	-0.0026 (0.0018)	-0.0045*** (0.0011)	-0.0022 (0.0018)	-0.0066*** (0.0021)	-0.0052 (0.0036)	-0.0058*** (0.0020)	-0.0053 (0.0035)	-0.0061*** (0.0020)	-0.0054 (0.0036)
sCFO	0.0120** (0.0054)	0.0010 (0.0023)	0.0144** (0.0071)	0.0018 (0.0026)	0.0133** (0.0066)	0.0017 (0.0026)	0.0159** (0.0072)	0.0047 (0.0033)	0.0186** (0.0091)	0.0053 (0.0034)	0.0170** (0.0083)	0.0051 (0.0034)
Lagged_DV	0.8507*** (0.0065)	0.6289*** (0.0102)	0.8598*** (0.0065)	0.6394*** (0.0101)	0.8560*** (0.0067)	0.6406*** (0.0101)	0.7112*** (0.0128)	0.2198*** (0.0154)	0.7263*** (0.0121)	0.2314*** (0.0156)	0.7171*** (0.0123)	0.2319*** (0.0156)
SalesGrowth			-0.0123*** (0.0033)	-0.0174*** (0.0034)	-0.0115*** (0.0032)	-0.0167*** (0.0034)			-0.0132*** (0.0048)	-0.0163*** (0.0037)	-0.0121** (0.0048)	-0.0159*** (0.0037)
RDSales			0.0045* (0.0023)	-0.0003 (0.0007)	0.0045* (0.0023)	-0.0002 (0.0007)			0.0064* (0.0034)	-0.0048 (0.0030)	0.0066* (0.0035)	-0.0047 (0.0030)
CashFlowAt			0.1065*** (0.0122)	0.1273*** (0.0160)	0.1031*** (0.0122)	0.1266*** (0.0161)			0.1702*** (0.0179)	0.1446*** (0.0190)	0.1598*** (0.0178)	0.1419*** (0.0191)
DailyVola			0.0001*** (0.0000)	-0.0001*** (0.0000)	0.0001*** (0.0000)	-0.0000 (0.0000)			0.0004*** (0.0000)	0.0001*** (0.0000)	0.0002*** (0.0001)	0.0001* (0.0000)
Extended Controls			Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes			Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Industry FE	Yes		Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes		Yes		Yes	
Firm FE		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes
Year FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes			Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes		
Year-Quarter FE					Yes	Yes					Yes	Yes
N	65,128	65,128	62,504	62,504	62,504	62,504	60,619	60,619	59,440	59,440	59,440	59,440
R ²	0.819	0.452	0.822	0.457	0.823	0.458	0.636	0.093	0.643	0.106	0.646	0.106
Adj. R ²	0.819	0.437	0.822	0.442	0.823	0.442	0.636	0.067	0.643	0.080	0.645	0.079

Notes: * $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$ (one-tailed for IVs, $\beta > 0$; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms). R^2 includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- R^2).

Table 12: H1 Robustness: Orthogonal Speaker Partition

	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)	(9)	(10)	(11)	(12)
	CashRatio						CashRatio_lead					
UncAnsCEO	0.0025*** (0.0010)	0.0022*** (0.0009)	0.0045*** (0.0010)	0.0019** (0.0009)	0.0028*** (0.0010)	0.0020*** (0.0009)	0.0025* (0.0016)	0.0029** (0.0013)	0.0060*** (0.0016)	0.0025** (0.0013)	0.0026* (0.0016)	0.0024** (0.0013)
UncAnsNoCEO	0.0005 (0.0006)	0.0006 (0.0005)	0.0018*** (0.0006)	0.0008* (0.0005)	0.0008* (0.0006)	0.0008* (0.0005)	-0.0015 (0.0009)	-0.0008 (0.0007)	0.0006 (0.0009)	-0.0010 (0.0007)	-0.0014 (0.0009)	-0.0011 (0.0007)
UncPreCEO	-0.0000 (0.0010)	0.0007 (0.0010)	0.0012 (0.0010)	0.0003 (0.0010)	0.0000 (0.0010)	0.0004 (0.0010)	-0.0001 (0.0019)	0.0019 (0.0017)	0.0023 (0.0019)	0.0014 (0.0016)	-0.0003 (0.0019)	0.0013 (0.0016)
UncPreNoCEO	-0.0002 (0.0008)	-0.0018 (0.0010)	0.0012* (0.0008)	-0.0016 (0.0010)	-0.0000 (0.0008)	-0.0015 (0.0010)	0.0005 (0.0015)	-0.0022 (0.0018)	0.0034*** (0.0014)	-0.0020 (0.0018)	0.0009 (0.0014)	-0.0020 (0.0018)
Leverage	-0.0193*** (0.0040)	-0.0366*** (0.0063)	-0.0142*** (0.0031)	-0.0262*** (0.0064)	-0.0143*** (0.0032)	-0.0263*** (0.0064)	-0.0345*** (0.0100)	-0.0252*** (0.0093)	-0.0288*** (0.0085)	-0.0173* (0.0093)	-0.0284*** (0.0085)	-0.0165* (0.0093)
lnAssets	-0.0016*** (0.0004)	-0.0178*** (0.0018)	-0.0001 (0.0002)	-0.0184*** (0.0018)	-0.0017** (0.0004)	-0.0181*** (0.0018)	-0.0026*** (0.0008)	-0.0294*** (0.0030)	0.0012** (0.0005)	-0.0296*** (0.0031)	-0.0025*** (0.0008)	-0.0297*** (0.0031)
TobinsQ	0.0058*** (0.0006)	0.0051*** (0.0011)	0.0054*** (0.0006)	0.0042*** (0.0013)	0.0048*** (0.0006)	0.0039*** (0.0013)	0.0065*** (0.0012)	0.0016 (0.0014)	0.0063*** (0.0010)	0.0009 (0.0015)	0.0052*** (0.0010)	0.0011 (0.0015)
ROA	-0.0141** (0.0060)	0.0112 (0.0081)	-0.0652*** (0.0081)	-0.0319*** (0.0095)	-0.0607*** (0.0081)	-0.0300*** (0.0095)	-0.0583*** (0.0142)	-0.0266** (0.0133)	-0.1318*** (0.0139)	-0.0712*** (0.0150)	-0.1251*** (0.0138)	-0.0695*** (0.0151)
Capex	-0.1094*** (0.0116)	-0.2389*** (0.0229)	-0.1407*** (0.0132)	-0.2485*** (0.0239)	-0.1436** (0.0134)	-0.2405*** (0.0238)	-0.1537*** (0.0184)	-0.2222*** (0.0350)	-0.2124*** (0.0198)	-0.2406*** (0.0349)	-0.2224*** (0.0206)	-0.2434*** (0.0352)
DivDummy	-0.0048*** (0.0011)	-0.0020 (0.0019)	-0.0053*** (0.0011)	-0.0029 (0.0019)	-0.0049** (0.0011)	-0.0025 (0.0019)	-0.0070** (0.0021)	-0.0052 (0.0037)	-0.0063*** (0.0020)	-0.0055 (0.0036)	-0.0065*** (0.0020)	-0.0056 (0.0036)
sCFO	0.0103** (0.0044)	0.0008 (0.0023)	0.0126** (0.0060)	0.0015 (0.0025)	0.0115** (0.0054)	0.0014 (0.0025)	0.0155** (0.0072)	0.0045 (0.0031)	0.0184** (0.0093)	0.0053 (0.0034)	0.0168** (0.0085)	0.0052 (0.0034)
Lagged_DV	0.8492*** (0.0066)	0.6282*** (0.0106)	0.8579*** (0.0065)	0.6388*** (0.0104)	0.8536*** (0.0067)	0.6400*** (0.0104)	0.7139*** (0.0129)	0.2244*** (0.0154)	0.7278*** (0.0123)	0.2359*** (0.0156)	0.7183*** (0.0124)	0.2364*** (0.0156)
SalesGrowth			-0.0127*** (0.0033)	-0.0186*** (0.0033)	-0.0118** (0.0033)	-0.0179*** (0.0033)			-0.0133*** (0.0050)	-0.0161*** (0.0037)	-0.0122** (0.0049)	-0.0157*** (0.0038)
RDSales			0.0049** (0.0022)	-0.0009 (0.0007)	0.0049** (0.0022)	-0.0007 (0.0007)			0.0070* (0.0036)	-0.0052 (0.0032)	0.0072* (0.0037)	-0.0051 (0.0032)
CashFlowAt			0.1098*** (0.0122)	0.1323*** (0.0163)	0.1061*** (0.0123)	0.1317*** (0.0164)			0.1715*** (0.0183)	0.1464*** (0.0195)	0.1610*** (0.0182)	0.1436*** (0.0196)
DailyVola			0.0001*** (0.0000)	-0.0001*** (0.0000)	0.0001** (0.0000)	-0.0000 (0.0000)			0.0004*** (0.0000)	0.0001*** (0.0000)	0.0002*** (0.0001)	0.0001 (0.0000)
Extended Controls			Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes			Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Industry FE	Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes	
Firm FE		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes
Year FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes			Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes		
Year-Quarter FE					Yes	Yes					Yes	Yes
N	61,120	61,120	58,681	58,681	58,681	58,681	56,891	56,891	55,809	55,809	55,809	55,809
R ²	0.819	0.454	0.821	0.460	0.822	0.460	0.638	0.097	0.645	0.110	0.647	0.110
Adj. R ²	0.819	0.438	0.821	0.444	0.822	0.443	0.638	0.070	0.645	0.083	0.646	0.082

Notes: * $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$ (one-tailed for IVs, $\beta > 0$; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms). R^2 includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- R^2).

Table 13: H1 CEO 2-IV: CEO Q&A + Presentation Uncertainty

	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)	(9)	(10)	(11)	(12)
	CashRatio						CashRatio_lead					
UncAnsCEO	0.0027*** (0.0010)	0.0020*** (0.0008)	0.0030*** (0.0010)	0.0018** (0.0008)	0.0031*** (0.0010)	0.0019** (0.0008)	0.0023* (0.0016)	0.0028** (0.0012)	0.0025* (0.0016)	0.0025** (0.0012)	0.0024* (0.0016)	0.0024** (0.0012)
UncPreCEO	0.0001 (0.0010)	0.0002 (0.0010)	0.0002 (0.0010)	0.0000 (0.0010)	0.0002 (0.0010)	0.0002 (0.0010)	0.0006 (0.0019)	0.0016 (0.0016)	0.0006 (0.0019)	0.0013 (0.0015)	0.0006 (0.0019)	0.0012 (0.0015)
Leverage	-0.0196*** (0.0039)	-0.0352*** (0.0061)	-0.0143*** (0.0031)	-0.0247*** (0.0062)	-0.0147*** (0.0032)	-0.0250*** (0.0062)	-0.0366*** (0.0099)	-0.0242*** (0.0090)	-0.0305*** (0.0085)	-0.0161* (0.0091)	-0.0305*** (0.0085)	-0.0155* (0.0091)
lnAssets	-0.0016*** (0.0004)	-0.0165*** (0.0018)	-0.0019*** (0.0005)	-0.0173*** (0.0018)	-0.0017*** (0.0005)	-0.0169*** (0.0018)	-0.0028*** (0.0008)	-0.0290*** (0.0030)	-0.0027*** (0.0008)	-0.0292*** (0.0031)	-0.0027*** (0.0008)	-0.0293*** (0.0031)
TobinsQ	0.0057*** (0.0006)	0.0051*** (0.0011)	0.0048*** (0.0006)	0.0041*** (0.0013)	0.0047*** (0.0006)	0.0038*** (0.0013)	0.0067*** (0.0012)	0.0019 (0.0014)	0.0054*** (0.0010)	0.0012 (0.0015)	0.0054*** (0.0010)	0.0013 (0.0015)
ROA	-0.0141** (0.0062)	0.0122 (0.0082)	-0.0624*** (0.0078)	-0.0296*** (0.0094)	-0.0593** (0.0078)	-0.0277*** (0.0095)	-0.0619*** (0.0139)	-0.0272** (0.0135)	-0.1330*** (0.0134)	-0.0716*** (0.0152)	-0.1292*** (0.0134)	-0.0696*** (0.0153)
Capex	-0.1068*** (0.0112)	-0.2294*** (0.0225)	-0.1431*** (0.0131)	-0.2399*** (0.0233)	-0.1400*** (0.0130)	-0.2315*** (0.0232)	-0.1521*** (0.0178)	-0.2140*** (0.0339)	-0.2209*** (0.0200)	-0.2308*** (0.0336)	-0.2190*** (0.0200)	-0.2330*** (0.0338)
DivDummy	-0.0044*** (0.0011)	-0.0018 (0.0018)	-0.0050*** (0.0011)	-0.0026 (0.0018)	-0.0045*** (0.0011)	-0.0022 (0.0018)	-0.0067*** (0.0036)	-0.0052 (0.0036)	-0.0063*** (0.0020)	-0.0053 (0.0035)	-0.0062*** (0.0020)	-0.0055 (0.0036)
sCFO	0.0120** (0.0054)	0.0010 (0.0022)	0.0137** (0.0068)	0.0018 (0.0026)	0.0133** (0.0066)	0.0017 (0.0025)	0.0159** (0.0072)	0.0047 (0.0033)	0.0173** (0.0085)	0.0052 (0.0034)	0.0170** (0.0083)	0.0051 (0.0034)
Lagged_DV	0.8508*** (0.0065)	0.6289*** (0.0102)	0.8555*** (0.0067)	0.6395*** (0.0101)	0.8560*** (0.0067)	0.6407*** (0.0101)	0.7114*** (0.0127)	0.2198*** (0.0154)	0.7170*** (0.0123)	0.2314*** (0.0156)	0.7174*** (0.0123)	0.2318*** (0.0156)
SalesGrowth			-0.0123*** (0.0033)	-0.0175*** (0.0034)	-0.0115*** (0.0032)	-0.0168*** (0.0034)			-0.0130*** (0.0048)	-0.0163*** (0.0037)	-0.0121** (0.0048)	-0.0159*** (0.0037)
RDSales			0.0045* (0.0023)	-0.0003 (0.0007)	0.0045* (0.0023)	-0.0002 (0.0007)			0.0066* (0.0035)	-0.0048 (0.0030)	0.0066* (0.0035)	-0.0047 (0.0030)
CashFlowAt			0.1034*** (0.0121)	0.1273*** (0.0160)	0.1029*** (0.0122)	0.1266*** (0.0161)			0.1635*** (0.0178)	0.1445*** (0.0190)	0.1601*** (0.0178)	0.1418*** (0.0191)
DailyVola			0.0000 (0.0000)	-0.0001*** (0.0000)	0.0001*** (0.0000)	-0.0000 (0.0000)			0.0002*** (0.0000)	0.0001*** (0.0000)	0.0002*** (0.0001)	0.0001* (0.0000)
Extended Controls			Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes			Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Industry FE	Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes	
Firm FE		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes
Year FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes			Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes		
Year-Quarter FE					Yes	Yes					Yes	Yes
N	65,148	65,148	62,523	62,523	62,523	62,523	60,638	60,638	59,459	59,459	59,459	59,459
R ²	0.819	0.452	0.822	0.457	0.823	0.458	0.636	0.093	0.645	0.106	0.646	0.106
Adj. R ²	0.819	0.437	0.822	0.442	0.823	0.442	0.636	0.067	0.645	0.080	0.645	0.079

Notes: * $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$ (one-tailed for IVs, $\beta > 0$; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms). R^2 includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- R^2).

Table 14: H1 CEO 5-IV Dual Stack: ClarityCEO + UncResCEO (DWZ Full + Qtr-Exp) + UncPreCEO

	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)	(9)	(10)	(11)	(12)
			CashRatio						CashRatio_Lead			
CEO Clarity (DWZ Full)	-0.0071** (0.0038)	-0.0094* (0.0061)	-0.0080** (0.0037)	-0.0070 (0.0060)	-0.0079** (0.0037)	-0.0067 (0.0059)	-0.0034 (0.0058)	-0.0206** (0.0120)	-0.0049 (0.0057)	-0.0201** (0.0114)	-0.0050 (0.0057)	-0.0202** (0.0114)
CEO Clarity (DWZ Qtr-Exp)	-0.0083*** (0.0033)	-0.0148*** (0.0047)	-0.0093*** (0.0033)	-0.0129*** (0.0045)	-0.0092*** (0.0033)	-0.0126*** (0.0045)	-0.0024 (0.0053)	-0.0215** (0.0097)	-0.0041 (0.0053)	-0.0210** (0.0094)	-0.0042 (0.0053)	-0.0210** (0.0095)
CEO Residual Unc. (DWZ Full)	0.0021** (0.0012)	0.0022** (0.0012)	0.0020* (0.0012)	0.0020* (0.0012)	0.0019* (0.0012)	0.0020* (0.0012)	0.0041** (0.0018)	0.0032** (0.0016)	0.0040** (0.0018)	0.0029** (0.0016)	0.0039** (0.0018)	0.0029** (0.0016)
CEO Residual Unc. (DWZ Qtr-Exp)	0.0018* (0.0012)	0.0020** (0.0012)	0.0016* (0.0012)	0.0018* (0.0012)	0.0016* (0.0012)	0.0017* (0.0012)	0.0046*** (0.0019)	0.0036** (0.0017)	0.0044** (0.0019)	0.0033** (0.0017)	0.0044** (0.0019)	0.0033** (0.0017)
CEO Pres Uncertainty	0.0003 (0.0013)	0.0008 (0.0013)	0.0001 (0.0013)	0.0002 (0.0013)	0.0001 (0.0013)	0.0003 (0.0013)	0.0001 (0.0025)	0.0017 (0.0021)	-0.0004 (0.0024)	0.0012 (0.0021)	-0.0004 (0.0024)	0.0012 (0.0021)
Leverage	-0.0131*** (0.0040)	-0.0324*** (0.0086)	-0.0089*** (0.0031)	-0.0200** (0.0085)	-0.0088*** (0.0031)	-0.0190** (0.0085)	-0.0293** (0.0122)	-0.0295** (0.0138)	-0.0242** (0.0108)	-0.0180 (0.0136)	-0.0244** (0.0109)	-0.0178 (0.0136)
InAssets	-0.0010 (0.0006)	-0.0168*** (0.0028)	-0.0011* (0.0006)	-0.0168*** (0.0027)	-0.0011* (0.0006)	-0.0167*** (0.0027)	-0.0018* (0.0011)	-0.0284*** (0.0049)	-0.0016 (0.0010)	-0.0285*** (0.0049)	-0.0015 (0.0011)	-0.0287*** (0.0050)
TobinsQ	0.0052*** (0.0007)	0.0039*** (0.0011)	0.0033*** (0.0009)	0.0028** (0.0012)	0.0032*** (0.0009)	0.0025** (0.0012)	0.0079*** (0.0012)	0.0011 (0.0017)	0.0046*** (0.0014)	-0.0009 (0.0017)	0.0047*** (0.0014)	-0.0009 (0.0018)
ROA	-0.0107 (0.0109)	0.0226* (0.0125)	-0.0509*** (0.0131)	-0.0138 (0.0144)	-0.0496*** (0.0132)	-0.0132 (0.0145)	-0.0623*** (0.0192)	-0.0193 (0.0228)	-0.1282*** (0.0202)	-0.0726*** (0.0238)	-0.1272*** (0.0204)	-0.0736*** (0.0240)
Capex	-0.0963*** (0.0150)	-0.2466*** (0.0254)	-0.1409*** (0.0169)	-0.2622*** (0.0258)	-0.1408*** (0.0169)	-0.2599*** (0.0257)	-0.1614*** (0.0214)	-0.2811*** (0.0372)	-0.2421*** (0.0249)	-0.2998*** (0.0375)	-0.2424*** (0.0249)	-0.2992*** (0.0375)
DivDummy	-0.0037** (0.0015)	-0.0021 (0.0026)	-0.0050*** (0.0015)	-0.0034 (0.0025)	-0.0049*** (0.0015)	-0.0034 (0.0025)	-0.0042* (0.0025)	-0.0080 (0.0054)	-0.0048** (0.0025)	-0.0090* (0.0053)	-0.0047* (0.0025)	-0.0091* (0.0053)
sCFO	0.0091*** (0.0024)	-0.0007 (0.0017)	0.0101*** (0.0031)	0.0005 (0.0015)	0.0100*** (0.0031)	0.0005 (0.0015)	0.0147* (0.0081)	0.0033 (0.0032)	0.0143* (0.0082)	0.0039 (0.0032)	0.0142* (0.0081)	0.0039 (0.0032)
Lagged_DV	0.8718*** (0.0090)	0.6437*** (0.0160)	0.8734*** (0.0091)	0.6581*** (0.0156)	0.8737*** (0.0091)	0.6583*** (0.0156)	0.7424*** (0.0150)	0.2163*** (0.0243)	0.7404*** (0.0148)	0.2324*** (0.0242)	0.7402*** (0.0148)	0.2322*** (0.0242)
SalesGrowth			-0.0165*** (0.0054)	-0.0258*** (0.0068)	-0.0165*** (0.0054)	-0.0257*** (0.0068)		-0.0106 (0.0070)	-0.0137** (0.0064)	-0.0107 (0.0070)	-0.0137** (0.0064)	
RDSales			0.0090*** (0.0025)	-0.0004 (0.0017)	0.0091*** (0.0025)	-0.0003 (0.0017)		0.0160*** (0.0038)	0.0005 (0.0021)	0.0159*** (0.0038)	0.0005 (0.0021)	
CashFlowAt			0.1178*** (0.0159)	0.1536*** (0.0175)	0.1185*** (0.0160)	0.1544*** (0.0175)		0.1978*** (0.0275)	0.1883*** (0.0301)	0.1975*** (0.0276)	0.1880*** (0.0301)	
DailyVola			0.0000 (0.0000)	-0.0001** (0.0000)	0.0000 (0.0000)	-0.0001** (0.0000)		0.0002*** (0.0001)	0.0000 (0.0000)	0.0003*** (0.0001)	0.0000 (0.0001)	
Extended Controls			Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes		Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	
Industry FE	Yes		Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	
Firm FE		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes
Year FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes			Yes	Yes	Yes			
Year-Quarter FE					Yes	Yes					Yes	Yes
N	24,868	24,868	24,855	24,855	24,855	24,855	23,127	23,127	23,120	23,120	23,120	23,120
R ²	0.839	0.456	0.842	0.473	0.842	0.473	0.675	0.087	0.683	0.105	0.683	0.105
Adj. R ²	0.839	0.429	0.841	0.446	0.842	0.446	0.674	0.040	0.682	0.059	0.682	0.057

Notes: * $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$ (one-tailed for IVs, $\beta > 0$; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms). R^2 includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- R^2).

Table 15: H1.1: Product Similarity–Moderated Speech Uncertainty and Cash Holdings

	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)
		CashRatio				CashRatio_lead		
UncAnsMgr_c	0.0045*** (0.0011)	0.0035*** (0.0009)	0.0046*** (0.0011)	0.0035*** (0.0009)	0.0026* (0.0019)	0.0032** (0.0015)	0.0025* (0.0019)	0.0029** (0.0015)
z_log_TotalSimilarity	0.0057*** (0.0007)	0.0030** (0.0017)	0.0055*** (0.0007)	0.0029** (0.0017)	0.0109*** (0.0014)	0.0087*** (0.0035)	0.0109*** (0.0014)	0.0088*** (0.0035)
UncAnsMgr_c_x_zlogTSIMM	0.0017 (0.0014)	0.0014 (0.0012)	0.0017 (0.0014)	0.0014 (0.0012)	-0.0014 (0.0027)	-0.0027 (0.0020)	-0.0013 (0.0027)	-0.0026 (0.0020)
Leverage	-0.0122*** (0.0027)	-0.0169*** (0.0065)	-0.0124*** (0.0028)	-0.0170*** (0.0065)	-0.0322*** (0.0060)	-0.0114 (0.0095)	-0.0322*** (0.0060)	-0.0110 (0.0094)
lnAssets	-0.0021*** (0.0004)	-0.0172*** (0.0017)	-0.0018*** (0.0004)	-0.0168*** (0.0017)	-0.0033*** (0.0007)	-0.0302*** (0.0029)	-0.0033*** (0.0007)	-0.0302*** (0.0029)
TobinsQ	0.0045*** (0.0006)	0.0032*** (0.0011)	0.0044*** (0.0006)	0.0029*** (0.0011)	0.0053*** (0.0009)	-0.0001 (0.0015)	0.0053*** (0.0009)	-0.0000 (0.0016)
ROA	-0.0601*** (0.0076)	-0.0329*** (0.0090)	-0.0572*** (0.0076)	-0.0309*** (0.0090)	-0.1302*** (0.0128)	-0.0759*** (0.0145)	-0.1268*** (0.0129)	-0.0738*** (0.0146)
Capex	-0.1578*** (0.0127)	-0.2392*** (0.0218)	-0.1543*** (0.0125)	-0.2312*** (0.0216)	-0.2458*** (0.0197)	-0.2288*** (0.0332)	-0.2435*** (0.0197)	-0.2294*** (0.0335)
DivDummy	-0.0033*** (0.0011)	-0.0024 (0.0018)	-0.0029*** (0.0011)	-0.0020 (0.0018)	-0.0032 (0.0020)	-0.0043 (0.0035)	-0.0032 (0.0020)	-0.0043 (0.0035)
sCFO	0.0122** (0.0055)	0.0026 (0.0030)	0.0119* (0.0054)	0.0026 (0.0030)	0.0165** (0.0071)	0.0062* (0.0033)	0.0162** (0.0070)	0.0060* (0.0033)
SalesGrowth	-0.0101*** (0.0028)	-0.0116*** (0.0029)	-0.0095*** (0.0027)	-0.0111*** (0.0029)	-0.0113*** (0.0039)	-0.0095*** (0.0033)	-0.0106*** (0.0039)	-0.0091*** (0.0033)
RDSales	0.0041*** (0.0015)	0.0014 (0.0009)	0.0041*** (0.0015)	0.0015* (0.0009)	0.0057*** (0.0022)	-0.0006 (0.0017)	0.0057*** (0.0022)	-0.0005 (0.0017)
CashFlowAt	0.1013*** (0.0111)	0.1279*** (0.0141)	0.1009*** (0.0112)	0.1271*** (0.0141)	0.1582*** (0.0163)	0.1418*** (0.0177)	0.1551*** (0.0163)	0.1393*** (0.0178)
DailyVola	-0.0000 (0.0000)	-0.0001*** (0.0000)	0.0000* (0.0000)	-0.0000 (0.0000)	0.0002*** (0.0000)	0.0001*** (0.0000)	0.0002*** (0.0000)	0.0001 (0.0000)
Lagged_DV	0.8574*** (0.0060)	0.6646*** (0.0096)	0.8581*** (0.0060)	0.6658*** (0.0096)	0.7044*** (0.0112)	0.2571*** (0.0155)	0.7048*** (0.0112)	0.2577*** (0.0155)
Industry FE	Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes	
Firm FE		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes
Year FE	Yes	Yes			Yes	Yes		
Year-Quarter FE			Yes	Yes			Yes	Yes
N	73,707	73,707	73,707	73,707	70,191	70,191	70,191	70,191
R ²	0.834	0.484	0.835	0.484	0.657	0.116	0.658	0.116
Adj. R ²	0.834	0.471	0.834	0.471	0.657	0.094	0.658	0.093

Notes: * $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$ (one-tailed for IVs, $\beta > 0$; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms). R^2 includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- R^2).

Table 16: H1.1.r: Product Similarity–Moderated Speech Uncertainty and Cash Holdings (Robustness: CEO Q&A Speaker Partition)

	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)
	CashRatio				CashRatio.Lead			
UncAnsCEO_c	0.0029*** (0.0010)	0.0016** (0.0008)	0.0029*** (0.0010)	0.0017** (0.0008)	0.0025* (0.0016)	0.0026** (0.0012)	0.0024* (0.0016)	0.0025** (0.0012)
z_log_TotalSimilarity	0.0058*** (0.0008)	0.0031** (0.0019)	0.0056*** (0.0008)	0.0030** (0.0019)	0.0118*** (0.0016)	0.0070** (0.0036)	0.0118*** (0.0016)	0.0071** (0.0036)
UncAnsCEO_c.x_zlogTSIMM	-0.0002 (0.0014)	-0.0008 (0.0011)	-0.0002 (0.0013)	-0.0008 (0.0011)	-0.0007 (0.0024)	-0.0029 (0.0015)	-0.0007 (0.0024)	-0.0028 (0.0015)
Leverage	-0.0155*** (0.0026)	-0.0245*** (0.0061)	-0.0157*** (0.0026)	-0.0247*** (0.0061)	-0.0327*** (0.0064)	-0.0157* (0.0088)	-0.0326*** (0.0065)	-0.0152* (0.0088)
InAssets	-0.0023*** (0.0004)	-0.0173*** (0.0017)	-0.0021*** (0.0004)	-0.0169*** (0.0017)	-0.0036*** (0.0008)	-0.0300*** (0.0031)	-0.0036*** (0.0008)	-0.0301*** (0.0031)
TobinsQ	0.0047*** (0.0006)	0.0040*** (0.0013)	0.0046*** (0.0006)	0.0037*** (0.0013)	0.0053*** (0.0009)	0.0008 (0.0015)	0.0053*** (0.0009)	0.0010 (0.0015)
ROA	-0.0592*** (0.0078)	-0.0297*** (0.0094)	-0.0563*** (0.0078)	-0.0277*** (0.0095)	-0.1262*** (0.0133)	-0.0725*** (0.0153)	-0.1227*** (0.0133)	-0.0705*** (0.0154)
Capex	-0.1563*** (0.0135)	-0.2378*** (0.0242)	-0.1527*** (0.0133)	-0.2293*** (0.0241)	-0.2500*** (0.0208)	-0.2249*** (0.0359)	-0.2481*** (0.0208)	-0.2267*** (0.0363)
DivDummy	-0.0036*** (0.0011)	-0.0025 (0.0018)	-0.0032*** (0.0011)	-0.0021 (0.0018)	-0.0036* (0.0021)	-0.0052 (0.0035)	-0.0035* (0.0021)	-0.0053 (0.0036)
sCFO	0.0133** (0.0067)	0.0019 (0.0027)	0.0129** (0.0065)	0.0018 (0.0026)	0.0163** (0.0082)	0.0054 (0.0036)	0.0160** (0.0081)	0.0053 (0.0035)
SalesGrowth	-0.0129*** (0.0032)	-0.0174*** (0.0034)	-0.0122*** (0.0031)	-0.0168*** (0.0033)	-0.0147*** (0.0047)	-0.0163*** (0.0036)	-0.0139*** (0.0047)	-0.0159*** (0.0036)
RDSales	0.0040* (0.0023)	-0.0004 (0.0007)	0.0040* (0.0023)	-0.0002 (0.0007)	0.0054* (0.0033)	-0.0049 (0.0030)	0.0054* (0.0033)	-0.0048 (0.0030)
CashFlowAt	0.1017*** (0.0121)	0.1280*** (0.0158)	0.1015*** (0.0122)	0.1274*** (0.0159)	0.1618*** (0.0173)	0.1492*** (0.0192)	0.1584*** (0.0174)	0.1465*** (0.0193)
DailyVola	-0.0000 (0.0000)	-0.0001*** (0.0000)	0.0001** (0.0000)	-0.0000 (0.0000)	0.0002*** (0.0000)	0.0001*** (0.0000)	0.0002*** (0.0001)	0.0001* (0.0000)
Lagged_DV	0.8487*** (0.0066)	0.6401*** (0.0100)	0.8495*** (0.0066)	0.6414*** (0.0100)	0.7049*** (0.0120)	0.2330*** (0.0156)	0.7053*** (0.0120)	0.2335*** (0.0156)
Industry FE	Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes	
Firm FE		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes
Year FE	Yes	Yes			Yes	Yes		
Year-Quarter FE			Yes	Yes			Yes	Yes
N	63,739	63,739	63,739	63,739	60,641	60,641	60,641	60,641
R ²	0.825	0.459	0.825	0.459	0.652	0.109	0.652	0.109
Adj. R ²	0.824	0.444	0.825	0.444	0.651	0.083	0.652	0.082

Notes: * $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$ (one-tailed for IVs, $\beta > 0$; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms). R^2 includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- R^2).

Table 17: H1.1b: Binary Product Similarity–Moderated Speech Uncertainty and Cash Holdings

	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)
		CashRatio				CashRatio.Lead		
UncAnsMgr.c	0.0044*** (0.0014)	0.0038*** (0.0012)	0.0044*** (0.0014)	0.0037*** (0.0012)	0.0033* (0.0023)	0.0039** (0.0018)	0.0032* (0.0023)	0.0036** (0.0018)
HighTSIMM	0.0060*** (0.0011)	0.0014 (0.0018)	0.0058*** (0.0011)	0.0014 (0.0018)	0.0122*** (0.0021)	0.0052* (0.0033)	0.0121*** (0.0021)	0.0051* (0.0033)
UncAnsMgr.c.x.HighTSIMM	0.0010 (0.0022)	-0.0006 (0.0018)	0.0010 (0.0022)	-0.0006 (0.0018)	-0.0000 (0.0038)	-0.0014 (0.0031)	0.0001 (0.0038)	-0.0013 (0.0031)
Leverage	-0.0109*** (0.0028)	-0.0171*** (0.0064)	-0.0113** (0.0029)	-0.0173*** (0.0065)	-0.0298*** (0.0071)	-0.0120 (0.0094)	-0.0298*** (0.0071)	-0.0117 (0.0094)
InAssets	-0.0018*** (0.0004)	-0.0169*** (0.0017)	-0.0016*** (0.0004)	-0.0166*** (0.0017)	-0.0029*** (0.0007)	-0.0294*** (0.0029)	-0.0029*** (0.0007)	-0.0294*** (0.0029)
TobinsQ	0.0046*** (0.0005)	0.0032*** (0.0011)	0.0045*** (0.0005)	0.0030*** (0.0011)	0.0055*** (0.0009)	0.0000 (0.0015)	0.0056*** (0.0009)	0.0001 (0.0016)
ROA	-0.0633*** (0.0076)	-0.0332*** (0.0090)	-0.0603** (0.0076)	-0.0313*** (0.0090)	-0.1360*** (0.0129)	-0.0767*** (0.0145)	-0.1324*** (0.0129)	-0.0746*** (0.0146)
Capex	-0.1488*** (0.0122)	-0.2384*** (0.0217)	-0.1455*** (0.0121)	-0.2303*** (0.0216)	-0.2302*** (0.0192)	-0.2276*** (0.0332)	-0.2278*** (0.0192)	-0.2282*** (0.0335)
DivDummy	-0.0039*** (0.0010)	-0.0025 (0.0018)	-0.0035*** (0.0010)	-0.0022 (0.0018)	-0.0043** (0.0019)	-0.0046 (0.0035)	-0.0042** (0.0019)	-0.0047 (0.0035)
sCFO	0.0127** (0.0058)	0.0026 (0.0030)	0.0124** (0.0056)	0.0026 (0.0030)	0.0172** (0.0075)	0.0062* (0.0033)	0.0169** (0.0074)	0.0061* (0.0032)
SalesGrowth	-0.0094*** (0.0028)	-0.0116*** (0.0029)	-0.0088*** (0.0027)	-0.0111*** (0.0029)	-0.0099** (0.0040)	-0.0095*** (0.0033)	-0.0092** (0.0039)	-0.0091*** (0.0034)
RDSales	0.0045*** (0.0015)	0.0014 (0.0009)	0.0045*** (0.0015)	0.0015* (0.0009)	0.0064*** (0.0022)	-0.0005 (0.0017)	0.0064*** (0.0022)	-0.0004 (0.0017)
CashFlowAt	0.1018*** (0.0110)	0.1278*** (0.0140)	0.1014*** (0.0111)	0.1271*** (0.0141)	0.1588*** (0.0164)	0.1415*** (0.0178)	0.1558*** (0.0164)	0.1390*** (0.0178)
DailyVola	-0.0000 (0.0000)	-0.0001*** (0.0000)	0.0001** (0.0000)	-0.0000 (0.0000)	0.0002*** (0.0000)	0.0001*** (0.0000)	0.0002*** (0.0000)	0.0001 (0.0000)
Lagged_DV	0.8623*** (0.0060)	0.6650*** (0.0096)	0.8628*** (0.0060)	0.6662*** (0.0096)	0.7130*** (0.0113)	0.2581*** (0.0155)	0.7133*** (0.0114)	0.2587*** (0.0155)
Industry FE	Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes	
Firm FE		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes
Year FE	Yes	Yes			Yes	Yes		
Year-Quarter FE			Yes	Yes			Yes	Yes
N	73,707	73,707	73,707	73,707	70,191	70,191	70,191	70,191
R ²	0.833	0.484	0.834	0.484	0.656	0.116	0.657	0.115
Adj. R ²	0.833	0.471	0.834	0.471	0.656	0.093	0.656	0.092

Notes: * $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$ (one-tailed for IVs, $\beta > 0$; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms). R^2 includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- R^2).

Table 18: H1.1b.r: Binary Product Similarity–Moderated Speech Uncertainty and Cash Holdings (Robustness: CEO Q&A Speaker Partition)

	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)
	CashRatio				CashRatio_lead			
UncAnsCEO_c	0.0037*** (0.0013)	0.0029*** (0.0010)	0.0037*** (0.0013)	0.0029*** (0.0010)	0.0033* (0.0020)	0.0035*** (0.0015)	0.0031* (0.0020)	0.0033** (0.0015)
HighTSIMM	0.0058*** (0.0012)	0.0005 (0.0019)	0.0056** (0.0012)	0.0006 (0.0019)	0.0123*** (0.0022)	0.0022 (0.0033)	0.0122*** (0.0022)	0.0021 (0.0033)
UncAnsCEO_c.x.HighTSIMM	-0.0013 (0.0020)	-0.0025 (0.0017)	-0.0012 (0.0020)	-0.0024 (0.0017)	-0.0009 (0.0031)	-0.0016 (0.0025)	-0.0008 (0.0031)	-0.0015 (0.0025)
Leverage	-0.0141*** (0.0029)	-0.0245*** (0.0061)	-0.0144*** (0.0030)	-0.0247*** (0.0061)	-0.0298*** (0.0079)	-0.0155* (0.0088)	-0.0298*** (0.0079)	-0.0150* (0.0088)
InAssets	-0.0020*** (0.0004)	-0.0170*** (0.0017)	-0.0018*** (0.0004)	-0.0166*** (0.0017)	-0.0031*** (0.0008)	-0.0294*** (0.0031)	-0.0031*** (0.0008)	-0.0295*** (0.0031)
TobinsQ	0.0048*** (0.0006)	0.0041*** (0.0013)	0.0047*** (0.0006)	0.0037*** (0.0013)	0.0054*** (0.0009)	0.0010 (0.0015)	0.0054*** (0.0010)	0.0011 (0.0015)
ROA	-0.0622*** (0.0078)	-0.0298*** (0.0094)	-0.0591*** (0.0077)	-0.0278*** (0.0095)	-0.1322*** (0.0133)	-0.0728*** (0.0153)	-0.1284*** (0.0133)	-0.0708*** (0.0154)
Capex	-0.1469*** (0.0131)	-0.2372*** (0.0242)	-0.1437*** (0.0129)	-0.2288*** (0.0241)	-0.2316*** (0.0203)	-0.2238*** (0.0360)	-0.2297*** (0.0203)	-0.2257*** (0.0364)
DivDummy	-0.0042*** (0.0011)	-0.0026 (0.0018)	-0.0037*** (0.0011)	-0.0022 (0.0018)	-0.0046** (0.0020)	-0.0054 (0.0035)	-0.0046** (0.0020)	-0.0055 (0.0036)
sCFO	0.0139** (0.0070)	0.0020 (0.0027)	0.0135** (0.0068)	0.0019 (0.0026)	0.0172** (0.0087)	0.0056 (0.0036)	0.0169** (0.0086)	0.0055 (0.0035)
SalesGrowth	-0.0122*** (0.0032)	-0.0174*** (0.0034)	-0.0114*** (0.0032)	-0.0168*** (0.0033)	-0.0134*** (0.0048)	-0.0164*** (0.0036)	-0.0125*** (0.0047)	-0.0159*** (0.0037)
RDSales	0.0045* (0.0023)	-0.0004 (0.0007)	0.0045* (0.0023)	-0.0002 (0.0007)	0.0064* (0.0034)	-0.0048 (0.0030)	0.0065* (0.0034)	-0.0047 (0.0030)
CashFlowAt	0.1027*** (0.0121)	0.1282*** (0.0158)	0.1024*** (0.0122)	0.1275*** (0.0159)	0.1633*** (0.0176)	0.1491*** (0.0192)	0.1599*** (0.0176)	0.1464*** (0.0193)
DailyVola	-0.0000 (0.0000)	-0.0001*** (0.0000)	0.0001** (0.0000)	-0.0000 (0.0000)	0.0002*** (0.0000)	0.0001*** (0.0000)	0.0002*** (0.0001)	0.0001* (0.0000)
Lagged_DV	0.8533*** (0.0067)	0.6406*** (0.0100)	0.8540*** (0.0067)	0.6418*** (0.0100)	0.7139*** (0.0122)	0.2340*** (0.0157)	0.7143*** (0.0122)	0.2345*** (0.0157)
Industry FE	Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes	
Firm FE		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes
Year FE	Yes	Yes			Yes	Yes		
Year-Quarter FE			Yes	Yes			Yes	Yes
N	63,739	63,739	63,739	63,739	60,641	60,641	60,641	60,641
R ²	0.824	0.459	0.825	0.459	0.650	0.108	0.651	0.108
Adj. R ²	0.824	0.444	0.825	0.444	0.650	0.083	0.650	0.082

Notes: * $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$ (one-tailed for IVs, $\beta > 0$; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms). R^2 includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- R^2).

Table 19: H1.2: Financial Constraint–Moderated Speech Uncertainty and Cash Holdings (Three-Category)

	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)
	CashRatio			CashRatio.lead				
UncAnsMgr_c	0.0053*** (0.0012)	0.0035*** (0.0010)	0.0050*** (0.0012)	0.0035*** (0.0010)	0.0035** (0.0020)	0.0032** (0.0015)	0.0028* (0.0020)	0.0031** (0.0015)
Unrated	0.0062*** (0.0012)	-0.0014 (0.0033)	-0.0004 (0.0015)	-0.0014 (0.0033)	0.0110*** (0.0020)	-0.0035 (0.0058)	-0.0032 (0.0029)	-0.0035 (0.0058)
UncAnsMgr_c.x.Unrated	0.0059*** (0.0024)	0.0040** (0.0021)	0.0064*** (0.0024)	0.0040** (0.0021)	0.0099** (0.0044)	0.0096*** (0.0036)	0.0110*** (0.0044)	0.0098*** (0.0036)
Leverage	-0.0095*** (0.0030)	-0.0154** (0.0072)	-0.0104*** (0.0032)	-0.0155** (0.0073)	-0.0241*** (0.0075)	-0.0076 (0.0106)	-0.0261*** (0.0080)	-0.0074 (0.0106)
InAssets	0.0005** (0.0002)	-0.0165*** (0.0019)	-0.0016*** (0.0005)	-0.0161*** (0.0019)	0.0021*** (0.0004)	-0.0299*** (0.0031)	-0.0028*** (0.0009)	-0.0299*** (0.0031)
TobinsQ	0.0051*** (0.0006)	0.0040*** (0.0012)	0.0045*** (0.0006)	0.0037*** (0.0012)	0.0057*** (0.0010)	-0.0000 (0.0016)	0.0048*** (0.0010)	0.0001 (0.0016)
ROA	-0.0647*** (0.0078)	-0.0328*** (0.0092)	-0.0603*** (0.0078)	-0.0309*** (0.0093)	-0.1397*** (0.0132)	-0.0800*** (0.0149)	-0.1329*** (0.0132)	-0.0779*** (0.0150)
Capex	-0.1378*** (0.0118)	-0.2415*** (0.0234)	-0.1391*** (0.0121)	-0.2330*** (0.0232)	-0.2038*** (0.0187)	-0.2262*** (0.0349)	-0.2119*** (0.0194)	-0.2268*** (0.0353)
DivDummy	-0.0045*** (0.0011)	-0.0032* (0.0019)	-0.0047*** (0.0011)	-0.0028 (0.0019)	-0.0051*** (0.0019)	-0.0040 (0.0035)	-0.0064*** (0.0020)	-0.0040 (0.0035)
sCFO	0.0112** (0.0049)	0.0024 (0.0029)	0.0105** (0.0045)	0.0024 (0.0029)	0.0174** (0.0075)	0.0068* (0.0035)	0.0161** (0.0068)	0.0066* (0.0034)
SalesGrowth	-0.0092*** (0.0029)	-0.0108*** (0.0030)	-0.0084*** (0.0028)	-0.0102*** (0.0030)	-0.0095** (0.0041)	-0.0079** (0.0034)	-0.0084** (0.0041)	-0.0075** (0.0034)
RDSales	0.0044*** (0.0016)	0.0024* (0.0013)	0.0044*** (0.0016)	0.0025** (0.0012)	0.0063*** (0.0024)	-0.0001 (0.0020)	0.0064*** (0.0024)	-0.0001 (0.0019)
CashFlowAt	0.1031*** (0.0114)	0.1278*** (0.0149)	0.1006*** (0.0115)	0.1270*** (0.0151)	0.1676*** (0.0171)	0.1389*** (0.0183)	0.1597*** (0.0170)	0.1364*** (0.0184)
DailyVola	0.0000 (0.0000)	-0.0001*** (0.0000)	0.0001* (0.0000)	-0.0000 (0.0000)	0.0004*** (0.0000)	0.0001*** (0.0000)	0.0003*** (0.0001)	0.0001 (0.0000)
Lagged_DV	0.8672*** (0.0060)	0.6558*** (0.0101)	0.8644*** (0.0061)	0.6571*** (0.0101)	0.7275*** (0.0114)	0.2449*** (0.0153)	0.7206*** (0.0115)	0.2457*** (0.0153)
Industry FE	Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes	
Firm FE		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes
Year FE	Yes	Yes			Yes	Yes		
Year-Quarter FE			Yes	Yes			Yes	Yes
N	67,544	67,544	67,544	67,544	66,216	66,216	66,216	66,216
R ²	0.831	0.469	0.832	0.469	0.651	0.106	0.654	0.106
Adj. R ²	0.831	0.454	0.832	0.454	0.651	0.082	0.653	0.081

Notes: * $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$ (one-tailed for IVs, $\beta > 0$; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms). Fiscal years 2002-2016. R^2 includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- R^2).

Table 20: H1.2.r: Financial Constraint–Moderated Speech Uncertainty and Cash Holdings (Three-Category, Robustness: CEO Q&A Speaker Partition)

	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)
		CashRatio				CashRatio_lead		
UncAnsCEO_c	0.0032*** (0.0010)	0.0015** (0.0008)	0.0030*** (0.0010)	0.0016** (0.0008)	0.0029** (0.0016)	0.0025** (0.0012)	0.0024* (0.0016)	0.0024** (0.0012)
Unrated	0.0063*** (0.0012)	-0.0008 (0.0034)	-0.0011 (0.0017)	-0.0008 (0.0034)	0.0101*** (0.0021)	-0.0035 (0.0060)	-0.0047 (0.0031)	-0.0036 (0.0061)
UncAnsCEO_c.x_Unrated	0.0032* (0.0022)	0.0005 (0.0020)	0.0036* (0.0022)	0.0006 (0.0020)	0.0059* (0.0037)	0.0012 (0.0033)	0.0064** (0.0037)	0.0014 (0.0033)
Leverage	-0.0134*** (0.0031)	-0.0226*** (0.0068)	-0.0143*** (0.0034)	-0.0229*** (0.0068)	-0.0248*** (0.0085)	-0.0109 (0.0095)	-0.0266*** (0.0091)	-0.0105 (0.0095)
lnAssets	0.0005** (0.0002)	-0.0163*** (0.0020)	-0.0019*** (0.0006)	-0.0158*** (0.0020)	0.0021*** (0.0004)	-0.0299*** (0.0033)	-0.0032*** (0.0010)	-0.0300*** (0.0033)
TobinsQ	0.0054*** (0.0007)	0.0049*** (0.0014)	0.0047*** (0.0007)	0.0045*** (0.0014)	0.0056*** (0.0010)	0.0007 (0.0015)	0.0046*** (0.0010)	0.0008 (0.0015)
ROA	-0.0625*** (0.0080)	-0.0279*** (0.0097)	-0.0581*** (0.0080)	-0.0258*** (0.0098)	-0.1353*** (0.0137)	-0.0751*** (0.0158)	-0.1284*** (0.0135)	-0.0730*** (0.0159)
Capex	-0.1355*** (0.0129)	-0.2383*** (0.0259)	-0.1367*** (0.0131)	-0.2295*** (0.0258)	-0.2061*** (0.0199)	-0.2231*** (0.0377)	-0.2138*** (0.0206)	-0.2250*** (0.0381)
DivDummy	-0.0047*** (0.0012)	-0.0034* (0.0019)	-0.0049*** (0.0012)	-0.0030 (0.0019)	-0.0054*** (0.0020)	-0.0049 (0.0035)	-0.0067*** (0.0021)	-0.0051 (0.0036)
sCFO	0.0119** (0.0055)	0.0017 (0.0025)	0.0109** (0.0049)	0.0016 (0.0025)	0.0176** (0.0088)	0.0064 (0.0040)	0.0161** (0.0078)	0.0063 (0.0039)
SalesGrowth	-0.0119*** (0.0036)	-0.0166*** (0.0035)	-0.0108*** (0.0035)	-0.0159*** (0.0034)	-0.0124** (0.0051)	-0.0143*** (0.0036)	-0.0109** (0.0050)	-0.0139*** (0.0036)
RDSales	0.0041* (0.0025)	0.0013 (0.0016)	0.0041 (0.0025)	0.0015 (0.0016)	0.0063* (0.0038)	-0.0052 (0.0042)	0.0063* (0.0038)	-0.0051 (0.0042)
CashFlowAt	0.1043*** (0.0126)	0.1304*** (0.0172)	0.1017*** (0.0127)	0.1297*** (0.0174)	0.1729*** (0.0182)	0.1504*** (0.0198)	0.1644*** (0.0181)	0.1476*** (0.0199)
DailyVola	0.0000* (0.0000)	-0.0001*** (0.0000)	0.0001** (0.0000)	-0.0000 (0.0000)	0.0004*** (0.0000)	0.0001*** (0.0000)	0.0003*** (0.0001)	0.0001* (0.0000)
Lagged_DV	0.8589*** (0.0068)	0.6298*** (0.0103)	0.8555*** (0.0068)	0.6312*** (0.0103)	0.7307*** (0.0122)	0.2207*** (0.0152)	0.7228*** (0.0124)	0.2213*** (0.0152)
Industry FE	Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes	
Firm FE		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes
Year FE	Yes	Yes			Yes	Yes		
Year-Quarter FE			Yes	Yes			Yes	Yes
N	58,157	58,157	58,157	58,157	57,042	57,042	57,042	57,042
R ²	0.822	0.443	0.823	0.444	0.645	0.100	0.648	0.099
Adj. R ²	0.821	0.427	0.822	0.427	0.645	0.073	0.647	0.072

Notes: * $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$ (one-tailed for IVs, $\beta > 0$; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms). Fiscal years 2002-2016. R^2 includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- R^2).

Table 21: H1.2 CEO 2-IV: Financial Constraint–Moderated CEO Speech Uncertainty and Cash Holdings

	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)
		CashRatio				CashRatio_lead		
UncAnsCEO_c	0.0029*** (0.0010)	0.0017** (0.0009)	0.0030*** (0.0010)	0.0018** (0.0009)	0.0022* (0.0016)	0.0024** (0.0013)	0.0021* (0.0016)	0.0023** (0.0013)
UncPreCEO_c	0.0004 (0.0011)	0.0001 (0.0011)	0.0004 (0.0011)	0.0002 (0.0011)	0.0008 (0.0019)	0.0012 (0.0016)	0.0007 (0.0019)	0.0011 (0.0016)
Unrated	0.0066*** (0.0012)	-0.0012 (0.0034)	-0.0013 (0.0017)	-0.0012 (0.0034)	0.0103*** (0.0022)	-0.0043 (0.0061)	-0.0053 (0.0031)	-0.0043 (0.0061)
UncAnsCEO_c.x.Unrated	0.0030* (0.0019)	0.0010 (0.0017)	0.0032** (0.0019)	0.0011 (0.0017)	0.0068** (0.0031)	0.0040* (0.0025)	0.0069** (0.0031)	0.0041** (0.0025)
UncPreCEO_c.x.Unrated	0.0028* (0.0020)	0.0010 (0.0021)	0.0027* (0.0019)	0.0010 (0.0021)	0.0027 (0.0035)	-0.0006 (0.0032)	0.0026 (0.0035)	-0.0007 (0.0032)
Leverage	-0.0140*** (0.0033)	-0.0229*** (0.0069)	-0.0150*** (0.0035)	-0.0232*** (0.0069)	-0.0261*** (0.0089)	-0.0117 (0.0097)	-0.0281*** (0.0095)	-0.0112 (0.0097)
lnAssets	0.0005** (0.0002)	-0.0169*** (0.0020)	-0.0021** (0.0006)	-0.0165*** (0.0020)	0.0022*** (0.0004)	-0.0302*** (0.0033)	-0.0035*** (0.0010)	-0.0303*** (0.0033)
TobinsQ	0.0054*** (0.0007)	0.0049*** (0.0014)	0.0048*** (0.0007)	0.0045*** (0.0014)	0.0057*** (0.0010)	0.0008 (0.0015)	0.0047*** (0.0010)	0.0010 (0.0015)
ROA	-0.0620*** (0.0081)	-0.0275*** (0.0098)	-0.0575*** (0.0080)	-0.0256*** (0.0098)	-0.1351*** (0.0138)	-0.0736*** (0.0158)	-0.1282*** (0.0137)	-0.0716*** (0.0159)
Capex	-0.1360*** (0.0131)	-0.2392*** (0.0249)	-0.1377*** (0.0134)	-0.2305*** (0.0248)	-0.2057*** (0.0202)	-0.2275*** (0.0354)	-0.2143*** (0.0210)	-0.2298*** (0.0357)
DivDummy	-0.0049*** (0.0012)	-0.0034* (0.0019)	-0.0052** (0.0012)	-0.0030 (0.0019)	-0.0057*** (0.0020)	-0.0049 (0.0035)	-0.0072*** (0.0021)	-0.0051 (0.0036)
sCFO	0.0116** (0.0053)	0.0015 (0.0024)	0.0106** (0.0047)	0.0015 (0.0024)	0.0174** (0.0087)	0.0061 (0.0038)	0.0158** (0.0076)	0.0060 (0.0038)
SalesGrowth	-0.0121*** (0.0036)	-0.0167*** (0.0035)	-0.0109*** (0.0035)	-0.0159*** (0.0035)	-0.0122** (0.0051)	-0.0145*** (0.0036)	-0.0108** (0.0050)	-0.0140*** (0.0037)
RDSales	0.0041 (0.0025)	0.0013 (0.0016)	0.0041 (0.0025)	0.0015 (0.0016)	0.0062* (0.0038)	-0.0052 (0.0042)	0.0062 (0.0038)	-0.0051 (0.0042)
CashFlowAt	0.1032*** (0.0128)	0.1294*** (0.0175)	0.1002** (0.0128)	0.1287*** (0.0176)	0.1697*** (0.0183)	0.1462*** (0.0197)	0.1606*** (0.0182)	0.1434*** (0.0197)
DailyVola	0.0000* (0.0000)	-0.0001*** (0.0000)	0.0001* (0.0000)	-0.0000 (0.0000)	0.0004*** (0.0000)	0.0001*** (0.0000)	0.0002*** (0.0001)	0.0001 (0.0000)
Lagged_DV	0.8580*** (0.0069)	0.6285*** (0.0104)	0.8542*** (0.0069)	0.6298*** (0.0104)	0.7272*** (0.0124)	0.2179*** (0.0150)	0.7186*** (0.0126)	0.2185*** (0.0151)
Industry FE	Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes	
Firm FE		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes
Year FE	Yes	Yes			Yes	Yes		
Year-Quarter FE			Yes	Yes			Yes	Yes
N	56,795	56,795	56,795	56,795	55,692	55,692	55,692	55,692
R ²	0.820	0.442	0.821	0.442	0.641	0.098	0.644	0.098
Adj. R ²	0.819	0.425	0.821	0.425	0.641	0.071	0.643	0.070

Notes: * $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$ (one-tailed for IVs, $\beta > 0$; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms). Fiscal years 2002-2016. R^2 includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- R^2).

Table 22: H1.2 CEO 5-IV Dual Stack HFC: ClarityCEO + UncResCEO (DWZ Full + Qtr-Exp) + UncPreCEO × Unrated Constraint

	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)
	CashRatio				CashRatio_Lead			
CEO Clarity (DWZ Full, c)	-0.0100*** (0.0040)	-0.0058 (0.0070)	-0.0088** (0.0039)	-0.0054 (0.0070)	-0.0045 (0.0059)	-0.0181* (0.0124)	-0.0025 (0.0059)	-0.0182* (0.0124)
CEO Clarity (DWZ Qtr-Exp, c)	-0.0114*** (0.0035)	-0.0132*** (0.0052)	-0.0104*** (0.0034)	-0.0127*** (0.0053)	-0.0037 (0.0054)	-0.0186** (0.0103)	-0.0019 (0.0054)	-0.0187** (0.0103)
CEO Residual Unc. (DWZ Full, c)	0.0024** (0.0013)	0.0027** (0.0013)	0.0025** (0.0013)	0.0026** (0.0013)	0.0040** (0.0019)	0.0033** (0.0016)	0.0041** (0.0019)	0.0032** (0.0016)
CEO Residual Unc. (DWZ Qtr-Exp, c)	0.0021* (0.0013)	0.0024** (0.0013)	0.0021* (0.0013)	0.0022** (0.0013)	0.0044** (0.0020)	0.0036** (0.0017)	0.0044** (0.0020)	0.0036** (0.0017)
CEO Pres Unc. (c)	0.0003 (0.0013)	-0.0003 (0.0013)	0.0003 (0.0013)	-0.0002 (0.0013)	0.0002 (0.0025)	0.0010 (0.0022)	-0.0000 (0.0025)	0.0010 (0.0022)
Unrated	0.0022 (0.0014)	-0.0043 (0.0043)	-0.0012 (0.0018)	-0.0042 (0.0043)	0.0050** (0.0024)	-0.0073 (0.0066)	-0.0019 (0.0032)	-0.0074 (0.0066)
UncRes (Full) × Unrated	0.0024 (0.0026)	0.0018 (0.0024)	0.0023 (0.0026)	0.0017 (0.0024)	0.0073** (0.0036)	0.0045* (0.0032)	0.0072** (0.0037)	0.0045* (0.0032)
UncRes (Qtr-Exp) × Unrated	0.0019 (0.0025)	0.0013 (0.0023)	0.0019 (0.0025)	0.0013 (0.0023)	0.0050* (0.0038)	0.0023 (0.0033)	0.0050* (0.0038)	0.0022 (0.0033)
UncPre × Unrated	0.0014 (0.0026)	-0.0014 (0.0030)	0.0017 (0.0026)	-0.0014 (0.0029)	-0.0001 (0.0046)	-0.0014 (0.0046)	0.0004 (0.0046)	-0.0014 (0.0046)
Leverage	-0.0084*** (0.0031)	-0.0172* (0.0105)	-0.0094*** (0.0034)	-0.0162 (0.0105)	-0.0210* (0.0108)	-0.0109 (0.0154)	-0.0240** (0.0121)	-0.0106 (0.0154)
lnAssets	0.0002 (0.0003)	-0.0156*** (0.0031)	-0.0016* (0.0008)	-0.0156*** (0.0031)	0.0016*** (0.0006)	-0.0299*** (0.0052)	-0.0021* (0.0013)	-0.0301*** (0.0053)
TobinsQ	0.0039*** (0.0010)	0.0030** (0.0015)	0.0034*** (0.0010)	0.0025* (0.0015)	0.0050*** (0.0014)	-0.0011 (0.0019)	0.0044*** (0.0015)	-0.0011 (0.0020)
ROA	-0.0554*** (0.0139)	-0.0073 (0.0145)	-0.0533*** (0.0140)	-0.0067 (0.0146)	-0.1338*** (0.0211)	-0.0764*** (0.0250)	-0.1306*** (0.0213)	-0.0776*** (0.0253)
Capex	-0.1389*** (0.0175)	-0.2556*** (0.0276)	-0.1433*** (0.0177)	-0.2528*** (0.0275)	-0.2278*** (0.0263)	-0.2867*** (0.0384)	-0.2379*** (0.0263)	-0.2862*** (0.0384)
DivDummy	-0.0054*** (0.0016)	-0.0041 (0.0027)	-0.0055*** (0.0016)	-0.0041 (0.0027)	-0.0044* (0.0025)	-0.0076 (0.0053)	-0.0046* (0.0026)	-0.0077 (0.0053)
sCFO	0.0100*** (0.0031)	0.0018 (0.0016)	0.0095*** (0.0028)	0.0018 (0.0016)	0.0123* (0.0069)	0.0042 (0.0032)	0.0115* (0.0062)	0.0042 (0.0032)
SalesGrowth	-0.0128** (0.0051)	-0.0268*** (0.0056)	-0.0128** (0.0051)	-0.0266*** (0.0056)	-0.0081 (0.0074)	-0.0128** (0.0063)	-0.0084 (0.0075)	-0.0128** (0.0063)
RDSales	0.0085*** (0.0021)	-0.0004 (0.0017)	0.0086*** (0.0022)	-0.0003 (0.0017)	0.0154*** (0.0035)	0.0010 (0.0022)	0.0154*** (0.0035)	0.0011 (0.0022)
CashFlowAt	0.1217*** (0.0170)	0.1746*** (0.0189)	0.1201*** (0.0170)	0.1755*** (0.0189)	0.2021*** (0.0288)	0.1992*** (0.0317)	0.1968*** (0.0289)	0.1989*** (0.0318)
DailyVola	0.0000 (0.0000)	-0.0001** (0.0000)	-0.0000 (0.0000)	-0.0001** (0.0000)	0.0003*** (0.0001)	0.0000 (0.0001)	0.0002*** (0.0001)	0.0000 (0.0001)
Lagged DV	0.8737*** (0.0096)	0.6452*** (0.0166)	0.8713*** (0.0096)	0.6456*** (0.0166)	0.7471*** (0.0152)	0.2128*** (0.0230)	0.7409*** (0.0154)	0.2126*** (0.0230)
Industry FE	Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes	
Firm FE		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes
Year FE	Yes	Yes			Yes	Yes		
Year-Quarter FE			Yes	Yes			Yes	Yes
N	21,824	21,824	21,824	21,824	21,371	21,371	21,371	21,371
R ²	0.841	0.452	0.841	0.453	0.679	0.094	0.680	0.094
Adj. R ²	0.841	0.423	0.841	0.423	0.679	0.045	0.679	0.044

Notes: * $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$ (one-tailed for IVs, $\beta > 0$; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms). Fiscal years 2002-2016. DWZ Eq.5 decomposition: Clarity = -CEO FE; UncRes = call-level residual. Two methods reported per cell: DWZ-faithful Full + no-look-ahead quarterly-expanding. R^2 includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- R^2).

Table 23: H4a: Speech Uncertainty and Book Leverage

	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)	(9)	(10)	(11)	(12)
			Leverage						Leverage Lead			
UncAnsCEO	0.0002 (0.0015)	-0.0002 (0.0015)	-0.0003 (0.0015)	-0.0001 (0.0015)	-0.0003 (0.0015)	-0.0002 (0.0015)	0.0054 (0.0026)	0.0044 (0.0026)	0.0056 (0.0026)	0.0047 (0.0026)	0.0056 (0.0026)	0.0047 (0.0026)
UncPreCEO	0.0011 (0.0013)	-0.0014 (0.0014)	0.0011 (0.0013)	-0.0006 (0.0014)	0.0011 (0.0013)	-0.0005 (0.0014)	0.0045 (0.0030)	-0.0015 (0.0027)	0.0041 (0.0030)	-0.0008 (0.0027)	0.0042 (0.0030)	-0.0004 (0.0027)
UncAnsMgr	-0.0002 (0.0017)	-0.0018 (0.0019)	-0.0011 (0.0018)	-0.0011 (0.0019)	0.0004 (0.0017)	-0.0012 (0.0019)	-0.0050* (0.0033)	-0.0073** (0.0033)	-0.0074** (0.0034)	-0.0069** (0.0034)	-0.0049* (0.0033)	-0.0064** (0.0034)
UncPreMgr	0.0018 (0.0018)	0.0016 (0.0021)	-0.0001 (0.0018)	0.0006 (0.0021)	0.0014 (0.0018)	0.0004 (0.0021)	0.0015 (0.0040)	0.0006 (0.0042)	-0.0001 (0.0040)	0.0002 (0.0043)	0.0021 (0.0040)	0.0001 (0.0043)
lnAssets	0.0029*** (0.0008)	0.0113*** (0.0021)	0.0025*** (0.0008)	0.0136*** (0.0021)	0.0035*** (0.0009)	0.0139*** (0.0021)	0.0069*** (0.0016)	0.0135*** (0.0042)	0.0060*** (0.0016)	0.0161*** (0.0042)	0.0076*** (0.0018)	0.0164*** (0.0042)
TobinsQ	0.0021** (0.0010)	0.0006 (0.0015)	0.0020* (0.0010)	0.0008 (0.0015)	0.0024** (0.0011)	0.0009 (0.0016)	0.0060*** (0.0023)	0.0031 (0.0030)	0.0062*** (0.0023)	0.0047* (0.0027)	0.0067*** (0.0024)	0.0043 (0.0028)
ROA	-0.0860*** (0.0118)	-0.1273*** (0.0164)	-0.0579*** (0.0127)	-0.0782*** (0.0150)	-0.0605*** (0.0128)	-0.0782*** (0.0152)	-0.1445*** (0.0226)	-0.1858*** (0.0261)	-0.0981*** (0.0236)	-0.1218*** (0.0238)	-0.1018*** (0.0237)	-0.1211*** (0.0240)
Capex	0.0125 (0.0148)	-0.0109 (0.0275)	0.0131 (0.0169)	0.0021 (0.0273)	0.0138 (0.0168)	-0.0013 (0.0274)	0.1133*** (0.0291)	0.0616 (0.0499)	0.1318*** (0.0314)	0.0834* (0.0499)	0.1321*** (0.0317)	0.0874* (0.0502)
DivDummy	0.0031** (0.0015)	0.0028 (0.0024)	0.0044*** (0.0015)	0.0036 (0.0025)	0.0043*** (0.0015)	0.0037 (0.0025)	0.0071** (0.0034)	0.0107** (0.0050)	0.0082** (0.0033)	0.0117** (0.0050)	0.0087*** (0.0033)	0.0122** (0.0050)
sCFO	-0.0039 (0.0025)	0.0001 (0.0022)	-0.0056* (0.0030)	-0.0015 (0.0019)	-0.0051* (0.0028)	-0.0016 (0.0019)	-0.0070 (0.0053)	-0.0060 (0.0051)	-0.0085 (0.0059)	-0.0068 (0.0052)	-0.0080 (0.0056)	-0.0069 (0.0052)
CashRatio	-0.0284*** (0.0064)	-0.0297*** (0.0092)	-0.0319*** (0.0066)	-0.0267*** (0.0094)	-0.0288*** (0.0067)	-0.0261*** (0.0095)	-0.0514*** (0.0124)	-0.0289* (0.0161)	-0.0569*** (0.0125)	-0.0284* (0.0157)	-0.0529*** (0.0128)	-0.0281* (0.0157)
Lagged_DV	0.9396*** (0.0172)	0.7622*** (0.0134)	0.9371*** (0.0182)	0.7548*** (0.0134)	0.9375*** (0.0182)	0.7548*** (0.0135)	0.8347*** (0.0360)	0.3754*** (0.0267)	0.8321*** (0.0378)	0.3686*** (0.0275)	0.8321*** (0.0379)	0.3673*** (0.0275)
SalesGrowth			0.0100*** (0.0034)	0.0140*** (0.0029)	0.0094*** (0.0034)	0.0136*** (0.0029)			0.0047 (0.0062)	0.0083* (0.0046)	0.0038 (0.0062)	0.0079* (0.0047)
RDSales			-0.0020** (0.0009)	-0.0001 (0.0014)	-0.0021** (0.0009)	-0.0001 (0.0014)			-0.0023 (0.0019)	0.0013 (0.0037)	-0.0024 (0.0020)	0.0013 (0.0037)
CashFlowAt			-0.0332** (0.0159)	-0.0931*** (0.0171)	-0.0304* (0.0161)	-0.0915*** (0.0171)			-0.0704** (0.0276)	-0.1412*** (0.0277)	-0.0628** (0.0278)	-0.1361*** (0.0279)
DailyVola			0.0002*** (0.0000)	0.0003*** (0.0000)	0.0002*** (0.0000)	0.0004*** (0.0001)			0.0001 (0.0001)	0.0003*** (0.0001)	0.0002** (0.0001)	0.0005*** (0.0001)
Extended Controls			Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes			Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Industry FE	Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes	
Firm FE		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes
Year FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes			Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes		
Year-Quarter FE					Yes	Yes					Yes	Yes
N	65,132	65,132	62,508	62,508	62,508	62,508	60,626	60,626	59,447	59,447	59,447	59,447
R ²	0.889	0.613	0.891	0.617	0.891	0.618	0.714	0.175	0.715	0.183	0.716	0.185
Adj. R ²	0.889	0.603	0.891	0.606	0.891	0.606	0.714	0.152	0.715	0.159	0.716	0.161

Notes: * $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$ (one-tailed for IVs, $\beta < 0$; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms). R^2 includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- R^2).

Table 24: H4a Robustness: Orthogonal Speaker Partition

	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)	(9)	(10)	(11)	(12)
			Leverage						Leverage Lead			
UncAnsCEO	0.0003 (0.0011)	-0.0009 (0.0010)	-0.0010 (0.0011)	-0.0006 (0.0010)	-0.0000 (0.0011)	-0.0006 (0.0010)	0.0022 (0.0020)	0.0001 (0.0018)	0.0008 (0.0020)	0.0006 (0.0018)	0.0024 (0.0021)	0.0009 (0.0018)
UncAnsNoCEO	0.0003 (0.0006)	0.0004 (0.0006)	-0.0001 (0.0006)	0.0004 (0.0006)	0.0004 (0.0006)	0.0004 (0.0006)	-0.0011 (0.0011)	-0.0010 (0.0010)	-0.0018* (0.0012)	-0.0007 (0.0010)	-0.0009 (0.0011)	-0.0006 (0.0010)
UncPreCEO	0.0021 (0.0011)	-0.0005 (0.0011)	0.0011 (0.0011)	-0.0001 (0.0012)	0.0018 (0.0012)	-0.0001 (0.0012)	0.0052 (0.0026)	-0.0011 (0.0022)	0.0039 (0.0026)	-0.0004 (0.0022)	0.0052 (0.0027)	0.0000 (0.0022)
UncPreNoCEO	0.0007 (0.0008)	-0.0000 (0.0011)	-0.0002 (0.0008)	-0.0006 (0.0010)	0.0005 (0.0008)	-0.0007 (0.0010)	0.0004 (0.0019)	-0.0003 (0.0021)	-0.0004 (0.0019)	-0.0005 (0.0021)	0.0007 (0.0019)	-0.0006 (0.0021)
lnAssets	0.0030*** (0.0008)	0.0120*** (0.0022)	0.0025*** (0.0008)	0.0143*** (0.0022)	0.0036*** (0.0009)	0.0145*** (0.0022)	0.0069*** (0.0017)	0.0138*** (0.0043)	0.0058*** (0.0017)	0.0167*** (0.0043)	0.0077*** (0.0019)	0.0169*** (0.0043)
TobinsQ	0.0021** (0.0011)	0.0009 (0.0016)	0.0020* (0.0011)	0.0011 (0.0015)	0.0024** (0.0011)	0.0012 (0.0016)	0.0058** (0.0024)	0.0036 (0.0029)	0.0060** (0.0024)	0.0052** (0.0026)	0.0065*** (0.0024)	0.0048* (0.0026)
ROA	-0.0878*** (0.0131)	-0.1305*** (0.0170)	-0.0588*** (0.0137)	-0.0789*** (0.0155)	-0.0613*** (0.0138)	-0.0788*** (0.0157)	-0.1381*** (0.0238)	-0.1858*** (0.0281)	-0.0924*** (0.0252)	-0.1185*** (0.0253)	-0.0961*** (0.0253)	-0.1177*** (0.0255)
Capex	0.0137 (0.0157)	-0.0032 (0.0278)	0.0133 (0.0178)	0.0069 (0.0276)	0.0146 (0.0177)	0.0040 (0.0277)	0.1171*** (0.0308)	0.0624 (0.0522)	0.1345*** (0.0331)	0.0858 (0.0523)	0.1356*** (0.0333)	0.0906* (0.0527)
DivDummy	0.0032** (0.0016)	0.0037 (0.0025)	0.0045*** (0.0015)	0.0046* (0.0025)	0.0044*** (0.0015)	0.0046* (0.0025)	0.0078** (0.0036)	0.0129** (0.0051)	0.0090*** (0.0035)	0.0139*** (0.0051)	0.0093*** (0.0034)	0.0144*** (0.0051)
sCFO	-0.0037 (0.0025)	0.0002 (0.0023)	-0.0051* (0.0028)	-0.0012 (0.0019)	-0.0046* (0.0026)	-0.0013 (0.0019)	-0.0073 (0.0056)	-0.0053 (0.0050)	-0.0089 (0.0063)	-0.0064 (0.0051)	-0.0084 (0.0060)	-0.0065 (0.0051)
CashRatio	-0.0276*** (0.0066)	-0.0316*** (0.0094)	-0.0319*** (0.0069)	-0.0287*** (0.0097)	-0.0285*** (0.0069)	-0.0280*** (0.0097)	-0.0494*** (0.0125)	-0.0326** (0.0160)	-0.0555*** (0.0126)	-0.0322** (0.0155)	-0.0511*** (0.0130)	-0.0319** (0.0156)
Lagged_DV	0.9387*** (0.0181)	0.7600*** (0.0136)	0.9365*** (0.0191)	0.7526*** (0.0137)	0.9369*** (0.0191)	0.7527*** (0.0137)	0.8353*** (0.0377)	0.3755*** (0.0277)	0.8325*** (0.0395)	0.3677*** (0.0284)	0.8324*** (0.0396)	0.3663*** (0.0284)
SalesGrowth			0.0093*** (0.0036)	0.0135*** (0.0030)	0.0087** (0.0036)	0.0131*** (0.0030)			0.0037 (0.0065)	0.0078 (0.0049)	0.0027 (0.0066)	0.0075 (0.0049)
RDSales			-0.0019** (0.0009)	0.0001 (0.0016)	-0.0020** (0.0009)	0.0001 (0.0016)			-0.0023 (0.0020)	0.0016 (0.0044)	-0.0024 (0.0020)	0.0016 (0.0044)
CashFlowAt			-0.0330** (0.0161)	-0.0932*** (0.0173)	-0.0301* (0.0163)	-0.0916*** (0.0173)			-0.0684** (0.0285)	-0.1454*** (0.0289)	-0.0604** (0.0287)	-0.1401*** (0.0292)
DailyVola			0.0002*** (0.0000)	0.0003*** (0.0000)	0.0002*** (0.0001)	0.0004*** (0.0001)			0.0001 (0.0001)	0.0003*** (0.0001)	0.0002** (0.0001)	0.0005*** (0.0001)
Extended Controls			Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes			Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Industry FE	Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes	
Firm FE		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes
Year FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes			Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes		
Year-Quarter FE					Yes	Yes					Yes	Yes
N	61,124	61,124	58,685	58,685	58,685	58,685	56,898	56,898	55,816	55,816	55,816	55,816
R ²	0.889	0.613	0.891	0.617	0.891	0.618	0.714	0.175	0.716	0.183	0.717	0.185
Adj. R ²	0.889	0.602	0.891	0.606	0.891	0.606	0.714	0.151	0.716	0.158	0.716	0.160

Notes: * $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$ (one-tailed for IVs, $\beta < 0$; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms). R^2 includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- R^2).

Table 25: H4b: Speech Uncertainty and Debt-to-Capital

	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)	(9)	(10)	(11)	(12)
			DebtToCapital						DebtToCapital_lead			
UncAnsCEO	0.0007 (0.0022)	0.0006 (0.0022)	-0.0004 (0.0023)	0.0003 (0.0023)	-0.0005 (0.0023)	0.0002 (0.0023)	0.0048 (0.0045)	0.0040 (0.0041)	0.0051 (0.0045)	0.0043 (0.0041)	0.0049 (0.0045)	0.0044 (0.0041)
UncPreCEO	0.0008 (0.0021)	-0.0011 (0.0023)	0.0011 (0.0021)	0.0001 (0.0023)	0.0010 (0.0020)	0.0002 (0.0023)	0.0059 (0.0050)	-0.0018 (0.0042)	0.0054 (0.0050)	-0.0011 (0.0042)	0.0056 (0.0050)	-0.0002 (0.0042)
UncAnsMgr	0.0002 (0.0027)	0.0005 (0.0029)	-0.0020 (0.0026)	0.0015 (0.0030)	0.0014 (0.0028)	0.0013 (0.0030)	-0.0087* (0.0059)	-0.0077* (0.0055)	-0.0154*** (0.0058)	-0.0079* (0.0055)	-0.0085* (0.0059)	-0.0069 (0.0055)
UncPreMgr	0.0007 (0.0028)	0.0022 (0.0036)	-0.0030 (0.0026)	0.0007 (0.0035)	0.0005 (0.0027)	0.0003 (0.0035)	-0.0023 (0.0063)	-0.0011 (0.0069)	-0.0078 (0.0063)	-0.0016 (0.0070)	-0.0013 (0.0064)	-0.0017 (0.0070)
lnAssets	0.0049*** (0.0010)	0.0008 (0.0040)	0.0042*** (0.0009)	0.0044 (0.0040)	0.0066*** (0.0012)	0.0049 (0.0040)	0.0149*** (0.0025)	0.0015 (0.0075)	0.0123*** (0.0020)	0.0057 (0.0076)	0.0172*** (0.0028)	0.0062 (0.0076)
TobinsQ	0.0043** (0.0019)	0.0028 (0.0020)	0.0035* (0.0020)	0.0024 (0.0020)	0.0043** (0.0021)	0.0026 (0.0021)	0.0116*** (0.0040)	0.0055 (0.0053)	0.0116*** (0.0043)	0.0077 (0.0053)	0.0129*** (0.0045)	0.0068 (0.0053)
ROA	-0.1691*** (0.0241)	-0.2194*** (0.0224)	-0.1482*** (0.0232)	-0.1672*** (0.0225)	-0.1522*** (0.0235)	-0.1670*** (0.0227)	-0.3196*** (0.0375)	-0.3319*** (0.0349)	-0.2638*** (0.0389)	-0.2364*** (0.0359)	-0.2700*** (0.0390)	-0.2345*** (0.0359)
Capex	-0.0007 (0.0246)	-0.0110 (0.0419)	-0.0260 (0.0301)	-0.0029 (0.0435)	-0.0238 (0.0299)	-0.0115 (0.0438)	0.1038** (0.0435)	0.0375 (0.0718)	0.1075** (0.0511)	0.0687 (0.0732)	0.1122** (0.0515)	0.0757 (0.0737)
DivDummy	0.0039* (0.0021)	0.0043 (0.0042)	0.0060*** (0.0021)	0.0052 (0.0043)	0.0061*** (0.0021)	0.0053 (0.0043)	0.0102** (0.0050)	0.0168* (0.0087)	0.0121** (0.0050)	0.0183** (0.0087)	0.0133*** (0.0050)	0.0192** (0.0087)
sCFO	-0.0036 (0.0028)	0.0008 (0.0029)	-0.0066 (0.0042)	-0.0021 (0.0026)	-0.0056 (0.0037)	-0.0021 (0.0026)	-0.0042 (0.0054)	-0.0004 (0.0071)	-0.0065 (0.0059)	-0.0021 (0.0071)	-0.0054 (0.0056)	-0.0023 (0.0071)
CashRatio	-0.0542*** (0.0077)	-0.0674*** (0.0142)	-0.0599*** (0.0079)	-0.0655*** (0.0147)	-0.0536*** (0.0079)	-0.0643*** (0.0147)	-0.0937*** (0.0180)	-0.0664** (0.0266)	-0.1039*** (0.0182)	-0.0662** (0.0265)	-0.0933*** (0.0180)	-0.0659** (0.0264)
Lagged_DV	0.9273*** (0.0123)	0.7897*** (0.0217)	0.9229*** (0.0133)	0.7782*** (0.0225)	0.9228*** (0.0134)	0.7785*** (0.0226)	0.7992*** (0.0297)	0.4064*** (0.0352)	0.7961*** (0.0307)	0.3955*** (0.0361)	0.7949*** (0.0311)	0.3937*** (0.0363)
SalesGrowth			0.0105** (0.0043)	0.0178*** (0.0046)	0.0091** (0.0043)	0.0166*** (0.0046)			-0.0034 (0.0084)	0.0078 (0.0076)	-0.0053 (0.0085)	0.0069 (0.0077)
RDSales			-0.0037** (0.0018)	0.0003 (0.0017)	-0.0038** (0.0018)	0.0002 (0.0017)			-0.0061* (0.0033)	0.0005 (0.0057)	-0.0063* (0.0033)	0.0005 (0.0057)
CashFlowAt			-0.0007 (0.0276)	-0.0666** (0.0314)	0.0056 (0.0278)	-0.0632** (0.0316)			-0.0728 (0.0518)	-0.1913*** (0.0454)	-0.0548 (0.0517)	-0.1811*** (0.0455)
DailyVola			0.0003*** (0.0001)	0.0006*** (0.0001)	0.0004*** (0.0001)	0.0007*** (0.0001)			0.0003* (0.0001)	0.0006*** (0.0001)	0.0006*** (0.0002)	0.0010*** (0.0002)
Extended Controls			Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes			Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Industry FE	Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes	
Firm FE		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes
Year FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes			Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes		
Year-Quarter FE					Yes	Yes					Yes	Yes
N	64,895	64,895	62,286	62,286	62,286	62,286	60,363	60,363	59,190	59,190	59,190	59,190
R ²	0.867	0.620	0.869	0.619	0.869	0.620	0.662	0.189	0.663	0.191	0.665	0.194
Adj. R ²	0.867	0.610	0.869	0.608	0.869	0.608	0.662	0.166	0.663	0.167	0.664	0.169

Notes: * $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$ (one-tailed for IVs, $\beta < 0$; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms). R^2 includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- R^2).

Table 26: H4b Robustness: Orthogonal Speaker Partition

	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)	(9)	(10)	(11)	(12)
			DebtToCapital						DebtToCapital_lead			
UncAnsCEO	0.0012 (0.0017)	0.0016 (0.0016)	-0.0015 (0.0017)	0.0017 (0.0016)	0.0006 (0.0017)	0.0016 (0.0016)	-0.0007 (0.0031)	-0.0005 (0.0030)	-0.0050* (0.0033)	0.0001 (0.0029)	-0.0004 (0.0032)	0.0007 (0.0029)
UncAnsNoCEO	0.0001 (0.0009)	0.0009 (0.0009)	-0.0009 (0.0009)	0.0010 (0.0009)	0.0004 (0.0009)	0.0009 (0.0009)	-0.0015 (0.0019)	-0.0001 (0.0015)	-0.0040** (0.0019)	0.0000 (0.0015)	-0.0014 (0.0019)	0.0002 (0.0015)
UncPreCEO	0.0019 (0.0017)	0.0006 (0.0020)	0.0000 (0.0017)	0.0010 (0.0020)	0.0017 (0.0018)	0.0010 (0.0020)	0.0055 (0.0041)	-0.0014 (0.0034)	0.0017 (0.0039)	-0.0008 (0.0034)	0.0053 (0.0041)	0.0001 (0.0034)
UncPreNoCEO	-0.0002 (0.0013)	-0.0011 (0.0022)	-0.0019* (0.0012)	-0.0017 (0.0022)	-0.0002 (0.0013)	-0.0019 (0.0022)	-0.0006 (0.0030)	-0.0002 (0.0033)	-0.0033 (0.0030)	-0.0005 (0.0034)	-0.0001 (0.0031)	-0.0008 (0.0034)
lnAssets	0.0053*** (0.0010)	0.0017 (0.0042)	0.0043*** (0.0009)	0.0047 (0.0042)	0.0068*** (0.0012)	0.0052 (0.0042)	0.0154*** (0.0025)	0.0030 (0.0073)	0.0122*** (0.0020)	0.0076 (0.0074)	0.0176*** (0.0028)	0.0080 (0.0074)
TobinsQ	0.0041** (0.0019)	0.0029 (0.0020)	0.0034 (0.0021)	0.0026 (0.0020)	0.0043** (0.0021)	0.0028 (0.0021)	0.0116*** (0.0042)	0.0064 (0.0052)	0.0115*** (0.0045)	0.0087* (0.0051)	0.0130*** (0.0046)	0.0078 (0.0052)
ROA	-0.1710*** (0.0263)	-0.2214*** (0.0238)	-0.1478*** (0.0251)	-0.1661*** (0.0239)	-0.1515*** (0.0254)	-0.1658*** (0.0240)	-0.3146*** (0.0411)	-0.3298*** (0.0362)	-0.2543*** (0.0415)	-0.2279*** (0.0374)	-0.2602*** (0.0417)	-0.2255*** (0.0374)
Capex	0.0032 (0.0262)	0.0033 (0.0440)	-0.0221 (0.0322)	0.0087 (0.0457)	-0.0191 (0.0320)	0.0007 (0.0461)	0.1129** (0.0464)	0.0361 (0.0755)	0.1163** (0.0546)	0.0707 (0.0772)	0.1239** (0.0550)	0.0795 (0.0779)
DivDummy	0.0039* (0.0022)	0.0057 (0.0044)	0.0060*** (0.0022)	0.0068 (0.0044)	0.0061*** (0.0022)	0.0068 (0.0044)	0.0109** (0.0052)	0.0199** (0.0090)	0.0129** (0.0052)	0.0213** (0.0090)	0.0140*** (0.0052)	0.0223** (0.0090)
sCFO	-0.0034 (0.0028)	0.0010 (0.0028)	-0.0060 (0.0040)	-0.0016 (0.0025)	-0.0050 (0.0035)	-0.0016 (0.0025)	-0.0040 (0.0055)	0.0000 (0.0069)	-0.0064 (0.0060)	-0.0014 (0.0069)	-0.0051 (0.0056)	-0.0017 (0.0069)
CashRatio	-0.0518*** (0.0078)	-0.0676*** (0.0148)	-0.0600*** (0.0081)	-0.0666*** (0.0153)	-0.0532*** (0.0080)	-0.0653*** (0.0153)	-0.0928*** (0.0182)	-0.0744*** (0.0267)	-0.1049*** (0.0187)	-0.0751*** (0.0267)	-0.0928*** (0.0183)	-0.0748*** (0.0267)
Lagged_DV	0.9255*** (0.0128)	0.7868*** (0.0225)	0.9223*** (0.0137)	0.7764*** (0.0233)	0.9222*** (0.0138)	0.7767*** (0.0233)	0.7960*** (0.0305)	0.4017*** (0.0357)	0.7939*** (0.0315)	0.3908*** (0.0366)	0.7926*** (0.0319)	0.3889*** (0.0367)
SalesGrowth			0.0097** (0.0046)	0.0171*** (0.0048)	0.0082* (0.0047)	0.0158*** (0.0049)			-0.0049 (0.0090)	0.0055 (0.0078)	-0.0068 (0.0091)	0.0046 (0.0079)
RDSales			-0.0031* (0.0018)	-0.0001 (0.0022)	-0.0032* (0.0018)	-0.0002 (0.0022)			-0.0062* (0.0036)	0.0009 (0.0068)	-0.0064* (0.0037)	0.0010 (0.0068)
CashFlowAt			-0.0047 (0.0292)	-0.0734** (0.0333)	0.0018 (0.0294)	-0.0699** (0.0334)			-0.0778 (0.0544)	-0.1934*** (0.0471)	-0.0591 (0.0544)	-0.1830*** (0.0472)
DailyVola			0.0003*** (0.0001)	0.0006*** (0.0001)	0.0005*** (0.0001)	0.0007*** (0.0001)			0.0002* (0.0001)	0.0007*** (0.0001)	0.0006*** (0.0002)	0.0011*** (0.0002)
Extended Controls			Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes			Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Industry FE	Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes	
Firm FE		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes
Year FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes			Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes		
Year-Quarter FE					Yes	Yes					Yes	Yes
N	60,906	60,906	58,477	58,477	58,477	58,477	56,652	56,652	55,571	55,571	55,571	55,571
R ²	0.867	0.619	0.868	0.616	0.869	0.617	0.662	0.186	0.663	0.188	0.665	0.191
Adj. R ²	0.867	0.608	0.868	0.605	0.869	0.606	0.662	0.162	0.663	0.163	0.664	0.165

Notes: * $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$ (one-tailed for IVs, $\beta < 0$; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms). R^2 includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- R^2).

Table 27: H5: Speech Uncertainty and Analyst Forecast Dispersion (Wang 2020)

	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)	(9)	(10)	(11)	(12)
	DISP						DISP _{lead}					
UncAnsCEO	-0.0001 (0.0001)	-0.0002 (0.0001)	-0.0002 (0.0001)	-0.0002 (0.0001)	-0.0002 (0.0001)	-0.0002 (0.0001)	-0.0001 (0.0001)	-0.0001 (0.0001)	-0.0002 (0.0001)	-0.0002 (0.0001)	-0.0002 (0.0001)	-0.0002 (0.0001)
UncPreCEO	0.0001 (0.0001)	0.0000 (0.0001)	0.0000 (0.0000)	-0.0001 (0.0001)	-0.0000 (0.0000)	-0.0001 (0.0001)	0.0001 (0.0001)	0.0001 (0.0001)	-0.0000 (0.0001)	-0.0001 (0.0001)	-0.0000 (0.0001)	-0.0001 (0.0001)
UncAnsMgr	0.0002*** (0.0001)	0.0001 (0.0001)	0.0002*** (0.0001)	0.0001 (0.0001)	0.0002*** (0.0001)	0.0001 (0.0001)	0.0002** (0.0001)	0.0001 (0.0001)	0.0002*** (0.0001)	0.0001 (0.0001)	0.0002** (0.0001)	0.0001 (0.0001)
UncPreMgr	0.0001* (0.0001)	0.0002*** (0.0001)	0.0001** (0.0001)	0.0001** (0.0001)	0.0001* (0.0001)	0.0001** (0.0001)	0.0001* (0.0001)	0.0003** (0.0001)	0.0002*** (0.0001)	0.0002** (0.0001)	0.0001** (0.0001)	0.0002** (0.0001)
lnAssets	-0.0000 (0.0000)	-0.0001 (0.0001)	0.0000 (0.0000)	-0.0001 (0.0001)	-0.0000 (0.0000)	-0.0001 (0.0001)	-0.0000 (0.0000)	-0.0001 (0.0001)	0.0000 (0.0000)	-0.0001 (0.0001)	-0.0000 (0.0000)	-0.0001 (0.0001)
TobinsQ	-0.0001*** (0.0000)	-0.0001*** (0.0000)	-0.0001*** (0.0000)	-0.0001** (0.0000)	-0.0001*** (0.0000)	-0.0001** (0.0000)	-0.0001*** (0.0000)	-0.0001*** (0.0000)	-0.0001*** (0.0000)	-0.0001*** (0.0000)	-0.0001*** (0.0000)	-0.0001*** (0.0000)
ROA	-0.0025*** (0.0004)	-0.0034*** (0.0005)	-0.0010*** (0.0004)	-0.0023*** (0.0005)	-0.0011*** (0.0004)	-0.0024*** (0.0005)	-0.0035*** (0.0005)	-0.0045*** (0.0006)	-0.0021*** (0.0005)	-0.0035*** (0.0006)	-0.0021*** (0.0005)	-0.0035*** (0.0006)
Leverage	0.0005*** (0.0001)	0.0014*** (0.0003)	0.0004*** (0.0001)	0.0012*** (0.0003)	0.0004*** (0.0001)	0.0012*** (0.0003)	0.0004*** (0.0001)	0.0013*** (0.0004)	0.0003*** (0.0001)	0.0010*** (0.0003)	0.0003*** (0.0001)	0.0009*** (0.0003)
Capex	-0.0006 (0.0006)	-0.0024*** (0.0009)	-0.0001 (0.0006)	-0.0019** (0.0008)	-0.0002 (0.0006)	-0.0020** (0.0008)	-0.0002 (0.0007)	-0.0011 (0.0010)	0.0004 (0.0007)	-0.0004 (0.0010)	-0.0001 (0.0007)	-0.0010 (0.0010)
DivDummy	-0.0002*** (0.0000)	-0.0001 (0.0001)	-0.0002*** (0.0000)	-0.0001 (0.0001)	-0.0002*** (0.0000)	-0.0001 (0.0001)	-0.0001** (0.0001)	-0.0001 (0.0001)	-0.0002*** (0.0001)	-0.0001 (0.0001)	-0.0002*** (0.0001)	-0.0001 (0.0001)
sCFO	0.0005* (0.0003)	0.0001 (0.0001)	0.0005* (0.0003)	0.0001* (0.0001)	0.0005* (0.0003)	0.0001* (0.0001)	0.0008** (0.0003)	0.0002*** (0.0001)	0.0008** (0.0003)	0.0002*** (0.0001)	0.0008*** (0.0003)	0.0003*** (0.0001)
Lagged_DV	0.6484*** (0.0176)	0.3880*** (0.0256)	0.6278*** (0.0177)	0.3722*** (0.0254)	0.6310*** (0.0178)	0.3758*** (0.0255)	0.5926*** (0.0213)	0.3103*** (0.0292)	0.5789*** (0.0206)	0.3019*** (0.0278)	0.5836*** (0.0209)	0.3093*** (0.0280)
SurpDec			-0.0000 (0.0000)	-0.0000 (0.0000)	-0.0000** (0.0000)	-0.0000 (0.0000)			-0.0000*** (0.0000)	-0.0000** (0.0000)	-0.0000*** (0.0000)	-0.0000** (0.0000)
Loss			0.0008*** (0.0001)	0.0006*** (0.0001)	0.0008*** (0.0001)	0.0006*** (0.0001)			0.0007*** (0.0001)	0.0005*** (0.0001)	0.0007*** (0.0001)	0.0005*** (0.0001)
UncQue			0.0001 (0.0000)	0.0000 (0.0000)	0.0000 (0.0000)	0.0000 (0.0000)			0.0001 (0.0000)	0.0000 (0.0000)	0.0000 (0.0000)	0.0000 (0.0000)
NegCall			0.0006*** (0.0001)	0.0008*** (0.0001)	0.0005*** (0.0001)	0.0008*** (0.0001)			0.0007*** (0.0001)	0.0009*** (0.0001)	0.0005*** (0.0001)	0.0008*** (0.0001)
Extended Controls			Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes			Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Industry FE	Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes	
Firm FE		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes
Year FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes			Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes		
Year-Quarter FE					Yes	Yes					Yes	Yes
N	20,069	20,069	19,124	19,124	19,124	19,124	19,355	19,355	18,406	18,406	18,406	18,406
R ²	0.488	0.204	0.501	0.223	0.503	0.223	0.431	0.158	0.452	0.179	0.458	0.180
Adj. R ²	0.487	0.163	0.500	0.182	0.501	0.180	0.430	0.116	0.451	0.136	0.455	0.134

Notes: * $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$ (one-tailed for IVs, $\beta > 0$; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms). R^2 includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- R^2).

Table 28: H5 Robustness: Orthogonal Speaker Partition

	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)	(9)	(10)	(11)	(12)
	DISP						DISP _{lead}					
UncAnsCEO	0.0000 (0.0000)	-0.0001 (0.0000)	-0.0000 (0.0000)	-0.0002 (0.0000)	-0.0000 (0.0000)	-0.0002 (0.0000)	-0.0000 (0.0000)	-0.0001 (0.0001)	-0.0000 (0.0000)	-0.0002 (0.0001)	-0.0001 (0.0000)	-0.0002 (0.0001)
UncAnsNoCEO	0.0001 ** (0.0000)	0.0000 (0.0000)	0.0001 *** (0.0000)	0.0000 (0.0000)	0.0001 ** (0.0000)	0.0000 (0.0000)	0.0001 *** (0.0000)	0.0000 (0.0000)	0.0001 *** (0.0000)	0.0000 (0.0000)	0.0001 *** (0.0000)	0.0000 (0.0000)
UncPreCEO	0.0001 *** (0.0000)	0.0001 * (0.0001)	0.0001 ** (0.0000)	-0.0000 (0.0001)	0.0001 * (0.0000)	-0.0000 (0.0001)	0.0001 ** (0.0000)	0.0001 (0.0001)	0.0001 * (0.0000)	0.0000 (0.0001)	0.0001 (0.0000)	0.0000 (0.0001)
UncPreNoCEO	0.0000 (0.0000)	0.0001 ** (0.0000)	0.0001 * (0.0000)	0.0001 * (0.0000)	0.0000 (0.0000)	0.0001 * (0.0000)	0.0000 (0.0000)	0.0001 (0.0001)	0.0001 * (0.0000)	0.0000 (0.0001)	0.0000 (0.0000)	0.0000 (0.0001)
lnAssets	-0.0000 (0.0000)	-0.0001 (0.0001)	0.0000 (0.0000)	-0.0001 (0.0001)	-0.0000 (0.0000)	-0.0001 (0.0001)	-0.0000 (0.0000)	-0.0001 (0.0001)	0.0000 (0.0000)	-0.0001 (0.0001)	-0.0000 (0.0000)	-0.0001 (0.0001)
TobinsQ	-0.0001 *** (0.0000)	-0.0001 *** (0.0000)	-0.0001 *** (0.0000)	-0.0001 ** (0.0000)	-0.0001 *** (0.0000)	-0.0000 ** (0.0000)	-0.0001 *** (0.0000)	-0.0001 *** (0.0000)	-0.0001 *** (0.0000)	-0.0001 *** (0.0000)	-0.0001 *** (0.0000)	-0.0001 *** (0.0000)
ROA	-0.0025 *** (0.0004)	-0.0035 *** (0.0005)	-0.0010 ** (0.0004)	-0.0024 ** (0.0005)	-0.0011 *** (0.0004)	-0.0025 *** (0.0005)	-0.0036 *** (0.0005)	-0.0046 *** (0.0006)	-0.0022 ** (0.0005)	-0.0035 *** (0.0006)	-0.0022 ** (0.0005)	-0.0035 *** (0.0006)
Leverage	0.0005 *** (0.0001)	0.0014 *** (0.0003)	0.0004 *** (0.0001)	0.0012 ** (0.0003)	0.0004 *** (0.0001)	0.0012 ** (0.0003)	0.0004 *** (0.0001)	0.0013 *** (0.0004)	0.0003 *** (0.0001)	0.0010 *** (0.0003)	0.0003 *** (0.0001)	0.0009 *** (0.0003)
Capex	-0.0004 (0.0006)	-0.0025 *** (0.0009)	0.0001 (0.0006)	-0.0021 * (0.0009)	-0.0001 (0.0006)	-0.0021 ** (0.0009)	0.0001 (0.0007)	-0.0012 (0.0010)	0.0007 (0.0007)	-0.0005 (0.0010)	0.0002 (0.0007)	-0.0011 (0.0010)
DivDummy	-0.0002 *** (0.0000)	-0.0001 (0.0001)	-0.0002 *** (0.0000)	-0.0002 (0.0001)	-0.0002 *** (0.0000)	-0.0002 (0.0001)	-0.0001 ** (0.0001)	-0.0001 (0.0001)	-0.0002 *** (0.0001)	-0.0001 (0.0001)	-0.0002 *** (0.0001)	-0.0001 (0.0001)
sCFO	0.0005 * (0.0003)	0.0001 * (0.0001)	0.0005 ** (0.0003)	0.0002 ** (0.0001)	0.0005 * (0.0003)	0.0002 ** (0.0001)	0.0007 *** (0.0003)	0.0003 *** (0.0001)	0.0007 *** (0.0003)	0.0003 *** (0.0001)	0.0007 *** (0.0002)	0.0003 *** (0.0001)
Lagged_DV	0.6440 *** (0.0179)	0.3882 *** (0.0264)	0.6247 *** (0.0179)	0.3739 *** (0.0262)	0.6279 *** (0.0181)	0.3774 *** (0.0263)	0.5827 *** (0.0219)	0.3038 *** (0.0294)	0.5701 *** (0.0211)	0.2970 *** (0.0281)	0.5750 *** (0.0215)	0.3045 *** (0.0283)
SurpDec			-0.0000 (0.0000)	-0.0000 (0.0000)	-0.0000 ** (0.0000)	-0.0000 (0.0000)			-0.0000 ** (0.0000)	-0.0000 (0.0000)	-0.0000 *** (0.0000)	-0.0000 ** (0.0000)
Loss			0.0008 *** (0.0001)	0.0006 ** (0.0001)	0.0008 *** (0.0001)	0.0006 ** (0.0001)			0.0007 *** (0.0001)	0.0005 *** (0.0001)	0.0007 *** (0.0001)	0.0005 *** (0.0001)
UncQue			0.0000 (0.0000)	0.0000 (0.0000)	0.0000 (0.0000)	-0.0000 (0.0000)			0.0001 * (0.0000)	0.0000 (0.0000)	0.0000 (0.0000)	0.0000 (0.0000)
NegCall			0.0006 *** (0.0001)	0.0008 *** (0.0001)	0.0006 *** (0.0001)	0.0008 *** (0.0001)			0.0007 *** (0.0001)	0.0009 *** (0.0001)	0.0006 *** (0.0001)	0.0008 *** (0.0001)
Extended Controls			Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes			Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Industry FE	Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes	
Firm FE		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes
Year FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes			Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes		
Year-Quarter FE					Yes	Yes					Yes	Yes
N	18,992	18,992	18,109	18,109	18,109	18,109	18,338	18,338	17,427	17,427	17,427	17,427
R ²	0.482	0.202	0.495	0.222	0.497	0.222	0.424	0.153	0.444	0.173	0.450	0.174
Adj. R ²	0.481	0.161	0.494	0.180	0.495	0.178	0.423	0.108	0.443	0.128	0.447	0.127

Notes: * $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$ (one-tailed for IVs, $\beta > 0$; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms). R^2 includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- R^2).

Table 29: H7: Speech Uncertainty and 3-Day Post-Call Illiquidity Change (ΔAmihud , $[+1, +3] - [-3, -1]$)

	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)	(9)	(10)	(11)	(12)
			DeltaILLIQ						DeltaILLIQ_lead1			
UncAnsCEO	0.0005 (0.0004)	0.0005 (0.0004)	0.0004 (0.0004)	0.0004 (0.0004)	0.0004 (0.0004)	0.0004 (0.0004)	0.0003 (0.0005)	0.0004 (0.0006)	0.0004 (0.0006)	0.0004 (0.0006)	0.0003 (0.0006)	0.0004 (0.0006)
UncPreCEO	0.0005 (0.0004)	0.0008* (0.0005)	0.0004 (0.0004)	0.0006 (0.0005)	0.0003 (0.0004)	0.0006 (0.0005)	0.0002 (0.0004)	0.0002 (0.0004)	0.0003 (0.0004)	0.0002 (0.0005)	0.0003 (0.0004)	0.0002 (0.0005)
UncAnsMgr	-0.0003 (0.0005)	-0.0005 (0.0005)	-0.0013 (0.0005)	-0.0005 (0.0006)	-0.0005 (0.0005)	-0.0005 (0.0006)	0.0001 (0.0007)	-0.0003 (0.0008)	-0.0008 (0.0007)	-0.0004 (0.0008)	-0.0001 (0.0007)	-0.0004 (0.0008)
UncPreMgr	0.0000 (0.0004)	-0.0007 (0.0005)	-0.0009 (0.0004)	-0.0006 (0.0006)	0.0001 (0.0004)	-0.0006 (0.0006)	0.0002 (0.0004)	-0.0001 (0.0005)	-0.0006 (0.0004)	0.0001 (0.0005)	0.0002 (0.0004)	0.0001 (0.0005)
InAssets	0.0009*** (0.0001)	0.0015*** (0.0004)	0.0003*** (0.0001)	0.0017*** (0.0004)	0.0009*** (0.0001)	0.0017*** (0.0004)	0.0009*** (0.0001)	0.0010*** (0.0004)	0.0003*** (0.0001)	0.0009** (0.0004)	0.0007*** (0.0001)	0.0009** (0.0004)
TobinsQ	0.0004*** (0.0001)	0.0003** (0.0001)	0.0002*** (0.0001)	0.0004*** (0.0001)	0.0004*** (0.0001)	0.0004*** (0.0001)	0.0005*** (0.0001)	0.0004*** (0.0001)	0.0002*** (0.0001)	0.0004*** (0.0001)	0.0004*** (0.0001)	0.0003*** (0.0001)
ROA	0.0018 (0.0017)	0.0023 (0.0024)	0.0004 (0.0016)	0.0010 (0.0024)	0.0003 (0.0016)	0.0009 (0.0024)	0.0031* (0.0019)	0.0045* (0.0025)	0.0005 (0.0017)	0.0023 (0.0023)	0.0008 (0.0018)	0.0026 (0.0023)
Leverage	-0.0002 (0.0005)	-0.0024* (0.0013)	0.0002 (0.0005)	-0.0023* (0.0013)	-0.0001 (0.0005)	-0.0021 (0.0013)	0.0001 (0.0006)	-0.0009 (0.0011)	0.0008 (0.0006)	-0.0001 (0.0012)	0.0004 (0.0006)	-0.0001 (0.0012)
Capex	0.0044** (0.0020)	0.0047 (0.0042)	0.0023 (0.0021)	0.0051 (0.0044)	0.0047** (0.0021)	0.0060 (0.0045)	0.0044** (0.0021)	0.0034 (0.0044)	0.0029 (0.0022)	0.0037 (0.0045)	0.0044** (0.0021)	0.0034 (0.0045)
DivDummy	-0.0002 (0.0002)	-0.0004 (0.0004)	-0.0003 (0.0002)	-0.0006 (0.0004)	-0.0003 (0.0002)	-0.0005 (0.0004)	-0.0003 (0.0002)	-0.0001 (0.0004)	-0.0004* (0.0002)	-0.0002 (0.0004)	-0.0004 (0.0002)	-0.0002 (0.0004)
sCFO	0.0001 (0.0003)	-0.0003 (0.0003)	-0.0002 (0.0003)	-0.0002 (0.0003)	0.0001 (0.0003)	-0.0002 (0.0003)	-0.0000 (0.0003)	-0.0004* (0.0002)	-0.0001 (0.0003)	-0.0003 (0.0002)	0.0001 (0.0003)	-0.0003 (0.0002)
Lagged_DV	0.0218 (0.0393)	-0.0118 (0.0382)	0.0276 (0.0409)	-0.0091 (0.0398)	0.0264 (0.0411)	-0.0085 (0.0399)	0.0122 (0.0382)	-0.0215 (0.0369)	0.0174 (0.0399)	-0.0181 (0.0389)	0.0162 (0.0401)	-0.0180 (0.0389)
DailyVola			-0.0001*** (0.0000)	-0.0000 (0.0000)	-0.0000 (0.0000)	-0.0000 (0.0000)			-0.0001*** (0.0000)	-0.0001*** (0.0000)	-0.0001** (0.0000)	-0.0001** (0.0000)
StockPrice			-0.0000 (0.0000)	-0.0000** (0.0000)	-0.0000** (0.0000)	-0.0000** (0.0000)			-0.0000** (0.0000)	-0.0000* (0.0000)	-0.0000** (0.0000)	-0.0000* (0.0000)
Turnover			0.0094*** (0.0028)	0.0046* (0.0026)	0.0091*** (0.0028)	0.0046* (0.0026)			0.0151*** (0.0028)	0.0130*** (0.0028)	0.0143*** (0.0028)	0.0125*** (0.0028)
UncQue			-0.0005* (0.0003)	0.0000 (0.0003)	-0.0000 (0.0003)	0.0000 (0.0003)			-0.0001 (0.0002)	0.0004 (0.0003)	0.0003 (0.0002)	0.0004 (0.0003)
Extended Controls			Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes			Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Industry FE	Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes	
Firm FE		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes
Year FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes			Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes		
Year-Quarter FE					Yes	Yes					Yes	Yes
N	63,736	63,736	60,182	60,182	60,182	60,182	63,313	63,313	61,060	61,060	61,060	61,060
R ²	0.004	0.001	0.003	0.001	0.005	0.001	0.004	0.001	0.005	0.003	0.005	0.002
Adj. R ²	0.004	-0.027	0.003	-0.028	0.003	-0.029	0.003	-0.027	0.004	-0.026	0.004	-0.028

Notes: * $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$ (one-tailed for IVs, $\beta > 0$; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms). R^2 includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- R^2).

Table 30: H7: Speech Uncertainty and 3-Day Post-Call Illiquidity Change (ΔAmihud , $[+1, +3] - [-3, -1]$)

	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)	(9)	(10)	(11)	(12)
	DeltaILLIQ					DeltaILLIQ_lead1						
UncAnsCEO	0.0001 (0.0003)	0.0001 (0.0003)	-0.0004 (0.0003)	0.0000 (0.0003)	0.0001 (0.0003)	0.0001 (0.0003)	0.0003 (0.0003)	0.0003 (0.0004)	-0.0000 (0.0003)	0.0003 (0.0004)	0.0003 (0.0003)	0.0003 (0.0004)
UncAnsNoCEO	-0.0001 (0.0002)	-0.0001 (0.0002)	-0.0004 (0.0002)	-0.0001 (0.0002)	-0.0001 (0.0002)	-0.0001 (0.0002)	-0.0001 (0.0002)	-0.0002 (0.0002)	-0.0003 (0.0002)	-0.0002 (0.0002)	-0.0001 (0.0002)	-0.0002 (0.0002)
UncPreCEO	0.0005** (0.0003)	0.0005* (0.0004)	0.0001 (0.0003)	0.0005* (0.0004)	0.0005** (0.0003)	0.0005 (0.0004)	0.0002 (0.0003)	0.0001 (0.0003)	-0.0001 (0.0003)	0.0000 (0.0003)	0.0002 (0.0003)	0.0001 (0.0003)
UncPreNoCEO	-0.0000 (0.0002)	-0.0004 (0.0003)	-0.0005 (0.0002)	-0.0004 (0.0003)	-0.0000 (0.0002)	-0.0004 (0.0003)	0.0002 (0.0002)	0.0002 (0.0003)	-0.0001 (0.0002)	0.0003 (0.0003)	0.0001 (0.0002)	0.0003 (0.0003)
InAssets	0.0009*** (0.0001)	0.0015*** (0.0004)	0.0003*** (0.0001)	0.0018*** (0.0004)	0.0008*** (0.0001)	0.0018*** (0.0004)	0.0008*** (0.0001)	0.0010*** (0.0004)	0.0002*** (0.0001)	0.0009** (0.0004)	0.0006*** (0.0001)	0.0009** (0.0004)
TobinsQ	0.0004*** (0.0001)	0.0003** (0.0001)	0.0002*** (0.0001)	0.0005*** (0.0002)	0.0004*** (0.0001)	0.0005*** (0.0002)	0.0004*** (0.0001)	0.0004*** (0.0001)	0.0002*** (0.0001)	0.0004*** (0.0001)	0.0004*** (0.0001)	0.0004*** (0.0001)
ROA	0.0011 (0.0016)	0.0018 (0.0025)	-0.0003 (0.0015)	0.0008 (0.0024)	-0.0003 (0.0016)	0.0008 (0.0025)	0.0029 (0.0019)	0.0040 (0.0025)	0.0010 (0.0018)	0.0023 (0.0024)	0.0011 (0.0019)	0.0024 (0.0025)
Leverage	-0.0001 (0.0004)	-0.0027** (0.0014)	0.0004 (0.0005)	-0.0025* (0.0014)	0.0000 (0.0004)	-0.0024* (0.0014)	0.0004 (0.0005)	-0.0009 (0.0012)	0.0010** (0.0005)	-0.0003 (0.0012)	0.0008 (0.0005)	-0.0003 (0.0012)
Capex	0.0038* (0.0021)	0.0052 (0.0046)	0.0015 (0.0021)	0.0055 (0.0048)	0.0039* (0.0022)	0.0061 (0.0049)	0.0033 (0.0021)	0.0030 (0.0044)	0.0020 (0.0022)	0.0035 (0.0045)	0.0034 (0.0021)	0.0031 (0.0045)
DivDummy	-0.0001 (0.0002)	-0.0004 (0.0004)	-0.0000 (0.0002)	-0.0004 (0.0004)	-0.0001 (0.0002)	-0.0004 (0.0004)	-0.0001 (0.0002)	0.0001 (0.0004)	-0.0002 (0.0002)	-0.0000 (0.0004)	-0.0002 (0.0002)	-0.0000 (0.0004)
sCFO	-0.0000 (0.0003)	-0.0003 (0.0003)	-0.0003 (0.0002)	-0.0002 (0.0003)	-0.0000 (0.0003)	-0.0002 (0.0003)	-0.0001 (0.0002)	-0.0004* (0.0002)	-0.0002 (0.0002)	-0.0003 (0.0002)	0.0000 (0.0003)	-0.0003 (0.0002)
Lagged_DV	0.0064 (0.0386)	-0.0256 (0.0371)	0.0034 (0.0389)	-0.0305 (0.0376)	0.0020 (0.0391)	-0.0300 (0.0377)	0.0252 (0.0420)	-0.0056 (0.0406)	0.0250 (0.0431)	-0.0075 (0.0419)	0.0238 (0.0432)	-0.0074 (0.0420)
DailyVola			-0.0000*** (0.0000)	-0.0000 (0.0000)	-0.0000 (0.0000)	-0.0000 (0.0000)			-0.0001*** (0.0000)	-0.0001** (0.0000)	-0.0001** (0.0000)	-0.0001** (0.0000)
StockPrice			-0.0000 (0.0000)	-0.0000** (0.0000)	-0.0000*** (0.0000)	-0.0000** (0.0000)			-0.0000* (0.0000)	-0.0000* (0.0000)	-0.0000*** (0.0000)	-0.0000* (0.0000)
Turnover			0.0084*** (0.0028)	0.0029 (0.0022)	0.0083*** (0.0028)	0.0029 (0.0023)			0.0136*** (0.0026)	0.0123*** (0.0028)	0.0133*** (0.0026)	0.0123*** (0.0028)
UncQue			-0.0007** (0.0003)	-0.0001 (0.0003)	-0.0001 (0.0003)	-0.0001 (0.0003)			-0.0003 (0.0002)	0.0002 (0.0003)	0.0001 (0.0002)	0.0002 (0.0003)
Extended Controls			Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes			Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Industry FE	Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes	
Firm FE		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes
Year FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes			Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes		
Year-Quarter FE					Yes	Yes					Yes	Yes
N	59,870	59,870	56,737	56,737	56,737	56,737	59,444	59,444	57,537	57,537	57,537	57,537
R^2	0.004	0.002	0.002	0.002	0.004	0.002	0.004	0.001	0.005	0.003	0.005	0.002
Adj. R^2	0.003	-0.028	0.002	-0.029	0.002	-0.029	0.004	-0.029	0.004	-0.028	0.004	-0.029

Notes: * $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$ (one-tailed for IVs, $\beta > 0$; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms). R^2 includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- R^2).

Table 31: H7b: Speech Uncertainty and 3-Day Post-Call Amihud Illiquidity Level ([+1, +3])

	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)	(9)	(10)	(11)	(12)
			PostCallAmihud						PostCallAmihud_lead1			
UncAnsCEO	-0.0006 (0.0010)	-0.0008 (0.0010)	-0.0008 (0.0010)	-0.0008 (0.0010)	-0.0007 (0.0010)	-0.0008 (0.0010)	0.0005 (0.0008)	0.0005 (0.0009)	0.0004 (0.0008)	0.0005 (0.0009)	0.0004 (0.0008)	0.0005 (0.0009)
UncPreCEO	0.0000 (0.0008)	0.0001 (0.0009)	-0.0006 (0.0008)	0.0003 (0.0009)	-0.0006 (0.0008)	0.0001 (0.0009)	-0.0006 (0.0007)	-0.0008 (0.0009)	-0.0009 (0.0007)	-0.0006 (0.0009)	-0.0008 (0.0007)	-0.0007 (0.0009)
UncAnsMgr	-0.0011 (0.0013)	-0.0013 (0.0014)	0.0002 (0.0013)	-0.0009 (0.0014)	-0.0008 (0.0014)	-0.0012 (0.0013)	-0.0006 (0.0014)	-0.0008 (0.0010)	0.0009 (0.0011)	-0.0009 (0.0011)	-0.0005 (0.0011)	-0.0009 (0.0011)
UncPreMgr	-0.0001 (0.0008)	-0.0005 (0.0013)	0.0013 ** (0.0008)	-0.0009 (0.0013)	0.0003 (0.0008)	-0.0011 (0.0013)	0.0002 (0.0008)	0.0006 (0.0013)	0.0019 *** (0.0008)	0.0003 (0.0014)	0.0004 (0.0007)	0.0003 (0.0014)
lnAssets	-0.0024 *** (0.0002)	-0.0046 *** (0.0008)	-0.0009 *** (0.0001)	-0.0040 *** (0.0009)	-0.0016 *** (0.0002)	-0.0043 *** (0.0009)	-0.0022 *** (0.0002)	-0.0037 *** (0.0008)	-0.0008 *** (0.0001)	-0.0033 *** (0.0008)	-0.0017 *** (0.0002)	-0.0034 *** (0.0008)
TobinsQ	-0.0010 *** (0.0002)	-0.0008 *** (0.0003)	-0.0006 *** (0.0001)	-0.0010 *** (0.0003)	-0.0009 *** (0.0002)	-0.0010 *** (0.0003)	-0.0008 *** (0.0002)	-0.0002 (0.0002)	-0.0003 ** (0.0001)	-0.0004 * (0.0002)	-0.0008 *** (0.0001)	-0.0004 * (0.0003)
ROA	-0.0259 *** (0.0041)	-0.0337 *** (0.0064)	-0.0125 *** (0.0039)	-0.0215 *** (0.0061)	-0.0139 *** (0.0040)	-0.0226 *** (0.0062)	-0.0258 *** (0.0040)	-0.0352 *** (0.0057)	-0.0172 *** (0.0042)	-0.0266 *** (0.0058)	-0.0176 *** (0.0043)	-0.0267 *** (0.0060)
Leverage	0.0011 (0.0010)	0.0038 ** (0.0019)	-0.0017 (0.0010)	-0.0016 (0.0017)	-0.0010 (0.0010)	-0.0014 (0.0018)	0.0004 (0.0009)	0.0017 (0.0018)	-0.0014 (0.0009)	-0.0016 (0.0018)	-0.0006 (0.0009)	-0.0008 (0.0018)
Capex	-0.0095 *** (0.0033)	-0.0042 (0.0081)	-0.0104 *** (0.0036)	-0.0056 (0.0082)	-0.0144 *** (0.0035)	-0.0134 * (0.0081)	-0.0154 *** (0.0030)	-0.0229 *** (0.0064)	-0.0148 *** (0.0033)	-0.0243 *** (0.0066)	-0.0161 *** (0.0031)	-0.0203 *** (0.0067)
DivDummy	0.0005 (0.0005)	-0.0016 ** (0.0008)	0.0014 ** (0.0005)	-0.0012 (0.0008)	0.0011 * (0.0005)	-0.0014 * (0.0007)	0.0000 (0.0004)	-0.0019 ** (0.0007)	0.0006 (0.0004)	-0.0017 ** (0.0007)	0.0005 (0.0004)	-0.0017 ** (0.0007)
sCFO	-0.0018 * (0.0010)	-0.0005 (0.0005)	-0.0023 * (0.0013)	-0.0010 * (0.0005)	-0.0023 * (0.0013)	-0.0009 * (0.0004)	-0.0017 * (0.0009)	-0.0004 (0.0004)	-0.0019 * (0.0011)	-0.0008 ** (0.0004)	-0.0022 * (0.0012)	-0.0008 * (0.0004)
Lagged_DV	0.7099 *** (0.0207)	0.6092 *** (0.0244)	0.6928 *** (0.0225)	0.5914 *** (0.0264)	0.6942 *** (0.0227)	0.5941 *** (0.0264)	0.7277 *** (0.0243)	0.6261 *** (0.0269)	0.7170 *** (0.0236)	0.6108 *** (0.0273)	0.7170 *** (0.0237)	0.6132 *** (0.0272)
DailyVola			0.0004 *** (0.0000)	0.0004 *** (0.0000)	0.0003 *** (0.0000)	0.0004 *** (0.0001)		0.0003 *** (0.0000)	0.0003 *** (0.0000)	0.0002 *** (0.0000)	0.0002 *** (0.0001)	0.0002 *** (0.0001)
StockPrice			0.0000 *** (0.0000)	0.0000 *** (0.0000)	0.0000 *** (0.0000)	0.0000 *** (0.0000)		0.0000 *** (0.0000)	0.0000 *** (0.0000)	0.0000 *** (0.0000)	0.0000 *** (0.0000)	0.0000 *** (0.0000)
Turnover			-0.0705 *** (0.0085)	-0.0595 *** (0.0073)	-0.0653 *** (0.0078)	-0.0549 *** (0.0068)		-0.0365 *** (0.0070)	-0.0239 *** (0.0042)	-0.0342 *** (0.0069)	-0.0216 *** (0.0042)	-0.0216 *** (0.0042)
UncQue			-0.0007 (0.0005)	-0.0011 * (0.0006)	-0.0013 ** (0.0005)	-0.0013 ** (0.0005)		-0.0002 (0.0004)	-0.0010 ** (0.0004)	-0.0009 ** (0.0004)	-0.0010 ** (0.0004)	-0.0010 ** (0.0004)
Extended Controls			Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes			Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Industry FE	Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes	
Firm FE		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes
Year FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes			Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes		
Year-Quarter FE					Yes	Yes					Yes	Yes
N	63,736	63,736	60,182	60,182	60,182	60,182	63,313	63,313	61,060	61,060	61,060	61,060
R ²	0.541	0.390	0.544	0.398	0.545	0.395	0.546	0.395	0.546	0.398	0.544	0.392
Adj. R ²	0.541	0.373	0.544	0.380	0.544	0.377	0.545	0.378	0.545	0.380	0.544	0.374

Notes: * $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$ (one-tailed for IVs, $\beta > 0$; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms). R^2 includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- R^2).

Table 32: H7b: Speech Uncertainty and 3-Day Post-Call Amihud Illiquidity Level ([+1, +3])

	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)	(9)	(10)	(11)	(12)
			PostCallAmihud						PostCallAmihud_lead1			
UncAnsCEO	-0.0007 (0.0005)	-0.0011 (0.0006)	-0.0006 (0.0006)	-0.0012 (0.0006)	-0.0011 (0.0005)	-0.0014 (0.0006)	0.0001 (0.0005)	0.0000 (0.0006)	0.0007* (0.0005)	-0.0001 (0.0006)	0.0000 (0.0005)	-0.0001 (0.0006)
UncAnsNoCEO	-0.0005 (0.0004)	-0.0005 (0.0005)	-0.0002 (0.0004)	-0.0005 (0.0005)	-0.0005 (0.0004)	-0.0005 (0.0005)	-0.0001 (0.0004)	-0.0001 (0.0004)	0.0004 (0.0004)	-0.0000 (0.0004)	-0.0001 (0.0004)	-0.0001 (0.0004)
UncPreCEO	-0.0000 (0.0006)	0.0001 (0.0007)	0.0002 (0.0006)	0.0000 (0.0008)	-0.0003 (0.0006)	-0.0002 (0.0008)	-0.0005 (0.0005)	-0.0005 (0.0006)	-0.0002 (0.0006)	-0.0007 (0.0006)	-0.0007 (0.0005)	-0.0007 (0.0006)
UncPreNoCEO	-0.0001 (0.0003)	-0.0006 (0.0006)	0.0004* (0.0003)	-0.0007 (0.0006)	0.0001 (0.0003)	-0.0007 (0.0006)	0.0003 (0.0003)	-0.0003 (0.0006)	0.0009*** (0.0004)	-0.0004 (0.0006)	0.0004 (0.0003)	-0.0004 (0.0006)
lnAssets	-0.0020*** (0.0002)	-0.0041*** (0.0008)	-0.0008*** (0.0001)	-0.0036*** (0.0009)	-0.0014*** (0.0002)	-0.0039*** (0.0009)	-0.0019*** (0.0002)	-0.0031*** (0.0007)	-0.0006*** (0.0001)	-0.0028*** (0.0008)	-0.0015*** (0.0002)	-0.0030*** (0.0008)
TobinsQ	-0.0008*** (0.0002)	-0.0006** (0.0003)	-0.0005*** (0.0001)	-0.0009*** (0.0003)	-0.0007*** (0.0002)	-0.0009*** (0.0003)	-0.0007*** (0.0002)	-0.0001 (0.0002)	-0.0003** (0.0001)	-0.0003 (0.0002)	-0.0007*** (0.0001)	-0.0003 (0.0002)
ROA	-0.0264*** (0.0044)	-0.0349*** (0.0067)	-0.0137*** (0.0043)	-0.0227*** (0.0064)	-0.0151*** (0.0044)	-0.0237*** (0.0065)	-0.0242*** (0.0041)	-0.0338*** (0.0059)	-0.0163*** (0.0043)	-0.0261*** (0.0060)	-0.0169*** (0.0045)	-0.0263*** (0.0062)
Leverage	0.0003 (0.0009)	0.0028* (0.0017)	-0.0021** (0.0010)	-0.0014 (0.0017)	-0.0015 (0.0010)	-0.0011 (0.0017)	-0.0000 (0.0009)	0.0013 (0.0016)	-0.0015* (0.0009)	-0.0014 (0.0017)	-0.0007 (0.0008)	-0.0006 (0.0017)
Capex	-0.0082** (0.0033)	0.0004 (0.0085)	-0.0095** (0.0037)	-0.0026 (0.0089)	-0.0134*** (0.0036)	-0.0108 (0.0088)	-0.0131*** (0.0029)	-0.0200*** (0.0067)	-0.0128*** (0.0033)	-0.0226*** (0.0071)	-0.0138*** (0.0030)	-0.0185** (0.0073)
DivDummy	0.0004 (0.0005)	-0.0018** (0.0008)	0.0013** (0.0005)	-0.0013* (0.0008)	0.0011** (0.0005)	-0.0015* (0.0008)	-0.0000 (0.0004)	-0.0019** (0.0007)	0.0005 (0.0004)	-0.0016* (0.0007)	0.0004 (0.0004)	-0.0016** (0.0007)
sCFO	-0.0015 (0.0009)	-0.0003 (0.0004)	-0.0019* (0.0011)	-0.0007* (0.0004)	-0.0019* (0.0011)	-0.0006* (0.0004)	-0.0014* (0.0008)	-0.0002 (0.0004)	-0.0015* (0.0008)	-0.0006* (0.0003)	-0.0018* (0.0009)	-0.0005 (0.0003)
Lagged_DV	0.7077*** (0.0246)	0.6113*** (0.0286)	0.6899*** (0.0256)	0.5910*** (0.0301)	0.6920*** (0.0256)	0.5938*** (0.0300)	0.7422*** (0.0271)	0.6448*** (0.0298)	0.7351*** (0.0253)	0.6318*** (0.0295)	0.7358*** (0.0254)	0.6344*** (0.0295)
DailyVola			0.0004*** (0.0000)	0.0004*** (0.0000)	0.0003*** (0.0000)	0.0004*** (0.0001)			0.0003*** (0.0000)	0.0003*** (0.0000)	0.0002*** (0.0000)	0.0002*** (0.0001)
StockPrice			0.0000*** (0.0000)	0.0000** (0.0000)	0.0000*** (0.0000)	0.0000** (0.0000)			0.0000*** (0.0000)	0.0000*** (0.0000)	0.0000*** (0.0000)	0.0000*** (0.0000)
Turnover			-0.0668*** (0.0082)	-0.0576*** (0.0069)	-0.0617*** (0.0076)	-0.0531*** (0.0067)			-0.0334*** (0.0068)	-0.0219*** (0.0040)	-0.0306*** (0.0066)	-0.0190*** (0.0039)
UncQue			-0.0009* (0.0005)	-0.0013** (0.0005)	-0.0014*** (0.0005)	-0.0014*** (0.0005)			-0.0006 (0.0004)	-0.0013*** (0.0005)	-0.0013*** (0.0004)	-0.0013*** (0.0005)
Extended Controls			Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes			Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Industry FE	Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes	
Firm FE		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes
Year FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes			Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes		
Year-Quarter FE					Yes	Yes					Yes	Yes
N	59,870	59,870	56,737	56,737	56,737	56,737	59,444	59,444	57,537	57,537	57,537	57,537
R ²	0.543	0.400	0.548	0.404	0.548	0.402	0.554	0.409	0.558	0.412	0.557	0.407
Adj. R ²	0.543	0.382	0.548	0.386	0.548	0.383	0.554	0.391	0.558	0.394	0.557	0.388

Notes: * $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$ (one-tailed for IVs, $\beta > 0$; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms). R^2 includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- R^2).

Table 33: H7c: Speech Uncertainty and BGT (2018) 25-Day Post-Call Amihud Level ([0, +25], day 0 included)

	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)	(9)	(10)	(11)	(12)
			BGTLevel_Amihud						BGTLevel_Amihud_lead1			
UncAnsCEO	0.0018** (0.0010)	0.0019** (0.0011)	0.0018** (0.0011)	0.0020** (0.0012)	0.0019** (0.0011)	0.0020** (0.0011)	0.0004 (0.0011)	0.0004 (0.0011)	0.0002 (0.0011)	0.0003 (0.0011)	0.0003 (0.0011)	0.0003 (0.0011)
UncPreCEO	-0.0002 (0.0008)	-0.0001 (0.0010)	-0.0008 (0.0008)	-0.0000 (0.0011)	-0.0008 (0.0008)	-0.0002 (0.0011)	-0.0009 (0.0010)	-0.0010 (0.0012)	-0.0012 (0.0011)	-0.0011 (0.0012)	-0.0011 (0.0011)	-0.0012 (0.0013)
UncAnsMgr	-0.0025 (0.0013)	-0.0031 (0.0014)	-0.0023 (0.0013)	-0.0032 (0.0015)	-0.0029 (0.0013)	-0.0035 (0.0015)	-0.0005 (0.0014)	-0.0007 (0.0015)	0.0014 (0.0015)	-0.0005 (0.0014)	-0.0002 (0.0016)	-0.0006 (0.0016)
UncPreMgr	0.0000 (0.0009)	0.0000 (0.0013)	0.0010 (0.0009)	-0.0003 (0.0013)	0.0005 (0.0008)	-0.0005 (0.0013)	0.0005 (0.0011)	0.0008 (0.0015)	0.0024** (0.0011)	0.0005 (0.0016)	0.0006 (0.0011)	0.0006 (0.0016)
lnAssets	-0.0021*** (0.0003)	-0.0044*** (0.0010)	-0.0009*** (0.0002)	-0.0035*** (0.0011)	-0.0014*** (0.0003)	-0.0040*** (0.0011)	-0.0022*** (0.0003)	-0.0041*** (0.0010)	-0.0008*** (0.0002)	-0.0037*** (0.0011)	-0.0019*** (0.0003)	-0.0038*** (0.0011)
TobinsQ	-0.0008*** (0.0002)	-0.0002 (0.0003)	-0.0005*** (0.0002)	-0.0005 (0.0003)	-0.0006*** (0.0002)	-0.0005 (0.0003)	-0.0008*** (0.0002)	-0.0001 (0.0003)	-0.0003 (0.0002)	-0.0003 (0.0003)	-0.0008*** (0.0002)	-0.0003 (0.0003)
ROA	-0.0303*** (0.0048)	-0.0414*** (0.0072)	-0.0157*** (0.0044)	-0.0276*** (0.0067)	-0.0181*** (0.0045)	-0.0297*** (0.0068)	-0.0286*** (0.0052)	-0.0396*** (0.0073)	-0.0219*** (0.0055)	-0.0325*** (0.0074)	-0.0225*** (0.0055)	-0.0324*** (0.0075)
Leverage	0.0004 (0.0011)	0.0022 (0.0022)	-0.0023* (0.0012)	-0.0037 (0.0023)	-0.0016 (0.0011)	-0.0030 (0.0023)	0.0000 (0.0012)	-0.0016 (0.0022)	-0.0016 (0.0013)	-0.0041* (0.0022)	-0.0005 (0.0012)	-0.0028 (0.0022)
Capex	-0.0109*** (0.0039)	-0.0086 (0.0094)	-0.0126*** (0.0042)	-0.0101 (0.0101)	-0.0152*** (0.0043)	-0.0186*** (0.0102)	-0.0167*** (0.0037)	-0.0245*** (0.0081)	-0.0144*** (0.0038)	-0.0254*** (0.0085)	-0.0156*** (0.0038)	-0.0198*** (0.0085)
DivDummy	0.0005 (0.0006)	-0.0015* (0.0009)	0.0015** (0.0006)	-0.0010 (0.0009)	0.0011* (0.0006)	-0.0013 (0.0009)	0.0002 (0.0006)	-0.0024** (0.0006)	0.0006 (0.0009)	-0.0022** (0.0009)	0.0005 (0.0006)	-0.0022** (0.0009)
sCFO	-0.0023 (0.0015)	-0.0009 (0.0007)	-0.0031 (0.0019)	-0.0015* (0.0008)	-0.0029 (0.0018)	-0.0013* (0.0007)	-0.0019 (0.0012)	-0.0005 (0.0005)	-0.0019 (0.0012)	-0.0008 (0.0005)	-0.0022 (0.0013)	-0.0007 (0.0006)
Lagged_DV	0.7896*** (0.0242)	0.6805*** (0.0297)	0.7740*** (0.0258)	0.6612*** (0.0314)	0.7773*** (0.0261)	0.6649*** (0.0315)	0.7859*** (0.0246)	0.6782*** (0.0299)	0.7828*** (0.0257)	0.6679*** (0.0310)	0.7840*** (0.0259)	0.6721*** (0.0310)
DailyVola			0.0004*** (0.0000)	0.0005*** (0.0001)	0.0003*** (0.0000)	0.0004*** (0.0001)		0.0002*** (0.0000)	0.0002*** (0.0000)	0.0001*** (0.0000)	0.0002*** (0.0000)	0.0002*** (0.0001)
StockPrice			0.0000*** (0.0000)	0.0000*** (0.0000)	0.0000*** (0.0000)	0.0000*** (0.0000)		0.0000*** (0.0000)	0.0000*** (0.0000)	0.0000*** (0.0000)	0.0000*** (0.0000)	0.0000*** (0.0000)
Turnover			-0.0787*** (0.0086)	-0.0708*** (0.0087)	-0.0707*** (0.0081)	-0.0635*** (0.0088)		-0.0321*** (0.0075)	-0.0229*** (0.0053)	-0.0289*** (0.0075)	-0.0198*** (0.0054)	-0.0198*** (0.0054)
UncQue			-0.0011* (0.0005)	-0.0012** (0.0006)	-0.0014** (0.0006)	-0.0014** (0.0006)		0.0005 (0.0005)	-0.0004 (0.0005)	-0.0003 (0.0005)	-0.0003 (0.0005)	-0.0003 (0.0005)
Extended Controls			Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes		Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Industry FE	Yes		Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes		Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Firm FE		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes
Year FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes			Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes		
Year-Quarter FE					Yes	Yes					Yes	Yes
N	63,806	63,806	60,256	60,256	60,256	60,256	63,351	63,351	61,099	61,099	61,099	61,099
R ²	0.621	0.451	0.621	0.456	0.622	0.454	0.623	0.456	0.618	0.453	0.619	0.451
Adj. R ²	0.621	0.435	0.621	0.440	0.621	0.437	0.623	0.441	0.618	0.437	0.618	0.434

Notes: * $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$ (one-tailed for IVs, $\beta > 0$; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms). R^2 includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- R^2).

Table 34: H7c Robustness: Orthogonal Speaker Partition

	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)	(9)	(10)	(11)	(12)
			BGTLevel_Amihud						BGTLevel_Amihud_lead1			
UncAnsCEO	0.0005 (0.0007)	0.0005 (0.0008)	0.0002 (0.0007)	0.0002 (0.0008)	0.0000 (0.0007)	-0.0001 (0.0008)	-0.0001 (0.0006)	-0.0003 (0.0006)	0.0005 (0.0006)	-0.0003 (0.0007)	-0.0002 (0.0006)	-0.0003 (0.0007)
UncAnsNoCEO	-0.0006 (0.0004)	-0.0007 (0.0005)	-0.0007 (0.0005)	-0.0008 (0.0005)	-0.0008 (0.0004)	-0.0008 (0.0005)	0.0004 (0.0004)	0.0005 (0.0005)	0.0010** (0.0005)	0.0007* (0.0005)	0.0005 (0.0004)	0.0007* (0.0005)
UncPreCEO	-0.0002 (0.0007)	-0.0001 (0.0009)	-0.0003 (0.0007)	-0.0001 (0.0009)	-0.0005 (0.0007)	-0.0004 (0.0009)	-0.0007 (0.0007)	-0.0008 (0.0009)	-0.0002 (0.0007)	-0.0010 (0.0010)	-0.0008 (0.0007)	-0.0010 (0.0010)
UncPreNoCEO	-0.0001 (0.0003)	-0.0003 (0.0005)	0.0001 (0.0003)	-0.0005 (0.0006)	0.0001 (0.0003)	-0.0005 (0.0006)	0.0006* (0.0004)	-0.0003 (0.0007)	0.0013*** (0.0005)	-0.0004 (0.0008)	0.0007* (0.0005)	-0.0003 (0.0008)
lnAssets	-0.0017*** (0.0003)	-0.0034*** (0.0010)	-0.0008*** (0.0002)	-0.0026** (0.0011)	-0.0011*** (0.0003)	-0.0031*** (0.0011)	-0.0018*** (0.0003)	-0.0036*** (0.0009)	-0.0006*** (0.0002)	-0.0033*** (0.0010)	-0.0016*** (0.0003)	-0.0034*** (0.0010)
TobinsQ	-0.0006*** (0.0002)	-0.0001 (0.0003)	-0.0004*** (0.0002)	-0.0003 (0.0003)	-0.0005*** (0.0002)	-0.0003 (0.0003)	-0.0006*** (0.0002)	0.0000 (0.0003)	-0.0002 (0.0002)	-0.0002 (0.0003)	-0.0007*** (0.0002)	-0.0002 (0.0003)
ROA	-0.0281*** (0.0048)	-0.0406*** (0.0073)	-0.0148*** (0.0046)	-0.0272*** (0.0068)	-0.0171*** (0.0047)	-0.0291*** (0.0069)	-0.0280*** (0.0053)	-0.0383*** (0.0073)	-0.0220*** (0.0056)	-0.0321*** (0.0074)	-0.0224*** (0.0057)	-0.0318*** (0.0075)
Leverage	-0.0000 (0.0010)	0.0014 (0.0020)	-0.0023** (0.0012)	-0.0033 (0.0021)	-0.0017 (0.0011)	-0.0025 (0.0020)	-0.0008 (0.0011)	-0.0015 (0.0012)	-0.0022* (0.0012)	-0.0038* (0.0021)	-0.0012 (0.0011)	-0.0026 (0.0020)
Capex	-0.0079** (0.0038)	-0.0003 (0.0102)	-0.0102** (0.0043)	-0.0023 (0.0110)	-0.0124*** (0.0043)	-0.0111 (0.0111)	-0.0145*** (0.0035)	-0.0237*** (0.0083)	-0.0130*** (0.0037)	-0.0253*** (0.0087)	-0.0136*** (0.0036)	-0.0193** (0.0088)
DivDummy	0.0002 (0.0005)	-0.0017* (0.0009)	0.0013* (0.0006)	-0.0010 (0.0009)	0.0010* (0.0006)	-0.0013 (0.0009)	0.0001 (0.0005)	-0.0024** (0.0009)	0.0006 (0.0005)	-0.0021* (0.0009)	0.0005 (0.0005)	-0.0021** (0.0009)
sCFO	-0.0020 (0.0014)	-0.0004 (0.0005)	-0.0027 (0.0017)	-0.0009* (0.0005)	-0.0024 (0.0016)	-0.0008* (0.0005)	-0.0016 (0.0011)	-0.0004 (0.0004)	-0.0016 (0.0010)	-0.0007 (0.0004)	-0.0019 (0.0012)	-0.0006 (0.0004)
Lagged_DV	0.7940*** (0.0278)	0.6882*** (0.0338)	0.7812*** (0.0290)	0.6716*** (0.0351)	0.7849*** (0.0292)	0.6753*** (0.0353)	0.8071*** (0.0270)	0.7025*** (0.0338)	0.8015*** (0.0276)	0.6911*** (0.0343)	0.8034*** (0.0276)	0.6956*** (0.0343)
DailyVola			0.0004*** (0.0000)	0.0005*** (0.0001)	0.0003*** (0.0001)	0.0004*** (0.0001)			0.0002*** (0.0000)	0.0002*** (0.0000)	0.0001*** (0.0000)	0.0002*** (0.0001)
StockPrice			0.0000*** (0.0000)	0.0000** (0.0000)	0.0000*** (0.0000)	0.0000** (0.0000)			0.0000*** (0.0000)	0.0000** (0.0000)	0.0000*** (0.0000)	0.0000** (0.0000)
Turnover			-0.0720*** (0.0080)	-0.0666*** (0.0094)	-0.0643*** (0.0076)	-0.0596*** (0.0099)			-0.0284*** (0.0072)	-0.0212*** (0.0058)	-0.0256*** (0.0073)	-0.0184*** (0.0060)
UncQue			-0.0012** (0.0005)	-0.0013** (0.0005)	-0.0015*** (0.0005)	-0.0015*** (0.0005)			0.0000 (0.0004)	-0.0007 (0.0004)	-0.0007 (0.0004)	-0.0006 (0.0004)
Extended Controls			Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes			Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Industry FE	Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes	
Firm FE		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes
Year FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes			Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes		
Year-Quarter FE					Yes	Yes					Yes	Yes
N	59,935	59,935	56,802	56,802	56,802	56,802	59,481	59,481	57,576	57,576	57,576	57,576
R ²	0.631	0.468	0.638	0.479	0.639	0.477	0.641	0.480	0.640	0.479	0.641	0.477
Adj. R ²	0.631	0.453	0.638	0.463	0.639	0.460	0.641	0.464	0.640	0.463	0.641	0.460

Notes: * $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$ (one-tailed for IVs, $\beta > 0$; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms). R^2 includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- R^2).

Table 35: H7d: Speech Uncertainty and BGT-Window 25-Day Amihud Delta ($[+1, +25] - [-25, -1]$)

	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)	(9)	(10)	(11)	(12)
			BGTDelta_Amihud						BGTDelta_Amihud_lead1			
UncAnsCEO	0.0001 (0.0005)	0.0003 (0.0006)	0.0000 (0.0006)	0.0002 (0.0006)	0.0001 (0.0006)	0.0003 (0.0006)	0.0000 (0.0005)	0.0001 (0.0005)	0.0002 (0.0005)	0.0002 (0.0006)	0.0002 (0.0005)	0.0002 (0.0005)
UncPreCEO	0.0002 (0.0004)	-0.0001 (0.0006)	0.0002 (0.0004)	-0.0003 (0.0006)	0.0000 (0.0004)	-0.0003 (0.0006)	0.0007** (0.0003)	0.0006 (0.0005)	0.0009*** (0.0004)	0.0006 (0.0005)	0.0010*** (0.0004)	0.0007* (0.0005)
UncAnsMgr	0.0011* (0.0007)	0.0009 (0.0008)	-0.0005 (0.0007)	0.0006 (0.0008)	0.0007 (0.0007)	0.0005 (0.0008)	-0.0003 (0.0006)	-0.0006 (0.0008)	0.0000 (0.0006)	-0.0003 (0.0008)	-0.0000 (0.0006)	-0.0001 (0.0008)
UncPreMgr	-0.0002 (0.0004)	0.0003 (0.0007)	-0.0017 (0.0004)	0.0002 (0.0008)	-0.0002 (0.0004)	0.0003 (0.0008)	-0.0005 (0.0004)	-0.0005 (0.0006)	-0.0005 (0.0004)	-0.0004 (0.0006)	-0.0007 (0.0004)	-0.0002 (0.0006)
InAssets	0.0008*** (0.0001)	0.0022*** (0.0004)	0.0001* (0.0001)	0.0029*** (0.0004)	0.0009*** (0.0001)	0.0027*** (0.0004)	0.0007*** (0.0001)	0.0017*** (0.0003)	0.0004*** (0.0001)	0.0016*** (0.0004)	0.0003*** (0.0001)	0.0016*** (0.0004)
TobinsQ	0.0005*** (0.0001)	0.0009*** (0.0002)	0.0002*** (0.0001)	0.0010*** (0.0002)	0.0005*** (0.0001)	0.0009*** (0.0002)	0.0004*** (0.0001)	0.0006*** (0.0001)	0.0003*** (0.0001)	0.0007*** (0.0001)	0.0003*** (0.0001)	0.0006*** (0.0001)
ROA	-0.0029* (0.0016)	-0.0059** (0.0026)	-0.0010 (0.0016)	-0.0035 (0.0027)	-0.0018 (0.0018)	-0.0040 (0.0028)	0.0022 (0.0018)	0.0028 (0.0026)	-0.0031* (0.0017)	-0.0020 (0.0026)	-0.0024 (0.0018)	-0.0012 (0.0027)
Leverage	-0.0012** (0.0005)	-0.0037** (0.0014)	-0.0011* (0.0006)	-0.0052*** (0.0015)	-0.0013** (0.0005)	-0.0045*** (0.0015)	-0.0002 (0.0005)	-0.0027** (0.0012)	0.0007 (0.0005)	-0.0006 (0.0013)	0.0008 (0.0005)	-0.0003 (0.0013)
Capex	0.0016 (0.0016)	0.0008 (0.0039)	-0.0027* (0.0016)	-0.0005 (0.0040)	0.0005 (0.0016)	-0.0002 (0.0041)	0.0006 (0.0019)	-0.0049 (0.0042)	0.0021 (0.0020)	-0.0039 (0.0042)	0.0026 (0.0019)	-0.0005 (0.0041)
DivDummy	-0.0002 (0.0002)	0.0005 (0.0004)	0.0001 (0.0002)	0.0007 (0.0005)	0.0000 (0.0002)	0.0006 (0.0005)	-0.0003 (0.0002)	0.0003 (0.0004)	-0.0007*** (0.0002)	0.0000 (0.0004)	-0.0007*** (0.0002)	0.0001 (0.0004)
sCFO	-0.0003 (0.0002)	-0.0002 (0.0002)	-0.0010* (0.0006)	-0.0003 (0.0002)	-0.0005 (0.0003)	-0.0002 (0.0002)	-0.0002 (0.0002)	-0.0002 (0.0002)	0.0002 (0.0003)	0.0000 (0.0002)	0.0001 (0.0003)	0.0000 (0.0002)
Lagged_DV	0.1639*** (0.0361)	0.1408*** (0.0377)	0.1718*** (0.0376)	0.1467*** (0.0390)	0.1700*** (0.0377)	0.1486*** (0.0391)	0.1776*** (0.0340)	0.1557*** (0.0353)	0.1715*** (0.0343)	0.1530*** (0.0356)	0.1740*** (0.0346)	0.1547*** (0.0357)
DailyVola			0.0000 (0.0000)	0.0001 (0.0000)	0.0000 (0.0000)	0.0001 (0.0000)			-0.0001*** (0.0000)	-0.0002*** (0.0000)	-0.0001*** (0.0000)	-0.0002*** (0.0000)
StockPrice			0.0000 (0.0000)	-0.0000*** (0.0000)	-0.0000* (0.0000)	-0.0000*** (0.0000)			-0.0000*** (0.0000)	-0.0000** (0.0000)	-0.0000*** (0.0000)	-0.0000** (0.0000)
Turnover			-0.0008 (0.0030)	-0.0045 (0.0028)	0.0014 (0.0033)	-0.0019 (0.0031)			0.0204*** (0.0031)	0.0180*** (0.0030)	0.0189*** (0.0031)	0.0166*** (0.0029)
UncQue			-0.0005 (0.0003)	0.0001 (0.0003)	0.0002 (0.0003)	0.0001 (0.0003)			0.0005 (0.0003)	0.0003 (0.0003)	0.0004 (0.0003)	0.0003 (0.0003)
Extended Controls			Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes			Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Industry FE	Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes	
Firm FE		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes
Year FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes			Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes		
Year-Quarter FE					Yes	Yes					Yes	Yes
N	63,537	63,537	60,036	60,036	60,036	60,036	63,066	63,066	60,826	60,826	60,826	60,826
R ²	0.030	0.022	0.031	0.028	0.032	0.025	0.034	0.026	0.039	0.032	0.038	0.031
Adj. R ²	0.030	-0.006	0.031	-0.001	0.031	-0.004	0.033	-0.002	0.038	0.004	0.036	0.001

Notes: * $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$ (one-tailed for IVs, $\beta > 0$; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms). R^2 includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- R^2).

Table 36: H7d Robustness: Orthogonal Speaker Partition

	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)	(9)	(10)	(11)	(12)
			BGTDelta_Amihud						BGTDelta_Amihud_lead1			
UncAnsCEO	0.0006** (0.0003)	0.0006* (0.0004)	-0.0002 (0.0003)	0.0005 (0.0004)	0.0004* (0.0003)	0.0004 (0.0004)	-0.0001 (0.0004)	-0.0000 (0.0005)	0.0001 (0.0004)	0.0001 (0.0005)	0.0001 (0.0004)	0.0002 (0.0005)
UncAnsNoCEO	-0.0001 (0.0003)	-0.0002 (0.0003)	-0.0006 (0.0003)	-0.0004 (0.0003)	-0.0002 (0.0003)	-0.0004 (0.0003)	0.0002 (0.0002)	0.0002 (0.0003)	0.0003 (0.0003)	0.0002 (0.0003)	0.0002 (0.0002)	0.0002 (0.0003)
UncPreCEO	0.0000 (0.0003)	-0.0001 (0.0005)	-0.0006 (0.0004)	-0.0002 (0.0005)	-0.0001 (0.0004)	-0.0003 (0.0005)	0.0004** (0.0003)	0.0003 (0.0003)	0.0006** (0.0003)	0.0003 (0.0003)	0.0006*** (0.0003)	0.0005* (0.0003)
UncPreNoCEO	-0.0001 (0.0002)	0.0000 (0.0003)	-0.0007 (0.0002)	-0.0000 (0.0004)	-0.0001 (0.0002)	0.0001 (0.0004)	-0.0001 (0.0002)	0.0002 (0.0003)	-0.0001 (0.0002)	0.0003 (0.0003)	-0.0001 (0.0002)	0.0003 (0.0003)
InAssets	0.0008*** (0.0001)	0.0022*** (0.0004)	0.0001* (0.0001)	0.0029*** (0.0005)	0.0008*** (0.0001)	0.0026*** (0.0005)	0.0006*** (0.0001)	0.0016*** (0.0004)	0.0004*** (0.0001)	0.0015*** (0.0004)	0.0003*** (0.0001)	0.0015*** (0.0004)
TobinsQ	0.0005*** (0.0001)	0.0008*** (0.0002)	0.0002*** (0.0001)	0.0010*** (0.0002)	0.0005*** (0.0001)	0.0009*** (0.0002)	0.0003*** (0.0001)	0.0005*** (0.0001)	0.0003*** (0.0001)	0.0006*** (0.0001)	0.0002*** (0.0001)	0.0005*** (0.0001)
ROA	-0.0033** (0.0016)	-0.0058** (0.0028)	-0.0014 (0.0017)	-0.0032 (0.0028)	-0.0022 (0.0019)	-0.0038 (0.0030)	0.0019 (0.0017)	0.0033 (0.0026)	-0.0032* (0.0017)	-0.0018 (0.0025)	-0.0025 (0.0018)	-0.0009 (0.0026)
Leverage	-0.0009* (0.0005)	-0.0040*** (0.0015)	-0.0007 (0.0005)	-0.0052*** (0.0016)	-0.0009* (0.0005)	-0.0045*** (0.0015)	-0.0002 (0.0005)	-0.0022* (0.0013)	0.0006 (0.0005)	-0.0004 (0.0013)	0.0007 (0.0005)	-0.0002 (0.0013)
Capex	0.0010 (0.0016)	0.0007 (0.0039)	-0.0029* (0.0016)	0.0001 (0.0041)	0.0003 (0.0016)	-0.0001 (0.0041)	-0.0004 (0.0019)	-0.0056 (0.0042)	0.0013 (0.0021)	-0.0045 (0.0042)	0.0017 (0.0019)	-0.0013 (0.0041)
DivDummy	-0.0001 (0.0002)	0.0005 (0.0005)	0.0002 (0.0002)	0.0008 (0.0005)	0.0001 (0.0002)	0.0007 (0.0005)	-0.0001 (0.0002)	0.0003 (0.0004)	-0.0006*** (0.0002)	0.0001 (0.0004)	-0.0005*** (0.0002)	0.0002 (0.0004)
sCFO	-0.0003 (0.0002)	-0.0001 (0.0002)	-0.0009* (0.0005)	-0.0002 (0.0002)	-0.0004 (0.0003)	-0.0001 (0.0002)	-0.0003 (0.0002)	-0.0004 (0.0002)	0.0001 (0.0002)	-0.0001 (0.0002)	-0.0000 (0.0002)	-0.0002 (0.0002)
Lagged_DV	0.1749*** (0.0407)	0.1543*** (0.0418)	0.1791*** (0.0415)	0.1551*** (0.0427)	0.1766*** (0.0415)	0.1562*** (0.0427)	0.1883*** (0.0375)	0.1682*** (0.0389)	0.1811*** (0.0366)	0.1641*** (0.0382)	0.1837*** (0.0369)	0.1658*** (0.0384)
DailyVola			0.0000 (0.0000)	0.0001*** (0.0000)	0.0000 (0.0000)	0.0001 (0.0000)			-0.0001*** (0.0000)	-0.0002*** (0.0000)	-0.0001*** (0.0000)	-0.0002*** (0.0000)
StockPrice			0.0000 (0.0000)	-0.0000*** (0.0000)	-0.0000* (0.0000)	-0.0000*** (0.0000)			-0.0000*** (0.0000)	-0.0000** (0.0000)	-0.0000*** (0.0000)	-0.0000** (0.0000)
Turnover			-0.0008 (0.0032)	-0.0052* (0.0029)	0.0018 (0.0035)	-0.0025 (0.0033)			0.0196*** (0.0032)	0.0177*** (0.0031)	0.0182*** (0.0031)	0.0163*** (0.0031)
UncQue			-0.0004 (0.0003)	0.0002 (0.0003)	0.0003 (0.0003)	0.0001 (0.0003)			0.0004 (0.0003)	0.0001 (0.0003)	0.0003 (0.0003)	0.0002 (0.0003)
Extended Controls			Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes			Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Industry FE	Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes	
Firm FE		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes
Year FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes			Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes		
Year-Quarter FE					Yes	Yes					Yes	Yes
N	59,692	59,692	56,602	56,602	56,602	56,602	59,228	59,228	57,334	57,334	57,334	57,334
R ²	0.034	0.026	0.034	0.030	0.035	0.028	0.037	0.029	0.042	0.035	0.041	0.034
Adj. R ²	0.033	-0.003	0.033	0.001	0.033	-0.003	0.036	0.000	0.041	0.006	0.039	0.003

Notes: * $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$ (one-tailed for IVs, $\beta > 0$; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms). R^2 includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- R^2).

Table 37: H7e: Speech Uncertainty and BGT-Window 25-Day Amihud Average ($[-25, +25]$, 51-day symmetric)

	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)	(9)	(10)	(11)	(12)
			BGTAvg_Amihud						BGTAvg_Amihud_Lead1			
UncAnsCEO	0.0009 (0.0011)	0.0008 (0.0011)	0.0010 (0.0011)	0.0010 (0.0011)	0.0009 (0.0011)	0.0009 (0.0011)	0.0002 (0.0013)	0.0003 (0.0014)	0.0000 (0.0013)	0.0002 (0.0014)	0.0001 (0.0013)	0.0002 (0.0014)
UncPreCEO	-0.0005 (0.0010)	-0.0005 (0.0013)	-0.0011 (0.0010)	-0.0002 (0.0013)	-0.0010 (0.0010)	-0.0003 (0.0013)	-0.0012 (0.0012)	-0.0015 (0.0015)	-0.0017 (0.0012)	-0.0016 (0.0015)	-0.0018 (0.0012)	-0.0018 (0.0015)
UncAnsMgr	-0.0031 (0.0014)	-0.0039 (0.0016)	-0.0024 (0.0015)	-0.0036 (0.0016)	-0.0030 (0.0014)	-0.0040 (0.0016)	0.0006 (0.0016)	0.0006 (0.0016)	0.0014 (0.0016)	0.0005 (0.0018)	0.0005 (0.0016)	0.0003 (0.0018)
UncPreMgr	0.0006 (0.0010)	0.0005 (0.0015)	0.0016** (0.0010)	-0.0000 (0.0015)	0.0009 (0.0009)	-0.0003 (0.0015)	0.0010 (0.0013)	0.0014 (0.0018)	0.0020* (0.0013)	0.0009 (0.0018)	0.0012 (0.0012)	0.0010 (0.0018)
lnAssets	-0.0022*** (0.0003)	-0.0045*** (0.0010)	-0.0010*** (0.0002)	-0.0037*** (0.0012)	-0.0015*** (0.0003)	-0.0042*** (0.0012)	-0.0021*** (0.0004)	-0.0037*** (0.0010)	-0.0009*** (0.0002)	-0.0028*** (0.0011)	-0.0016*** (0.0003)	-0.0031*** (0.0011)
TobinsQ	-0.0010*** (0.0002)	-0.0006* (0.0003)	-0.0007*** (0.0002)	-0.0009* (0.0004)	-0.0009*** (0.0002)	-0.0008** (0.0004)	-0.0008*** (0.0002)	0.0001 (0.0003)	-0.0005** (0.0002)	-0.0002 (0.0003)	-0.0007*** (0.0002)	-0.0001 (0.0004)
ROA	-0.0312*** (0.0054)	-0.0422*** (0.0083)	-0.0159*** (0.0051)	-0.0280*** (0.0079)	-0.0188*** (0.0052)	-0.0306*** (0.0080)	-0.0316*** (0.0058)	-0.0438*** (0.0081)	-0.0199*** (0.0059)	-0.0321*** (0.0080)	-0.0216*** (0.0060)	-0.0331*** (0.0082)
Leverage	0.0001 (0.0012)	0.0032 (0.0022)	-0.0027** (0.0013)	-0.0029 (0.0023)	-0.0020 (0.0012)	-0.0024 (0.0023)	-0.0007 (0.0014)	-0.0016 (0.0023)	-0.0029** (0.0015)	-0.0065*** (0.0024)	-0.0020 (0.0014)	-0.0050** (0.0023)
Capex	-0.0082* (0.0047)	0.0002 (0.0115)	-0.0102** (0.0049)	-0.0021 (0.0119)	-0.0149*** (0.0049)	-0.0164 (0.0119)	-0.0171*** (0.0042)	-0.0231** (0.0091)	-0.0186*** (0.0046)	-0.0251*** (0.0095)	-0.0178*** (0.0044)	-0.0210** (0.0096)
DivDummy	0.0007 (0.0006)	-0.0014 (0.0009)	0.0018** (0.0007)	-0.0008 (0.0009)	0.0013* (0.0007)	-0.0013 (0.0009)	0.0003 (0.0006)	-0.0025** (0.0010)	0.0011* (0.0006)	-0.0021** (0.0010)	0.0009 (0.0007)	-0.0022** (0.0010)
sCFO	-0.0025 (0.0017)	-0.0007 (0.0007)	-0.0032 (0.0021)	-0.0013* (0.0008)	-0.0030 (0.0019)	-0.0012* (0.0007)	-0.0021 (0.0014)	-0.0005 (0.0005)	-0.0027 (0.0017)	-0.0011* (0.0006)	-0.0027 (0.0017)	-0.0009 (0.0006)
Lagged_DV	0.7988*** (0.0237)	0.7012*** (0.0290)	0.7871*** (0.0244)	0.6888*** (0.0301)	0.7902*** (0.0247)	0.6925*** (0.0303)	0.8046*** (0.0245)	0.7083*** (0.0300)	0.7974*** (0.0255)	0.6987*** (0.0310)	0.7985*** (0.0257)	0.7005*** (0.0309)
DailyVola			0.0004*** (0.0000)	0.0005*** (0.0001)	0.0003*** (0.0001)	0.0004*** (0.0001)		0.0003*** (0.0001)	0.0004*** (0.0001)	0.0003*** (0.0001)	0.0003*** (0.0001)	0.0003*** (0.0001)
StockPrice			0.0000*** (0.0000)	0.0000** (0.0000)	0.0000*** (0.0000)	0.0000** (0.0000)		0.0000*** (0.0000)	0.0000** (0.0000)	0.0000*** (0.0000)	0.0000*** (0.0000)	0.0000** (0.0000)
Turnover			-0.0733*** (0.0121)	-0.0591*** (0.0108)	-0.0644*** (0.0110)	-0.0516*** (0.0096)		-0.0542*** (0.0070)	-0.0455*** (0.0107)	-0.0485*** (0.0070)	-0.0403*** (0.0112)	
UncQue			-0.0009 (0.0007)	-0.0011 (0.0007)	-0.0013** (0.0007)	-0.0013* (0.0007)		-0.0002 (0.0006)	-0.0006 (0.0006)	-0.0006 (0.0006)	-0.0006 (0.0006)	-0.0006 (0.0006)
Extended Controls			Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes		Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Industry FE	Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes	
Firm FE		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes
Year FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes			Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes		
Year-Quarter FE					Yes	Yes					Yes	Yes
N	63,816	63,816	60,256	60,256	60,256	60,256	63,397	63,397	61,136	61,136	61,136	61,136
R ²	0.647	0.496	0.647	0.500	0.649	0.500	0.644	0.494	0.643	0.496	0.642	0.492
Adj. R ²	0.646	0.482	0.647	0.485	0.649	0.485	0.644	0.479	0.643	0.482	0.641	0.476

Notes: * $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$ (one-tailed for IVs, $\beta > 0$; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms). R^2 includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- R^2).

Table 38: H7e Robustness: Orthogonal Speaker Partition

	(1)	(2)	(3) BGTAvg_Amihud		(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)	(9) BGTAvg_Amihud_Lead1		(10)	(11)	(12)
UncAnsCEO	-0.0005 (0.0007)	-0.0010 (0.0009)	-0.0007 (0.0008)	-0.0012 (0.0009)	-0.0010 (0.0008)	-0.0015 (0.0009)	0.0004 (0.0007)	0.0002 (0.0008)	0.0006 (0.0007)	0.0002 (0.0009)	0.0002 (0.0008)	0.0002 (0.0009)	0.0001 (0.0009)
UncAnsNoCEO	-0.0007 (0.0005)	-0.0008 (0.0005)	-0.0007 (0.0005)	-0.0008 (0.0005)	-0.0008 (0.0005)	-0.0008 (0.0005)	0.0001 (0.0005)	0.0001 (0.0006)	0.0005 (0.0005)	0.0003 (0.0006)	0.0002 (0.0005)	0.0003 (0.0005)	0.0003 (0.0006)
UncPreCEO	-0.0003 (0.0008)	-0.0003 (0.0010)	-0.0003 (0.0008)	-0.0003 (0.0010)	-0.0006 (0.0008)	-0.0006 (0.0010)	-0.0009 (0.0008)	-0.0011 (0.0010)	-0.0009 (0.0008)	-0.0014 (0.0011)	-0.0013 (0.0008)	-0.0013 (0.0011)	-0.0016 (0.0011)
UncPreNoCEO	-0.0000 (0.0003)	-0.0005 (0.0007)	0.0003 (0.0004)	-0.0007 (0.0007)	0.0001 (0.0004)	-0.0008 (0.0007)	0.0005 (0.0005)	-0.0007 (0.0008)	0.0009** (0.0005)	-0.0009 (0.0008)	0.0006* (0.0005)	-0.0008 (0.0005)	-0.0008 (0.0008)
lnAssets	-0.0018*** (0.0003)	-0.0034*** (0.0011)	-0.0008*** (0.0002)	-0.0028** (0.0012)	-0.0012*** (0.0003)	-0.0033*** (0.0012)	-0.0018*** (0.0003)	-0.0033*** (0.0010)	-0.0008*** (0.0002)	-0.0026** (0.0011)	-0.0014*** (0.0003)	-0.0029*** (0.0011)	-0.0029*** (0.0011)
TobinsQ	-0.0008*** (0.0002)	-0.0004 (0.0003)	-0.0006*** (0.0002)	-0.0007** (0.0004)	-0.0007*** (0.0002)	-0.0006*** (0.0004)	-0.0007*** (0.0002)	0.0001 (0.0003)	-0.0004** (0.0002)	-0.0001 (0.0004)	-0.0007*** (0.0002)	-0.0001 (0.0004)	-0.0001 (0.0004)
ROA	-0.0298*** (0.0056)	-0.0428*** (0.0087)	-0.0165*** (0.0054)	-0.0296*** (0.0083)	-0.0194*** (0.0056)	-0.0321*** (0.0084)	-0.0307*** (0.0059)	-0.0435*** (0.0083)	-0.0199*** (0.0060)	-0.0323*** (0.0083)	-0.0214*** (0.0062)	-0.0332*** (0.0085)	-0.0332*** (0.0085)
Leverage	-0.0005 (0.0012)	0.0024 (0.0020)	-0.0028** (0.0013)	-0.0025 (0.0021)	-0.0021* (0.0012)	-0.0019 (0.0021)	-0.0014 (0.0013)	-0.0021 (0.0020)	-0.0033*** (0.0014)	-0.0062*** (0.0022)	-0.0025** (0.0013)	-0.0048** (0.0022)	-0.0048** (0.0022)
Capex	-0.0047 (0.0047)	0.0089 (0.0123)	-0.0070 (0.0049)	0.0061 (0.0128)	-0.0115** (0.0049)	-0.0080 (0.0127)	-0.0146*** (0.0041)	-0.0216** (0.0091)	-0.0166*** (0.0046)	-0.0244** (0.0098)	-0.0154*** (0.0044)	-0.0193* (0.0099)	-0.0193* (0.0099)
DivDummy	0.0004 (0.0006)	-0.0015* (0.0009)	0.0016** (0.0006)	-0.0009 (0.0009)	0.0011* (0.0006)	-0.0014 (0.0009)	0.0000 (0.0006)	-0.0028*** (0.0010)	0.0010* (0.0006)	-0.0023** (0.0010)	0.0007 (0.0006)	-0.0024** (0.0010)	-0.0024** (0.0010)
sCFO	-0.0023 (0.0016)	-0.0004 (0.0005)	-0.0029 (0.0019)	-0.0009 (0.0006)	-0.0027 (0.0018)	-0.0008 (0.0005)	-0.0017 (0.0012)	-0.0002 (0.0004)	-0.0023 (0.0014)	-0.0007* (0.0004)	-0.0022 (0.0014)	-0.0006 (0.0004)	-0.0006 (0.0004)
Lagged_DV	0.8094*** (0.0280)	0.7140*** (0.0339)	0.7963*** (0.0283)	0.6989*** (0.0346)	0.7997*** (0.0285)	0.7027*** (0.0348)	0.8203*** (0.0292)	0.7252*** (0.0367)	0.8091*** (0.0299)	0.7119*** (0.0374)	0.8106*** (0.0301)	0.7141*** (0.0373)	0.7141*** (0.0373)
DailyVola			0.0004*** (0.0000)	0.0005*** (0.0001)	0.0003*** (0.0001)	0.0004*** (0.0001)			0.0003*** (0.0001)	0.0004*** (0.0001)	0.0003*** (0.0001)	0.0003*** (0.0001)	0.0003*** (0.0001)
StockPrice			0.0000*** (0.0000)	0.0000** (0.0000)	0.0000*** (0.0000)	0.0000** (0.0000)			0.0000*** (0.0000)	0.0000** (0.0000)	0.0000*** (0.0000)	0.0000** (0.0000)	0.0000** (0.0000)
Turnover			-0.0651*** (0.0112)	-0.0525*** (0.0085)	-0.0564*** (0.0101)	-0.0452*** (0.0075)			-0.0519*** (0.0072)	-0.0452*** (0.0120)	-0.0468*** (0.0073)	-0.0404*** (0.0125)	-0.0404*** (0.0125)
UncQue			-0.0010 (0.0006)	-0.0012* (0.0006)	-0.0013** (0.0006)	-0.0014** (0.0006)			-0.0006 (0.0006)	-0.0009 (0.0006)	-0.0010* (0.0005)	-0.0009* (0.0005)	-0.0009* (0.0006)
Extended Controls			Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes			Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Industry FE	Yes		Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes		Yes		Yes	Yes	
Firm FE		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes			Yes
Year FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes			Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes			
Year-Quarter FE					Yes	Yes					Yes	Yes	
N	59,943	59,943	56,803	56,803	56,803	56,803	59,521	59,521	57,609	57,609	57,609	57,609	57,609
R ²	0.656	0.513	0.659	0.517	0.661	0.518	0.649	0.501	0.649	0.503	0.648	0.499	0.499
Adj. R ²	0.656	0.499	0.659	0.502	0.661	0.503	0.649	0.487	0.649	0.488	0.648	0.483	0.483

Notes: * $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$ (one-tailed for IVs, $\beta > 0$; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms). R^2 includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- R^2).

Table 39: H11: Political Risk and Language Uncertainty

	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)	(9)	(10)	(11)	(12)
	Industry FE						Firm FE					
	UncAnsMgr	UncAnsCEO	UncPreMgr	UncPreCEO	UncAnsNoCEO	UncPreNoCEO	UncAnsMgr	UncAnsCEO	UncPreMgr	UncPreCEO	UncAnsNoCEO	UncPreNoCEO
Political Risk _t	0.0002 *** (0.0000)	0.0001 *** (0.0000)	0.0002 *** (0.0000)	0.0003 *** (0.0000)	0.0001 *** (0.0000)	0.0001 *** (0.0000)	0.0001 *** (0.0000)	0.0001 *** (0.0000)	0.0001 *** (0.0000)	0.0002 *** (0.0000)	0.0001 *** (0.0000)	0.0001 *** (0.0000)
UncQue	0.0431 *** (0.0035)	0.0452 *** (0.0043)	0.0240 *** (0.0041)	0.0204 *** (0.0045)	0.0504 *** (0.0057)	0.0270 *** (0.0077)	0.0346 *** (0.0026)	0.0380 *** (0.0033)	0.0091 *** (0.0024)	0.0081 *** (0.0029)	0.0410 *** (0.0051)	0.0130 *** (0.0044)
NegCall	0.0890 *** (0.0091)	0.0867 *** (0.0107)	0.1248 *** (0.0124)	0.1874 *** (0.0141)	0.0652 *** (0.0127)	0.0562 *** (0.0242)	0.0618 *** (0.0059)	0.0672 *** (0.0075)	0.1093 *** (0.0072)	0.1477 *** (0.0082)	0.0372 *** (0.0099)	0.0761 *** (0.0130)
InAssets	-0.0218 *** (0.0026)	-0.0199 *** (0.0031)	-0.0333 *** (0.0042)	-0.0296 *** (0.0039)	-0.0347 *** (0.0033)	-0.0532 *** (0.0073)	-0.0012 (0.0050)	-0.0001 (0.0062)	0.0046 (0.0075)	0.0048 (0.0078)	-0.0037 (0.0080)	0.0050 (0.0137)
TobinsQ	-0.0106 *** (0.0024)	-0.0115 *** (0.0025)	0.0002 (0.0034)	-0.0007 (0.0036)	-0.0116 *** (0.0029)	-0.0091 * (0.0055)	0.0022 (0.0019)	0.0025 (0.0026)	0.0012 (0.0022)	0.0001 (0.0023)	-0.0011 (0.0027)	-0.0037 (0.0037)
ROA	0.0763 *** (0.0236)	0.1018 *** (0.0281)	0.0720 ** (0.0333)	0.0477 (0.0318)	0.0805 *** (0.0292)	0.0600 (0.0578)	0.0572 *** (0.0164)	0.0604 *** (0.0207)	0.0029 (0.0217)	0.0346 (0.0230)	0.0625 ** (0.0289)	-0.0537 (0.0379)
CashRatio	-0.0234 (0.0253)	0.0080 (0.0300)	0.0923 *** (0.0344)	-0.0354 (0.0357)	-0.0642 ** (0.0295)	0.0967 (0.0613)	0.0581 *** (0.0189)	0.0463 * (0.0238)	-0.0023 (0.0278)	0.0265 (0.0287)	0.0485 (0.0335)	-0.0748 (0.0504)
DivDummy	0.0100 (0.0076)	0.0121 (0.0088)	-0.0481 *** (0.0117)	-0.0139 (0.0118)	0.0016 (0.0099)	-0.0731 *** (0.0220)	-0.0094 (0.0073)	-0.0043 (0.0095)	-0.0185 ** (0.0092)	-0.0229 ** (0.0103)	0.0095 (0.0104)	-0.0302 (0.0184)
FirmMat	0.0012 (0.0013)	0.0006 (0.0017)	0.0044 * (0.0024)	0.0021 ** (0.0010)	0.0016 (0.0021)	0.0051 (0.0045)	0.0030 *** (0.0006)	0.0033 *** (0.0009)	0.0009 (0.0012)	0.0006 (0.0007)	-0.0020 (0.0026)	0.0016 (0.0020)
EarnVol	-0.0076 (0.0082)	-0.0107 (0.0114)	-0.0151 (0.0179)	-0.0072 (0.0157)	-0.0097 (0.0100)	-0.0267 (0.0278)	-0.0044 (0.0076)	-0.0022 (0.0113)	0.0081 (0.0088)	-0.0104 (0.0132)	-0.0059 (0.0093)	0.0266 (0.0184)
UncPreMgr	0.1637 *** (0.0097)						0.1174 *** (0.0065)					
UncPreCEO		0.1786 *** (0.0089)						0.1078 *** (0.0056)				
UncPreNoCEO					0.0598 *** (0.0091)						0.0577 *** (0.0077)	
Industry FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes						
Firm FE							Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Year FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
N	77,658	65,394	77,758	65,760	73,816	76,549	77,658	65,394	77,758	65,760	73,816	76,549
R ²	0.066	0.057	0.053	0.043	0.018	0.029	0.026	0.021	0.018	0.023	0.005	0.005
Adj. R ²	0.065	0.056	0.052	0.043	0.018	0.029	0.002	-0.006	-0.005	-0.004	-0.020	-0.020

Notes: * $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$ (one-tailed for IVs, $\beta > 0$; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms). Firms with fewer than 5 calls are excluded. R^2 includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- R^2).

Table 40: H11-Lag1: Political Risk (1-Qtr Lag) and Language Uncertainty

	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)	(9)	(10)	(11)	(12)
	Industry FE						Firm FE					
	UncAnsMgr	UncAnsCEO	UncPreMgr	UncPreCEO	UncAnsNoCEO	UncPreNoCEO	UncAnsMgr	UncAnsCEO	UncPreMgr	UncPreCEO	UncAnsNoCEO	UncPreNoCEO
PRisk _{t-1}	0.0001 *** (0.0000)	0.0001 *** (0.0000)	0.0001 *** (0.0000)	0.0002 *** (0.0000)	0.0001 *** (0.0000)	0.0001 *** (0.0000)	0.0000 *** (0.0000)	0.0000 *** (0.0000)	0.0001 *** (0.0000)	0.0001 *** (0.0000)	0.0001 *** (0.0000)	0.0000 *** (0.0000)
UncQue	0.0448 *** (0.0036)	0.0462 *** (0.0044)	0.0263 *** (0.0042)	0.0247 *** (0.0046)	0.0523 *** (0.0057)	0.0265 *** (0.0079)	0.0357 *** (0.0026)	0.0381 *** (0.0034)	0.0108 *** (0.0025)	0.0097 *** (0.0030)	0.0421 *** (0.0051)	0.0140 *** (0.0044)
NegCall	0.0935 *** (0.0092)	0.0919 *** (0.0109)	0.1342 *** (0.0126)	0.1981 *** (0.0144)	0.0686 *** (0.0128)	0.0634 *** (0.0244)	0.0668 *** (0.0060)	0.0715 *** (0.0077)	0.1170 *** (0.0073)	0.1591 *** (0.0084)	0.0417 *** (0.0101)	0.0834 *** (0.0131)
InAssets	-0.0217 *** (0.0026)	-0.0191 *** (0.0031)	-0.0335 *** (0.0043)	-0.0298 *** (0.0040)	-0.0352 *** (0.0033)	-0.0527 *** (0.0074)	-0.0014 (0.0052)	0.0009 (0.0065)	0.0045 (0.0077)	0.0054 (0.0080)	-0.0064 (0.0081)	0.0051 (0.0141)
TobinsQ	-0.0108 *** (0.0024)	-0.0119 *** (0.0025)	0.0005 (0.0034)	-0.0003 (0.0036)	-0.0115 *** (0.0030)	-0.0085 (0.0055)	0.0020 (0.0020)	0.0021 (0.0027)	0.0014 (0.0023)	0.0001 (0.0023)	-0.0008 (0.0028)	-0.0038 (0.0037)
ROA	0.0885 *** (0.0249)	0.1151 *** (0.0295)	0.0718 ** (0.0335)	0.0480 (0.0331)	0.0854 *** (0.0303)	0.0442 (0.0589)	0.0610 *** (0.0175)	0.0633 *** (0.0219)	0.0029 (0.0229)	0.0455 * (0.0246)	0.0614 ** (0.0294)	-0.0592 (0.0395)
CashRatio	-0.0217 (0.0257)	0.0126 (0.0305)	0.0918 *** (0.0352)	-0.0347 (0.0365)	-0.0647 ** (0.0301)	0.0958 (0.0620)	0.0598 *** (0.0192)	0.0534 * (0.0243)	-0.0016 (0.0284)	0.0271 (0.0290)	0.0334 (0.0333)	-0.0647 (0.0509)
DivDummy	0.0102 (0.0077)	0.0117 (0.0088)	-0.0501 *** (0.0119)	-0.0145 (0.0120)	0.0018 (0.0100)	-0.0725 *** (0.0220)	-0.0097 (0.0074)	-0.0061 (0.0097)	-0.0183 ** (0.0093)	-0.0242 ** (0.0107)	0.0113 (0.0107)	-0.0288 (0.0183)
FirmMat	0.0003 (0.0017)	-0.0004 (0.0022)	0.0059 *** (0.0023)	0.0021 (0.0014)	0.0014 (0.0021)	0.0090 ** (0.0038)	0.0028 * (0.0015)	0.0039 ** (0.0019)	0.0017 (0.0024)	-0.0007 (0.0015)	-0.0017 (0.0027)	0.0047 (0.0035)
EarnVol	-0.0065 (0.0106)	-0.0074 (0.0125)	-0.0174 (0.0201)	-0.0070 (0.0158)	-0.0077 (0.0137)	-0.0283 (0.0325)	-0.0039 (0.0082)	0.0035 (0.0115)	0.0082 (0.0107)	-0.0131 (0.0146)	-0.0047 (0.0118)	0.0341 (0.0230)
UncPreMgr	0.1693 *** (0.0099)						0.1219 *** (0.0066)					
UncPreCEO		0.1821 *** (0.0090)						0.1122 *** (0.0058)				
UncPreNoCEO					0.0614 *** (0.0092)						0.0583 *** (0.0078)	
Industry FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes		Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Firm FE							Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Year FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
N	74,918	63,049	75,014	63,399	71,264	73,875	74,918	63,049	75,014	63,399	71,264	73,875
R ²	0.063	0.055	0.049	0.036	0.018	0.028	0.022	0.018	0.014	0.016	0.005	0.004
Adj. R ²	0.063	0.054	0.049	0.035	0.018	0.027	-0.002	-0.009	-0.011	-0.012	-0.021	-0.021

Notes: * $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$ (one-tailed for IVs, $\beta > 0$; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms). Firms with fewer than 5 calls are excluded. R^2 includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- R^2).

Table 41: H11-Lag2: Political Risk (2-Qtr Lag) and Language Uncertainty

	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)	(9)	(10)	(11)	(12)
	Industry FE						Firm FE					
	UncAnsMgr	UncAnsCEO	UncPreMgr	UncPreCEO	UncAnsNoCEO	UncPreNoCEO	UncAnsMgr	UncAnsCEO	UncPreMgr	UncPreCEO	UncAnsNoCEO	UncPreNoCEO
PRisk _{t-2}	0.0001 *** (0.0000)	0.0001 *** (0.0000)	0.0001 *** (0.0000)	0.0001 *** (0.0000)	0.0001 *** (0.0000)	0.0001 ** (0.0000)	0.0000 *** (0.0000)	0.0000 ** (0.0000)	0.0000 *** (0.0000)	0.0000 *** (0.0000)	0.0000 ** (0.0000)	0.0000 (0.0000)
UncQue	0.0447 *** (0.0036)	0.0470 *** (0.0044)	0.0265 *** (0.0043)	0.0242 *** (0.0047)	0.0519 *** (0.0058)	0.0287 *** (0.0080)	0.0358 *** (0.0027)	0.0395 *** (0.0034)	0.0108 *** (0.0025)	0.0099 *** (0.0031)	0.0419 *** (0.0052)	0.0146 *** (0.0045)
NegCall	0.0937 *** (0.0092)	0.0923 *** (0.0109)	0.1365 *** (0.0127)	0.2019 *** (0.0145)	0.0688 *** (0.0129)	0.0654 *** (0.0244)	0.0657 *** (0.0060)	0.0719 *** (0.0077)	0.1180 *** (0.0073)	0.1609 *** (0.0084)	0.0400 *** (0.0101)	0.0826 *** (0.0131)
InAssets	-0.0215 *** (0.0026)	-0.0194 *** (0.0031)	-0.0332 *** (0.0043)	-0.0298 *** (0.0040)	-0.0346 *** (0.0034)	-0.0529 *** (0.0075)	-0.0010 (0.0052)	0.0016 (0.0066)	0.0045 (0.0076)	0.0047 (0.0078)	-0.0050 (0.0082)	0.0032 (0.0143)
TobinsQ	-0.0105 *** (0.0024)	-0.0115 *** (0.0026)	0.0004 (0.0035)	-0.0002 (0.0037)	-0.0112 *** (0.0030)	-0.0091 (0.0055)	0.0021 (0.0020)	0.0025 (0.0028)	0.0014 (0.0023)	-0.0002 (0.0023)	-0.0008 (0.0028)	-0.0035 (0.0038)
ROA	0.0838 *** (0.0247)	0.1100 *** (0.0293)	0.0735 ** (0.0335)	0.0518 (0.0331)	0.0810 *** (0.0308)	0.0477 (0.0588)	0.0575 *** (0.0176)	0.0617 *** (0.0219)	0.0055 (0.0221)	0.0464 * (0.0247)	0.0599 *** (0.0304)	-0.0559 (0.0383)
CashRatio	-0.0210 (0.0259)	0.0111 (0.0308)	0.0928 *** (0.0353)	-0.0400 (0.0368)	-0.0648 ** (0.0304)	0.1037 * (0.0624)	0.0627 *** (0.0193)	0.0498 * (0.0244)	-0.0033 (0.0281)	0.0233 (0.0292)	0.0498 (0.0342)	-0.0683 (0.0515)
DivDummy	0.0091 (0.0077)	0.0106 (0.0089)	-0.0497 *** (0.0120)	-0.0142 (0.0121)	0.0013 (0.0101)	-0.0715 *** (0.0221)	-0.0119 (0.0074)	-0.0079 (0.0098)	-0.0169 * (0.0094)	-0.0207 * (0.0106)	0.0092 (0.0106)	-0.0276 (0.0187)
FirmMat	0.0002 (0.0017)	-0.0005 (0.0021)	0.0059 ** (0.0023)	0.0021 (0.0015)	0.0015 (0.0021)	0.0088 ** (0.0039)	0.0029 * (0.0015)	0.0037 ** (0.0018)	0.0017 (0.0023)	-0.0007 (0.0016)	-0.0014 (0.0028)	0.0050 (0.0033)
EarnVol	-0.0079 (0.0114)	-0.0086 (0.0134)	-0.0152 (0.0208)	-0.0078 (0.0159)	-0.0066 (0.0136)	-0.0235 (0.0344)	-0.0069 (0.0098)	0.0005 (0.0129)	0.0092 (0.0109)	-0.0154 (0.0158)	-0.0052 (0.0129)	0.0376 (0.0234)
UncPreMgr	0.1707 *** (0.0100)						0.1247 *** (0.0067)					
UncPreCEO		0.1827 *** (0.0091)						0.1138 *** (0.0058)				
UncPreNoCEO					0.0608 *** (0.0093)						0.0567 *** (0.0078)	
Industry FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes		Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Firm FE							Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Year FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
N	74,467	62,674	74,561	63,022	70,842	73,432	74,467	62,674	74,561	63,022	70,842	73,432
R ²	0.063	0.055	0.048	0.035	0.017	0.028	0.023	0.019	0.013	0.015	0.004	0.004
Adj. R ²	0.063	0.054	0.047	0.034	0.017	0.027	-0.002	-0.009	-0.012	-0.013	-0.022	-0.022

Notes: * $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$ (one-tailed for IVs, $\beta > 0$; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms). Firms with fewer than 5 calls are excluded. R^2 includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- R^2).

Table 42: H12: Speech Uncertainty and Quarterly Payout Ratio

	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)	(9)	(10)	(11)	(12)
			PayoutRatio_q						PayoutRatio_q_lead_qtr			
UncAnsCEO	0.0067 (0.0135)	0.0068 (0.0119)	0.0073 (0.0138)	0.0063 (0.0123)	0.0088 (0.0139)	0.0070 (0.0123)	-0.0092 (0.0136)	-0.0070 (0.0134)	-0.0126 (0.0137)	-0.0107 (0.0134)	-0.0114 (0.0136)	-0.0106 (0.0134)
UncPreCEO	0.0311 (0.0136)	0.0074 (0.0104)	0.0265 (0.0133)	0.0037 (0.0105)	0.0273 (0.0133)	0.0038 (0.0106)	0.0282 (0.0150)	-0.0079 (0.0125)	0.0213 (0.0146)	-0.0114 (0.0127)	0.0215 (0.0145)	-0.0125 (0.0127)
UncAnsMgr	0.0008 (0.0163)	-0.0047 (0.0151)	0.0165 (0.0165)	-0.0051 (0.0153)	-0.0021 (0.0165)	-0.0089 (0.0153)	0.0196 (0.0182)	0.0058 (0.0174)	0.0392 (0.0179)	0.0093 (0.0174)	0.0216 (0.0181)	0.0062 (0.0174)
UncPreMgr	-0.0498*** (0.0173)	-0.0139 (0.0143)	-0.0299** (0.0161)	-0.0142 (0.0147)	-0.0439*** (0.0171)	-0.0151 (0.0147)	-0.0529*** (0.0186)	-0.0053 (0.0173)	-0.0312** (0.0172)	-0.0041 (0.0177)	-0.0436*** (0.0181)	-0.0032 (0.0177)
lnAssets	0.0212*** (0.0042)	-0.0480*** (0.0142)	0.0257*** (0.0024)	-0.0485*** (0.0145)	0.0142*** (0.0045)	-0.0446*** (0.0146)	0.0232*** (0.0046)	-0.0102 (0.0145)	0.0287*** (0.0025)	-0.0082 (0.0146)	0.0167*** (0.0049)	-0.0092 (0.0148)
TobinsQ	0.0188*** (0.0045)	0.0079* (0.0044)	0.0215*** (0.0045)	0.0113** (0.0045)	0.0202*** (0.0044)	0.0144*** (0.0046)	0.0154*** (0.0048)	-0.0025 (0.0050)	0.0185*** (0.0045)	0.0009 (0.0050)	0.0165*** (0.0044)	0.0029 (0.0051)
ROA	-0.4909*** (0.0737)	-0.9512*** (0.0959)	-0.5694*** (0.0810)	-0.8803*** (0.1025)	-0.5859*** (0.0807)	-0.8901*** (0.1026)	-0.5769*** (0.0890)	-1.0889*** (0.1126)	-0.6496*** (0.0977)	-0.9826*** (0.1162)	-0.6714*** (0.0980)	-1.0044*** (0.1171)
Leverage	0.0429 (0.0306)	0.1533*** (0.0406)	0.0533 (0.0328)	0.1682*** (0.0440)	0.0544 (0.0331)	0.1682*** (0.0440)	0.0085 (0.0289)	-0.0327 (0.0455)	0.0163 (0.0297)	-0.0421 (0.0466)	0.0168 (0.0298)	-0.0460 (0.0467)
CashRatio	-0.0114 (0.0510)	-0.1152** (0.0454)	0.0472 (0.0604)	-0.1300*** (0.0465)	0.0323 (0.0598)	-0.1308*** (0.0464)	0.0661 (0.0554)	0.1666*** (0.0531)	0.1289** (0.0639)	0.1542*** (0.0543)	0.1166* (0.0636)	0.1511*** (0.0545)
Capex	-0.4504*** (0.0814)	-0.2244* (0.1231)	-0.4675*** (0.0795)	-0.2234* (0.1232)	-0.4724*** (0.0799)	-0.2466** (0.1246)	-0.4275*** (0.0963)	-0.1644 (0.0943)	-0.4400*** (0.1777)	-0.1381 (0.1769)	-0.4553*** (0.0944)	-0.1784 (0.1765)
sCFO	-0.0491** (0.0243)	-0.0084 (0.0214)	-0.0182* (0.0108)	-0.0043 (0.0215)	-0.0157 (0.0113)	-0.0050 (0.0219)	-0.0584** (0.0284)	-0.0076 (0.0208)	-0.0241* (0.0126)	-0.0041 (0.0206)	-0.0205* (0.0123)	-0.0045 (0.0201)
Lagged_DV	0.2574*** (0.0187)	0.0729*** (0.0137)	0.2522*** (0.0191)	0.0685*** (0.0139)	0.2529*** (0.0190)	0.0708*** (0.0139)	0.2400*** (0.0193)	0.0385*** (0.0139)	0.2339*** (0.0197)	0.0353** (0.0140)	0.2336*** (0.0196)	0.0363*** (0.0140)
SalesGrowth			-0.1573*** (0.0207)	-0.0825*** (0.0180)	-0.1582*** (0.0209)	-0.0874*** (0.0180)			-0.1907*** (0.0229)	-0.0836*** (0.0227)	-0.1940*** (0.0236)	-0.0903*** (0.0232)
RDSales			-0.2557** (0.1178)	-0.1845 (0.1624)	-0.2495** (0.1167)	-0.1941 (0.1624)			-0.3090** (0.1309)	-0.2174 (0.1984)	-0.2999** (0.1303)	-0.2401 (0.1994)
CashFlowAt			0.2095*** (0.0712)	-0.0950 (0.0726)	0.1615** (0.0709)	-0.1102 (0.0726)			0.2051*** (0.0776)	-0.2064** (0.0807)	0.1759** (0.0775)	-0.2013** (0.0808)
DailyVola			-0.0008*** (0.0003)	0.0003 (0.0003)	-0.0020*** (0.0004)	0.0001 (0.0004)			-0.0005* (0.0003)	0.0008*** (0.0003)	-0.0019*** (0.0004)	0.0008** (0.0004)
Extended Controls			Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes			Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Industry FE	Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes	
Firm FE		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes
Year FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes			Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes		
Year-Quarter FE					Yes	Yes					Yes	Yes
N	47,651	47,651	45,779	45,779	45,779	45,779	45,466	45,466	44,624	44,624	44,624	44,624
R ²	0.079	0.015	0.083	0.016	0.086	0.016	0.064	0.010	0.068	0.011	0.070	0.012
Adj. R ²	0.079	-0.019	0.082	-0.019	0.084	-0.020	0.063	-0.024	0.067	-0.024	0.068	-0.025

Notes: * $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$ (one-tailed for IVs, $\beta < 0$; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms). R^2 includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- R^2).

Table 43: H12 Robustness: Orthogonal Speaker Partition

	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)	(9)	(10)	(11)	(12)
			PayoutRatio.q						PayoutRatio.q_lead.qtr			
UncAnsCEO	0.0071 (0.0106)	0.0065 (0.0091)	0.0158 (0.0104)	0.0054 (0.0094)	0.0081 (0.0108)	0.0042 (0.0094)	0.0001 (0.0108)	-0.0065 (0.0100)	0.0075 (0.0108)	-0.0083 (0.0101)	-0.0004 (0.0108)	-0.0099 (0.0101)
UncAnsNoCEO	0.0000 (0.0058)	-0.0018 (0.0056)	0.0050 (0.0057)	-0.0012 (0.0056)	-0.0003 (0.0057)	-0.0022 (0.0056)	0.0059 (0.0062)	0.0017 (0.0056)	0.0115 (0.0062)	0.0034 (0.0055)	0.0068 (0.0061)	0.0028 (0.0055)
UncPreCEO	0.0038 (0.0102)	0.0013 (0.0089)	0.0085 (0.0103)	-0.0026 (0.0090)	0.0037 (0.0104)	-0.0029 (0.0090)	0.0015 (0.0116)	-0.0089 (0.0104)	0.0053 (0.0113)	-0.0109 (0.0105)	0.0003 (0.0116)	-0.0119 (0.0105)
UncPreNoCEO	-0.0169** (0.0078)	-0.0022 (0.0069)	-0.0106* (0.0075)	-0.0031 (0.0071)	-0.0154** (0.0077)	-0.0033 (0.0071)	-0.0199*** (0.0082)	-0.0067 (0.0079)	-0.0127* (0.0077)	-0.0067 (0.0081)	-0.0167** (0.0080)	-0.0058 (0.0082)
lnAssets	0.0232*** (0.0041)	-0.0462*** (0.0145)	0.0260*** (0.0023)	-0.0463*** (0.0147)	0.0166*** (0.0045)	-0.0425*** (0.0147)	0.0250*** (0.0045)	-0.0090 (0.0148)	0.0290*** (0.0024)	-0.0071 (0.0149)	0.0190*** (0.0048)	-0.0076 (0.0150)
TobinsQ	0.0180*** (0.0039)	0.0081* (0.0044)	0.0196*** (0.0041)	0.0115*** (0.0045)	0.0187*** (0.0040)	0.0142*** (0.0045)	0.0163*** (0.0044)	-0.0009 (0.0049)	0.0186*** (0.0043)	0.0027 (0.0049)	0.0169*** (0.0043)	0.0044 (0.0050)
ROA	-0.5019*** (0.0712)	-0.9539*** (0.0980)	-0.5877*** (0.0804)	-0.8989*** (0.1046)	-0.6038*** (0.0804)	-0.9062*** (0.1047)	-0.6010*** (0.0877)	-1.0798*** (0.1124)	-0.6801*** (0.0987)	-1.0006*** (0.1172)	-0.6996*** (0.0992)	-1.0178*** (0.1184)
Leverage	0.0414 (0.0283)	0.1384*** (0.0393)	0.0524* (0.0311)	0.1525*** (0.0313)	0.0532* (0.0425)	0.1518*** (0.0425)	0.0170 (0.0289)	-0.0355 (0.0456)	0.0232 (0.0301)	-0.0451 (0.0467)	0.0231 (0.0301)	-0.0497 (0.0467)
CashRatio	-0.0285 (0.0425)	-0.1195*** (0.0448)	0.0201 (0.0498)	-0.1330*** (0.0460)	0.0079 (0.0493)	-0.1344*** (0.0459)	0.0492 (0.0475)	0.1588*** (0.0537)	0.1044* (0.0543)	0.1489*** (0.0551)	0.0948* (0.0543)	0.1463*** (0.0552)
Capex	-0.4588*** (0.0795)	-0.2484*** (0.1194)	-0.4964*** (0.0774)	-0.2453** (0.1196)	-0.5026*** (0.0780)	-0.2679** (0.1209)	-0.4352*** (0.0952)	-0.1654 (0.1762)	-0.4632*** (0.0934)	-0.1305 (0.1767)	-0.4797*** (0.0936)	-0.1724 (0.1764)
sCFO	-0.0447** (0.0220)	-0.0117 (0.0219)	-0.0172 (0.0106)	-0.0082 (0.0217)	-0.0146 (0.0111)	-0.0088 (0.0222)	-0.0530** (0.0252)	-0.0096 (0.0210)	-0.0224* (0.0120)	-0.0070 (0.0206)	-0.0189 (0.0119)	-0.0076 (0.0200)
Lagged_DV	0.2533*** (0.0196)	0.0707*** (0.0144)	0.2484*** (0.0201)	0.0665*** (0.0145)	0.2493*** (0.0201)	0.0686*** (0.0145)	0.2386*** (0.0203)	0.0364** (0.0146)	0.2327*** (0.0208)	0.0334** (0.0146)	0.2326*** (0.0207)	0.0342** (0.0146)
SalesGrowth			-0.1464*** (0.0194)	-0.0742*** (0.0175)	-0.1472*** (0.0196)	-0.0783*** (0.0175)			-0.1777*** (0.0221)	-0.0738*** (0.0225)	-0.1811*** (0.0227)	-0.0800*** (0.0228)
RDSales			-0.1984* (0.1054)	-0.2458 (0.1529)	-0.1959* (0.1044)	-0.2522* (0.1529)			-0.2657** (0.1213)	-0.3618** (0.1832)	-0.2594** (0.1208)	-0.3842** (0.1838)
CashFlowAt			0.2349*** (0.0689)	-0.0849 (0.0730)	0.1934*** (0.0682)	-0.0994 (0.0730)			0.2195*** (0.0759)	-0.1902** (0.0807)	0.1959*** (0.0755)	-0.1854** (0.0807)
DailyVola			-0.0008*** (0.0003)	0.0002 (0.0003)	-0.0019*** (0.0004)	0.0001 (0.0004)			-0.0006* (0.0003)	0.0007** (0.0003)	-0.0017*** (0.0004)	0.0007* (0.0004)
Extended Controls			Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes			Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Industry FE	Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes	
Firm FE		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes
Year FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes			Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes		
Year-Quarter FE					Yes	Yes					Yes	Yes
N	44,882	44,882	43,106	43,106	43,106	43,106	42,786	42,786	41,994	41,994	41,994	41,994
R ²	0.079	0.015	0.083	0.015	0.085	0.016	0.065	0.010	0.069	0.011	0.070	0.011
Adj. R ²	0.078	-0.020	0.082	-0.021	0.083	-0.022	0.064	-0.026	0.068	-0.026	0.068	-0.027

Notes: * $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$ (one-tailed for IVs, $\beta < 0$; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms). R^2 includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- R^2).

Table 44: H12b: Speech Uncertainty and Dividend Payer Indicator (Hoberg-Prabhala 2009 analog)

	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)	(9)	(10)	(11)	(12)
			DivPayerQ						DivPayerQ_lead1			
UncAnsCEO	0.0024 (0.0033)	0.0030 (0.0036)	0.0031 (0.0034)	0.0039 (0.0036)	0.0035 (0.0034)	0.0041 (0.0036)	-0.0004 (0.0034)	-0.0004 (0.0035)	-0.0006 (0.0034)	-0.0006 (0.0035)	-0.0004 (0.0034)	-0.0007 (0.0035)
UncPreCEO	0.0078 (0.0028)	0.0027 (0.0032)	0.0083 (0.0028)	0.0025 (0.0032)	0.0079 (0.0027)	0.0017 (0.0032)	0.0053 (0.0028)	-0.0015 (0.0035)	0.0053 (0.0028)	-0.0019 (0.0036)	0.0055 (0.0028)	-0.0020 (0.0036)
UncAnsMgr	0.0001 (0.0041)	-0.0041 (0.0046)	0.0014 (0.0041)	-0.0050 (0.0047)	-0.0016 (0.0042)	-0.0063* (0.0047)	0.0031 (0.0040)	-0.0028 (0.0043)	0.0067 (0.0040)	-0.0023 (0.0044)	0.0031 (0.0041)	-0.0024 (0.0044)
UncPreMgr	-0.0113*** (0.0033)	-0.0059 (0.0047)	-0.0093*** (0.0032)	-0.0054 (0.0048)	-0.0102*** (0.0033)	-0.0043 (0.0047)	-0.0096*** (0.0033)	-0.0058 (0.0049)	-0.0055** (0.0032)	-0.0042 (0.0049)	-0.0086*** (0.0033)	-0.0037 (0.0049)
InAssets	0.0097*** (0.0010)	0.0204*** (0.0038)	0.0089*** (0.0008)	0.0200*** (0.0040)	0.0073*** (0.0010)	0.0196*** (0.0040)	0.0092*** (0.0009)	0.0239*** (0.0038)	0.0091*** (0.0006)	0.0222*** (0.0039)	0.0065*** (0.0039)	0.0210*** (0.0039)
TobinsQ	0.0023*** (0.0007)	0.0025* (0.0013)	0.0024*** (0.0007)	0.0028** (0.0013)	0.0021*** (0.0007)	0.0030** (0.0014)	0.0015* (0.0009)	0.0009 (0.0013)	0.0016* (0.0008)	0.0013 (0.0014)	0.0009 (0.0008)	0.0012 (0.0014)
ROA	0.0501*** (0.0078)	0.0273*** (0.0079)	0.0326*** (0.0075)	0.0102 (0.0091)	0.0288*** (0.0074)	0.0066 (0.0092)	0.0811*** (0.0109)	0.0651*** (0.0110)	0.0535*** (0.0102)	0.0390*** (0.0116)	0.0517*** (0.0102)	0.0361*** (0.0116)
Leverage	-0.0215*** (0.0054)	-0.0550*** (0.0120)	-0.0185*** (0.0051)	-0.0511*** (0.0124)	-0.0169*** (0.0049)	-0.0481*** (0.0123)	-0.0196*** (0.0059)	-0.0747*** (0.0132)	-0.0143*** (0.0054)	-0.0660*** (0.0132)	-0.0130** (0.0052)	-0.0639*** (0.0132)
CashRatio	-0.0200*** (0.0066)	0.0139 (0.0120)	-0.0171*** (0.0065)	0.0110 (0.0122)	-0.0195*** (0.0067)	0.0093 (0.0121)	-0.0075 (0.0069)	0.0332*** (0.0127)	0.0003 (0.0068)	0.0306** (0.0126)	-0.0045 (0.0071)	0.0309** (0.0126)
Capex	-0.0673*** (0.0180)	0.0736** (0.0358)	-0.0549*** (0.0180)	0.0715** (0.0352)	-0.0579*** (0.0180)	0.0602* (0.0349)	-0.0646*** (0.0178)	0.0408 (0.0385)	-0.0432** (0.0186)	0.0435 (0.0378)	-0.0483*** (0.0185)	0.0416 (0.0380)
sCFO	-0.0027 (0.0026)	-0.0042 (0.0052)	0.0001 (0.0024)	-0.0008 (0.0056)	0.0003 (0.0024)	-0.0008 (0.0024)	0.0000 (0.0055)	-0.0014 (0.0046)	0.0035 (0.0025)	-0.0000 (0.0051)	0.0034 (0.0022)	0.0003 (0.0021)
Lagged_DV	0.9062*** (0.0080)	0.6988*** (0.0232)	0.9024*** (0.0083)	0.6929*** (0.0238)	0.9019*** (0.0083)	0.6938*** (0.0236)	0.9147*** (0.0049)	0.7243*** (0.0135)	0.9101*** (0.0050)	0.7210*** (0.0137)	0.9095*** (0.0050)	0.7208*** (0.0137)
SalesGrowth			-0.0068*** (0.0020)	-0.0034 (0.0024)	-0.0070*** (0.0020)	-0.0042* (0.0024)			-0.0039* (0.0023)	-0.0028 (0.0030)	-0.0036 (0.0023)	-0.0028 (0.0030)
RDSales			0.0020*** (0.0006)	-0.0001 (0.0008)	0.0020*** (0.0006)	-0.0003 (0.0008)			0.0029*** (0.0008)	0.0009 (0.0011)	0.0029*** (0.0008)	0.0008 (0.0011)
CashFlowAt			0.0028 (0.0102)	0.0159 (0.0128)	-0.0010 (0.0100)	0.0151 (0.0127)			0.0036 (0.0132)	0.0135 (0.0155)	-0.0012 (0.0130)	0.0136 (0.0154)
DailyVola			-0.0005*** (0.0000)	-0.0004*** (0.0001)	-0.0007*** (0.0001)	-0.0006*** (0.0001)			-0.0008*** (0.0001)	-0.0007*** (0.0001)	-0.0010*** (0.0001)	-0.0009*** (0.0001)
Extended Controls			Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes			Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Industry FE	Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes	
Firm FE		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes
Year FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes			Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes		
Year-Quarter FE					Yes	Yes					Yes	Yes
N	64,145	64,145	61,535	61,535	61,535	61,535	61,359	61,359	60,175	60,175	60,175	60,175
R ²	0.846	0.500	0.845	0.494	0.846	0.496	0.859	0.536	0.859	0.536	0.860	0.537
Adj. R ²	0.846	0.486	0.845	0.479	0.846	0.480	0.859	0.523	0.859	0.522	0.860	0.523

Notes: * $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$ (one-tailed for IVs, $\beta < 0$; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms). R^2 includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- R^2).

Table 45: H12b Robustness: Orthogonal Speaker Partition

	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)	(9)	(10)	(11)	(12)
	DivPayerQ						DivPayerQ_lead1					
UncAnsCEO	0.0019 (0.0020)	0.0005 (0.0023)	0.0033 (0.0020)	0.0008 (0.0023)	0.0020 (0.0020)	0.0002 (0.0023)	0.0009 (0.0022)	-0.0017 (0.0024)	0.0029 (0.0022)	-0.0017 (0.0025)	0.0009 (0.0022)	-0.0018 (0.0025)
UncAnsNoCEO	-0.0006 (0.0013)	0.0003 (0.0013)	-0.0002 (0.0013)	0.0003 (0.0013)	-0.0010 (0.0013)	-0.0001 (0.0013)	-0.0000 (0.0014)	0.0008 (0.0014)	0.0010 (0.0014)	0.0008 (0.0014)	-0.0002 (0.0014)	0.0008 (0.0014)
UncPreCEO	0.0010 (0.0022)	-0.0009 (0.0026)	0.0025 (0.0022)	-0.0009 (0.0026)	0.0018 (0.0022)	-0.0012 (0.0026)	0.0002 (0.0023)	-0.0042* (0.0027)	0.0021 (0.0023)	-0.0039* (0.0023)	0.0009 (0.0028)	-0.0037* (0.0028)
UncPreNoCEO	-0.0026** (0.0015)	-0.0017 (0.0024)	-0.0022* (0.0015)	-0.0016 (0.0024)	-0.0024* (0.0016)	-0.0009 (0.0024)	-0.0017 (0.0016)	-0.0016 (0.0024)	-0.0000 (0.0016)	-0.0009 (0.0024)	-0.0013 (0.0016)	-0.0006 (0.0024)
InAssets	0.0100*** (0.0011)	0.0192*** (0.0040)	0.0090*** (0.0008)	0.0186*** (0.0041)	0.0075*** (0.0010)	0.0181*** (0.0041)	0.0093*** (0.0009)	0.0224*** (0.0039)	0.0091*** (0.0006)	0.0205*** (0.0039)	0.0065*** (0.0009)	0.0193*** (0.0039)
TobinsQ	0.0023*** (0.0008)	0.0023* (0.0013)	0.0024*** (0.0008)	0.0025* (0.0014)	0.0021*** (0.0008)	0.0028** (0.0014)	0.0013 (0.0009)	0.0004 (0.0013)	0.0015* (0.0009)	0.0008 (0.0014)	0.0007 (0.0009)	0.0008 (0.0014)
ROA	0.0504*** (0.0084)	0.0270*** (0.0080)	0.0280*** (0.0078)	0.0036 (0.0095)	0.0241*** (0.0077)	-0.0001 (0.0095)	0.0807*** (0.0116)	0.0665*** (0.0111)	0.0521*** (0.0106)	0.0376*** (0.0119)	0.0502*** (0.0107)	0.0348*** (0.0119)
Leverage	-0.0217*** (0.0057)	-0.0554*** (0.0121)	-0.0186*** (0.0053)	-0.0505*** (0.0124)	-0.0171*** (0.0051)	-0.0474*** (0.0123)	-0.0210*** (0.0063)	-0.0761*** (0.0131)	-0.0158*** (0.0056)	-0.0666*** (0.0130)	-0.0145*** (0.0055)	-0.0644*** (0.0130)
CashRatio	-0.0221*** (0.0067)	0.0164 (0.0129)	-0.0191*** (0.0066)	0.0130 (0.0130)	-0.0211*** (0.0068)	0.0114 (0.0129)	-0.0100 (0.0071)	0.0303** (0.0133)	-0.0015 (0.0069)	0.0275** (0.0132)	-0.0062 (0.0072)	0.0277** (0.0131)
Capex	-0.0709*** (0.0175)	0.0593* (0.0356)	-0.0601*** (0.0178)	0.0584* (0.0354)	-0.0630*** (0.0178)	0.0467 (0.0351)	-0.0673*** (0.0180)	0.0347 (0.0395)	-0.0425** (0.0188)	0.0405 (0.0389)	-0.0475** (0.0187)	0.0386 (0.0390)
sCFO	-0.0026 (0.0026)	-0.0035 (0.0045)	0.0002 (0.0024)	-0.0001 (0.0049)	0.0004 (0.0024)	-0.0002 (0.0049)	0.0003 (0.0048)	-0.0006 (0.0019)	0.0037 (0.0054)	0.0007 (0.0017)	0.0036 (0.0052)	0.0010 (0.0017)
Lagged_DV	0.9062*** (0.0081)	0.6999*** (0.0236)	0.9022*** (0.0085)	0.6941*** (0.0242)	0.9017*** (0.0084)	0.6949*** (0.0240)	0.9154*** (0.0049)	0.7272*** (0.0137)	0.9107*** (0.0051)	0.7237*** (0.0139)	0.9103*** (0.0051)	0.7235*** (0.0139)
SalesGrowth			-0.0074*** (0.0022)	-0.0032 (0.0025)	-0.0077*** (0.0022)	-0.0041 (0.0026)			-0.0045* (0.0026)	-0.0025 (0.0030)	-0.0042 (0.0026)	-0.0025 (0.0030)
RDSales			0.0019*** (0.0006)	-0.0002 (0.0009)	0.0019*** (0.0006)	-0.0006 (0.0009)			0.0027*** (0.0008)	0.0010 (0.0011)	0.0027*** (0.0008)	0.0009 (0.0011)
CashFlowAt			0.0080 (0.0107)	0.0263* (0.0137)	0.0043 (0.0106)	0.0253* (0.0136)			0.0029 (0.0137)	0.0159 (0.0161)	-0.0019 (0.0136)	0.0160 (0.0161)
DailyVola			-0.0006*** (0.0001)	-0.0004*** (0.0001)	-0.0008*** (0.0001)	-0.0006*** (0.0001)			-0.0008*** (0.0001)	-0.0008*** (0.0001)	-0.0010*** (0.0001)	-0.0009*** (0.0001)
Extended Controls			Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes			Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Industry FE	Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes	
Firm FE		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes
Year FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes			Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes		
Year-Quarter FE					Yes	Yes					Yes	Yes
N	60,224	60,224	57,777	57,777	57,777	57,777	57,627	57,627	56,535	56,535	56,535	56,535
R ²	0.846	0.501	0.845	0.495	0.846	0.497	0.860	0.540	0.860	0.540	0.861	0.541
Adj. R ²	0.846	0.486	0.845	0.480	0.846	0.481	0.860	0.526	0.860	0.526	0.860	0.526

Notes: * $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$ (one-tailed for IVs, $\beta < 0$; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms). R^2 includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- R^2).

Table 46: H13: Speech Uncertainty and Capital Expenditure

	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)	(9)	(10)	(11)	(12)
	Capex						Capex_lead					
UncAnsCEO	0.0003 (0.0006)	0.0012** (0.0006)	0.0003 (0.0006)	0.0011* (0.0006)	0.0003 (0.0006)	0.0010* (0.0006)	-0.0003 (0.0007)	0.0005 (0.0006)	-0.0003 (0.0007)	0.0005 (0.0006)	-0.0003 (0.0007)	0.0005 (0.0006)
UncPreCEO	0.0004 (0.0006)	0.0008 (0.0007)	0.0005 (0.0006)	0.0008 (0.0007)	0.0005 (0.0006)	0.0008 (0.0007)	0.0001 (0.0009)	0.0000 (0.0007)	0.0001 (0.0009)	0.0001 (0.0007)	0.0002 (0.0009)	0.0001 (0.0007)
UncAnsMgr	0.0009 (0.0008)	-0.0008 (0.0007)	0.0020** (0.0008)	-0.0007 (0.0007)	0.0012 (0.0008)	-0.0009 (0.0007)	0.0024** (0.0010)	-0.0000 (0.0008)	0.0049*** (0.0010)	0.0001 (0.0008)	0.0028*** (0.0010)	0.0001 (0.0008)
UncPreMgr	-0.0003 (0.0008)	-0.0011 (0.0009)	-0.0002 (0.0008)	-0.0013 (0.0010)	-0.0010 (0.0008)	-0.0014 (0.0009)	-0.0015 (0.0011)	-0.0017 (0.0011)	0.0001 (0.0011)	-0.0017 (0.0011)	-0.0020* (0.0011)	-0.0017 (0.0011)
lnAssets	-0.0002 (0.0002)	-0.0014** (0.0007)	0.0003*** (0.0001)	-0.0016** (0.0007)	-0.0003 (0.0002)	-0.0018** (0.0007)	-0.0004 (0.0003)	-0.0018* (0.0009)	0.0007*** (0.0002)	-0.0025*** (0.0009)	-0.0007** (0.0003)	-0.0027*** (0.0009)
TobinsQ	0.0018*** (0.0002)	0.0032*** (0.0004)	0.0012*** (0.0003)	0.0028*** (0.0004)	0.0010*** (0.0003)	0.0029*** (0.0004)	0.0018*** (0.0003)	0.0036*** (0.0004)	0.0013*** (0.0004)	0.0033*** (0.0004)	0.0009*** (0.0004)	0.0033*** (0.0004)
ROA	-0.0017 (0.0028)	-0.0019 (0.0053)	-0.0348*** (0.0061)	-0.0175*** (0.0065)	-0.0358*** (0.0061)	-0.0190*** (0.0065)	0.0187*** (0.0033)	0.0332*** (0.0052)	-0.0153*** (0.0047)	0.0189*** (0.0053)	-0.0162*** (0.0047)	0.0164*** (0.0052)
Leverage	-0.0045*** (0.0013)	-0.0225*** (0.0033)	-0.0037*** (0.0012)	-0.0223*** (0.0033)	-0.0033*** (0.0012)	-0.0213*** (0.0033)	-0.0005 (0.0016)	-0.0203*** (0.0033)	0.0012 (0.0016)	-0.0181*** (0.0033)	0.0014 (0.0016)	-0.0177*** (0.0033)
CashRatio	-0.0095*** (0.0016)	-0.0156*** (0.0031)	-0.0088*** (0.0016)	-0.0149*** (0.0031)	-0.0095*** (0.0017)	-0.0140*** (0.0031)	-0.0033 (0.0022)	0.0050 (0.0038)	-0.0004 (0.0023)	0.0056 (0.0038)	-0.0039* (0.0024)	0.0055 (0.0038)
DivDummy	-0.0013* (0.0005)	0.0021** (0.0009)	-0.0008 (0.0005)	0.0021** (0.0010)	-0.0011** (0.0005)	0.0017* (0.0009)	-0.0025*** (0.0008)	0.0002 (0.0011)	-0.0025*** (0.0008)	-0.0001 (0.0011)	-0.0027*** (0.0008)	-0.0002 (0.0011)
sCFO	-0.0039** (0.0020)	-0.0069*** (0.0025)	-0.0043** (0.0018)	-0.0073*** (0.0023)	-0.0042** (0.0018)	-0.0071*** (0.0023)	-0.0016 (0.0012)	-0.0057*** (0.0017)	-0.0012 (0.0014)	-0.0058*** (0.0016)	-0.0015 (0.0012)	-0.0057*** (0.0016)
Lagged_DV	0.7612*** (0.0150)	0.3241*** (0.0224)	0.7383*** (0.0152)	0.3184*** (0.0225)	0.7394*** (0.0155)	0.3213*** (0.0225)	0.6545*** (0.0198)	0.0857*** (0.0193)	0.6398*** (0.0194)	0.0868*** (0.0196)	0.6364*** (0.0199)	0.0883*** (0.0196)
SalesGrowth			0.0092*** (0.0019)	0.0067*** (0.0016)	0.0083*** (0.0018)	0.0059*** (0.0015)			0.0096*** (0.0017)	0.0058*** (0.0014)	0.0089*** (0.0017)	0.0054*** (0.0014)
RDSales			0.0008*** (0.0002)	0.0010*** (0.0003)	0.0008*** (0.0002)	0.0009*** (0.0003)			0.0016*** (0.0003)	0.0019*** (0.0004)	0.0016*** (0.0002)	0.0018*** (0.0004)
CashFlowAt			0.0588*** (0.0065)	0.0328*** (0.0064)	0.0582*** (0.0065)	0.0333*** (0.0064)			0.0549*** (0.0062)	0.0184*** (0.0066)	0.0546*** (0.0062)	0.0195*** (0.0066)
DailyVola			0.0001*** (0.0000)	0.0000** (0.0000)	0.0000 (0.0000)	-0.0000* (0.0000)			-0.0000* (0.0000)	-0.0001*** (0.0000)	-0.0001*** (0.0000)	-0.0002*** (0.0000)
Extended Controls			Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes			Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Industry FE	Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes	
Firm FE		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes
Year FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes			Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes		
Year-Quarter FE					Yes	Yes					Yes	Yes
N	65,105	65,105	62,482	62,482	62,482	62,482	60,090	60,090	58,897	58,897	58,897	58,897
R ²	0.617	0.144	0.622	0.148	0.626	0.150	0.490	0.058	0.496	0.070	0.501	0.068
Adj. R ²	0.617	0.120	0.622	0.124	0.625	0.125	0.490	0.031	0.495	0.043	0.500	0.040

Notes: * $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$ (two-tailed). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms). R^2 includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- R^2).

Table 47: H13 Robustness: Orthogonal Speaker Partition

	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)	(9)	(10)	(11)	(12)
	Capex					Capex_lead						
UncAnsCEO	0.0008* (0.0004)	0.0007* (0.0004)	0.0014*** (0.0004)	0.0006 (0.0004)	0.0009** (0.0004)	0.0004 (0.0004)	0.0013** (0.0006)	0.0007 (0.0004)	0.0028*** (0.0006)	0.0007 (0.0004)	0.0015*** (0.0006)	0.0007 (0.0004)
UncAnsNoCEO	0.0002 (0.0002)	-0.0001 (0.0002)	0.0005** (0.0002)	-0.0001 (0.0002)	0.0002 (0.0002)	-0.0001 (0.0002)	0.0007** (0.0003)	0.0002 (0.0003)	0.0014*** (0.0003)	0.0002 (0.0003)	0.0007** (0.0003)	0.0002 (0.0003)
UncPreCEO	0.0002 (0.0005)	0.0002 (0.0005)	0.0003 (0.0005)	0.0002 (0.0005)	-0.0000 (0.0005)	0.0001 (0.0005)	-0.0005 (0.0008)	-0.0007 (0.0006)	0.0003 (0.0007)	-0.0006 (0.0006)	-0.0005 (0.0008)	-0.0006 (0.0006)
UncPreNoCEO	-0.0002 (0.0004)	-0.0007 (0.0005)	-0.0000 (0.0004)	-0.0008* (0.0005)	-0.0004 (0.0004)	-0.0008* (0.0005)	-0.0008 (0.0005)	-0.0011** (0.0005)	-0.0001 (0.0005)	-0.0011** (0.0006)	-0.0010* (0.0005)	-0.0011* (0.0006)
lnAssets	-0.0003 (0.0002)	-0.0017** (0.0007)	0.0003*** (0.0001)	-0.0018** (0.0008)	-0.0003 (0.0002)	-0.0020*** (0.0008)	-0.0005* (0.0003)	-0.0015 (0.0009)	0.0007*** (0.0002)	-0.0022** (0.0009)	-0.0007** (0.0003)	-0.0023** (0.0009)
TobinsQ	0.0017*** (0.0002)	0.0031*** (0.0004)	0.0012*** (0.0003)	0.0027*** (0.0004)	0.0010*** (0.0003)	0.0028*** (0.0004)	0.0018*** (0.0003)	0.0035*** (0.0004)	0.0014*** (0.0004)	0.0032*** (0.0004)	0.0010*** (0.0004)	0.0033*** (0.0004)
ROA	-0.0012 (0.0028)	-0.0022 (0.0053)	-0.0330*** (0.0058)	-0.0171*** (0.0064)	-0.0341*** (0.0058)	-0.0186*** (0.0064)	0.0193*** (0.0034)	0.0332*** (0.0052)	-0.0130*** (0.0047)	0.0194*** (0.0052)	-0.0141*** (0.0047)	0.0170*** (0.0052)
Leverage	-0.0042*** (0.0013)	-0.0218*** (0.0032)	-0.0035*** (0.0012)	-0.0218*** (0.0032)	-0.0031*** (0.0011)	-0.0208*** (0.0032)	-0.0000 (0.0016)	-0.0200*** (0.0034)	0.0015 (0.0016)	-0.0179*** (0.0034)	0.0017 (0.0016)	-0.0175*** (0.0034)
CashRatio	-0.0093*** (0.0016)	-0.0163*** (0.0030)	-0.0088*** (0.0016)	-0.0154*** (0.0031)	-0.0095*** (0.0017)	-0.0146*** (0.0031)	-0.0037 (0.0023)	0.0041 (0.0038)	-0.0009 (0.0023)	0.0048 (0.0038)	-0.0045* (0.0024)	0.0047 (0.0038)
DivDummy	-0.0013* (0.0005)	0.0020** (0.0009)	-0.0008 (0.0006)	0.0020** (0.0010)	-0.0011** (0.0006)	0.0016* (0.0010)	-0.0024** (0.0008)	-0.0000 (0.0011)	-0.0024*** (0.0008)	-0.0003 (0.0011)	-0.0025*** (0.0008)	-0.0004 (0.0011)
sCFO	-0.0040** (0.0020)	-0.0067** (0.0026)	-0.0041** (0.0020)	-0.0071*** (0.0023)	-0.0041** (0.0020)	-0.0070*** (0.0024)	-0.0016 (0.0012)	-0.0054*** (0.0017)	-0.0012 (0.0014)	-0.0055*** (0.0016)	-0.0015 (0.0012)	-0.0054*** (0.0016)
Lagged_DV	0.7638*** (0.0149)	0.3251*** (0.0231)	0.7405*** (0.0152)	0.3160*** (0.0235)	0.7416*** (0.0154)	0.3191*** (0.0234)	0.6601*** (0.0199)	0.0909*** (0.0195)	0.6463*** (0.0196)	0.0908*** (0.0197)	0.6425*** (0.0201)	0.0921*** (0.0197)
SalesGrowth			0.0082*** (0.0017)	0.0059*** (0.0015)	0.0074*** (0.0016)	0.0051*** (0.0015)			0.0090*** (0.0017)	0.0057*** (0.0014)	0.0083*** (0.0016)	0.0053*** (0.0013)
RDSales			0.0008*** (0.0003)	0.0010*** (0.0004)	0.0008*** (0.0003)	0.0008*** (0.0004)			0.0018*** (0.0003)	0.0022*** (0.0005)	0.0018*** (0.0003)	0.0020*** (0.0005)
CashFlowAt			0.0574*** (0.0062)	0.0322*** (0.0065)	0.0567*** (0.0062)	0.0327*** (0.0064)			0.0527*** (0.0062)	0.0173*** (0.0065)	0.0523*** (0.0062)	0.0184*** (0.0065)
DailyVola			0.0001*** (0.0000)	0.0000** (0.0000)	0.0000 (0.0000)	-0.0000 (0.0000)			-0.0000 (0.0000)	-0.0001*** (0.0000)	-0.0001*** (0.0000)	-0.0002*** (0.0000)
Extended Controls			Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes			Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Industry FE	Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes	
Firm FE		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes
Year FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes			Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes		
Year-Quarter FE					Yes	Yes					Yes	Yes
N	61,097	61,097	58,659	58,659	58,659	58,659	56,394	56,394	55,299	55,299	55,299	55,299
R ²	0.618	0.143	0.622	0.145	0.626	0.147	0.494	0.059	0.498	0.070	0.503	0.069
Adj. R ²	0.618	0.118	0.622	0.119	0.625	0.121	0.494	0.031	0.498	0.042	0.502	0.039

Notes: * $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$ (two-tailed). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms). R^2 includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- R^2).

Table 48: H13.1: Product Similarity–Moderated Speech Uncertainty and Capital Expenditure

	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)
	Capex				Capex_lead			
UncAnsMgr_c	0.0010** (0.0005)	0.0002 (0.0004)	0.0010** (0.0005)	-0.0000 (0.0004)	0.0017*** (0.0007)	0.0005 (0.0006)	0.0017*** (0.0007)	0.0004 (0.0006)
z_log_TotalSimilarity	0.0020*** (0.0004)	0.0010 (0.0010)	0.0021*** (0.0004)	0.0010 (0.0010)	0.0027*** (0.0006)	0.0024** (0.0012)	0.0027*** (0.0006)	0.0024** (0.0012)
UncAnsMgr_c_x_zlogTSIMM	0.0012** (0.0006)	0.0013** (0.0006)	0.0011** (0.0006)	0.0013** (0.0006)	0.0024*** (0.0009)	0.0025*** (0.0009)	0.0023*** (0.0009)	0.0024*** (0.0009)
InAssets	-0.0004* (0.0002)	-0.0019** (0.0007)	-0.0005** (0.0002)	-0.0021*** (0.0007)	-0.0009*** (0.0003)	-0.0028*** (0.0009)	-0.0009*** (0.0003)	-0.0029*** (0.0009)
TobinsQ	0.0010*** (0.0002)	0.0026*** (0.0004)	0.0010*** (0.0002)	0.0027*** (0.0004)	0.0008* (0.0003)	0.0031*** (0.0004)	0.0008*** (0.0003)	0.0031*** (0.0004)
ROA	-0.0300*** (0.0054)	-0.0152*** (0.0058)	-0.0315*** (0.0054)	-0.0168*** (0.0058)	-0.0122*** (0.0042)	0.0177*** (0.0048)	-0.0142*** (0.0042)	0.0152*** (0.0048)
Leverage	-0.0034*** (0.0011)	-0.0205*** (0.0028)	-0.0031*** (0.0011)	-0.0196*** (0.0027)	0.0013 (0.0017)	-0.0170*** (0.0029)	0.0013 (0.0016)	-0.0166*** (0.0029)
CashRatio	-0.0126*** (0.0018)	-0.0122*** (0.0032)	-0.0121*** (0.0018)	-0.0114*** (0.0032)	-0.0081*** (0.0023)	0.0059 (0.0037)	-0.0080*** (0.0023)	0.0059 (0.0037)
DivDummy	-0.0002 (0.0005)	0.0014 (0.0009)	-0.0004 (0.0005)	0.0011 (0.0009)	-0.0017** (0.0007)	-0.0003 (0.0011)	-0.0016** (0.0007)	-0.0004 (0.0010)
sCFO	-0.0040** (0.0018)	-0.0058** (0.0027)	-0.0039** (0.0017)	-0.0058** (0.0026)	-0.0017* (0.0010)	-0.0043** (0.0021)	-0.0016 (0.0010)	-0.0042** (0.0021)
SalesGrowth	0.0065*** (0.0013)	0.0051*** (0.0013)	0.0059*** (0.0012)	0.0045*** (0.0013)	0.0067*** (0.0012)	0.0046*** (0.0011)	0.0062*** (0.0011)	0.0043*** (0.0011)
RDSales	0.0005** (0.0003)	0.0008*** (0.0004)	0.0005* (0.0002)	0.0007* (0.0004)	0.0012*** (0.0004)	0.0017*** (0.0006)	0.0012*** (0.0004)	0.0016** (0.0006)
CashFlowAt	0.0520*** (0.0060)	0.0320*** (0.0064)	0.0531*** (0.0059)	0.0326*** (0.0064)	0.0500*** (0.0054)	0.0193*** (0.0063)	0.0517*** (0.0054)	0.0205*** (0.0063)
DailyVola	0.0000*** (0.0000)	0.0000** (0.0000)	0.0000 (0.0000)	-0.0000** (0.0000)	-0.0001*** (0.0000)	-0.0002*** (0.0000)	-0.0001*** (0.0000)	-0.0002*** (0.0000)
Lagged_DV	0.7311*** (0.0150)	0.3325*** (0.0221)	0.7337*** (0.0150)	0.3354*** (0.0221)	0.6234*** (0.0192)	0.0949*** (0.0187)	0.6251*** (0.0192)	0.0969*** (0.0187)
Industry FE	Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes	
Firm FE		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes
Year FE	Yes	Yes			Yes	Yes		
Year-Quarter FE			Yes	Yes			Yes	Yes
N	73,673	73,673	73,673	73,673	69,580	69,580	69,580	69,580
R ²	0.620	0.156	0.623	0.159	0.494	0.071	0.497	0.070
Adj. R ²	0.620	0.135	0.623	0.137	0.494	0.047	0.496	0.045

Notes: * $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$ (one-tailed for IVs, $\beta > 0$; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms). R^2 includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- R^2).

Table 49: H13.1.r: Product Similarity–Moderated Speech Uncertainty and Capital Expenditure (Robustness: CEO Q&A Speaker Partition)

	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)
	Capex				Capex_lead			
UncAnsCEO_c	0.0010** (0.0004)	0.0006* (0.0004)	0.0010** (0.0004)	0.0005 (0.0004)	0.0012** (0.0006)	0.0004 (0.0005)	0.0013** (0.0006)	0.0004 (0.0005)
z_log_TotalSimilarity	0.0022*** (0.0004)	0.0010 (0.0011)	0.0022*** (0.0004)	0.0010 (0.0011)	0.0030*** (0.0006)	0.0024** (0.0013)	0.0030*** (0.0006)	0.0024** (0.0013)
UncAnsCEO_c.x_zlogTSIMM	0.0006 (0.0006)	0.0006 (0.0005)	0.0006 (0.0006)	0.0006 (0.0005)	0.0014** (0.0009)	0.0015** (0.0008)	0.0014* (0.0009)	0.0014** (0.0008)
lnAssets	-0.0003 (0.0002)	-0.0021** (0.0009)	-0.0004** (0.0002)	-0.0022*** (0.0009)	-0.0009*** (0.0003)	-0.0032*** (0.0010)	-0.0009*** (0.0003)	-0.0033*** (0.0010)
TobinsQ	0.0010*** (0.0003)	0.0027*** (0.0004)	0.0010*** (0.0003)	0.0028*** (0.0004)	0.0009** (0.0004)	0.0032*** (0.0004)	0.0009** (0.0004)	0.0032*** (0.0004)
ROA	-0.0324*** (0.0061)	-0.0173*** (0.0067)	-0.0338*** (0.0060)	-0.0188*** (0.0067)	-0.0122*** (0.0047)	0.0192*** (0.0055)	-0.0142*** (0.0047)	0.0167*** (0.0054)
Leverage	-0.0040*** (0.0011)	-0.0214*** (0.0032)	-0.0037*** (0.0011)	-0.0204*** (0.0032)	0.0010 (0.0018)	-0.0173*** (0.0032)	0.0010 (0.0018)	-0.0169*** (0.0032)
CashRatio	-0.0133*** (0.0019)	-0.0144*** (0.0037)	-0.0128*** (0.0019)	-0.0135*** (0.0036)	-0.0082*** (0.0025)	0.0062 (0.0043)	-0.0082*** (0.0025)	0.0061 (0.0043)
DivDummy	-0.0004 (0.0005)	0.0017* (0.0010)	-0.0007 (0.0005)	0.0014 (0.0010)	-0.0020** (0.0008)	-0.0002 (0.0011)	-0.0019** (0.0008)	-0.0002 (0.0011)
sCFO	-0.0047*** (0.0016)	-0.0074*** (0.0022)	-0.0045*** (0.0017)	-0.0073*** (0.0023)	-0.0020* (0.0010)	-0.0058*** (0.0016)	-0.0019* (0.0011)	-0.0057*** (0.0016)
SalesGrowth	0.0086*** (0.0018)	0.0066*** (0.0016)	0.0078*** (0.0017)	0.0058*** (0.0015)	0.0091*** (0.0017)	0.0061*** (0.0014)	0.0085*** (0.0016)	0.0057*** (0.0014)
RDSales	0.0006** (0.0002)	0.0010*** (0.0003)	0.0005** (0.0002)	0.0009*** (0.0003)	0.0014*** (0.0003)	0.0019*** (0.0004)	0.0013*** (0.0003)	0.0018*** (0.0004)
CashFlowAt	0.0562*** (0.0064)	0.0345*** (0.0073)	0.0563*** (0.0064)	0.0350*** (0.0072)	0.0509*** (0.0061)	0.0203*** (0.0074)	0.0526*** (0.0061)	0.0214*** (0.0074)
DailyVola	0.0000*** (0.0000)	0.0000** (0.0000)	0.0000 (0.0000)	-0.0000* (0.0000)	-0.0001*** (0.0000)	-0.0001*** (0.0000)	-0.0001*** (0.0000)	-0.0002*** (0.0000)
Lagged_DV	0.7326*** (0.0157)	0.3280*** (0.0242)	0.7354*** (0.0156)	0.3310*** (0.0242)	0.6278*** (0.0199)	0.0933*** (0.0208)	0.6293*** (0.0199)	0.0948*** (0.0208)
Industry FE	Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes	
Firm FE		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes
Year FE	Yes	Yes			Yes	Yes		
Year-Quarter FE			Yes	Yes			Yes	Yes
N	63,716	63,716	63,716	63,716	60,094	60,094	60,094	60,094
R ²	0.625	0.154	0.629	0.157	0.501	0.074	0.503	0.072
Adj. R ²	0.625	0.130	0.628	0.132	0.501	0.047	0.503	0.044

Notes: * $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$ (one-tailed for IVs, $\beta > 0$; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms). R^2 includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- R^2).

Table 50: H13.2: Speech Uncertainty and Capital Expenditure — Lead Horizons

	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)	(9)	(10)	(11)	(12)	(13)	(14)	(15)	(16)
		Capex_lead				Capex_lead2				Capex_lead3				Capex_lead4		
UncAnsCEO	-0.0003 (0.0007)	0.0005 (0.0006)	-0.0003 (0.0007)	0.0005 (0.0006)	-0.0010 (0.0008)	-0.0002 (0.0007)	-0.0010 (0.0008)	-0.0002 (0.0007)	-0.0013 (0.0010)	-0.0008 (0.0008)	-0.0012 (0.0010)	-0.0008 (0.0008)	-0.0011 (0.0010)	-0.0008 (0.0006)	-0.0011 (0.0010)	-0.0009 (0.0006)
UncPreCEO	0.0001 (0.0009)	0.0001 (0.0007)	0.0002 (0.0009)	0.0001 (0.0007)	-0.0005 (0.0010)	-0.0006 (0.0008)	-0.0006 (0.0010)	-0.0007 (0.0008)	-0.0016 (0.0012)	-0.0012 (0.0008)	-0.0015 (0.0012)	-0.0012 (0.0008)	-0.0013 (0.0013)	-0.0004 (0.0008)	-0.0012 (0.0013)	-0.0004 (0.0008)
UncAnsMgr	0.0049*** (0.0010)	0.0001 (0.0008)	0.0028*** (0.0010)	0.0001 (0.0008)	0.0036*** (0.0011)	0.0004 (0.0009)	0.0035*** (0.0011)	0.0003 (0.0009)	0.0070*** (0.0014)	0.0019* (0.0010)	0.0049*** (0.0013)	0.0018* (0.0010)	0.0071*** (0.0014)	0.0016 (0.0010)	0.0048*** (0.0014)	0.0015 (0.0010)
UncPreMgr	0.0001 (0.0011)	-0.0017 (0.0011)	-0.0020* (0.0011)	-0.0017 (0.0011)	-0.0010 (0.0014)	0.0005 (0.0012)	-0.0009 (0.0014)	0.0005 (0.0012)	0.0022 (0.0015)	0.0016 (0.0011)	0.0002 (0.0016)	0.0016 (0.0011)	0.0023 (0.0017)	0.0010 (0.0012)	0.0001 (0.0018)	0.0010 (0.0012)
InAssets	0.0007*** (0.0002)	-0.0025*** (0.0003)	-0.0007** (0.0003)	-0.0027*** (0.0003)	-0.0009** (0.0003)	-0.0052*** (0.0011)	-0.0009** (0.0003)	-0.0052*** (0.0011)	0.0006** (0.0002)	-0.0065*** (0.0013)	-0.0008** (0.0004)	-0.0065*** (0.0013)	0.0005** (0.0003)	-0.0061*** (0.0013)	-0.0010** (0.0005)	-0.0062*** (0.0013)
TobinsQ	0.0013*** (0.0004)	0.0033*** (0.0004)	0.0009*** (0.0004)	0.0033*** (0.0004)	0.0005 (0.0004)	0.0018*** (0.0004)	0.0005 (0.0004)	0.0020*** (0.0004)	0.0003 (0.0004)	0.0004 (0.0004)	-0.0001 (0.0004)	0.0005 (0.0004)	-0.0002 (0.0004)	-0.0002 (0.0003)	-0.0006 (0.0004)	-0.0002 (0.0004)
ROA	-0.0153*** (0.0047)	0.0189*** (0.0053)	-0.0162*** (0.0047)	0.0164*** (0.0052)	-0.0289*** (0.0052)	0.0074 (0.0046)	-0.0293*** (0.0052)	0.0070 (0.0046)	-0.0376*** (0.0057)	-0.0013 (0.0045)	-0.0370*** (0.0057)	-0.0011 (0.0045)	-0.0364*** (0.0063)	-0.0019 (0.0042)	-0.0364*** (0.0063)	-0.0024 (0.0042)
Leverage	0.0012 (0.0016)	-0.0181*** (0.0033)	0.0014 (0.0016)	-0.0177*** (0.0033)	0.0052*** (0.0020)	-0.0126*** (0.0034)	0.0053*** (0.0020)	-0.0121*** (0.0034)	0.0069*** (0.0024)	-0.0074** (0.0033)	0.0070*** (0.0024)	-0.0070** (0.0033)	0.0091*** (0.0026)	-0.0027 (0.0035)	0.0093*** (0.0026)	-0.0026 (0.0035)
CashRatio	-0.0004 (0.0023)	0.0056 (0.0038)	-0.0039* (0.0024)	0.0055 (0.0038)	-0.0022 (0.0028)	0.0082** (0.0039)	-0.0022 (0.0028)	0.0083** (0.0039)	0.0004 (0.0031)	0.0054 (0.0035)	-0.0032 (0.0032)	0.0050 (0.0035)	-0.0005 (0.0035)	0.0034 (0.0035)	-0.0041 (0.0036)	0.0038 (0.0036)
DivDummy	-0.0025*** (0.0008)	-0.0001 (0.0011)	-0.0027*** (0.0008)	-0.0002 (0.0011)	-0.0023** (0.0010)	0.0005 (0.0013)	-0.0023** (0.0009)	0.0004 (0.0013)	-0.0017 (0.0011)	-0.0010 (0.0012)	-0.0020* (0.0011)	-0.0010 (0.0012)	-0.0015 (0.0012)	-0.0018 (0.0012)	-0.0017 (0.0012)	-0.0017 (0.0012)
sCFO	-0.0012 (0.0014)	-0.0058*** (0.0016)	-0.0015 (0.0012)	-0.0057*** (0.0016)	0.0021** (0.0010)	-0.0014 (0.0010)	0.0022** (0.0010)	-0.0013 (0.0010)	0.0054*** (0.0019)	0.0028** (0.0013)	0.0051** (0.0020)	0.0027** (0.0013)	0.0068*** (0.0020)	0.0049*** (0.0013)	0.0064*** (0.0021)	0.0049*** (0.0013)
Lagged_DV	0.6398*** (0.0194)	0.0868*** (0.0196)	0.6364*** (0.0199)	0.0883*** (0.0196)	0.5626*** (0.0215)	-0.0351* (0.0184)	0.5645*** (0.0216)	-0.0343* (0.0184)	0.5206*** (0.0248)	-0.0774*** (0.0180)	0.5175*** (0.0253)	-0.0782*** (0.0180)	0.4968*** (0.0252)	-0.0641*** (0.0201)	0.4939*** (0.0256)	-0.0625*** (0.0203)
SalesGrowth	0.0096*** (0.0017)	0.0058*** (0.0014)	0.0089*** (0.0017)	0.0054*** (0.0014)	0.0061*** (0.0016)	0.0023* (0.0012)	0.0057*** (0.0016)	0.0023* (0.0012)	0.0054*** (0.0020)	0.0011 (0.0010)	0.0050** (0.0020)	0.0013 (0.0011)	0.0044** (0.0019)	-0.0000 (0.0010)	0.0037** (0.0018)	-0.0001 (0.0010)
RDSales	0.0016*** (0.0003)	0.0019*** (0.0004)	0.0016*** (0.0002)	0.0018*** (0.0004)	0.0017** (0.0007)	0.0020* (0.0011)	0.0017** (0.0007)	0.0021* (0.0011)	0.0007** (0.0003)	-0.0001 (0.0007)	0.0007** (0.0003)	-0.0000 (0.0007)	0.0010 (0.0007)	0.0010* (0.0005)	0.0010 (0.0007)	0.0009* (0.0005)
CashFlowAt	0.0549*** (0.0062)	0.0184*** (0.0066)	0.0546*** (0.0062)	0.0195*** (0.0066)	0.0687*** (0.0067)	0.0226*** (0.0058)	0.0689*** (0.0067)	0.0220*** (0.0057)	0.0769*** (0.0075)	0.0167*** (0.0056)	0.0743*** (0.0074)	0.0154*** (0.0056)	0.0725*** (0.0089)	0.0102* (0.0060)	0.0707*** (0.0089)	0.0101* (0.0060)
Daily Vola	-0.0000* (0.0000)	-0.0001*** (0.0000)	-0.0001*** (0.0000)	-0.0002*** (0.0000)	-0.0001*** (0.0000)	-0.0001*** (0.0000)	-0.0001*** (0.0000)	-0.0001*** (0.0000)	0.0001*** (0.0000)	-0.0000 (0.0000)	-0.0000 (0.0000)	-0.0000** (0.0000)	0.0001*** (0.0000)	0.0000 (0.0000)	0.0000 (0.0000)	-0.0000 (0.0000)
Industry FE	Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes	
Firm FE		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes
Year FE	Yes	Yes			Yes	Yes			Yes	Yes			Yes	Yes		
Year-Quarter FE			Yes	Yes			Yes	Yes			Yes	Yes			Yes	Yes
N	58,897	58,897	58,897	58,897	52,648	52,648	52,648	52,648	46,679	46,679	46,679	46,679	41,091	41,091	41,091	41,091
R ²	0.496	0.070	0.501	0.068	0.426	0.034	0.428	0.035	0.381	0.022	0.386	0.023	0.361	0.016	0.366	0.016
Adj. R ²	0.495	0.043	0.500	0.040	0.425	0.005	0.427	0.004	0.381	-0.009	0.384	-0.010	0.360	-0.019	0.365	-0.020

Notes: * $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$ (two-tailed). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms). R^2 includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- R^2).

Table 51: H13.2 Robustness: Orthogonal Speaker Partition

	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)	(9)	(10)	(11)	(12)	(13)	(14)	(15)	(16)
		Capex_lead				Capex_lead2				Capex_lead3				Capex_lead4		
UncAnsCEO	0.0028*** (0.0006)	0.0007 (0.0004)	0.0015*** (0.0006)	0.0007 (0.0004)	0.0010 (0.0007)	-0.0001 (0.0005)	0.0010 (0.0007)	-0.0002 (0.0005)	0.0029*** (0.0008)	0.0003 (0.0006)	0.0017** (0.0008)	0.0003 (0.0006)	0.0032*** (0.0009)	0.0002 (0.0005)	0.0018** (0.0009)	0.0001 (0.0005)
UncAnsNoCEO	0.0014*** (0.0003)	0.0002 (0.0003)	0.0007** (0.0003)	0.0002 (0.0003)	0.0005 (0.0004)	-0.0001 (0.0003)	0.0005 (0.0004)	-0.0001 (0.0003)	0.0019*** (0.0004)	0.0005 (0.0003)	0.0011*** (0.0004)	0.0005 (0.0003)	0.0016*** (0.0005)	0.0001 (0.0003)	0.0008* (0.0005)	0.0001 (0.0003)
UncPreCEO	0.0003 (0.0007)	-0.0006 (0.0006)	-0.0005 (0.0008)	-0.0006 (0.0006)	-0.0009 (0.0009)	-0.0005 (0.0006)	-0.0009 (0.0009)	-0.0006 (0.0006)	-0.0004 (0.0010)	-0.0004 (0.0006)	-0.0013 (0.0011)	-0.0004 (0.0006)	-0.0002 (0.0011)	-0.0001 (0.0006)	-0.0011 (0.0011)	-0.0000 (0.0006)
UncPreNoCEO	-0.0001 (0.0005)	-0.0011** (0.0006)	-0.0010* (0.0005)	-0.0011* (0.0006)	-0.0008 (0.0007)	-0.0006 (0.0006)	-0.0008 (0.0007)	-0.0005 (0.0006)	0.0007 (0.0008)	0.0005 (0.0006)	-0.0002 (0.0008)	0.0006 (0.0006)	0.0011 (0.0008)	0.0009 (0.0006)	0.0001 (0.0009)	0.0009 (0.0006)
InAssets	0.0007*** (0.0002)	-0.0022** (0.0003)	-0.0007*** (0.0003)	-0.0023** (0.0003)	-0.0009** (0.0003)	-0.0049*** (0.0011)	-0.0009** (0.0004)	-0.0049*** (0.0011)	0.0006*** (0.0002)	-0.0059*** (0.0012)	-0.0008* (0.0004)	-0.0059*** (0.0012)	0.0006** (0.0003)	-0.0057*** (0.0013)	-0.0010** (0.0005)	-0.0058*** (0.0013)
TobinsQ	0.0014*** (0.0004)	0.0032*** (0.0004)	0.0010*** (0.0004)	0.0033*** (0.0004)	0.0006 (0.0004)	0.0018*** (0.0004)	0.0006 (0.0004)	0.0019*** (0.0004)	0.0003 (0.0004)	0.0004 (0.0004)	-0.0000 (0.0004)	0.0005 (0.0004)	-0.0000 (0.0004)	-0.0002 (0.0004)	-0.0005 (0.0004)	-0.0002 (0.0004)
ROA	-0.0130*** (0.0047)	0.0194*** (0.0052)	-0.0141*** (0.0047)	0.0170*** (0.0052)	-0.0258*** (0.0052)	0.0090** (0.0046)	-0.0261*** (0.0052)	0.0087* (0.0046)	-0.0367*** (0.0057)	-0.0030 (0.0045)	-0.0362*** (0.0057)	-0.0027 (0.0045)	-0.0349*** (0.0064)	-0.0025 (0.0042)	-0.0350*** (0.0064)	-0.0029 (0.0042)
Leverage	0.0015 (0.0016)	-0.0179*** (0.0034)	0.0017 (0.0016)	-0.0175*** (0.0034)	0.0056*** (0.0020)	-0.0120*** (0.0034)	0.0056*** (0.0020)	-0.0115*** (0.0034)	0.0070*** (0.0024)	-0.0077*** (0.0034)	0.0072*** (0.0024)	-0.0073*** (0.0034)	0.0092*** (0.0026)	-0.0031 (0.0034)	0.0094*** (0.0026)	-0.0030 (0.0034)
CashRatio	-0.0009 (0.0023)	0.0048 (0.0038)	-0.0045* (0.0024)	0.0047 (0.0038)	-0.0027 (0.0028)	0.0077** (0.0038)	-0.0027 (0.0028)	0.0078** (0.0038)	-0.0002 (0.0032)	0.0056* (0.0034)	-0.0041 (0.0033)	0.0053 (0.0034)	-0.0014 (0.0036)	0.0033 (0.0034)	-0.0051 (0.0037)	0.0037 (0.0034)
DivDummy	-0.0024*** (0.0008)	-0.0003 (0.0011)	-0.0025*** (0.0008)	-0.0004 (0.0011)	-0.0021** (0.0010)	0.0006 (0.0013)	-0.0021** (0.0009)	0.0004 (0.0012)	-0.0018* (0.0011)	-0.0013 (0.0011)	-0.0020* (0.0011)	-0.0014 (0.0011)	-0.0013 (0.0012)	-0.0016 (0.0011)	-0.0014 (0.0012)	-0.0015 (0.0011)
sCFO	-0.0012 (0.0014)	-0.0055*** (0.0016)	-0.0015 (0.0012)	-0.0054*** (0.0016)	0.0021** (0.0010)	-0.0016 (0.0010)	0.0022** (0.0010)	-0.0015 (0.0010)	0.0061*** (0.0017)	0.0027** (0.0012)	0.0057*** (0.0018)	0.0027** (0.0012)	0.0069*** (0.0019)	0.0051*** (0.0013)	0.0066*** (0.0020)	0.0050*** (0.0013)
Lagged_DV	0.6463*** (0.0196)	0.0908*** (0.0197)	0.6425*** (0.0201)	0.0921*** (0.0197)	0.5643*** (0.0219)	-0.0269 (0.0194)	0.5663*** (0.0220)	-0.0260 (0.0194)	0.5231*** (0.0261)	-0.0743*** (0.0181)	0.5195*** (0.0266)	-0.0752*** (0.0181)	0.4977*** (0.0260)	-0.0588*** (0.0197)	0.4946*** (0.0265)	-0.0571*** (0.0198)
SalesGrowth	0.0090*** (0.0017)	0.0057*** (0.0014)	0.0083*** (0.0016)	0.0053*** (0.0013)	0.0056*** (0.0016)	0.0022** (0.0012)	0.0052*** (0.0016)	0.0023* (0.0012)	0.0052** (0.0020)	0.0012 (0.0010)	0.0048** (0.0020)	0.0014 (0.0010)	0.0043** (0.0019)	0.0006 (0.0010)	0.0036** (0.0018)	0.0004 (0.0010)
RDSales	0.0018*** (0.0003)	0.0022*** (0.0005)	0.0018*** (0.0003)	0.0020*** (0.0005)	0.0016** (0.0006)	0.0022** (0.0011)	0.0016** (0.0006)	0.0022** (0.0011)	0.0011** (0.0004)	0.0000 (0.0010)	0.0011*** (0.0004)	0.0002 (0.0010)	0.0012 (0.0007)	0.0014** (0.0007)	0.0012* (0.0007)	0.0013* (0.0007)
CashFlowAt	0.0527*** (0.0062)	0.0173*** (0.0065)	0.0523*** (0.0062)	0.0184*** (0.0065)	0.0658*** (0.0067)	0.0211*** (0.0059)	0.0659*** (0.0067)	0.0205*** (0.0058)	0.0777*** (0.0076)	0.0194*** (0.0057)	0.0752*** (0.0075)	0.0182*** (0.0056)	0.0727*** (0.0089)	0.0130** (0.0061)	0.0708*** (0.0089)	0.0129** (0.0061)
Daily Vola	-0.0000 (0.0000)	-0.0001*** (0.0000)	-0.0001*** (0.0000)	-0.0002*** (0.0000)	-0.0001*** (0.0000)	-0.0001*** (0.0000)	-0.0001*** (0.0000)	-0.0001*** (0.0000)	0.0001*** (0.0000)	-0.0000 (0.0000)	-0.0000 (0.0000)	-0.0000*** (0.0000)	0.0001*** (0.0000)	0.0000 (0.0000)	0.0000 (0.0000)	-0.0000 (0.0000)
Industry FE	Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes	
Firm FE		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes
Year FE	Yes	Yes			Yes	Yes			Yes	Yes			Yes	Yes		
Year-Quarter FE			Yes	Yes			Yes	Yes			Yes	Yes			Yes	Yes
N	55,299	55,299	55,299	55,299	49,446	49,446	49,446	49,446	43,847	43,847	43,847	43,847	38,613	38,613	38,613	38,613
R ²	0.498	0.070	0.503	0.069	0.428	0.034	0.431	0.034	0.384	0.022	0.388	0.022	0.363	0.015	0.368	0.015
Adj. R ²	0.498	0.042	0.502	0.039	0.427	0.003	0.430	0.002	0.383	-0.012	0.387	-0.012	0.362	-0.021	0.367	-0.022

Notes: * $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$ (two-tailed). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms). R^2 includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- R^2).

Table 52: H13.3: Financial Constraint–Moderated Speech Uncertainty and Capital Expenditure (Three-Category, CEO Q&A)

	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)
	Capex				Capex_lead			
UncAnsCEO_c	0.0013*** (0.0005)	0.0008** (0.0004)	0.0012*** (0.0005)	0.0006* (0.0004)	0.0015*** (0.0006)	0.0005 (0.0005)	0.0014*** (0.0006)	0.0005 (0.0005)
Unrated	0.0016*** (0.0006)	-0.0037 (0.0016)	0.0000 (0.0008)	-0.0035 (0.0016)	0.0045*** (0.0009)	-0.0044 (0.0021)	-0.0003 (0.0011)	-0.0043 (0.0020)
UncAnsCEO_c.x.Unrated	-0.0004 (0.0012)	0.0001 (0.0009)	-0.0005 (0.0012)	-0.0000 (0.0009)	-0.0010 (0.0017)	0.0002 (0.0011)	-0.0008 (0.0017)	0.0003 (0.0011)
InAssets	0.0004*** (0.0001)	-0.0022** (0.0009)	-0.0003 (0.0002)	-0.0024*** (0.0009)	0.0009*** (0.0001)	-0.0033*** (0.0011)	-0.0008** (0.0003)	-0.0034*** (0.0011)
TobinsQ	0.0015*** (0.0003)	0.0030*** (0.0005)	0.0014*** (0.0003)	0.0031*** (0.0005)	0.0016*** (0.0004)	0.0034*** (0.0005)	0.0013*** (0.0004)	0.0034*** (0.0005)
ROA	-0.0369*** (0.0065)	-0.0190*** (0.0072)	-0.0381*** (0.0064)	-0.0205*** (0.0071)	-0.0167*** (0.0047)	0.0191*** (0.0057)	-0.0180*** (0.0047)	0.0166*** (0.0057)
Leverage	-0.0046*** (0.0013)	-0.0225*** (0.0036)	-0.0046*** (0.0013)	-0.0215*** (0.0036)	-0.0007 (0.0018)	-0.0195*** (0.0035)	-0.0013 (0.0017)	-0.0191*** (0.0035)
CashRatio	-0.0097*** (0.0017)	-0.0156*** (0.0039)	-0.0102*** (0.0018)	-0.0147*** (0.0039)	-0.0018 (0.0023)	0.0060 (0.0045)	-0.0046* (0.0024)	0.0059 (0.0045)
DivDummy	-0.0005 (0.0006)	0.0018* (0.0010)	-0.0008 (0.0006)	0.0014 (0.0010)	-0.0017** (0.0008)	-0.0002 (0.0011)	-0.0022*** (0.0008)	-0.0003 (0.0011)
sCFO	-0.0042** (0.0018)	-0.0076*** (0.0021)	-0.0041** (0.0018)	-0.0075*** (0.0021)	-0.0014 (0.0012)	-0.0059*** (0.0015)	-0.0016 (0.0010)	-0.0059*** (0.0015)
SalesGrowth	0.0091*** (0.0018)	0.0071*** (0.0017)	0.0082*** (0.0017)	0.0062*** (0.0016)	0.0102*** (0.0017)	0.0069*** (0.0015)	0.0096*** (0.0017)	0.0065*** (0.0015)
RDSales	0.0008*** (0.0002)	0.0010** (0.0004)	0.0007*** (0.0002)	0.0009** (0.0004)	0.0018*** (0.0003)	0.0019*** (0.0005)	0.0017*** (0.0003)	0.0018*** (0.0005)
CashFlowAt	0.0603*** (0.0069)	0.0344*** (0.0076)	0.0599*** (0.0068)	0.0350*** (0.0075)	0.0543*** (0.0063)	0.0185*** (0.0076)	0.0546*** (0.0062)	0.0196*** (0.0075)
DailyVola	0.0001*** (0.0000)	0.0000*** (0.0000)	0.0000 (0.0000)	-0.0000 (0.0000)	-0.0001*** (0.0000)	-0.0001*** (0.0000)	-0.0001*** (0.0000)	-0.0002*** (0.0000)
Lagged_DV	0.7346*** (0.0155)	0.3090*** (0.0253)	0.7362*** (0.0157)	0.3122*** (0.0253)	0.6361*** (0.0191)	0.0769*** (0.0226)	0.6340*** (0.0195)	0.0781*** (0.0226)
Industry FE	Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes	
Firm FE		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes
Year FE	Yes	Yes			Yes	Yes		
Year-Quarter FE			Yes	Yes			Yes	Yes
N	58,134	58,134	58,134	58,134	56,546	56,546	56,546	56,546
R ²	0.621	0.140	0.624	0.142	0.496	0.070	0.500	0.068
Adj. R ²	0.620	0.115	0.623	0.116	0.495	0.042	0.499	0.039

Notes: * $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$ (one-tailed for IVs, $\beta > 0$; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms). Fiscal years 2002-2016. R^2 includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- R^2).

Table 53: H14: Speech Uncertainty and Lee (2016) 3-Day Bid-Ask Spread Change (Δ DSPREAD, $[+1, +3] - [-3, -1]$)

	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)	(9)	(10)	(11)	(12)
	DSPREAD					DSPREAD_lead1						
UncAnsCEO	0.0721 (0.2738)	0.2457 (0.2983)	0.1653 (0.2777)	0.2254 (0.3033)	0.1684 (0.2794)	0.2395 (0.3039)	0.1112 (0.2690)	0.2853 (0.2840)	0.1363 (0.2430)	0.3082 (0.2709)	0.1506 (0.2439)	0.3201 (0.2708)
UncPreCEO	0.0185 (0.2398)	-0.0765 (0.2600)	-0.1418 (0.2046)	-0.3875 (0.2629)	-0.1715 (0.2024)	-0.3536 (0.2631)	-0.3044 (0.2320)	-0.5044 (0.2733)	-0.2891 (0.2003)	-0.4453 (0.2576)	-0.3379 (0.2000)	-0.4565 (0.2579)
UncAnsMgr	-0.0315 (0.3374)	-0.1868 (0.3822)	-0.7957 (0.3329)	-0.3429 (0.3865)	0.0273 (0.3386)	-0.2787 (0.3856)	-0.1289 (0.3325)	-0.3308 (0.3615)	-0.5742 (0.3035)	-0.4183 (0.3547)	-0.0418 (0.3095)	-0.4509 (0.3549)
UncPreMgr	0.0214 (0.3028)	0.2118 (0.3634)	-0.5961 (0.2278)	0.4146 (0.3357)	0.2046 (0.2359)	0.4657* (0.3358)	0.0893 (0.2705)	0.2456 (0.3503)	-0.3615 (0.2121)	0.0130 (0.3271)	0.2221 (0.2232)	0.0099 (0.3303)
InAssets	0.7344*** (0.0590)	0.7552*** (0.2258)	0.1646*** (0.0324)	0.5619** (0.2762)	0.7274*** (0.0623)	0.5960** (0.2776)	0.7361*** (0.0615)	0.7467*** (0.2184)	0.2366*** (0.0313)	0.3760 (0.2641)	0.6435*** (0.0609)	0.4207 (0.2668)
TobinsQ	0.3066*** (0.0506)	0.1395** (0.0663)	-0.0558 (0.0488)	0.0560 (0.1016)	0.2158*** (0.0517)	0.0427 (0.1024)	0.2820*** (0.0479)	0.1348* (0.0693)	0.0180 (0.0459)	0.1266 (0.0983)	0.2023*** (0.0484)	0.0962 (0.0989)
ROA	-1.8575*** (0.7026)	-1.1000 (1.0527)	-1.0631 (1.1363)	-0.7649 (1.3640)	-0.7092 (1.1426)	-0.4102 (1.3826)	-1.6177** (0.8161)	-1.0204 (1.1724)	-1.4546 (1.1036)	-1.7546 (1.2815)	-1.0991 (1.1014)	-1.5553 (1.2937)
Leverage	-0.5893* (0.3221)	-0.4334 (0.6995)	-0.3255 (0.3282)	-0.9628 (0.6904)	-0.6732* (0.3472)	-0.8884 (0.6937)	-0.6776** (0.3353)	-0.8467 (0.7292)	-0.1184 (0.3221)	-0.4588 (0.7764)	-0.3854 (0.3304)	-0.4953 (0.7783)
Capex	2.1288 (1.3649)	1.6389 (2.3213)	1.1760 (1.3274)	3.3313 (2.7262)	3.5965*** (1.3301)	3.7776 (2.7238)	2.4026 (1.5009)	2.3216 (2.5284)	1.6629 (1.3692)	2.0620 (2.9078)	3.2983** (1.3879)	2.0994 (2.9161)
DivDummy	-0.0010 (0.1380)	0.1017 (0.2946)	0.0674 (0.1447)	0.0959 (0.3130)	0.0894 (0.1404)	0.1453 (0.3133)	0.0031 (0.1400)	0.3251 (0.2896)	-0.0453 (0.1395)	0.1584 (0.2924)	-0.0110 (0.1377)	0.1826 (0.2929)
sCFO	0.3380** (0.1684)	0.1634 (0.1081)	0.3689 (0.2270)	0.5873*** (0.1493)	0.4803** (0.1888)	0.5840*** (0.1492)	0.2978* (0.1658)	0.1483 (0.1036)	0.2073* (0.1172)	0.2858*** (0.0998)	0.2659** (0.1185)	0.2699*** (0.0992)
Lagged_DV	0.0138 (0.0097)	-0.0170* (0.0097)	0.0167 (0.0113)	-0.0226** (0.0112)	0.0128 (0.0113)	-0.0226** (0.0112)	0.0133 (0.0103)	-0.0185* (0.0103)	0.0221* (0.0118)	-0.0156 (0.0115)	0.0193 (0.0119)	-0.0155 (0.0116)
StockPrice			-0.0050*** (0.0016)	-0.0048 (0.0034)	-0.0108*** (0.0016)	-0.0069** (0.0034)			-0.0091*** (0.0017)	-0.0040 (0.0034)	-0.0123*** (0.0017)	-0.0038 (0.0034)
Turnover			12.2966*** (2.1559)	9.4258*** (2.7872)	11.4327*** (2.1590)	8.2241*** (2.8270)			13.0113*** (2.0881)	7.4111*** (2.5671)	12.3677*** (2.1074)	7.1405*** (2.5740)
DailyVola			-0.0325*** (0.0066)	-0.0094 (0.0084)	-0.0068 (0.0085)	-0.0031 (0.0110)			-0.0614*** (0.0068)	-0.0524*** (0.0085)	-0.0379*** (0.0084)	-0.0461*** (0.0107)
AbsSurpDec			-0.2203*** (0.0441)	-0.0171 (0.0493)	-0.1023** (0.0427)	-0.0182 (0.0492)			-0.1480*** (0.0434)	-0.0339 (0.0488)	-0.0724* (0.0418)	-0.0399 (0.0487)
Extended Controls			Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes			Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Industry FE	Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes	
Firm FE		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes
Year FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes			Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes		
Year-Quarter FE					Yes	Yes					Yes	Yes
N	63,972	63,972	44,132	44,132	44,132	44,132	63,554	63,554	44,640	44,640	44,640	44,640
R ²	0.005	0.001	0.003	0.001	0.007	0.001	0.006	0.001	0.008	0.004	0.009	0.002
Adj. R ²	0.005	-0.027	0.002	-0.032	0.005	-0.034	0.005	-0.027	0.007	-0.029	0.007	-0.032

Notes: * $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$ (one-tailed for IVs, $\beta > 0$; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms). R^2 includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- R^2). DSPREAD values rescaled by 10^4 for readability; multiply coefficients by 10^{-4} to recover raw units.

Table 54: H14 Robustness: Orthogonal Speaker Partition

	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)	(9)	(10)	(11)	(12)
	DSPREAD					DSPREAD_lead1						
UncAnsCEO	0.0026 (0.1719)	0.1218 (0.1996)	-0.3174 (0.1656)	-0.0088 (0.2015)	0.1603 (0.1698)	0.0330 (0.2018)	-0.0090 (0.1775)	0.0622 (0.1949)	-0.1079 (0.1647)	0.1328 (0.1950)	0.1989 (0.1656)	0.1246 (0.1956)
UncAnsNoCEO	0.2320** (0.1138)	0.1691* (0.1235)	-0.1918 (0.1173)	0.0145 (0.1295)	0.0790 (0.1181)	0.0241 (0.1291)	-0.0800 (0.1192)	-0.1820 (0.1274)	-0.2268 (0.1099)	-0.1691 (0.1255)	-0.0486 (0.1101)	-0.1755 (0.1257)
UncPreCEO	0.1636 (0.1687)	0.0717 (0.2089)	-0.3160 (0.1635)	-0.1484 (0.2153)	0.0339 (0.1637)	-0.0949 (0.2153)	-0.1523 (0.1788)	-0.4084 (0.2201)	-0.3865 (0.1623)	-0.4276 (0.2023)	-0.1734 (0.1620)	-0.4424 (0.2019)
UncPreNoCEO	-0.1356 (0.1265)	-0.0761 (0.1733)	-0.3681 (0.1033)	0.0439 (0.1755)	-0.0305 (0.1073)	0.0619 (0.1757)	-0.0010 (0.1232)	0.1155 (0.1803)	-0.2805 (0.1069)	-0.2018 (0.1744)	-0.0442 (0.1080)	-0.1960 (0.1742)
lnAssets	0.7054*** (0.0555)	0.7328*** (0.2285)	0.1382*** (0.0311)	0.5337* (0.2821)	0.6865*** (0.0627)	0.5605** (0.2826)	0.7000*** (0.0616)	0.6423*** (0.2299)	0.2207*** (0.0304)	0.3804 (0.2720)	0.6060*** (0.0613)	0.4349 (0.2753)
TobinsQ	0.3108*** (0.0484)	0.1780*** (0.0654)	-0.0589 (0.0497)	0.0692 (0.1013)	0.2114*** (0.0526)	0.0556 (0.1020)	0.2509*** (0.0461)	0.1475** (0.0739)	0.0115 (0.0455)	0.1372 (0.1004)	0.1896*** (0.0479)	0.1083 (0.1010)
ROA	-1.9421*** (0.7530)	-1.1921 (1.1118)	-1.2887 (1.2230)	-0.8390 (1.3595)	-0.9952 (1.2285)	-0.5161 (1.3801)	-1.1165 (0.9081)	-0.5780 (1.2908)	-1.4995 (1.2550)	-1.7977 (1.3959)	-1.1579 (1.2614)	-1.6102 (1.4158)
Leverage	-0.5636* (0.3165)	-0.4383 (0.7108)	-0.2681 (0.3245)	-1.0213 (0.7219)	-0.6165* (0.3394)	-0.9221 (0.7257)	-0.5010 (0.3309)	-0.6213 (0.7151)	-0.0485 (0.3214)	-0.6030 (0.7945)	-0.3150 (0.3258)	-0.6443 (0.7970)
Capex	1.8980 (1.4356)	2.1716 (2.4814)	1.1888 (1.4049)	4.2046 (2.8613)	3.5514** (1.4100)	4.6214 (2.8620)	2.0217 (1.5527)	2.3992 (2.4809)	1.7765 (1.4539)	2.7398 (3.0130)	3.3055** (1.4657)	2.8279 (3.0042)
DivDummy	0.0352 (0.1359)	0.1742 (0.2951)	0.1834 (0.1412)	0.2095 (0.3180)	0.1796 (0.3172)	0.2603 (0.3184)	0.0006 (0.1486)	0.2216 (0.3059)	0.0377 (0.1415)	0.1162 (0.3070)	0.0585 (0.1397)	0.1399 (0.3077)
sCFO	0.3010* (0.1631)	0.1212 (0.1228)	0.3811 (0.2318)	0.5695*** (0.1869)	0.4984** (0.1941)	0.5630*** (0.1910)	0.3577* (0.1897)	0.1900* (0.1131)	0.2623*** (0.1017)	0.2886*** (0.0975)	0.3224*** (0.1193)	0.2748*** (0.0965)
Lagged_DV	0.0122 (0.0098)	-0.0170* (0.0098)	0.0138 (0.0112)	-0.0244** (0.0111)	0.0100 (0.0112)	-0.0243** (0.0112)	0.0053 (0.0102)	-0.0246** (0.0102)	0.0157 (0.0115)	-0.0210* (0.0113)	0.0134 (0.0116)	-0.0205* (0.0114)
StockPrice			-0.0041* (0.0016)	-0.0044 (0.0035)	-0.0099*** (0.0016)	-0.0064* (0.0035)			-0.0085*** (0.0017)	-0.0048 (0.0035)	-0.0115*** (0.0017)	-0.0047 (0.0035)
Turnover			12.6927*** (2.1465)	10.2015*** (2.7887)	12.1176*** (2.1384)	9.1792*** (2.8167)			12.7779*** (2.1172)	7.0613*** (2.6130)	12.1657*** (2.1312)	6.7178** (2.6149)
DailyVola			-0.0323*** (0.0069)	-0.0090 (0.0087)	-0.0087 (0.0087)	-0.0049 (0.0111)			-0.0612*** (0.0070)	-0.0524*** (0.0087)	-0.0383*** (0.0086)	-0.0456*** (0.0108)
AbsSurpDec			-0.2115*** (0.0450)	-0.0201 (0.0508)	-0.0901** (0.0432)	-0.0204 (0.0508)			-0.1312*** (0.0440)	-0.0373 (0.0501)	-0.0566 (0.0423)	-0.0422 (0.0500)
Extended Controls			Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes			Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Industry FE	Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes	
Firm FE		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes
Year FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes			Yes	Yes	Yes			
Year-Quarter FE					Yes	Yes					Yes	Yes
N	60,073	60,073	41,604	41,604	41,604	41,604	59,652	59,652	42,079	42,079	42,079	42,079
R ²	0.005	0.001	0.003	0.001	0.007	0.001	0.005	0.001	0.008	0.004	0.009	0.003
Adj. R ²	0.005	-0.029	0.002	-0.034	0.005	-0.035	0.005	-0.028	0.007	-0.030	0.006	-0.033

Notes: * $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$ (one-tailed for IVs, $\beta > 0$; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms). R^2 includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- R^2). DSPREAD values rescaled by 10^4 for readability; multiply coefficients by 10^{-4} to recover raw units.

Table 55: H14b: Speech Uncertainty and Lee (2016) 3-Day Post-Call Bid-Ask Spread Level ([+1, +3])

	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)	(9)	(10)	(11)	(12)
			PostCallSpread						PostCallSpread_lead1			
UncAnsCEO	0.3079 (0.3119)	0.3472 (0.3161)	0.1388 (0.3049)	0.2889 (0.3138)	0.1819 (0.2991)	0.3226 (0.3069)	0.3095 (0.2729)	0.3918* (0.2912)	0.2882 (0.2784)	0.4555* (0.2985)	0.2577 (0.2750)	0.4227* (0.2961)
UncPreCEO	-0.0462 (0.2582)	-0.1350 (0.3123)	-0.3205 (0.2502)	0.0272 (0.3061)	-0.2701 (0.2565)	-0.0882 (0.3069)	-0.1692 (0.2685)	-0.2959 (0.2743)	-0.4984 (0.2615)	-0.2957 (0.2738)	-0.2886 (0.2643)	-0.1984 (0.2696)
UncAnsMgr	-0.6930 (0.4162)	-0.6583 (0.4219)	0.9758*** (0.3966)	-0.6171 (0.4014)	-0.7201 (0.3978)	-0.7251 (0.3937)	-0.5963 (0.3590)	-0.6496 (0.3590)	1.2029*** (0.3642)	-0.8783 (0.3776)	-0.5739 (0.3596)	-0.7621 (0.3748)
UncPreMgr	-0.2043 (0.3243)	0.5918* (0.4084)	1.8059*** (0.2927)	0.3764 (0.3916)	-0.0108 (0.3111)	0.3317 (0.3912)	-0.3807 (0.3634)	0.3017 (0.4006)	1.8837*** (0.3251)	0.2146 (0.3951)	-0.1308 (0.3493)	0.2570 (0.3922)
lnAssets	-2.2449*** (0.1008)	-5.6123*** (0.4016)	-0.5519*** (0.0438)	-5.2908*** (0.4557)	-1.8081*** (0.0958)	-5.4885*** (0.4618)	-2.1586*** (0.0948)	-4.8212*** (0.3852)	-0.4556*** (0.0491)	-4.8193*** (0.4406)	-1.7785*** (0.0952)	-4.6667*** (0.4366)
TobinsQ	-0.9005*** (0.0770)	-1.4164*** (0.1886)	-0.1767** (0.0697)	-1.5253*** (0.2102)	-0.7275*** (0.0715)	-1.5319*** (0.2099)	-0.7758*** (0.0836)	-0.9581*** (0.1570)	-0.0410 (0.0811)	-1.1163*** (0.1773)	-0.6528*** (0.0749)	-1.0908*** (0.1759)
ROA	-19.6307*** (1.3717)	-19.5171*** (1.6754)	-11.4686*** (1.3235)	-12.7195*** (1.6609)	-12.5378*** (1.3434)	-13.2437*** (1.7004)	-20.6243*** (1.6285)	-23.1154*** (1.9547)	-15.0302*** (1.6196)	-18.9815*** (1.9422)	-15.2633*** (1.5608)	-18.3149*** (1.9477)
Leverage	2.7808*** (0.5171)	7.5040*** (1.0851)	0.5029 (0.4471)	5.0850*** (1.0451)	1.4582*** (0.4688)	5.2325*** (1.0607)	2.0013*** (0.4799)	5.2610*** (1.0171)	0.3341 (0.4332)	4.1282*** (1.0268)	1.2640*** (0.4244)	4.1818*** (1.0112)
Capex	-4.7750*** (1.7723)	-6.0196*** (2.9167)	-1.5721 (1.6394)	-8.2452*** (2.8183)	-6.0395*** (1.7033)	-9.0720*** (2.8204)	-5.8414*** (1.7853)	-7.8678*** (3.1849)	-1.6370 (1.6288)	-9.3587*** (3.1556)	-5.9424*** (1.6540)	-8.0232*** (3.1313)
DivDummy	0.0569 (0.2104)	-0.8433** (0.3670)	0.3302* (0.1786)	-0.6241* (0.3569)	0.2743 (0.1867)	-0.6348* (0.3554)	-0.1545 (0.2072)	-0.9509** (0.3706)	0.1248 (0.1836)	-0.7079** (0.3599)	0.1010 (0.1871)	-0.6227* (0.3545)
sCFO	0.1535 (0.3535)	0.6136* (0.3573)	0.2303 (0.3439)	0.3486 (0.3408)	-0.1314 (0.4116)	0.3672 (0.3280)	0.0646 (0.2892)	0.7209** (0.3186)	0.2766 (0.2640)	0.5339* (0.2944)	-0.1852 (0.3561)	0.5205* (0.2919)
Lagged_DV	0.6150*** (0.0113)	0.4535*** (0.0124)	0.5912*** (0.0120)	0.4132*** (0.0129)	0.5630*** (0.0125)	0.4092*** (0.0135)	0.6131*** (0.0116)	0.4473*** (0.0130)	0.6116*** (0.0132)	0.4156*** (0.0147)	0.5900*** (0.0131)	0.4252*** (0.0149)
DailyVola			0.2463*** (0.0083)	0.2226*** (0.0097)	0.2124*** (0.0105)	0.2237*** (0.0122)			0.1786*** (0.0079)	0.1571*** (0.0093)	0.1430*** (0.0105)	0.1515*** (0.0121)
StockPrice			-0.0081*** (0.0026)	0.0111* (0.0058)	0.0039 (0.0029)	0.0176*** (0.0059)			-0.0082*** (0.0025)	0.0194*** (0.0057)	0.0007 (0.0029)	0.0138** (0.0057)
Turnover			-58.2412*** (2.9710)	-55.8152*** (3.6440)	-58.8217*** (3.0241)	-53.0175*** (3.6546)			-37.7213*** (2.5472)	-34.1353*** (3.0256)	-40.8038*** (2.6341)	-34.1169*** (3.0173)
UncQue			0.5015*** (0.1564)	-0.4223*** (0.1613)	-0.4708*** (0.1568)	-0.4552*** (0.1592)			0.8859*** (0.2010)	-0.1749 (0.1883)	-0.1494 (0.2030)	-0.1318 (0.1863)
Extended Controls			Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes			Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Industry FE	Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes	
Firm FE		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes
Year FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes			Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes		
Year-Quarter FE					Yes	Yes					Yes	Yes
N	63,972	63,972	60,368	60,368	60,368	60,368	63,554	63,554	61,257	61,257	61,257	61,257
R ²	0.539	0.294	0.549	0.326	0.554	0.313	0.547	0.292	0.545	0.311	0.555	0.303
Adj. R ²	0.539	0.274	0.549	0.306	0.553	0.292	0.546	0.272	0.544	0.291	0.555	0.282

Notes: * $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$ (one-tailed for IVs, $\beta > 0$; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms). R^2 includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- R^2). PostCallSpread values rescaled by 10^4 for readability; multiply coefficients by 10^{-4} to recover raw units.

Table 56: H14b Robustness: Orthogonal Speaker Partition

	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)	(9)	(10)	(11)	(12)
			PostCallSpread						PostCallSpread_lead1			
UncAnsCEO	0.0118 (0.2060)	0.0160 (0.2120)	0.6556*** (0.1937)	-0.1124 (0.2081)	-0.2747 (0.1934)	-0.1339 (0.2060)	-0.0577 (0.2045)	-0.0371 (0.2217)	0.8765*** (0.1960)	-0.1142 (0.2168)	-0.1581 (0.1956)	-0.0794 (0.2141)
UncAnsNoCEO	-0.2855 (0.1421)	-0.2528 (0.1425)	0.1912* (0.1349)	-0.2727 (0.1377)	-0.3321 (0.1378)	-0.2726 (0.1369)	-0.2800 (0.1302)	-0.2521 (0.1304)	0.3358*** (0.1336)	-0.2383 (0.1333)	-0.2442 (0.1314)	-0.2120 (0.1314)
UncPreCEO	-0.1018 (0.2025)	0.1782 (0.2416)	0.5904*** (0.2010)	0.2957 (0.2382)	-0.1977 (0.2048)	0.1634 (0.2372)	-0.3161 (0.1932)	-0.1266 (0.2162)	0.4156** (0.1973)	-0.1275 (0.2201)	-0.2993 (0.1908)	-0.0151 (0.2165)
UncPreNoCEO	-0.0097 (0.1538)	0.2235 (0.1962)	0.7797*** (0.1460)	0.1434 (0.1931)	0.0375 (0.1510)	0.1483 (0.1945)	0.1397 (0.1629)	0.4572** (0.1998)	1.0624*** (0.1574)	0.4797*** (0.1998)	0.2224* (0.1590)	0.4875*** (0.1970)
lnAssets	-2.1057*** (0.0906)	-5.3720*** (0.3992)	-0.5231*** (0.0432)	-5.1024*** (0.4526)	-1.7276*** (0.0915)	-5.3041*** (0.4580)	-2.0320*** (0.0873)	-4.6718*** (0.3959)	-0.4202*** (0.0447)	-4.7195*** (0.4521)	-1.6713*** (0.0891)	-4.5461*** (0.4476)
TobinsQ	-0.8267*** (0.0707)	-1.3460*** (0.1819)	-0.1525** (0.0713)	-1.5030*** (0.2079)	-0.6887*** (0.0710)	-1.5139*** (0.2085)	-0.7561*** (0.0829)	-0.9101*** (0.1544)	-0.0472 (0.0826)	-1.0946*** (0.1777)	-0.6334*** (0.0742)	-1.0702*** (0.1752)
ROA	-19.5372*** (1.2527)	-19.0975*** (1.7255)	-11.6122*** (1.2851)	-12.1161*** (1.7137)	-12.7071*** (1.3060)	-12.6354*** (1.7537)	-20.1463*** (1.5555)	-22.6970*** (1.9696)	-14.8325*** (1.5687)	-18.7190*** (1.9546)	-15.0107*** (1.4942)	-17.9279*** (1.9566)
Leverage	2.5754*** (0.5039)	6.9911*** (1.0572)	0.3410 (0.4496)	4.7200*** (1.0295)	1.2742*** (0.4637)	4.8943*** (1.0460)	1.9618*** (0.4683)	5.3313*** (1.0300)	0.3163 (0.4248)	4.1979*** (1.0408)	1.2192*** (0.4116)	4.2159*** (1.0209)
Capex	-4.0856** (1.7804)	-4.0266 (3.0797)	-1.1654 (1.6644)	-6.9322** (2.9467)	-5.6326*** (1.7209)	-7.7819*** (2.9462)	-5.4724*** (1.7876)	-7.2793** (3.0489)	-1.3083 (1.6597)	-8.7564*** (2.9976)	-5.5113*** (1.6644)	-7.2474** (2.9645)
DivDummy	0.0483 (0.1895)	-0.6939* (0.3743)	0.3443* (0.1781)	-0.5000 (0.3639)	0.3304* (0.1844)	-0.5055 (0.3620)	-0.2535 (0.1855)	-0.9980*** (0.3861)	0.0209 (0.1726)	-0.7672** (0.3777)	0.0386 (0.1761)	-0.6906* (0.3713)
sCFO	0.2526 (0.3609)	0.6148* (0.3639)	0.3458 (0.3347)	0.3803 (0.3331)	0.0115 (0.3512)	0.4096 (0.3110)	0.2511 (0.2392)	0.7815** (0.3128)	0.4440* (0.2565)	0.6146** (0.2848)	-0.0024 (0.2705)	0.5968** (0.2853)
Lagged_DV	0.6104*** (0.0120)	0.4618*** (0.0127)	0.5877*** (0.0125)	0.4166*** (0.0136)	0.5606*** (0.0132)	0.4128*** (0.0142)	0.6063*** (0.0127)	0.4496*** (0.0136)	0.6036*** (0.0140)	0.4140*** (0.0154)	0.5839*** (0.0141)	0.4243*** (0.0156)
DailyVola			0.2482*** (0.0085)	0.2256*** (0.0099)	0.2141*** (0.0108)	0.2260*** (0.0126)			0.1791*** (0.0082)	0.1581*** (0.0096)	0.1464*** (0.0108)	0.1543*** (0.0124)
StockPrice			-0.0083*** (0.0026)	0.0090 (0.0058)	0.0033 (0.0029)	0.0155*** (0.0059)			-0.0091*** (0.0025)	0.0178*** (0.0057)	-0.0006 (0.0029)	0.0121** (0.0056)
Turnover			-56.6870*** (2.9266)	-54.1555*** (3.6074)	-57.3868*** (2.9842)	-51.3262*** (3.6182)			-36.8840*** (2.5240)	-32.3719*** (3.0400)	-40.3397*** (2.6272)	-32.5773*** (3.0346)
UncQue			0.5159*** (0.1562)	-0.4290*** (0.1639)	-0.4562*** (0.1557)	-0.4572*** (0.1618)			0.8341*** (0.1891)	-0.1901 (0.1879)	-0.1958 (0.1930)	-0.1505 (0.1863)
Extended Controls			Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes			Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Industry FE	Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes	
Firm FE		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes
Year FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes			Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes		
Year-Quarter FE					Yes	Yes					Yes	Yes
N	60,073	60,073	56,894	56,894	56,894	56,894	59,652	59,652	57,708	57,708	57,708	57,708
R ²	0.531	0.300	0.546	0.330	0.550	0.316	0.537	0.296	0.541	0.313	0.551	0.304
Adj. R ²	0.530	0.280	0.546	0.310	0.549	0.295	0.537	0.275	0.541	0.292	0.551	0.283

Notes: * $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$ (one-tailed for IVs, $\beta > 0$; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms). R^2 includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- R^2). PostCallSpread values rescaled by 10^4 for readability; multiply coefficients by 10^{-4} to recover raw units.

Table 57: H14c: Speech Uncertainty and BGT-Window 25-Day Bid-Ask Spread Level ([0, +25], day 0 included)

	(1)	(2)	(3) BGTLevel_Spread		(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)	(9) BGTLevel_Spread_lead1		(11)	(12)
UncAnsCEO	0.0607 (0.1731)	0.0708 (0.1812)	-0.0853 (0.1469)	-0.1041 (0.1586)	-0.0234 (0.1424)	-0.0318 (0.1538)	0.4110** (0.1890)	0.4414** (0.2027)	0.2477* (0.1511)	0.2353* (0.1646)	0.1808 (0.1412)	0.2111* (0.1561)
UncPreCEO	0.2994** (0.1468)	0.4255*** (0.1805)	0.0809 (0.1259)	0.2626* (0.1668)	0.0409 (0.1237)	0.1282 (0.1622)	-0.1097 (0.1785)	-0.1067 (0.1856)	-0.2037 (0.1347)	-0.2426 (0.1678)	-0.0340 (0.1278)	-0.0930 (0.1606)
UncAnsMgr	-0.3223 (0.2454)	-0.2516 (0.2610)	0.3616* (0.2202)	-0.2453 (0.2380)	-0.2257 (0.2121)	-0.3266 (0.2294)	-0.5609 (0.2351)	-0.6551 (0.2465)	0.5780*** (0.1819)	-0.4518 (0.1953)	-0.2466 (0.1683)	-0.3593 (0.1824)
UncPreMgr	-0.0123 (0.1939)	0.1870 (0.2529)	0.5508*** (0.1452)	0.1023 (0.2181)	-0.0070 (0.1438)	0.0686 (0.2112)	0.0435 (0.2308)	0.2640 (0.2562)	0.9476*** (0.1605)	0.2786* (0.2124)	0.0401 (0.1543)	0.2893* (0.2060)
InAssets	-0.9594*** (0.0499)	-2.5455*** (0.2089)	-0.2252*** (0.0241)	-1.7035*** (0.2173)	-0.6564*** (0.0469)	-1.8416*** (0.2171)	-0.9824*** (0.0506)	-2.2880*** (0.2052)	-0.1237*** (0.0209)	-1.9742*** (0.2200)	-0.7042*** (0.0472)	-1.6746*** (0.2073)
TobinsQ	-0.3685*** (0.0444)	-0.5237*** (0.0960)	-0.0744* (0.0438)	-0.5635*** (0.0928)	-0.2873*** (0.0449)	-0.6012*** (0.0929)	-0.3229*** (0.0477)	-0.3226*** (0.0813)	0.1008** (0.0449)	-0.4965*** (0.0991)	-0.2262*** (0.0437)	-0.4499*** (0.0927)
ROA	-11.6319*** (0.9450)	-14.5821*** (1.2001)	-5.5265*** (0.9644)	-7.6522*** (1.2206)	-6.0851*** (0.9579)	-7.9264*** (1.2085)	-12.0880*** (1.0613)	-16.1297*** (1.3354)	-8.6103*** (1.0478)	-12.1990*** (1.2320)	-7.9920*** (0.9826)	-10.8672*** (1.1553)
Leverage	0.7509*** (0.2517)	3.0868*** (0.6504)	-0.4576 (0.2811)	0.5512 (0.5467)	-0.0774 (0.2374)	0.7327 (0.5374)	0.4738* (0.2731)	1.6062*** (0.6180)	-0.4303* (0.2546)	0.3486 (0.5592)	-0.0481 (0.2245)	0.3114 (0.5251)
Capex	-1.0022 (0.9913)	0.4156 (2.0398)	-0.1040 (1.0079)	-0.0825 (2.3713)	-1.5745 (0.9891)	-0.0027 (2.3137)	-3.0126*** (1.0066)	-5.7827*** (2.0725)	0.7643 (0.9699)	-5.1554** (2.4258)	-1.5022 (0.9306)	-3.3424 (2.3625)
DivDummy	0.0510 (0.1125)	-0.3279 (0.2223)	0.3469*** (0.0906)	0.2128 (0.1853)	0.3181** (0.0879)	0.2635 (0.1845)	-0.1062 (0.1162)	-0.5052* (0.2397)	0.1127 (0.0903)	0.0979 (0.2099)	0.1152 (0.0851)	0.1096 (0.2000)
sCFO	-0.1729 (0.2676)	0.4766** (0.2071)	0.4348 (0.4177)	0.6670* (0.3679)	0.3905 (0.4107)	0.6844** (0.3253)	-0.1719 (0.2596)	0.5206*** (0.1847)	0.0969 (0.1734)	0.2838 (0.2091)	-0.0954 (0.2117)	0.2223 (0.1810)
Lagged_DV	0.8143*** (0.0085)	0.7030*** (0.0089)	0.7331*** (0.0140)	0.6306*** (0.0171)	0.7328*** (0.0152)	0.6416*** (0.0181)	0.8053*** (0.0095)	0.6810*** (0.0099)	0.7543*** (0.0149)	0.6111*** (0.0186)	0.7596*** (0.0150)	0.6476*** (0.0181)
StockPrice			-0.0042*** (0.0015)	-0.0035 (0.0024)	0.0006 (0.0014)	0.0016 (0.0024)		-0.0062*** (0.0013)	0.0099*** (0.0025)	-0.0019 (0.0013)	0.0045*** (0.0022)	
Turnover			-24.6047*** (1.7426)	-24.3939*** (2.1413)	-21.9680*** (1.7020)	-20.4118*** (2.0935)		-7.4275*** (1.5223)	-5.8266*** (2.0556)	-8.5559*** (1.4983)	-5.1441*** (1.9559)	
DailyVola			0.1386*** (0.0068)	0.1436*** (0.0079)	0.1106*** (0.0080)	0.1291*** (0.0097)		0.0610*** (0.0060)	0.0536*** (0.0066)	0.0429*** (0.0068)	0.0466*** (0.0080)	
AbsSurpDec			-0.0120 (0.0277)	-0.0235 (0.0316)	-0.0778*** (0.0272)	-0.0106 (0.0304)		0.1462*** (0.0300)	0.0222 (0.0315)	-0.0099 (0.0279)	0.0087 (0.0298)	
Extended Controls			Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes		Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Industry FE	Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes	
Firm FE		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes
Year FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes			Yes	Yes	Yes			
Year-Quarter FE					Yes	Yes					Yes	Yes
N	63,899	63,899	44,092	44,092	44,092	44,092	63,443	63,443	44,569	44,569	44,569	44,569
R ²	0.778	0.585	0.721	0.563	0.730	0.557	0.774	0.567	0.699	0.514	0.723	0.530
Adj. R ²	0.778	0.573	0.720	0.548	0.730	0.542	0.774	0.555	0.699	0.498	0.723	0.514

Notes: * $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$ (one-tailed for IVs, $\beta > 0$; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms). R^2 includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- R^2). BGTLevel_Spread values rescaled by 10^4 for readability; multiply coefficients by 10^{-4} to recover raw units.

Table 58: H14c Robustness: Orthogonal Speaker Partition

	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)	(9)	(10)	(11)	(12)
			BGTLevel_Spread						BGTLevel_Spread_lead1			
UncAnsCEO	-0.0536 (0.1181)	-0.0022 (0.1332)	0.1530* (0.1049)	-0.2225 (0.1097)	-0.1533 (0.0968)	-0.2013 (0.1063)	0.1171 (0.1319)	0.1222 (0.1567)	0.5631*** (0.1206)	-0.0338 (0.1411)	0.0113 (0.1146)	-0.0090 (0.1350)
UncAnsNoCEO	-0.0992 (0.0891)	-0.0618 (0.0931)	0.1090* (0.0787)	-0.1069 (0.0858)	-0.0816 (0.0771)	-0.0981 (0.0827)	-0.1109 (0.0813)	-0.0862 (0.0861)	0.2994*** (0.0735)	-0.0066 (0.0803)	-0.0165 (0.0705)	0.0025 (0.0765)
UncPreCEO	0.2306** (0.1117)	0.4663*** (0.1375)	0.3183*** (0.1077)	0.2826** (0.1316)	0.0012 (0.1044)	0.1397 (0.1277)	-0.1248 (0.1198)	-0.0079 (0.1414)	0.2353** (0.1038)	-0.1307 (0.1343)	-0.0294 (0.0972)	0.0293 (0.1290)
UncPreNoCEO	-0.0116 (0.0933)	0.0493 (0.1247)	0.2019*** (0.0654)	0.0047 (0.1031)	-0.0223 (0.0644)	0.0246 (0.1007)	0.1007 (0.0944)	0.2068* (0.1300)	0.3711*** (0.0710)	0.0706 (0.1084)	-0.0387 (0.0644)	0.0560 (0.1036)
InAssets	-0.9264*** (0.0501)	-2.4784*** (0.2156)	-0.2065*** (0.0242)	-1.7495*** (0.2244)	-0.6584*** (0.0491)	-1.8843*** (0.2249)	-0.9414*** (0.0502)	-2.2520*** (0.2081)	-0.1125*** (0.0210)	-2.0044*** (0.2308)	-0.7064*** (0.0480)	-1.7142*** (0.2177)
TobinsQ	-0.3411*** (0.0424)	-0.4989*** (0.0961)	-0.0518 (0.0452)	-0.5866*** (0.0973)	-0.2791*** (0.0460)	-0.6246*** (0.0975)	-0.3094*** (0.0520)	-0.3042*** (0.0820)	0.1209** (0.0472)	-0.5182*** (0.1026)	-0.2177*** (0.0455)	-0.4684*** (0.0952)
ROA	-11.9168*** (0.9227)	-14.6359*** (1.2565)	-6.0142*** (1.0180)	-8.0326*** (1.2841)	-6.5826*** (1.0130)	-8.2914*** (1.2641)	-12.2366*** (1.0892)	-16.2875*** (1.3653)	-9.0499*** (1.0958)	-12.4130*** (1.2803)	-8.4034*** (1.0357)	-10.9936*** (1.2042)
Leverage	0.7118*** (0.2585)	2.9709*** (0.6566)	-0.5126* (0.2920)	0.6011 (0.5530)	-0.1071 (0.2481)	0.7421 (0.5548)	0.4070 (0.2792)	1.5519** (0.6210)	-0.5051* (0.2615)	0.3897 (0.5683)	-0.0762 (0.2291)	0.3902 (0.5333)
Capex	-0.9383 (1.0544)	1.5238 (2.2405)	-0.0298 (1.0679)	0.3240 (2.5487)	-1.6043 (1.0368)	0.3999 (2.4886)	-2.7165*** (1.0329)	-4.9035** (2.1117)	1.1317 (0.9887)	-5.2605*** (2.5587)	-1.1251 (0.9287)	-3.3188 (2.4779)
DivDummy	-0.0087 (0.1058)	-0.3900* (0.2329)	0.3390*** (0.0937)	0.1695 (0.1952)	0.3300*** (0.0903)	0.2123 (0.1941)	-0.1160 (0.1108)	-0.4521* (0.2484)	0.1321 (0.0935)	0.1371 (0.2204)	0.1520* (0.0878)	0.1392 (0.2103)
sCFO	-0.0748 (0.2538)	0.4965** (0.2098)	0.5818 (0.3565)	0.6926* (0.3647)	0.5519 (0.3359)	0.7275** (0.3024)	-0.1033 (0.2387)	0.5157*** (0.1775)	0.1934 (0.1427)	0.3010 (0.2074)	-0.0143 (0.1853)	0.2307 (0.1861)
Lagged_DV	0.8046*** (0.0089)	0.6990*** (0.0096)	0.7233*** (0.0145)	0.6227*** (0.0178)	0.7225*** (0.0159)	0.6341*** (0.0189)	0.8017*** (0.0097)	0.6818*** (0.0104)	0.7496*** (0.0161)	0.6054*** (0.0195)	0.7546*** (0.0162)	0.6427*** (0.0189)
StockPrice			-0.0045*** (0.0015)	-0.0028 (0.0025)	0.0005 (0.0015)	0.0023 (0.0025)			-0.0065*** (0.0013)	0.0101*** (0.0025)	-0.0022* (0.0013)	0.0046** (0.0023)
Turnover			-24.2920*** (1.7648)	-24.4940*** (2.1608)	-21.7210*** (1.7327)	-20.3661*** (2.1179)			-6.9017*** (1.5482)	-5.4612*** (2.0959)	-8.1633*** (1.5274)	-4.7962** (1.9941)
DailyVola			0.1418*** (0.0071)	0.1455*** (0.0084)	0.1130*** (0.0085)	0.1311*** (0.0103)			0.0616*** (0.0063)	0.0542*** (0.0068)	0.0428*** (0.0071)	0.0467*** (0.0082)
AbsSurpDec			-0.0295 (0.0283)	-0.0473 (0.0324)	-0.1015*** (0.0275)	-0.0336 (0.0312)			0.1458*** (0.0305)	0.0170 (0.0325)	-0.0165 (0.0284)	0.0036 (0.0306)
Extended Controls			Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes			Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Industry FE	Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes	
Firm FE		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes
Year FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes			Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes		
Year-Quarter FE					Yes	Yes					Yes	Yes
N	60,002	60,002	41,563	41,563	41,563	41,563	59,548	59,548	42,009	42,009	42,009	42,009
R ²	0.768	0.583	0.717	0.559	0.726	0.553	0.765	0.566	0.694	0.510	0.719	0.525
Adj. R ²	0.768	0.571	0.716	0.544	0.726	0.537	0.765	0.553	0.694	0.493	0.718	0.508

Notes: * $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$ (one-tailed for IVs, $\beta > 0$; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms). R^2 includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- R^2). BGTLevel_Spread values rescaled by 10^4 for readability; multiply coefficients by 10^{-4} to recover raw units.

Table 59: H14c CEO 3-IV Decomp: ClarityCEO + UncResCEO (DWZ Eq.5) + UncPreCEO (raw) and 25-Day Post-Call Bid-Ask Spread Level ($[0, +25]$, the call day plus 25 trading days)

	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)	(9)	(10)	(11)	(12)
	Spread _{25D,t}						Spread _{25D,t+1}					
CEO Clarity (DWZ, qtr-exp)	-0.2204 (0.2305)	1.4148 (0.4656)	0.0262 (0.2417)	1.3893 (0.4625)	0.0109 (0.2223)	1.4933 (0.4493)	-0.1275 (0.2592)	0.6917 (0.4574)	-0.0236 (0.2644)	0.7437 (0.4559)	0.0763 (0.2425)	0.5928 (0.4196)
CEO Residual Uncertainty (DWZ, qtr-exp)	-0.0777 (0.1193)	-0.1298 (0.1215)	-0.1490 (0.1141)	-0.2119 (0.1138)	-0.1379 (0.1083)	-0.2079 (0.1092)	0.1807 (0.1893)	0.1807 (0.2043)	0.1469 (0.1885)	0.1360 (0.2033)	0.1321 (0.1787)	0.1251 (0.1922)
CEO Pres Uncertainty	0.3068*** (0.1102)	0.5572*** (0.1551)	0.2203** (0.1121)	0.5138*** (0.1535)	0.1389* (0.1043)	0.3382*** (0.1439)	-0.0164 (0.1128)	-0.1225 (0.1594)	-0.0497 (0.1139)	-0.1312 (0.1600)	0.0803 (0.1069)	0.0437 (0.1531)
InAssets	-0.7095*** (0.0756)	-2.1371*** (0.3076)	-0.5621*** (0.0729)	-1.8990*** (0.3351)	-0.5434*** (0.0705)	-1.9109*** (0.3228)	-0.6332*** (0.0577)	-1.0740*** (0.2334)	-0.5988*** (0.0565)	-1.3264*** (0.2613)	-0.4376*** (0.0539)	-0.7944*** (0.2356)
TobinsQ	-0.2030*** (0.0532)	-0.4901*** (0.1175)	-0.1753*** (0.0544)	-0.5675*** (0.1328)	-0.1845*** (0.0506)	-0.5919*** (0.1270)	-0.1454*** (0.0536)	-0.0866 (0.1002)	-0.1623*** (0.0545)	-0.2916** (0.1213)	-0.1361*** (0.0489)	-0.2360** (0.1103)
ROA	-9.4345*** (1.0946)	-10.7964*** (1.5412)	-5.8667*** (1.0313)	-7.1497*** (1.4108)	-5.8184*** (1.0058)	-7.2962*** (1.3463)	-10.4691*** (1.4521)	-14.6681*** (1.9186)	-9.1171*** (1.3901)	-13.6031*** (1.8669)	-7.5250*** (1.2854)	-11.7603*** (1.7448)
Leverage	0.1856 (0.2504)	1.1765* (0.6513)	-0.3231 (0.3019)	0.1291 (0.6310)	-0.2263 (0.2759)	0.2443 (0.6009)	0.3024 (0.2420)	0.8637 (0.7229)	0.0963 (0.2448)	0.4351 (0.7404)	0.0395 (0.2307)	0.2717 (0.6888)
Capex	0.3990 (1.1490)	1.4567 (2.6382)	-0.5845 (1.1795)	1.6137 (2.5342)	-0.3511 (1.1165)	2.0409 (2.4868)	-0.6991 (1.1166)	-1.5144 (2.4289)	-1.3902 (1.1455)	-1.8481 (2.4476)	-1.0884 (1.0334)	-0.8747 (2.2682)
DivDummy	0.0510 (0.0903)	-0.0855 (0.2034)	0.2667*** (0.0927)	0.0409 (0.2037)	0.2566*** (0.0869)	0.0674 (0.1925)	0.0701 (0.1038)	0.4854* (0.2776)	0.2018* (0.1072)	0.5554** (0.2765)	0.2402** (0.1011)	0.5878** (0.2653)
sCFO	-0.6773*** (0.2140)	-0.7092*** (0.1540)	-1.0703*** (0.1661)	-0.9110*** (0.1307)	-1.1514*** (0.1375)	-1.0050*** (0.1186)	0.2974 (0.2081)	0.3345** (0.1606)	0.0922 (0.2968)	0.2072 (0.1930)	0.0583 (0.2446)	0.2130* (0.1287)
Lagged_DV	0.8057*** (0.0283)	0.6581*** (0.0379)	0.7626*** (0.0313)	0.6219*** (0.0407)	0.7969*** (0.0302)	0.6594*** (0.0404)	0.7919*** (0.0197)	0.6617*** (0.0261)	0.7670*** (0.0212)	0.6325*** (0.0275)	0.8059*** (0.0200)	0.6881*** (0.0264)
StockPrice			-0.0019 (0.0016)	-0.0054* (0.0031)	0.0008 (0.0015)	0.0023 (0.0029)			0.0016 (0.0015)	0.0106*** (0.0030)	0.0005 (0.0013)	0.0039 (0.0026)
Turnover			-21.1468*** (2.3249)	-21.5445*** (2.7957)	-16.0906*** (2.3237)	-16.1862*** (2.7452)			-7.1288*** (1.9336)	-4.5617* (2.5672)	-7.3925*** (1.8664)	-5.0107** (2.4012)
DailyVola			0.1137*** (0.0097)	0.1314*** (0.0105)	0.0928*** (0.0114)	0.1114*** (0.0134)			0.0550*** (0.0085)	0.0653*** (0.0101)	0.0643*** (0.0092)	0.0729*** (0.0117)
AbsSurpDec			-0.0682** (0.0316)	-0.0184 (0.0367)	-0.0627** (0.0298)	-0.0202 (0.0346)			-0.0373 (0.0335)	-0.0231 (0.0372)	-0.0579* (0.0315)	-0.0402 (0.0350)
Extended Controls			Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes			Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Industry FE	Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes	
Firm FE		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes
Year FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes			Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes		
Year-Quarter FE					Yes	Yes					Yes	Yes
N	24,391	24,391	24,391	24,391	24,391	24,391	24,307	24,307	24,307	24,307	24,307	24,307
R ²	0.673	0.442	0.692	0.479	0.718	0.504	0.681	0.452	0.685	0.460	0.720	0.505
Adj. R ²	0.673	0.414	0.691	0.453	0.717	0.479	0.681	0.425	0.684	0.433	0.719	0.479

Notes: * $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$ (one-tailed for IVs, $\beta > 0$; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms). DWZ quarterly-expanding decomposition: Clarity = -CEO FE; UncRes = call-level residual. R^2 includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- R^2). Spread_{25D} values rescaled by 10^4 (basis points) for readability; multiply coefficients by 10^{-4} to recover raw fraction units.

Table 60: H14d: Speech Uncertainty and BGT-Window 25-Day Bid-Ask Spread Delta ($[+1, +25] - [-25, -1]$)

	(1)	(2)	(3) BGTDelta_Spread		(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)	(9) BGTDelta_Spread_lead1		(11)	(12)
UncAnsCEO	0.0033 (0.1409)	0.0628 (0.1548)	0.0413 (0.1287)	0.0703 (0.1444)	0.0482 (0.1265)	0.0950 (0.1421)	0.1323 (0.1262)	0.1830* (0.1319)	0.1294 (0.1280)	0.1490 (0.1418)	0.1190 (0.1237)	0.1454 (0.1375)
UncPreCEO	0.0420 (0.1093)	0.0618 (0.1379)	-0.0527 (0.0922)	-0.0421 (0.1245)	-0.0482 (0.0898)	-0.0029 (0.1217)	-0.0911 (0.1013)	-0.1049 (0.1311)	-0.0536 (0.0911)	-0.0709 (0.1145)	-0.0559 (0.0897)	-0.0469 (0.1138)
UncAnsMgr	0.0051 (0.1708)	-0.1221 (0.1967)	-0.3530 (0.1600)	-0.2365 (0.1886)	0.0177 (0.1610)	-0.1870 (0.1865)	-0.1212 (0.1477)	-0.2639 (0.1648)	-0.2532 (0.1434)	-0.3746 (0.1660)	-0.2203 (0.1405)	-0.4045 (0.1623)
UncPreMgr	0.1251 (0.1195)	0.0931 (0.1767)	-0.2611 (0.1007)	-0.0456 (0.1576)	0.1059 (0.1005)	0.0252 (0.1545)	0.1294 (0.1120)	0.0598 (0.1629)	0.0726 (0.1015)	0.0830 (0.1445)	0.1164 (0.1026)	0.0273 (0.1438)
lnAssets	0.3082*** (0.0293)	0.6417*** (0.1124)	0.0157 (0.0150)	0.5822*** (0.1365)	0.2602*** (0.0274)	0.5347*** (0.1365)	0.2920*** (0.0278)	0.6610*** (0.1111)	0.0953*** (0.0140)	0.3272*** (0.1123)	0.1487*** (0.0254)	0.3829*** (0.1139)
TobinsQ	0.1991*** (0.0251)	0.2965*** (0.0476)	-0.0137 (0.0226)	0.2217*** (0.0452)	0.0941*** (0.0233)	0.1572*** (0.0435)	0.1386*** (0.0225)	0.1891*** (0.0401)	0.0687*** (0.0200)	0.1730*** (0.0397)	0.0700*** (0.0212)	0.1249*** (0.0389)
ROA	-1.9859*** (0.4388)	-3.2837*** (0.7130)	-0.7765 (0.5578)	-1.2591* (0.7153)	-0.5896 (0.5498)	-0.9897 (0.6974)	-0.4808 (0.4238)	-0.7793 (0.6721)	-1.5432*** (0.4639)	-1.7847*** (0.6470)	-1.1306** (0.4662)	-1.3676** (0.6519)
Leverage	-0.4547*** (0.1737)	-1.0995*** (0.4209)	-0.1425 (0.1552)	-0.8998** (0.3837)	-0.2961* (0.1625)	-0.8747** (0.3777)	-0.4361*** (0.1638)	-1.7838*** (0.4324)	-0.0022 (0.1322)	-0.4553 (0.4008)	-0.0561 (0.1316)	-0.5173 (0.3979)
Capex	2.4808*** (0.6280)	4.5739*** (1.4754)	0.0029 (0.5573)	4.0794*** (1.2948)	0.9174* (0.5428)	4.1364*** (1.2383)	1.2728** (0.5790)	0.2977 (1.2999)	0.6336 (0.5358)	0.0826 (1.1331)	0.8721 (0.5373)	0.7056 (1.1266)
DivDummy	0.0862 (0.0658)	0.2179 (0.1402)	0.0927 (0.0613)	0.2536* (0.1415)	0.0968 (0.0602)	0.2729* (0.1398)	-0.0217 (0.0624)	0.1632 (0.1391)	-0.0924 (0.0570)	-0.0098 (0.1343)	-0.0689 (0.0571)	0.0052 (0.1339)
sCFO	0.1792 (0.2230)	0.3020* (0.1724)	0.4893 (0.3602)	0.7107** (0.3048)	0.5269 (0.3350)	0.6947** (0.2931)	0.2170 (0.1538)	0.2461 (0.1581)	0.3427** (0.1734)	0.3899** (0.1910)	0.3123* (0.1695)	0.3727** (0.1832)
Lagged_DV	-0.0056 (0.0099)	-0.0325*** (0.0103)	0.0104 (0.0131)	-0.0232* (0.0134)	0.0191 (0.0133)	-0.0132 (0.0136)	-0.0022 (0.0104)	-0.0277** (0.0108)	0.0180 (0.0141)	-0.0105 (0.0141)	0.0193 (0.0141)	-0.0096 (0.0141)
StockPrice			0.0027*** (0.0008)	-0.0024 (0.0015)	0.0001 (0.0008)	-0.0036** (0.0015)			-0.0035*** (0.0007)	-0.0025* (0.0014)	-0.0033*** (0.0007)	-0.0023* (0.0014)
Turnover			3.3270*** (1.0552)	3.2232** (1.3946)	2.4221** (1.0737)	1.7001 (1.3984)			8.3582*** (1.0491)	8.8869*** (1.3434)	7.6445*** (1.0537)	8.4446*** (1.3394)
DailyVola			0.0053 (0.0040)	0.0200*** (0.0048)	0.0181*** (0.0050)	0.0292*** (0.0061)			-0.0366*** (0.0034)	-0.0411*** (0.0042)	-0.0255*** (0.0043)	-0.0315*** (0.0053)
AbsSurpDec			-0.1624*** (0.0204)	-0.1094*** (0.0233)	-0.1129*** (0.0187)	-0.1072*** (0.0229)			-0.0102 (0.0196)	-0.0197 (0.0237)	-0.0169 (0.0193)	-0.0279 (0.0232)
Extended Controls			Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes			Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Industry FE	Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes	
Firm FE		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes
Year FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes			Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes		
Year-Quarter FE					Yes	Yes					Yes	Yes
N	62,480	62,480	43,282	43,282	43,282	43,282	62,029	62,029	43,750	43,750	43,750	43,750
R ²	0.005	0.004	0.002	0.006	0.006	0.006	0.003	0.003	0.012	0.012	0.007	0.006
Adj. R ²	0.004	-0.024	0.001	-0.028	0.004	-0.029	0.003	-0.026	0.011	-0.022	0.005	-0.029

Notes: * $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$ (one-tailed for IVs, $\beta > 0$; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms). R^2 includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- R^2). BGTDelta_Spread values rescaled by 10^4 for readability; multiply coefficients by 10^{-4} to recover raw units.

Table 61: H14d Robustness: Orthogonal Speaker Partition

	(1)	(2)	(3) BGTDelta_Spread		(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)	(9) BGTDelta_Spread_lead1		(11)	(12)
UncAnsCEO	0.0272 (0.0845)	0.0422 (0.1015)	-0.1609 (0.0787)	-0.0414 (0.0983)	0.0645 (0.0779)	0.0059 (0.0961)	0.0685 (0.0863)	0.0754 (0.0979)	-0.0369 (0.0807)	-0.0765 (0.1008)	-0.0281 (0.0834)	-0.0987 (0.0991)
UncAnsNoCEO	0.0622 (0.0595)	0.0361 (0.0658)	-0.0984 (0.0566)	-0.0293 (0.0613)	0.0220 (0.0549)	-0.0206 (0.0606)	0.0255 (0.0543)	0.0012 (0.0600)	0.0241 (0.0493)	0.0173 (0.0554)	0.0293 (0.0494)	0.0018 (0.0546)
UncPreCEO	0.0607 (0.0842)	0.0400 (0.1046)	-0.1963 (0.0749)	-0.0727 (0.0975)	-0.0137 (0.0729)	-0.0035 (0.0965)	-0.0093 (0.0797)	-0.0821 (0.1005)	-0.0124 (0.0702)	-0.0339 (0.0913)	0.0068 (0.0685)	-0.0329 (0.0910)
UncPreNoCEO	0.0079 (0.0570)	-0.0176 (0.0855)	-0.1372 (0.0484)	-0.0560 (0.0796)	0.0223 (0.0481)	-0.0311 (0.0788)	0.0406 (0.0526)	0.0266 (0.0813)	-0.0245 (0.0464)	-0.0326 (0.0791)	-0.0073 (0.0472)	-0.0545 (0.0778)
InAssets	0.2951*** (0.0291)	0.5948*** (0.1127)	0.0167 (0.0152)	0.5975*** (0.1426)	0.2584*** (0.0281)	0.5448*** (0.1413)	0.2726*** (0.0283)	0.6113*** (0.1100)	0.0895*** (0.0142)	0.3499*** (0.1129)	0.1419*** (0.0262)	0.4015*** (0.1149)
TobinsQ	0.1991*** (0.0256)	0.3044*** (0.0492)	-0.0153 (0.0219)	0.2214*** (0.0448)	0.0956*** (0.0228)	0.1596*** (0.0434)	0.1196*** (0.0213)	0.1733*** (0.0403)	0.0566*** (0.0193)	0.1676*** (0.0401)	0.0586*** (0.0208)	0.1189*** (0.0392)
ROA	-2.1145*** (0.4617)	-3.4336*** (0.7415)	-0.8698 (0.5799)	-1.5261** (0.7316)	-0.7249 (0.5691)	-1.2786* (0.7134)	-0.2503 (0.4622)	-0.6192 (0.6988)	-1.3445*** (0.4771)	-1.6766** (0.6663)	-0.9297* (0.4830)	-1.2287* (0.6727)
Leverage	-0.4280** (0.1714)	-1.1227*** (0.4346)	-0.1571 (0.1631)	-1.0590* (0.4126)	-0.3169* (0.1710)	-1.0427** (0.4095)	-0.3467** (0.1590)	-1.5924*** (0.4327)	0.0351 (0.1324)	-0.4319 (0.4129)	-0.0103 (0.1309)	-0.4849 (0.4115)
Capex	2.2278*** (0.6845)	4.6026*** (1.6429)	-0.0912 (0.6088)	4.6647*** (1.3982)	0.8018 (0.5964)	4.7414*** (1.3464)	0.9783 (0.6137)	0.3321 (1.3577)	0.5252 (0.5590)	0.3533 (1.2004)	0.7693 (0.5675)	1.0090 (1.1969)
DivDummy	0.0820 (0.0656)	0.2110 (0.1443)	0.1156* (0.0627)	0.2634* (0.1489)	0.1073* (0.0619)	0.2753* (0.1474)	-0.0259 (0.0648)	0.1614 (0.1415)	-0.0718 (0.0564)	0.0134 (0.1347)	-0.0502 (0.0565)	0.0326 (0.1346)
sCFO	0.2277 (0.1935)	0.3221** (0.1498)	0.5605* (0.3288)	0.7328** (0.2878)	0.6015** (0.2990)	0.7136** (0.2801)	0.2042 (0.1672)	0.1930 (0.1909)	0.3377* (0.1908)	0.3683* (0.2103)	0.3147* (0.1796)	0.3560* (0.1975)
Lagged_DV	-0.0053 (0.0108)	-0.0318*** (0.0112)	0.0050 (0.0144)	-0.0285* (0.0148)	0.0142 (0.0146)	-0.0180 (0.0150)	0.0048 (0.0105)	-0.0215* (0.0111)	0.0206 (0.0150)	-0.0080 (0.0149)	0.0215 (0.0150)	-0.0076 (0.0150)
StockPrice			0.0027*** (0.0008)	-0.0025* (0.0015)	0.0000 (0.0008)	-0.0037** (0.0015)			-0.0034*** (0.0008)	-0.0028** (0.0014)	-0.0032*** (0.0007)	-0.0028** (0.0014)
Turnover			3.6228*** (1.0688)	3.3493** (1.4181)	2.8989*** (1.0875)	1.9686 (1.4205)			8.1654*** (1.0573)	8.6794*** (1.3697)	7.4333*** (1.0666)	8.1456*** (1.3685)
DailyVola			0.0050 (0.0040)	0.0204*** (0.0050)	0.0169*** (0.0051)	0.0289*** (0.0062)			-0.0357*** (0.0035)	-0.0399*** (0.0042)	-0.0247*** (0.0043)	-0.0300*** (0.0053)
AbsSurpDec			-0.1736*** (0.0211)	-0.1221*** (0.0242)	-0.1203*** (0.0194)	-0.1182*** (0.0238)			-0.0137 (0.0196)	-0.0263 (0.0240)	-0.0190 (0.0192)	-0.0338 (0.0235)
Extended Controls			Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes			Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Industry FE	Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes	
Firm FE		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes
Year FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes			Yes	Yes	Yes			
Year-Quarter FE					Yes	Yes					Yes	Yes
N	58,647	58,647	40,785	40,785	40,785	40,785	58,200	58,200	41,231	41,231	41,231	41,231
R ²	0.005	0.005	0.002	0.007	0.006	0.006	0.003	0.002	0.011	0.011	0.007	0.005
Adj. R ²	0.004	-0.025	0.001	-0.028	0.004	-0.030	0.003	-0.028	0.011	-0.024	0.005	-0.031

Notes: * $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$ (one-tailed for IVs, $\beta > 0$; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms). R^2 includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- R^2). BGTDelta_Spread values rescaled by 10^4 for readability; multiply coefficients by 10^{-4} to recover raw units.

Table 62: H14e: Speech Uncertainty and BGT-Window 25-Day Bid-Ask Spread Average ($[-25, +25]$, 51-day symmetric)

	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)	(9)	(10)	(11)	(12)
			BGTAvg_Spread						BGTAvg_Spread_lead1			
UncAnsCEO	0.1354 (0.1647)	0.1566 (0.1736)	-0.0536 (0.1358)	-0.0459 (0.1462)	0.0072 (0.1323)	0.0159 (0.1421)	0.2878** (0.1747)	0.3317** (0.1879)	0.1521 (0.1374)	0.1354 (0.1491)	0.1034 (0.1282)	0.1289 (0.1415)
UncPreCEO	0.2071* (0.1352)	0.3705** (0.1633)	0.1114 (0.1128)	0.2982** (0.1455)	0.0386 (0.1113)	0.1313 (0.1423)	0.0022 (0.1577)	0.0617 (0.1759)	-0.1434 (0.1178)	-0.1698 (0.1534)	0.0248 (0.1106)	-0.0009 (0.1437)
UncAnsMgr	-0.3037 (0.2243)	-0.2103 (0.2407)	0.1897 (0.2058)	-0.2336 (0.2218)	-0.2979 (0.1981)	-0.3408 (0.2129)	-0.4073 (0.2188)	-0.4894 (0.2325)	0.4651*** (0.1752)	-0.3026 (0.1884)	-0.1191 (0.1569)	-0.1745 (0.1731)
UncPreMgr	0.0803 (0.1686)	0.2279 (0.2265)	0.4347*** (0.1309)	0.1031 (0.1943)	-0.0148 (0.1301)	0.0467 (0.1884)	-0.0020 (0.2022)	0.1060 (0.2319)	0.6979*** (0.1369)	0.1930 (0.1932)	0.0368 (0.1320)	0.2599* (0.1845)
lnAssets	-0.7474*** (0.0422)	-2.0513*** (0.1837)	-0.2071*** (0.0229)	-1.4110*** (0.2040)	-0.5722*** (0.0447)	-1.5815*** (0.2054)	-0.7857*** (0.0437)	-1.8059*** (0.1825)	-0.1437*** (0.0194)	-1.5334*** (0.2018)	-0.5484*** (0.0432)	-1.2237*** (0.1884)
TobinsQ	-0.3771*** (0.0421)	-0.6016*** (0.0936)	-0.1277*** (0.0389)	-0.6175*** (0.0901)	-0.2877*** (0.0413)	-0.6244*** (0.0896)	-0.2187*** (0.0441)	-0.1493** (0.0645)	0.0532 (0.0418)	-0.4117*** (0.0890)	-0.1829*** (0.0403)	-0.3500*** (0.0818)
ROA	-9.9380*** (0.8194)	-12.6747*** (1.0064)	-4.3688*** (0.8425)	-6.2204*** (1.0597)	-5.1122*** (0.8505)	-6.7600*** (1.0649)	-11.2007*** (1.0012)	-15.4200*** (1.1944)	-7.4140*** (0.9755)	-10.6907*** (1.1206)	-6.7481*** (0.9069)	-9.3817*** (1.0392)
Leverage	0.5849** (0.2271)	2.8393*** (0.6103)	-0.4101 (0.2604)	0.4769 (0.4917)	-0.0782 (0.2146)	0.7121 (0.4867)	0.1702 (0.2488)	1.3597** (0.5578)	-0.5081** (0.2397)	-0.1210 (0.4894)	-0.2247 (0.2112)	-0.1657 (0.4559)
Capex	-0.4168 (0.8706)	1.6157 (1.7827)	-0.0197 (0.9317)	0.5126 (2.1846)	-1.0097 (0.9219)	0.8917 (2.1523)	-2.0113** (0.9168)	-3.4057* (1.9593)	0.2696 (0.8883)	-3.3575 (2.4109)	-1.3267 (0.8421)	-1.5965 (2.3457)
DivDummy	0.1142 (0.0966)	-0.1822 (0.1974)	0.3404*** (0.0824)	0.2063 (0.1689)	0.3107*** (0.0807)	0.2409 (0.1689)	-0.0156 (0.1048)	-0.4271** (0.2169)	0.1937** (0.0798)	0.1525 (0.1816)	0.1829** (0.0751)	0.1615 (0.1715)
sCFO	-0.2827 (0.2671)	0.2897 (0.2022)	-0.0006 (0.3070)	0.1812 (0.2536)	-0.0080 (0.2988)	0.2201 (0.2247)	-0.2655 (0.2685)	0.4092** (0.1772)	0.0061 (0.1823)	0.1965 (0.1547)	-0.1436 (0.2154)	0.1512 (0.1327)
Lagged_DV	0.8559*** (0.0074)	0.7647*** (0.0077)	0.7817*** (0.0125)	0.6943*** (0.0157)	0.7789*** (0.0137)	0.6994*** (0.0167)	0.8406*** (0.0085)	0.7344*** (0.0091)	0.7886*** (0.0141)	0.6670*** (0.0179)	0.8020*** (0.0142)	0.7080*** (0.0171)
StockPrice			-0.0026* (0.0013)	-0.0039* (0.0023)	0.0016 (0.0013)	0.0023 (0.0023)			-0.0018 (0.0011)	0.0103*** (0.0022)	0.0005 (0.0011)	0.0037* (0.0019)
Turnover			-23.1346*** (1.6492)	-23.7444*** (2.0032)	-20.1206*** (1.6117)	-19.2191*** (1.9702)			-8.0598*** (1.3957)	-6.6693*** (1.8563)	-8.5505*** (1.3726)	-6.2162*** (1.7616)
DailyVola			0.1239*** (0.0067)	0.1307*** (0.0078)	0.0965*** (0.0078)	0.1129*** (0.0095)			0.0704*** (0.0061)	0.0700*** (0.0070)	0.0525*** (0.0070)	0.0614*** (0.0086)
AbsSurpDec			-0.0084 (0.0266)	0.0008 (0.0305)	-0.0510** (0.0259)	0.0148 (0.0291)			0.0526** (0.0259)	-0.0268 (0.0273)	-0.0649*** (0.0240)	-0.0404 (0.0255)
Extended Controls			Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes			Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Industry FE	Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes	
Firm FE		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes
Year FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes			Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes		
Year-Quarter FE					Yes	Yes					Yes	Yes
N	63,936	63,936	44,100	44,100	44,100	44,100	63,509	63,509	44,600	44,600	44,600	44,600
R ²	0.826	0.663	0.776	0.638	0.786	0.638	0.818	0.641	0.762	0.604	0.787	0.625
Adj. R ²	0.826	0.654	0.775	0.626	0.786	0.625	0.818	0.631	0.762	0.591	0.786	0.612

Notes: * $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$ (one-tailed for IVs, $\beta > 0$; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms). R^2 includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- R^2). BGTAvg_Spread values rescaled by 10^4 for readability; multiply coefficients by 10^{-4} to recover raw units.

Table 63: H14e Robustness: Orthogonal Speaker Partition

	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)	(9)	(10)	(11)	(12)
			BGTAvg_Spread						BGTAvg_Spread_lead1			
UncAnsCEO	-0.0148 (0.1119)	0.0447 (0.1259)	0.0676 (0.0998)	-0.1845 (0.1046)	-0.1780 (0.0933)	-0.1839 (0.1013)	0.0869 (0.1221)	0.1085 (0.1446)	0.4166*** (0.1076)	-0.0378 (0.1214)	0.0206 (0.1011)	0.0238 (0.1164)
UncAnsNoCEO	-0.1277 (0.0769)	-0.1018 (0.0809)	0.0307 (0.0690)	-0.1240 (0.0749)	-0.1164 (0.0673)	-0.1167 (0.0719)	-0.0936 (0.0760)	-0.0774 (0.0818)	0.2219*** (0.0647)	-0.0105 (0.0726)	-0.0111 (0.0606)	0.0089 (0.0680)
UncPreCEO	0.2279** (0.1041)	0.4759*** (0.1258)	0.3197*** (0.0956)	0.3458*** (0.1160)	0.0207 (0.0929)	0.1603* (0.1126)	-0.0451 (0.1105)	0.0809 (0.1357)	0.1664** (0.0919)	-0.1024 (0.1198)	0.0177 (0.0837)	0.1013 (0.1127)
UncPreNoCEO	0.0045 (0.0782)	0.0384 (0.1129)	0.1486*** (0.0577)	0.0050 (0.0962)	-0.0281 (0.0559)	0.0165 (0.0938)	0.0600 (0.0870)	0.1125 (0.1191)	0.2746*** (0.0610)	0.0653 (0.0950)	-0.0336 (0.0570)	0.0692 (0.0900)
InAssets	-0.7357*** (0.0428)	-1.9950*** (0.1890)	-0.1943*** (0.0225)	-1.4821*** (0.2061)	-0.5770*** (0.0463)	-1.6488*** (0.2083)	-0.7620*** (0.0439)	-1.7865*** (0.1877)	-0.1323*** (0.0195)	-1.5806*** (0.2131)	-0.5545*** (0.0443)	-1.2776*** (0.1988)
TobinsQ	-0.3506*** (0.0392)	-0.5790*** (0.0935)	-0.1001** (0.0399)	-0.6347*** (0.0931)	-0.2743*** (0.0420)	-0.6441*** (0.0927)	-0.2052*** (0.0486)	-0.1313** (0.0658)	0.0788* (0.0447)	-0.4350*** (0.0925)	-0.1697*** (0.0428)	-0.3686*** (0.0845)
ROA	-10.1876*** (0.8001)	-12.6668*** (1.0496)	-4.9018*** (0.9007)	-6.6188*** (1.1098)	-5.6381*** (0.9089)	-7.1343*** (1.1018)	-11.4667*** (1.0389)	-15.6598*** (1.2166)	-7.9293*** (1.0194)	-10.9551*** (1.1521)	-7.2350*** (0.9545)	-9.5761*** (1.0755)
Leverage	0.5637** (0.2304)	2.8324*** (0.6036)	-0.4732* (0.2682)	0.6239 (0.4658)	-0.1198 (0.2223)	0.8159* (0.4707)	0.1034 (0.2555)	1.3075** (0.5591)	-0.5862** (0.2482)	-0.0924 (0.4905)	-0.2647 (0.2164)	-0.1095 (0.4570)
Capex	-0.2857 (0.9249)	2.7254 (1.9677)	0.0729 (0.9809)	1.0394 (2.3760)	-1.0142 (0.9633)	1.3670 (2.3393)	-1.8248* (0.9649)	-2.8813 (2.0304)	0.5871 (0.9274)	-3.5536 (2.5633)	-1.0100 (0.8588)	-1.6360 (2.4835)
DivDummy	0.0713 (0.0927)	-0.2143 (0.2046)	0.3416*** (0.0838)	0.1912 (0.1779)	0.3280*** (0.0813)	0.2224 (0.1777)	-0.0280 (0.1028)	-0.3777* (0.2264)	0.2076** (0.0835)	0.1885 (0.1898)	0.2087*** (0.0784)	0.1848 (0.1793)
sCFO	-0.2147 (0.2654)	0.2998 (0.2095)	0.0862 (0.2780)	0.1814 (0.2655)	0.0985 (0.2507)	0.2420 (0.2122)	-0.1822 (0.2394)	0.4238** (0.1693)	0.1212 (0.1271)	0.2239 (0.1430)	-0.0515 (0.1764)	0.1652 (0.1309)
Lagged_DV	0.8471*** (0.0077)	0.7600*** (0.0083)	0.7748*** (0.0130)	0.6879*** (0.0164)	0.7713*** (0.0143)	0.6932*** (0.0174)	0.8349*** (0.0089)	0.7322*** (0.0098)	0.7824*** (0.0150)	0.6589*** (0.0186)	0.7957*** (0.0150)	0.7009*** (0.0177)
StockPrice			-0.0027** (0.0014)	-0.0033 (0.0023)	0.0016 (0.0013)	0.0028 (0.0023)		-0.0024** (0.0011)	0.0105*** (0.0023)	0.0001 (0.0011)	0.0040** (0.0020)	
Turnover			-23.0471*** (1.6602)	-24.0079*** (1.9906)	-20.0854*** (1.6258)	-19.3555*** (1.9546)		-7.5017*** (1.4427)	-6.3587*** (1.9079)	-8.0995*** (1.4285)	-5.8752*** (1.8091)	
DailyVola			0.1270*** (0.0070)	0.1326*** (0.0082)	0.0989*** (0.0082)	0.1150*** (0.0100)		0.0711*** (0.0064)	0.0708*** (0.0073)	0.0524*** (0.0075)	0.0617*** (0.0089)	
AbsSurpDec			-0.0192 (0.0269)	-0.0159 (0.0314)	-0.0686*** (0.0261)	-0.0023 (0.0299)		0.0528** (0.0266)	-0.0297 (0.0282)	-0.0705*** (0.0245)	-0.0435* (0.0261)	
Extended Controls			Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes		Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Industry FE	Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes	
Firm FE		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes
Year FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes			Yes	Yes	Yes			
Year-Quarter FE					Yes	Yes					Yes	Yes
N	60,035	60,035	41,570	41,570	41,570	41,570	59,608	59,608	42,039	42,039	42,039	42,039
R ²	0.817	0.661	0.772	0.634	0.783	0.634	0.810	0.638	0.758	0.598	0.782	0.619
Adj. R ²	0.816	0.651	0.772	0.622	0.783	0.620	0.809	0.627	0.758	0.584	0.782	0.605

Notes: * $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$ (one-tailed for IVs, $\beta > 0$; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms). R^2 includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- R^2). BGTAvg_Spread values rescaled by 10^4 for readability; multiply coefficients by 10^{-4} to recover raw units.

Table 64: H16: Speech Uncertainty and R&D Investment Intensity

	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)	(9)	(10)	(11)	(12)
			RDSales						RDSales.Lead			
UncAnsCEO	-0.0048 (0.0214)	-0.0205 (0.0166)	-0.0006 (0.0213)	-0.0196 (0.0163)	-0.0009 (0.0212)	-0.0197 (0.0164)	0.0108 (0.0243)	-0.0200 (0.0198)	0.0126 (0.0255)	-0.0195 (0.0204)	0.0125 (0.0255)	-0.0194 (0.0204)
UncPreCEO	0.0138 (0.0110)	0.0022 (0.0103)	0.0063 (0.0097)	-0.0137 (0.0090)	0.0062 (0.0098)	-0.0138 (0.0089)	0.0181 (0.0136)	0.0049 (0.0140)	0.0150 (0.0139)	0.0026 (0.0175)	0.0146 (0.0138)	0.0023 (0.0176)
UncAnsMgr	0.0255 (0.0264)	0.0170 (0.0158)	0.0090 (0.0291)	0.0077 (0.0156)	0.0168 (0.0263)	0.0067 (0.0158)	0.0176 (0.0361)	0.0181 (0.0281)	0.0010 (0.0399)	0.0174 (0.0290)	0.0103 (0.0374)	0.0165 (0.0290)
UncPreMgr	0.0020 (0.0114)	0.0085 (0.0163)	0.0106 (0.0095)	0.0196 (0.0153)	0.0185 (0.0116)	0.0192 (0.0153)	-0.0107 (0.0156)	0.0152 (0.0163)	-0.0119 (0.0184)	0.0183 (0.0186)	-0.0025 (0.0180)	0.0180 (0.0183)
InAssets	0.0103*** (0.0036)	0.0253 (0.0240)	0.0043*** (0.0015)	0.0428* (0.0250)	0.0088** (0.0037)	0.0411* (0.0247)	0.0074* (0.0039)	0.0720 (0.0484)	0.0035 (0.0022)	0.0789 (0.0517)	0.0097** (0.0047)	0.0784 (0.0515)
TobinsQ	0.0158* (0.0094)	0.0118 (0.0142)	0.0380*** (0.0142)	0.0383** (0.0170)	0.0396*** (0.0147)	0.0393** (0.0173)	0.0064 (0.0107)	-0.0015 (0.0285)	0.0160 (0.0154)	0.0053 (0.0318)	0.0179 (0.0162)	0.0057 (0.0323)
ROA	-0.7946*** (0.2690)	-0.6379*** (0.1764)	-0.1769 (0.1683)	-0.0567 (0.1521)	-0.1948 (0.1703)	-0.0768 (0.1500)	-0.4412** (0.1990)	0.1815 (0.1960)	0.1252 (0.1911)	0.3848 (0.2706)	0.1188 (0.1891)	0.3790 (0.2690)
Leverage	-0.0647** (0.0295)	-0.0685** (0.0319)	-0.0580** (0.0276)	0.0020 (0.0401)	-0.0567** (0.0276)	0.0085 (0.0410)	-0.0154 (0.0289)	0.0730 (0.0660)	-0.0429 (0.0350)	0.0736 (0.0560)	-0.0441 (0.0353)	0.0762 (0.0564)
CashRatio	0.2919*** (0.1027)	0.1755** (0.0708)	0.2724*** (0.0971)	0.0777 (0.0610)	0.2869*** (0.1016)	0.0796 (0.0618)	0.4871*** (0.1392)	0.1941** (0.0984)	0.4711*** (0.1327)	0.1841 (0.1136)	0.4865*** (0.1378)	0.1841 (0.1131)
Capex	-0.1390** (0.0671)	-0.1341 (0.1383)	0.3351*** (0.1243)	0.2092* (0.1193)	0.3382*** (0.1280)	0.1567 (0.1218)	-0.1309 (0.1151)	0.0394 (0.2539)	0.2668 (0.1678)	0.1542 (0.2428)	0.2825 (0.1733)	0.1363 (0.2488)
DivDummy	0.0101 (0.0075)	-0.0046 (0.0073)	-0.0182* (0.0095)	-0.0103 (0.0092)	-0.0192** (0.0096)	-0.0123 (0.0096)	0.0009 (0.0057)	-0.0143 (0.0147)	-0.0026 (0.0108)	-0.0146 (0.0158)	-0.0020 (0.0108)	-0.0152 (0.0164)
sCFO	0.0012 (0.0368)	-0.0053 (0.0090)	0.0547 (0.0500)	0.0265 (0.0233)	0.0586 (0.0518)	0.0280 (0.0241)	0.0130 (0.0380)	0.0034 (0.0106)	0.0084 (0.0291)	0.0080 (0.0152)	0.0110 (0.0288)	0.0084 (0.0155)
Lagged_DV	0.6564*** (0.0687)	0.2772** (0.1166)	0.7354*** (0.0711)	0.3889*** (0.1296)	0.7367*** (0.0711)	0.3911*** (0.1298)	0.5155*** (0.1287)	0.0404 (0.1800)	0.5132*** (0.1355)	0.0568 (0.1930)	0.5132*** (0.1355)	0.0570 (0.1934)
SalesGrowth			-0.6094*** (0.1736)	-0.6535*** (0.1954)	-0.6163*** (0.1751)	-0.6626*** (0.1976)			-0.0925 (0.1648)	-0.0959 (0.1768)	-0.0940 (0.1671)	-0.0974 (0.1797)
CashFlowAt			-0.7053*** (0.2435)	-0.3184** (0.1567)	-0.6851*** (0.2382)	-0.2995* (0.1574)			-0.9530** (0.4444)	-0.3752 (0.3748)	-0.9404** (0.4430)	-0.3738 (0.3771)
DailyVola			-0.0002 (0.0004)	-0.0003 (0.0003)	-0.0002 (0.0005)	-0.0007** (0.0004)			-0.0002 (0.0003)	-0.0004 (0.0002)	0.0001 (0.0004)	-0.0006 (0.0004)
Extended Controls			Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes			Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Industry FE	Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes	
Firm FE		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes
Year FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes			Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes		
Year-Quarter FE					Yes	Yes					Yes	Yes
N	65,086	65,086	62,517	62,517	62,517	62,517	60,105	60,105	58,970	58,970	58,970	58,970
R ²	0.448	0.072	0.504	0.183	0.505	0.185	0.252	0.004	0.259	0.007	0.259	0.007
Adj. R ²	0.447	0.047	0.504	0.159	0.504	0.161	0.252	-0.025	0.258	-0.022	0.258	-0.023

Notes: * $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$ (two-tailed). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms). R^2 includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- R^2).

Table 65: H16 Robustness: Orthogonal Speaker Partition

	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)	(9)	(10)	(11)	(12)
			RDSales						RDSales.Lead			
UncAnsCEO	0.0053 (0.0074)	-0.0109 (0.0082)	0.0010 (0.0067)	-0.0141 (0.0088)	0.0049 (0.0076)	-0.0148* (0.0088)	0.0200** (0.0099)	-0.0030 (0.0050)	0.0135* (0.0079)	-0.0038 (0.0050)	0.0188* (0.0097)	-0.0041 (0.0051)
UncAnsNoCEO	0.0040 (0.0044)	-0.0009 (0.0041)	0.0023 (0.0051)	0.0000 (0.0039)	0.0049 (0.0045)	0.0001 (0.0039)	0.0009 (0.0042)	0.0000 (0.0056)	-0.0026 (0.0048)	-0.0000 (0.0058)	0.0005 (0.0042)	-0.0001 (0.0057)
UncPreCEO	0.0150* (0.0089)	0.0075 (0.0074)	0.0121 (0.0080)	-0.0026 (0.0088)	0.0152* (0.0065)	-0.0032 (0.0088)	0.0090 (0.0065)	0.0070 (0.0081)	0.0053 (0.0109)	0.0047 (0.0069)	0.0090 (0.0124)	0.0043 (0.0081)
UncPreNoCEO	-0.0034 (0.0038)	-0.0029 (0.0066)	-0.0011 (0.0034)	0.0026 (0.0062)	0.0021 (0.0037)	0.0028 (0.0061)	-0.0056 (0.0060)	-0.0032 (0.0080)	-0.0072 (0.0071)	-0.0015 (0.0091)	-0.0034 (0.0067)	-0.0014 (0.0090)
InAssets	0.0086*** (0.0028)	0.0228 (0.0237)	0.0036*** (0.0012)	0.0437* (0.0251)	0.0077** (0.0030)	0.0421* (0.0248)	0.0058 (0.0038)	0.0731 (0.0526)	0.0017 (0.0018)	0.0800 (0.0563)	0.0077* (0.0045)	0.0792 (0.0561)
TobinsQ	0.0112 (0.0074)	0.0136 (0.0144)	0.0311*** (0.0112)	0.0381** (0.0173)	0.0325*** (0.0118)	0.0391** (0.0176)	0.0019 (0.0094)	0.0016 (0.0290)	0.0101 (0.0131)	0.0077 (0.0321)	0.0119 (0.0140)	0.0081 (0.0327)
ROA	-0.5923** (0.1857)	-0.5866*** (0.1584)	-0.0710 (0.1232)	-0.0616 (0.1277)	-0.0853 (0.1223)	-0.0799 (0.1249)	-0.3455** (0.1662)	0.1118 (0.1763)	0.0442 (0.1764)	0.2442 (0.2265)	0.0382 (0.1727)	0.2372 (0.2231)
Leverage	-0.0564** (0.0240)	-0.0779** (0.0318)	-0.0515** (0.0222)	-0.0241 (0.0330)	-0.0502** (0.0223)	-0.0170 (0.0337)	-0.0181 (0.0268)	0.0212 (0.0364)	-0.0309 (0.0299)	0.0434 (0.0439)	-0.0320 (0.0303)	0.0467 (0.0448)
CashRatio	0.2552*** (0.0898)	0.1558*** (0.0578)	0.2414*** (0.0845)	0.0719 (0.0514)	0.2549*** (0.0896)	0.0738 (0.0522)	0.4637*** (0.1313)	0.1694* (0.0915)	0.4513*** (0.1286)	0.1452 (0.1044)	0.4661*** (0.1334)	0.1458 (0.1040)
Capex	-0.1119** (0.0561)	-0.1240 (0.1201)	0.2573*** (0.0936)	0.1659 (0.1082)	0.2609*** (0.0970)	0.1118 (0.1122)	-0.1127 (0.1107)	0.0336 (0.2616)	0.1390 (0.1233)	0.1214 (0.2596)	0.1500 (0.1277)	0.0923 (0.2639)
DivDummy	0.0063 (0.0055)	-0.0056 (0.0065)	-0.0177** (0.0080)	-0.0111 (0.0084)	-0.0187** (0.0081)	-0.0133 (0.0088)	-0.0000 (0.0052)	-0.0156 (0.0146)	-0.0059 (0.0093)	-0.0178 (0.0161)	-0.0053 (0.0092)	-0.0189 (0.0167)
sCFO	0.0098 (0.0194)	-0.0052 (0.0084)	0.0510 (0.0408)	0.0241 (0.0217)	0.0548 (0.0427)	0.0255 (0.0225)	-0.0103 (0.0190)	-0.0006 (0.0125)	-0.0053 (0.0195)	0.0081 (0.0180)	-0.0027 (0.0188)	0.0087 (0.0184)
Lagged_DV	0.6868*** (0.0744)	0.3034*** (0.1151)	0.7573*** (0.0722)	0.4057*** (0.1225)	0.7588*** (0.0721)	0.4078*** (0.1225)	0.4881*** (0.1307)	-0.0142 (0.1946)	0.5008*** (0.1434)	0.0167 (0.2161)	0.5011*** (0.1435)	0.0172 (0.2166)
SalesGrowth			-0.5579*** (0.1540)	-0.5959*** (0.1723)	-0.5644*** (0.1554)	-0.6048*** (0.1743)			-0.1627 (0.1386)	-0.1669 (0.1720)	-0.1653 (0.1407)	-0.1699 (0.1748)
CashFlowAt			-0.5685*** (0.1900)	-0.3355** (0.1579)	-0.5509*** (0.1845)	-0.3185** (0.1582)			-0.5702** (0.2480)	-0.0591 (0.2098)	-0.5538** (0.2395)	-0.0536 (0.2088)
Daily Vola			0.0001 (0.0003)	-0.0002 (0.0002)	0.0001 (0.0004)	-0.0006** (0.0003)			0.0001 (0.0002)	-0.0004 (0.0003)	0.0004 (0.0004)	-0.0006 (0.0004)
Extended Controls			Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes			Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Industry FE	Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes	
Firm FE		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes
Year FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes			Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes		
Year-Quarter FE					Yes	Yes					Yes	Yes
N	61,096	61,096	58,693	58,693	58,693	58,693	56,422	56,422	55,367	55,367	55,367	55,367
R ²	0.487	0.087	0.540	0.198	0.541	0.200	0.240	0.003	0.246	0.010	0.246	0.010
Adj. R ²	0.486	0.061	0.540	0.174	0.540	0.175	0.240	-0.027	0.246	-0.021	0.245	-0.021

Notes: * $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$ (two-tailed). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms). R^2 includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- R^2).

Table 66: H17: Speech Uncertainty and Repurchase Intensity

	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)	(9)	(10)	(11)	(12)
			RepurchaseIntensity						RepurchaseIntensity_lead_qtr			
UncAnsCEO	0.0001 (0.0002)	0.0001 (0.0002)	0.0001 (0.0003)	0.0001 (0.0002)	0.0000 (0.0002)	0.0000 (0.0002)	0.0000 (0.0003)	0.0000 (0.0002)	-0.0001 (0.0003)	-0.0001 (0.0002)	-0.0001 (0.0003)	-0.0001 (0.0002)
UncPreCEO	-0.0001 (0.0003)	0.0002 (0.0002)	-0.0001 (0.0003)	0.0002 (0.0002)	-0.0001 (0.0003)	0.0002 (0.0002)	0.0001 (0.0003)	0.0004* (0.0003)	0.0001 (0.0003)	0.0004 (0.0003)	0.0001 (0.0003)	0.0004 (0.0003)
UncAnsMgr	-0.0008*** (0.0003)	-0.0003 (0.0003)	-0.0007** (0.0003)	-0.0002 (0.0003)	-0.0007** (0.0003)	-0.0001 (0.0003)	-0.0007** (0.0003)	-0.0001 (0.0003)	-0.0005 (0.0003)	0.0000 (0.0003)	-0.0005 (0.0003)	0.0001 (0.0003)
UncPreMgr	0.0007** (0.0003)	0.0007** (0.0003)	0.0006** (0.0003)	0.0006** (0.0003)	0.0005* (0.0003)	0.0006* (0.0003)	0.0006* (0.0003)	0.0004 (0.0003)	0.0005 (0.0003)	0.0005 (0.0003)	0.0005 (0.0003)	0.0004 (0.0003)
lnAssets	0.0006*** (0.0001)	0.0001 (0.0002)	0.0005*** (0.0001)	-0.0000 (0.0002)	0.0005*** (0.0001)	-0.0001 (0.0002)	0.0010*** (0.0001)	0.0017*** (0.0001)	0.0009*** (0.0001)	0.0016*** (0.0001)	0.0009*** (0.0001)	0.0015*** (0.0001)
TobinsQ	0.0011*** (0.0001)	0.0004*** (0.0001)	0.0010*** (0.0001)	0.0003** (0.0001)	0.0010*** (0.0001)	0.0004*** (0.0001)	0.0015*** (0.0001)	0.0009*** (0.0002)	0.0014*** (0.0002)	0.0009*** (0.0002)	0.0014*** (0.0002)	0.0008*** (0.0002)
ROA	0.0117*** (0.0008)	0.0094*** (0.0009)	0.0040*** (0.0009)	0.0064*** (0.0009)	0.0035*** (0.0009)	0.0059*** (0.0009)	0.0137*** (0.0010)	0.0091*** (0.0011)	0.0047*** (0.0012)	0.0063*** (0.0011)	0.0042*** (0.0012)	0.0059*** (0.0011)
Leverage	-0.0009 (0.0006)	-0.0024*** (0.0008)	-0.0003 (0.0005)	-0.0016* (0.0008)	-0.0002 (0.0005)	-0.0015* (0.0008)	-0.0030** (0.0009)	-0.0108*** (0.0011)	-0.0022*** (0.0008)	-0.0100*** (0.0011)	-0.0021*** (0.0007)	-0.0099*** (0.0011)
Capex	-0.0003 (0.0016)	0.0069** (0.0027)	-0.0052*** (0.0018)	0.0060** (0.0028)	-0.0056*** (0.0018)	0.0041 (0.0028)	-0.0015 (0.0020)	0.0006 (0.0034)	-0.0075*** (0.0021)	-0.0003 (0.0035)	-0.0075*** (0.0021)	-0.0006 (0.0035)
CashRatio	0.0025*** (0.0006)	-0.0021** (0.0010)	0.0028*** (0.0007)	-0.0024* (0.0010)	0.0029*** (0.0007)	-0.0022** (0.0010)	0.0052*** (0.0009)	0.0073*** (0.0013)	0.0057*** (0.0009)	0.0071*** (0.0013)	0.0058*** (0.0009)	0.0071*** (0.0013)
DivDummy	0.0002 (0.0002)	0.0006* (0.0003)	-0.0001 (0.0002)	0.0005 (0.0003)	-0.0002 (0.0002)	0.0004 (0.0003)	-0.0000 (0.0002)	0.0002 (0.0004)	-0.0003 (0.0004)	0.0001 (0.0004)	-0.0004 (0.0002)	0.0000 (0.0004)
sCFO	-0.0010* (0.0005)	-0.0008 (0.0006)	-0.0006** (0.0003)	-0.0006 (0.0005)	-0.0005** (0.0003)	-0.0006 (0.0005)	-0.0013* (0.0007)	-0.0009 (0.0007)	-0.0008* (0.0004)	-0.0008 (0.0007)	-0.0008* (0.0004)	-0.0008 (0.0006)
Lagged_DV	0.4701*** (0.0105)	0.3216*** (0.0100)	0.4573*** (0.0106)	0.3169*** (0.0101)	0.4546*** (0.0107)	0.3135*** (0.0102)	0.3623*** (0.0112)	0.1910*** (0.0099)	0.3483*** (0.0112)	0.1879*** (0.0100)	0.3489*** (0.0112)	0.1878*** (0.0101)
SalesGrowth			-0.0018*** (0.0003)	-0.0014*** (0.0002)	-0.0019*** (0.0003)	-0.0015*** (0.0003)			-0.0021*** (0.0003)	-0.0014*** (0.0003)	-0.0021*** (0.0003)	-0.0014*** (0.0003)
RDSales			0.0004*** (0.0001)	0.0000 (0.0001)	0.0004*** (0.0001)	0.0000 (0.0001)			0.0003** (0.0001)	0.0000 (0.0001)	0.0003** (0.0001)	-0.0000 (0.0001)
CashFlowAt			0.0145*** (0.0014)	0.0105*** (0.0014)	0.0145*** (0.0014)	0.0107*** (0.0014)			0.0173*** (0.0018)	0.0108*** (0.0016)	0.0174*** (0.0018)	0.0112*** (0.0016)
DailyVola			-0.0000*** (0.0000)	-0.0000*** (0.0000)	-0.0000*** (0.0000)	-0.0000*** (0.0000)			-0.0000*** (0.0000)	-0.0000** (0.0000)	-0.0000*** (0.0000)	-0.0000*** (0.0000)
Extended Controls			Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes			Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Industry FE	Yes		Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes		Yes		Yes	
Firm FE		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes
Year FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes			Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes		
Year-Quarter FE					Yes	Yes					Yes	Yes
N	61,030	61,030	58,550	58,550	58,550	58,550	58,610	58,610	57,529	57,529	57,529	57,529
R ²	0.300	0.117	0.308	0.120	0.309	0.119	0.233	0.064	0.244	0.067	0.245	0.067
Adj. R ²	0.299	0.091	0.307	0.093	0.308	0.091	0.232	0.036	0.244	0.039	0.244	0.037

Notes: * $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$ (two-tailed). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms). R^2 includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- R^2).

Table 67: H17 Robustness: Orthogonal Speaker Partition

	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)	(9)	(10)	(11)	(12)
			RepurchaseIntensity				RepurchaseIntensity_lead_qtr					
UncAnsCEO	-0.0003** (0.0002)	0.0000 (0.0002)	-0.0003* (0.0002)	-0.0000 (0.0002)	-0.0003* (0.0002)	-0.0000 (0.0002)	-0.0004** (0.0002)	-0.0000 (0.0002)	-0.0004** (0.0002)	-0.0001 (0.0002)	-0.0004* (0.0002)	-0.0000 (0.0002)
UncAnsNoCEO	-0.0002* (0.0001)	-0.0001 (0.0001)	-0.0002* (0.0001)	-0.0000 (0.0001)	-0.0000 (0.0001)	-0.0000 (0.0001)	-0.0002** (0.0001)	-0.0001 (0.0001)	-0.0002 (0.0001)	-0.0000 (0.0001)	-0.0002 (0.0001)	-0.0000 (0.0001)
UncPreCEO	0.0002 (0.0002)	0.0005*** (0.0002)	0.0002 (0.0002)	0.0004** (0.0002)	0.0002 (0.0002)	0.0004** (0.0002)	0.0004 (0.0003)	0.0007*** (0.0002)	0.0004 (0.0003)	0.0006*** (0.0002)	0.0004 (0.0003)	0.0006*** (0.0002)
UncPreNoCEO	0.0001 (0.0001)	0.0002 (0.0001)	0.0001 (0.0001)	0.0001 (0.0002)	0.0001 (0.0001)	0.0001 (0.0002)	0.0001 (0.0002)	0.0001 (0.0002)	0.0001 (0.0001)	0.0001 (0.0002)	0.0001 (0.0001)	0.0001 (0.0002)
InAssets	0.0006*** (0.0001)	0.0000 (0.0002)	0.0005*** (0.0001)	-0.0001 (0.0002)	0.0005*** (0.0001)	-0.0002 (0.0002)	0.0010*** (0.0001)	0.0017*** (0.0003)	0.0009*** (0.0001)	0.0016*** (0.0003)	0.0009*** (0.0001)	0.0015*** (0.0003)
TobinsQ	0.0011*** (0.0001)	0.0004*** (0.0001)	0.0010*** (0.0001)	0.0004*** (0.0001)	0.0011*** (0.0001)	0.0004*** (0.0001)	0.0015*** (0.0001)	0.0010*** (0.0002)	0.0014*** (0.0002)	0.0009*** (0.0002)	0.0014*** (0.0002)	0.0009*** (0.0002)
ROA	0.0120*** (0.0008)	0.0092*** (0.0009)	0.0037*** (0.0010)	0.0059*** (0.0010)	0.0033*** (0.0010)	0.0054*** (0.0010)	0.0140*** (0.0011)	0.0087*** (0.0010)	0.0044*** (0.0012)	0.0057*** (0.0011)	0.0040*** (0.0012)	0.0053*** (0.0011)
Leverage	-0.0009 (0.0006)	-0.0025*** (0.0009)	-0.0004 (0.0005)	-0.0016* (0.0009)	-0.0003 (0.0005)	-0.0016* (0.0009)	-0.0031*** (0.0009)	-0.0109*** (0.0011)	-0.0023*** (0.0008)	-0.0101*** (0.0011)	-0.0022*** (0.0008)	-0.0100*** (0.0011)
Capex	-0.0000 (0.0017)	0.0069** (0.0029)	-0.0053*** (0.0019)	0.0060** (0.0030)	-0.0057*** (0.0019)	0.0041 (0.0030)	-0.0014 (0.0021)	0.0005 (0.0037)	-0.0077*** (0.0022)	-0.0005 (0.0038)	-0.0077*** (0.0022)	-0.0008 (0.0038)
CashRatio	0.0026*** (0.0007)	-0.0022** (0.0010)	0.0028*** (0.0007)	-0.0026** (0.0010)	0.0029*** (0.0007)	-0.0024** (0.0010)	0.0053*** (0.0009)	0.0073*** (0.0013)	0.0058*** (0.0009)	0.0072*** (0.0013)	0.0059*** (0.0009)	0.0071*** (0.0013)
DivDummy	0.0002 (0.0002)	0.0007** (0.0003)	-0.0001 (0.0002)	0.0005 (0.0003)	-0.0002 (0.0003)	0.0005 (0.0003)	0.0000 (0.0002)	0.0003 (0.0004)	-0.0003 (0.0002)	0.0002 (0.0004)	-0.0003 (0.0002)	0.0001 (0.0004)
sCFO	-0.0010* (0.0006)	-0.0008 (0.0006)	-0.0006** (0.0003)	-0.0006 (0.0005)	-0.0006* (0.0003)	-0.0006 (0.0005)	-0.0012 (0.0008)	-0.0009 (0.0007)	-0.0008* (0.0005)	-0.0008 (0.0006)	-0.0008* (0.0004)	-0.0008 (0.0006)
Lagged_DV	0.4711*** (0.0108)	0.3215*** (0.0102)	0.4578*** (0.0109)	0.3168*** (0.0104)	0.4551*** (0.0109)	0.3135*** (0.0104)	0.3630*** (0.0116)	0.1914*** (0.0102)	0.3484*** (0.0115)	0.1883*** (0.0103)	0.3492*** (0.0115)	0.1885*** (0.0104)
SalesGrowth			-0.0019*** (0.0003)	-0.0014*** (0.0003)	-0.0020*** (0.0003)	-0.0015*** (0.0003)			-0.0023*** (0.0003)	-0.0015*** (0.0003)	-0.0023*** (0.0003)	-0.0015*** (0.0003)
RDSales			0.0004*** (0.0001)	0.0000 (0.0001)	0.0004*** (0.0001)	0.0000 (0.0001)			0.0003** (0.0001)	-0.0000 (0.0002)	0.0003** (0.0001)	-0.0000 (0.0002)
CashFlowAt			0.0150*** (0.0015)	0.0109*** (0.0015)	0.0150*** (0.0015)	0.0111*** (0.0015)			0.0179*** (0.0019)	0.0112*** (0.0016)	0.0180*** (0.0019)	0.0115*** (0.0016)
DailyVola			-0.0000*** (0.0000)	-0.0000*** (0.0000)	-0.0000*** (0.0000)	-0.0000*** (0.0000)			-0.0000*** (0.0000)	-0.0000*** (0.0000)	-0.0000*** (0.0000)	-0.0000*** (0.0000)
Extended Controls			Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes			Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Industry FE	Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes	
Firm FE		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes
Year FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes			Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes		
Year-Quarter FE					Yes	Yes					Yes	Yes
N	57,334	57,334	54,977	54,977	54,977	54,977	55,039	55,039	54,033	54,033	54,033	54,033
R ²	0.302	0.117	0.310	0.119	0.311	0.119	0.236	0.064	0.248	0.067	0.249	0.067
Adj. R ²	0.301	0.090	0.309	0.092	0.310	0.090	0.235	0.035	0.247	0.038	0.248	0.037

Notes: * $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$ (two-tailed). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms). R^2 includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- R^2).

Table 68: H18: Speech Uncertainty and SEC Comment Letters

	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)
	CCCL					
UncAnsCEO	-0.0012 (0.0009)	-0.0007 (0.0009)	-0.0014 (0.0009)	-0.0008 (0.0009)	-0.0014 (0.0009)	-0.0009 (0.0009)
UncPreCEO	-0.0004 (0.0008)	-0.0002 (0.0010)	0.0000 (0.0007)	0.0003 (0.0009)	0.0000 (0.0007)	0.0003 (0.0009)
UncAnsMgr	-0.0003 (0.0011)	0.0003 (0.0011)	-0.0000 (0.0011)	0.0006 (0.0012)	-0.0001 (0.0011)	0.0005 (0.0012)
UncPreMgr	0.0017* (0.0011)	0.0020* (0.0014)	0.0013 (0.0010)	0.0016 (0.0013)	0.0013 (0.0010)	0.0016 (0.0013)
lnAssets	-0.0003* (0.0002)	0.0012 (0.0007)	-0.0004** (0.0002)	0.0014* (0.0007)	-0.0004** (0.0002)	0.0014* (0.0007)
TobinsQ	-0.0001 (0.0002)	0.0002 (0.0002)	-0.0001 (0.0002)	0.0001 (0.0003)	-0.0001 (0.0002)	0.0002 (0.0002)
ROA	-0.0012 (0.0021)	-0.0009 (0.0032)	-0.0024 (0.0034)	-0.0008 (0.0040)	-0.0020 (0.0034)	-0.0005 (0.0040)
Leverage	-0.0013 (0.0010)	-0.0006 (0.0021)	-0.0011 (0.0010)	-0.0002 (0.0023)	-0.0011 (0.0010)	-0.0002 (0.0024)
Capex	0.0030 (0.0045)	0.0109 (0.0084)	0.0032 (0.0047)	0.0120 (0.0086)	0.0033 (0.0047)	0.0119 (0.0086)
CashRatio	-0.0010 (0.0018)	-0.0065** (0.0032)	-0.0007 (0.0019)	-0.0053* (0.0031)	-0.0008 (0.0019)	-0.0054* (0.0031)
DivDummy	-0.0004 (0.0005)	-0.0001 (0.0010)	-0.0004 (0.0006)	0.0000 (0.0010)	-0.0004 (0.0006)	0.0001 (0.0010)
sCFO	-0.0002 (0.0007)	-0.0014 (0.0019)	-0.0001 (0.0007)	-0.0015 (0.0020)	-0.0001 (0.0007)	-0.0015 (0.0020)
Lagged_DV	-0.0030 (0.0043)	-0.0297*** (0.0047)	-0.0030 (0.0044)	-0.0306*** (0.0048)	-0.0029 (0.0044)	-0.0306*** (0.0048)
SalesGrowth			-0.0001 (0.0005)	-0.0005 (0.0006)	-0.0000 (0.0005)	-0.0004 (0.0006)
RDSales			-0.0003** (0.0001)	-0.0001 (0.0001)	-0.0003** (0.0001)	-0.0000 (0.0001)
CashFlowAt			0.0007 (0.0033)	-0.0006 (0.0040)	0.0004 (0.0033)	-0.0011 (0.0040)
DailyVola			-0.0000 (0.0000)	-0.0000** (0.0000)	-0.0000 (0.0000)	-0.0000* (0.0000)
Extended Controls			Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Industry FE	Yes		Yes		Yes	
Firm FE		Yes		Yes		Yes
Year FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes		
Year-Quarter FE					Yes	Yes
N	66,886	66,886	64,172	64,172	64,172	64,172
R ²	0.000	0.001	0.000	0.001	0.000	0.001
Adj. R ²	-0.000	-0.026	-0.000	-0.027	-0.001	-0.028

Notes: * $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$ (one-tailed for IVs, $\beta > 0$; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms). R^2 includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- R^2).

Table 69: H18 Robustness: Orthogonal Speaker Partition

	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)
	CCCL					
UncAnsCEO	-0.0015 (0.0006)	-0.0006 (0.0007)	-0.0015 (0.0007)	-0.0005 (0.0007)	-0.0015 (0.0007)	-0.0006 (0.0007)
UncAnsNoCEO	-0.0003 (0.0004)	-0.0003 (0.0004)	-0.0003 (0.0005)	-0.0002 (0.0005)	-0.0003 (0.0004)	-0.0002 (0.0005)
UncPreCEO	0.0005 (0.0006)	0.0009 (0.0007)	0.0007 (0.0006)	0.0012** (0.0007)	0.0007 (0.0006)	0.0012** (0.0007)
UncPreNoCEO	0.0006* (0.0004)	0.0007 (0.0006)	0.0005 (0.0005)	0.0007 (0.0006)	0.0005 (0.0005)	0.0008 (0.0006)
lnAssets	-0.0004** (0.0002)	0.0012 (0.0008)	-0.0005** (0.0002)	0.0015* (0.0008)	-0.0005** (0.0002)	0.0016** (0.0008)
TobinsQ	-0.0001 (0.0002)	0.0002 (0.0003)	-0.0001 (0.0002)	0.0002 (0.0003)	-0.0001 (0.0002)	0.0002 (0.0003)
ROA	-0.0011 (0.0023)	-0.0005 (0.0034)	-0.0026 (0.0035)	-0.0005 (0.0042)	-0.0022 (0.0035)	-0.0002 (0.0042)
Leverage	-0.0013 (0.0010)	-0.0008 (0.0022)	-0.0011 (0.0011)	-0.0004 (0.0024)	-0.0010 (0.0011)	-0.0003 (0.0024)
Capex	0.0036 (0.0047)	0.0118 (0.0087)	0.0036 (0.0049)	0.0131 (0.0090)	0.0038 (0.0049)	0.0131 (0.0089)
CashRatio	-0.0010 (0.0019)	-0.0062* (0.0033)	-0.0007 (0.0021)	-0.0049 (0.0032)	-0.0008 (0.0021)	-0.0050 (0.0032)
DivDummy	-0.0002 (0.0006)	-0.0001 (0.0011)	-0.0003 (0.0006)	0.0000 (0.0011)	-0.0003 (0.0006)	0.0001 (0.0011)
sCFO	-0.0001 (0.0007)	-0.0014 (0.0019)	-0.0000 (0.0007)	-0.0014 (0.0020)	-0.0001 (0.0007)	-0.0014 (0.0020)
Lagged_DV	-0.0028 (0.0046)	-0.0304*** (0.0051)	-0.0028 (0.0047)	-0.0314** (0.0052)	-0.0027 (0.0047)	-0.0314*** (0.0052)
SalesGrowth			-0.0004 (0.0005)	-0.0009 (0.0007)	-0.0003 (0.0005)	-0.0008 (0.0006)
RDSales			-0.0003** (0.0001)	-0.0001 (0.0001)	-0.0003** (0.0001)	-0.0001 (0.0001)
CashFlowAt			0.0016 (0.0034)	0.0006 (0.0042)	0.0013 (0.0034)	0.0001 (0.0042)
DailyVola			-0.0000 (0.0000)	-0.0000** (0.0000)	-0.0000 (0.0000)	-0.0000* (0.0000)
Extended Controls			Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Industry FE	Yes		Yes		Yes	
Firm FE		Yes		Yes		Yes
Year FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes		
Year-Quarter FE					Yes	Yes
N	62,704	62,704	60,199	60,199	60,199	60,199
R ²	0.000	0.001	0.000	0.001	0.000	0.001
Adj. R ²	-0.000	-0.027	-0.000	-0.028	-0.001	-0.029

Notes: * $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$ (one-tailed for IVs, $\beta > 0$; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms). R^2 includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- R^2).

Table 70: H18b: Logit Robustness — Speech Uncertainty and SEC Comment Letters

	(1)	(2)
	CCCL	
UncAnsCEO	-0.0012 (0.0009)	-0.0016 (0.0010)
UncPreCEO	-0.0005 (0.0008)	0.0001 (0.0007)
UncAnsMgr	-0.0004 (0.0011)	0.0001 (0.0011)
UncPreMgr	0.0018** (0.0010)	0.0012* (0.0009)
InAssets	-0.0003 (0.0002)	-0.0003* (0.0002)
TobinsQ	-0.0001 (0.0002)	-0.0001 (0.0002)
ROA	-0.0018 (0.0019)	-0.0030 (0.0030)
Leverage	-0.0015 (0.0013)	-0.0008 (0.0013)
Capex	0.0011 (0.0053)	0.0022 (0.0054)
CashRatio	-0.0006 (0.0018)	0.0007 (0.0020)
DivDummy	-0.0004 (0.0006)	-0.0005 (0.0006)
sCFO	-0.0004 (0.0023)	0.0001 (0.0014)
Lagged_DV	-0.0022 (0.0037)	-0.0026 (0.0041)
SalesGrowth		-0.0003 (0.0008)
RDSales		-0.0026 (0.0023)
CashFlowAt		0.0003 (0.0037)
DailyVola		-0.0000 (0.0000)
Extended Controls		Yes
Industry FE	Yes	Yes
Year FE	Yes	Yes
N	66,886	64,172
Pseudo R^2	0.089	0.090

Notes: * $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$ (one-tailed for IVs, $\beta > 0$; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms). R^2 includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- R^2).

Table 71: H18b.r: Logit + Orthogonal Speaker Partition — SEC Comment Letters

	(1)	(2)
	CCCL	
UncAnsCEO	-0.0016 (0.0007)	-0.0016 (0.0008)
UncAnsNoCEO	-0.0003 (0.0004)	-0.0002 (0.0005)
UncPreCEO	0.0006 (0.0006)	0.0008 (0.0006)
UncPreNoCEO	0.0006* (0.0004)	0.0006* (0.0004)
lnAssets	-0.0004* (0.0002)	-0.0004** (0.0002)
TobinsQ	-0.0000 (0.0002)	-0.0001 (0.0002)
ROA	-0.0017 (0.0020)	-0.0031 (0.0031)
Leverage	-0.0010 (0.0013)	-0.0008 (0.0013)
Capex	0.0003 (0.0058)	0.0031 (0.0059)
CashRatio	-0.0001 (0.0019)	0.0004 (0.0022)
DivDummy	-0.0002 (0.0006)	-0.0004 (0.0006)
sCFO	-0.0007 (0.0034)	-0.0000 (0.0019)
Lagged_DV	-0.0016 (0.0033)	-0.0026 (0.0043)
SalesGrowth		-0.0008 (0.0010)
RDSales		-0.0022 (0.0023)
CashFlowAt		0.0019 (0.0040)
DailyVola		-0.0000 (0.0000)
Extended Controls		Yes
Industry FE	Yes	Yes
Year FE	Yes	Yes
N	62,704	60,199
Pseudo R^2	0.091	0.092

Notes: * $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$ (one-tailed for IVs, $\beta > 0$; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms). R^2 includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- R^2).

Table 72: H19b: Speech Uncertainty and External vs Internal Financing (Chang et al. 2006)

	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)	(9)	(10)	(11)	(12)
			Chang	External	Funding				Chang	External	Funding	lead
UncAnsCEO	0.0093 (0.0083)	0.0073 (0.0077)	0.0096 (0.0083)	0.0081 (0.0077)	0.0096 (0.0082)	0.0081 (0.0077)	0.0140 (0.0090)	0.0088 (0.0079)	0.0145 (0.0090)	0.0084 (0.0079)	0.0144 (0.0090)	0.0082 (0.0079)
UncPreCEO	-0.0039 (0.0093)	-0.0115 (0.0092)	-0.0045 (0.0092)	-0.0053 (0.0093)	-0.0045 (0.0092)	-0.0054 (0.0093)	0.0051 (0.0102)	-0.0070 (0.0093)	0.0033 (0.0101)	-0.0075 (0.0094)	0.0032 (0.0101)	-0.0074 (0.0094)
UncAnsMgr	-0.0049 (0.0105)	-0.0038 (0.0100)	-0.0083 (0.0105)	0.0015 (0.0100)	-0.0085 (0.0100)	0.0010 (0.0100)	-0.0133 (0.0114)	-0.0096 (0.0106)	-0.0160* (0.0114)	-0.0092 (0.0107)	-0.0155* (0.0115)	-0.0084 (0.0107)
UncPreMgr	0.0257 (0.0114)	0.0176 (0.0130)	0.0290 (0.0112)	0.0143 (0.0132)	0.0292 (0.0113)	0.0143 (0.0132)	-0.0037 (0.0124)	-0.0104 (0.0135)	0.0001 (0.0123)	-0.0091 (0.0137)	0.0003 (0.0123)	-0.0090 (0.0137)
lnAssets	-0.0080** (0.0034)	0.0074 (0.0102)	-0.0058* (0.0035)	0.0146 (0.0107)	-0.0056 (0.0036)	0.0148 (0.0107)	-0.0148*** (0.0031)	-0.1222*** (0.0106)	-0.0153*** (0.0032)	-0.1207*** (0.0108)	-0.0145*** (0.0032)	-0.1196*** (0.0108)
TobinsQ	0.0229*** (0.0039)	0.0293*** (0.0048)	0.0237*** (0.0056)	0.0334*** (0.0061)	0.0238*** (0.0056)	0.0337*** (0.0062)	0.0223*** (0.0033)	0.0109** (0.0049)	0.0240*** (0.0038)	0.0140*** (0.0048)	0.0241*** (0.0038)	0.0135*** (0.0049)
ROA	-0.2348*** (0.0504)	-0.0686 (0.0461)	0.1241** (0.0534)	0.1169** (0.0531)	0.1234** (0.0539)	0.1148** (0.0536)	-0.1917*** (0.0411)	0.0251 (0.0517)	0.0757* (0.0460)	0.1061** (0.0518)	0.0779* (0.0463)	0.1051** (0.0520)
Leverage	0.2928*** (0.0553)	0.4679*** (0.0413)	0.2745*** (0.0521)	0.4318*** (0.0431)	0.2737*** (0.0522)	0.4304*** (0.0433)	0.0945*** (0.0253)	-0.2967*** (0.0402)	0.0886*** (0.0242)	-0.3010*** (0.0406)	0.0868*** (0.0239)	-0.3041*** (0.0408)
Capex	0.6445*** (0.1001)	0.9281*** (0.1461)	0.8643*** (0.1116)	0.9986*** (0.1529)	0.8593*** (0.1119)	0.9841*** (0.1537)	0.6948*** (0.0946)	0.8689*** (0.1481)	0.8668*** (0.0995)	0.9102*** (0.1484)	0.8694*** (0.0998)	0.9330*** (0.1498)
CashRatio	-0.0484 (0.0332)	0.0258 (0.0401)	-0.0923*** (0.0319)	0.0319 (0.0404)	-0.0929** (0.0319)	0.0319 (0.0405)	-0.1565*** (0.0329)	-0.2364*** (0.0407)	-0.1824*** (0.0312)	-0.2382*** (0.0409)	-0.1849*** (0.0311)	-0.2395*** (0.0409)
DivDummy	-0.0047 (0.0081)	0.0547*** (0.0132)	0.0023 (0.0083)	0.0581*** (0.0139)	0.0026 (0.0083)	0.0579*** (0.0139)	0.0006 (0.0085)	0.0502*** (0.0139)	0.0002 (0.0085)	0.0486*** (0.0140)	0.0017 (0.0085)	0.0495*** (0.0141)
sCFO	0.0390 (0.0421)	-0.0151 (0.0210)	0.0077 (0.0214)	-0.0265* (0.0152)	0.0077 (0.0215)	-0.0266* (0.0153)	0.0379 (0.0396)	-0.0362*** (0.0120)	0.0297 (0.0335)	-0.0365*** (0.0118)	0.0293 (0.0330)	-0.0360*** (0.0116)
Lagged_DV	0.0814*** (0.0100)	-0.0711*** (0.0090)	0.0575*** (0.0100)	-0.0851*** (0.0092)	0.0574*** (0.0100)	-0.0854*** (0.0092)	0.0827*** (0.0090)	-0.0347*** (0.0088)	0.0720*** (0.0090)	-0.0360*** (0.0089)	0.0722*** (0.0090)	-0.0358*** (0.0088)
SalesGrowth			0.1731*** (0.0199)	0.1597*** (0.0196)	0.1724*** (0.0200)	0.1591*** (0.0198)			0.0411*** (0.0123)	-0.0078 (0.0134)	0.0418*** (0.0123)	-0.0069 (0.0134)
RDSales			0.0089 (0.0058)	0.0147** (0.0070)	0.0088 (0.0058)	0.0147** (0.0070)			0.0186*** (0.0055)	0.0012 (0.0066)	0.0186*** (0.0056)	0.0016 (0.0066)
CashFlowAt			-0.6527*** (0.0894)	-0.7543*** (0.0976)	-0.6486*** (0.0896)	-0.7507*** (0.0979)			-0.4337*** (0.0623)	-0.2165*** (0.0674)	-0.4280*** (0.0624)	-0.2112*** (0.0676)
DailyVola			0.0000 (0.0002)	-0.0000 (0.0002)	0.0001 (0.0002)	0.0000 (0.0002)			-0.0003* (0.0002)	-0.0002 (0.0002)	-0.0000 (0.0002)	0.0001 (0.0002)
Extended Controls			Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes			Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Industry FE	Yes		Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes		Yes		Yes	
Firm FE		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes
Year FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes			Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes		
Year-Quarter FE					Yes	Yes					Yes	Yes
N	65,069	65,069	62,450	62,450	62,450	62,450	60,052	60,052	58,871	58,871	58,871	58,871
R ²	0.054	0.025	0.083	0.049	0.082	0.048	0.033	0.031	0.040	0.032	0.040	0.031
Adj. R ²	0.054	-0.002	0.082	0.022	0.081	0.020	0.032	0.003	0.040	0.003	0.039	0.002

Notes: * $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$ (one-tailed for IVs, $\beta < 0$; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms). R^2 includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- R^2).

Table 73: H19b Robustness: Orthogonal Speaker Partition

	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)	(9)	(10)	(11)	(12)
			Chang	External	Funding				Chang	External	Funding_lead	
UncAnsCEO	0.0060 (0.0065)	0.0039 (0.0058)	0.0043 (0.0064)	0.0082 (0.0057)	0.0043 (0.0064)	0.0080 (0.0057)	0.0063 (0.0072)	0.0012 (0.0060)	0.0054 (0.0071)	0.0011 (0.0060)	0.0056 (0.0071)	0.0015 (0.0060)
UncAnsNoCEO	0.0074 (0.0036)	0.0062 (0.0034)	0.0061 (0.0036)	0.0067 (0.0034)	0.0061 (0.0036)	0.0067 (0.0034)	-0.0035 (0.0038)	-0.0043 (0.0035)	-0.0045 (0.0039)	-0.0045 (0.0036)	-0.0044 (0.0039)	-0.0043 (0.0036)
UncPreCEO	0.0095 (0.0077)	-0.0032 (0.0074)	0.0110 (0.0076)	0.0023 (0.0075)	0.0111 (0.0076)	0.0023 (0.0075)	0.0049 (0.0083)	-0.0118* (0.0075)	0.0055 (0.0083)	-0.0119* (0.0075)	0.0054 (0.0083)	-0.0117* (0.0075)
UncPreNoCEO	0.0116 (0.0057)	0.0053 (0.0068)	0.0122 (0.0055)	0.0029 (0.0069)	0.0123 (0.0056)	0.0029 (0.0069)	-0.0015 (0.0059)	-0.0108* (0.0072)	-0.0007 (0.0058)	-0.0109* (0.0073)	-0.0007 (0.0058)	-0.0110* (0.0073)
InAssets	-0.0088** (0.0035)	0.0073 (0.0107)	-0.0065* (0.0036)	0.0137 (0.0112)	-0.0062* (0.0036)	0.0141 (0.0112)	-0.0156*** (0.0032)	-0.1245*** (0.0109)	-0.0160*** (0.0033)	-0.1228*** (0.0111)	-0.0151*** (0.0033)	-0.1216*** (0.0112)
TobinsQ	0.0227*** (0.0039)	0.0296*** (0.0050)	0.0236*** (0.0057)	0.0332*** (0.0063)	0.0237*** (0.0057)	0.0334*** (0.0064)	0.0225*** (0.0033)	0.0102** (0.0050)	0.0245*** (0.0039)	0.0135*** (0.0049)	0.0246*** (0.0039)	0.0130*** (0.0050)
ROA	-0.2187*** (0.0522)	-0.0558 (0.0473)	0.1498*** (0.0551)	0.1413*** (0.0548)	0.1495*** (0.0556)	0.1398*** (0.0554)	-0.1787*** (0.0420)	0.0353 (0.0500)	0.0959** (0.0476)	0.1220** (0.0522)	0.0989** (0.0479)	0.1216** (0.0524)
Leverage	0.2916*** (0.0579)	0.4797*** (0.0429)	0.2711*** (0.0540)	0.4430*** (0.0447)	0.2702*** (0.0540)	0.4411*** (0.0448)	0.0954*** (0.0263)	-0.2953*** (0.0409)	0.0882*** (0.0250)	-0.2994*** (0.0413)	0.0862*** (0.0246)	-0.3027*** (0.0415)
Capex	0.6169*** (0.1011)	0.9680*** (0.1515)	0.8576*** (0.1143)	1.0408*** (0.1600)	0.8524*** (0.1146)	1.0282*** (0.1607)	0.6617*** (0.0971)	0.8526*** (0.1520)	0.8485*** (0.1027)	0.9075*** (0.1524)	0.8515*** (0.1029)	0.9335*** (0.1539)
CashRatio	-0.0437 (0.0340)	0.0268 (0.0411)	-0.0839* (0.0327)	0.0375 (0.0414)	-0.0845** (0.0327)	0.0374 (0.0415)	-0.1574*** (0.0336)	-0.2496*** (0.0416)	-0.1797*** (0.0317)	-0.2520*** (0.0418)	-0.1826*** (0.0317)	-0.2532*** (0.0419)
DivDummy	-0.0025 (0.0083)	0.0568*** (0.0137)	0.0056 (0.0085)	0.0602*** (0.0143)	0.0060 (0.0084)	0.0601*** (0.0143)	0.0038 (0.0087)	0.0526*** (0.0143)	0.0036 (0.0087)	0.0511*** (0.0144)	0.0053 (0.0087)	0.0522*** (0.0145)
sCFO	0.0317 (0.0391)	-0.0145 (0.0209)	0.0053 (0.0209)	-0.0256* (0.0154)	0.0052 (0.0209)	-0.0258* (0.0154)	0.0377 (0.0407)	-0.0352*** (0.0124)	0.0306 (0.0350)	-0.0350*** (0.0124)	0.0301 (0.0345)	-0.0346*** (0.0122)
Lagged_DV	0.0792*** (0.0101)	-0.0714*** (0.0091)	0.0560*** (0.0101)	-0.0853*** (0.0093)	0.0559*** (0.0101)	-0.0857*** (0.0094)	0.0806*** (0.0092)	-0.0345*** (0.0089)	0.0708*** (0.0092)	-0.0360*** (0.0090)	0.0708*** (0.0092)	-0.0358*** (0.0090)
SalesGrowth			0.1766*** (0.0208)	0.1692*** (0.0205)	0.1759*** (0.0210)	0.1685*** (0.0207)			0.0359*** (0.0128)	-0.0096 (0.0137)	0.0367*** (0.0128)	-0.0084 (0.0138)
RDSales			0.0093 (0.0061)	0.0182** (0.0079)	0.0093 (0.0061)	0.0182** (0.0079)			0.0198*** (0.0063)	0.0026 (0.0082)	0.0198*** (0.0064)	0.0032 (0.0082)
CashFlowAt			-0.6696*** (0.0915)	-0.7697*** (0.1013)	-0.6651*** (0.0917)	-0.7658*** (0.1017)			-0.4496*** (0.0650)	-0.2286*** (0.0684)	-0.4434*** (0.0651)	-0.2231*** (0.0686)
DailyVola			0.0001 (0.0002)	0.0000 (0.0002)	0.0002 (0.0002)	0.0001 (0.0002)			-0.0003* (0.0002)	-0.0002 (0.0002)	0.0000 (0.0002)	0.0002 (0.0002)
Extended Controls			Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes			Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Industry FE	Yes		Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes		Yes		Yes	
Firm FE		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes
Year FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes			Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes		
Year-Quarter FE					Yes	Yes					Yes	Yes
N	61,063	61,063	58,629	58,629	58,629	58,629	56,359	56,359	55,275	55,275	55,275	55,275
R ²	0.052	0.026	0.081	0.050	0.081	0.050	0.032	0.031	0.039	0.032	0.039	0.032
Adj. R ²	0.052	-0.002	0.080	0.022	0.079	0.021	0.031	0.002	0.038	0.002	0.038	0.001

Notes: * $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$ (one-tailed for IVs, $\beta < 0$; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms). R^2 includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- R^2).

Table 74: H20b: Speech Uncertainty and Debt vs Equity Choice (Chang et al. 2006)

	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)	(9)	(10)	(11)	(12)
			ChangDebtChoice						ChangDebtChoice_lead			
UncAnsCEO	-0.0144 (0.0143)	-0.0102 (0.0134)	-0.0153 (0.0144)	-0.0086 (0.0137)	-0.0162 (0.0141)	-0.0101 (0.0135)	-0.0234 (0.0299)	0.0034 (0.0265)	-0.0272 (0.0288)	0.0012 (0.0264)	-0.0301 (0.0286)	0.0002 (0.0263)
UncPreCEO	-0.0320** (0.0162)	-0.0079 (0.0149)	-0.0269* (0.0162)	-0.0049 (0.0150)	-0.0259 (0.0161)	-0.0031 (0.0150)	-0.0382 (0.0328)	-0.0169 (0.0309)	-0.0324 (0.0322)	-0.0272 (0.0326)	-0.0295 (0.0326)	-0.0242 (0.0338)
UncAnsMgr	0.0240 (0.0184)	0.0118 (0.0163)	0.0273 (0.0185)	0.0127 (0.0170)	0.0264 (0.0184)	0.0132 (0.0169)	0.0444 (0.0437)	-0.0217 (0.0348)	0.0554 (0.0424)	-0.0208 (0.0350)	0.0583 (0.0421)	-0.0207 (0.0344)
UncPreMgr	0.0389* (0.0201)	0.0128 (0.0225)	0.0362* (0.0202)	0.0130 (0.0228)	0.0333* (0.0201)	0.0065 (0.0230)	0.0073 (0.0446)	0.0539 (0.0561)	0.0035 (0.0440)	0.0627 (0.0583)	0.0018 (0.0443)	0.0584 (0.0595)
lnAssets	0.0523*** (0.0051)	0.0932*** (0.0172)	0.0487*** (0.0052)	0.0996*** (0.0181)	0.0443*** (0.0051)	0.0955*** (0.0180)	0.0636*** (0.0106)	0.0472 (0.0408)	0.0511*** (0.0106)	0.0551 (0.0425)	0.0500*** (0.0108)	0.0542 (0.0438)
TobinsQ	-0.0248*** (0.0043)	-0.0271*** (0.0060)	-0.0252*** (0.0043)	-0.0271*** (0.0059)	-0.0261*** (0.0043)	-0.0267*** (0.0061)	-0.0116* (0.0060)	-0.0112 (0.0135)	-0.0115* (0.0062)	-0.0069 (0.0125)	-0.0120* (0.0063)	-0.0071 (0.0123)
ROA	0.2663*** (0.0479)	0.1211* (0.0673)	0.2829*** (0.0715)	0.1639* (0.0839)	0.2509*** (0.0713)	0.1411* (0.0835)	0.3790*** (0.0838)	0.3614*** (0.1384)	0.5384*** (0.1268)	0.3817** (0.1757)	0.5364*** (0.1283)	0.3842** (0.1791)
Leverage	0.1617*** (0.0294)	0.1198*** (0.0455)	0.1727*** (0.0297)	0.1208*** (0.0461)	0.1808*** (0.0302)	0.1320*** (0.0458)	0.0221 (0.0594)	-0.2478** (0.1105)	0.0166 (0.0526)	-0.2279** (0.1058)	0.0166 (0.0526)	-0.2313** (0.1046)
Capex	0.1538 (0.1298)	1.0006*** (0.2856)	0.2759** (0.1323)	1.0307*** (0.2875)	0.2553* (0.1308)	0.9389*** (0.2830)	0.1418 (0.2231)	0.1569 (0.4918)	0.3236 (0.2311)	0.2549 (0.4784)	0.3383 (0.2323)	0.3605 (0.4833)
CashRatio	-0.4541*** (0.0498)	-0.3466*** (0.0704)	-0.4531*** (0.0527)	-0.3413*** (0.0726)	-0.4280*** (0.0525)	-0.3318*** (0.0721)	-0.3771*** (0.0916)	-0.0174 (0.1617)	-0.3433*** (0.0940)	-0.0535 (0.1535)	-0.3343*** (0.0944)	-0.0326 (0.1539)
DivDummy	0.0630** (0.0134)	0.0450* (0.0273)	0.0562*** (0.0134)	0.0413 (0.0274)	0.0494*** (0.0133)	0.0379 (0.0273)	0.0528* (0.0291)	0.0605 (0.0643)	0.0414 (0.0285)	0.0575 (0.0639)	0.0387 (0.0287)	0.0561 (0.0635)
sCFO	-0.1698*** (0.0374)	-0.1861*** (0.0385)	-0.1753*** (0.0349)	-0.1864*** (0.0386)	-0.1656*** (0.0353)	-0.1846*** (0.0391)	0.0154 (0.1040)	-0.0832 (0.1428)	-0.0058 (0.0943)	-0.0616 (0.1430)	-0.0012 (0.0936)	-0.0668 (0.1434)
Lagged_DV	-0.0867*** (0.0116)	-0.0496*** (0.0134)	-0.0887*** (0.0116)	-0.0564*** (0.0132)	-0.0859*** (0.0115)	-0.0561*** (0.0131)	-0.0520** (0.0263)	-0.0132 (0.0275)	-0.0530** (0.0261)	-0.0165 (0.0276)	-0.0525** (0.0261)	-0.0175 (0.0275)
SalesGrowth			0.0244* (0.0130)	0.0384*** (0.0142)	0.0219* (0.0129)	0.0348** (0.0141)			-0.0117 (0.0216)	-0.0038 (0.0324)	-0.0117 (0.0218)	-0.0034 (0.0334)
RDSales			0.0039 (0.0039)	0.0049 (0.0035)	0.0032 (0.0037)	0.0040 (0.0036)			-0.0011 (0.0036)	-0.0012 (0.0080)	-0.0015 (0.0035)	-0.0014 (0.0081)
CashFlowAt			-0.1186 (0.0772)	-0.1956* (0.1034)	-0.1273* (0.0761)	-0.1888* (0.1022)			-0.3490** (0.1409)	-0.0747 (0.2240)	-0.3615** (0.1417)	-0.0803 (0.2264)
DailyVola			-0.0019*** (0.0003)	-0.0004 (0.0003)	-0.0033*** (0.0004)	-0.0015*** (0.0004)			-0.0039*** (0.0006)	-0.0021*** (0.0006)	-0.0043*** (0.0009)	-0.0019** (0.0008)
Extended Controls			Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes			Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Industry FE	Yes		Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes		Yes		Yes	
Firm FE		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes
Year FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes			Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes		
Year-Quarter FE					Yes	Yes					Yes	Yes
N	13,666	13,666	13,057	13,057	13,057	13,057	3,518	3,518	3,404	3,404	3,404	3,404
R ²	0.249	0.075	0.253	0.082	0.260	0.083	0.231	0.056	0.256	0.071	0.254	0.066
Adj. R ²	0.247	-0.002	0.251	0.004	0.255	0.000	0.222	-0.043	0.247	-0.029	0.234	-0.051

Notes: * $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$ (two-tailed). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms). R^2 includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- R^2).

Table 75: H20b Robustness: Orthogonal Speaker Partition

	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)	(9)	(10)	(11)	(12)
			ChangDebtChoice						ChangDebtChoice_lead			
UncAnsCEO	-0.0026 (0.0115)	-0.0036 (0.0099)	-0.0004 (0.0115)	-0.0007 (0.0101)	-0.0014 (0.0112)	-0.0021 (0.0099)	-0.0120 (0.0241)	-0.0213 (0.0193)	-0.0093 (0.0229)	-0.0229 (0.0196)	-0.0104 (0.0231)	-0.0240 (0.0198)
UncAnsNoCEO	0.0042 (0.0065)	0.0015 (0.0058)	0.0046 (0.0066)	0.0023 (0.0059)	0.0052 (0.0066)	0.0028 (0.0059)	0.0030 (0.0154)	-0.0189* (0.0113)	0.0069 (0.0148)	-0.0181* (0.0110)	0.0111 (0.0150)	-0.0165 (0.0113)
UncPreCEO	-0.0125 (0.0129)	-0.0026 (0.0116)	-0.0120 (0.0131)	0.0006 (0.0118)	-0.0128 (0.0130)	-0.0006 (0.0117)	-0.0263 (0.0267)	0.0065 (0.0221)	-0.0237 (0.0260)	0.0033 (0.0222)	-0.0222 (0.0261)	0.0053 (0.0220)
UncPreNoCEO	0.0181* (0.0096)	0.0079 (0.0113)	0.0159 (0.0098)	0.0052 (0.0116)	0.0155 (0.0097)	0.0028 (0.0117)	0.0091 (0.0203)	0.0282 (0.0273)	0.0106 (0.0197)	0.0388 (0.0276)	0.0097 (0.0198)	0.0358 (0.0277)
InAssets	0.0543*** (0.0051)	0.0946*** (0.0177)	0.0506*** (0.0052)	0.1011*** (0.0184)	0.0460*** (0.0051)	0.0964*** (0.0182)	0.0649*** (0.0108)	0.0494 (0.0405)	0.0540*** (0.0107)	0.0632 (0.0416)	0.0538*** (0.0108)	0.0672 (0.0423)
TobinsQ	-0.0246*** (0.0043)	-0.0279*** (0.0060)	-0.0252*** (0.0043)	-0.0277*** (0.0059)	-0.0262*** (0.0043)	-0.0272*** (0.0061)	-0.0111* (0.0062)	-0.0131 (0.0142)	-0.0108* (0.0064)	-0.0059 (0.0133)	-0.0109* (0.0064)	-0.0060 (0.0130)
ROA	0.2541*** (0.0486)	0.0970 (0.0683)	0.2619*** (0.0701)	0.1605** (0.0800)	0.2266*** (0.0698)	0.1360* (0.0804)	0.3781*** (0.0868)	0.3682** (0.1475)	0.5641*** (0.1308)	0.4576** (0.1868)	0.5667*** (0.1329)	0.4686** (0.1889)
Leverage	0.1518*** (0.0287)	0.1200*** (0.0453)	0.1658*** (0.0296)	0.1251*** (0.0457)	0.1743*** (0.0301)	0.1373*** (0.0454)	0.0074 (0.0602)	-0.2560** (0.1168)	0.0016 (0.0529)	-0.2472** (0.1102)	0.0012 (0.0530)	-0.2546** (0.1077)
Capex	0.2471** (0.1255)	1.0041*** (0.2872)	0.3635*** (0.1308)	1.0366*** (0.2873)	0.3417*** (0.1286)	0.9345*** (0.2814)	0.2294 (0.2196)	0.0507 (0.4610)	0.4192* (0.2297)	0.2101 (0.4528)	0.4433* (0.2310)	0.3394 (0.4619)
CashRatio	-0.4399*** (0.0507)	-0.3310*** (0.0713)	-0.4335*** (0.0540)	-0.3230*** (0.0734)	-0.4052*** (0.0535)	-0.3151*** (0.0729)	-0.3637*** (0.0949)	0.0133 (0.1598)	-0.3166*** (0.0975)	-0.0110 (0.1500)	-0.3066*** (0.0978)	0.0208 (0.1491)
DivDummy	0.0606*** (0.0133)	0.0453 (0.0276)	0.0512*** (0.0134)	0.0410 (0.0275)	0.0437*** (0.0133)	0.0376 (0.0273)	0.0555* (0.0288)	0.0902 (0.0662)	0.0433 (0.0283)	0.0879 (0.0657)	0.0409 (0.0285)	0.0859 (0.0649)
sCFO	-0.1874*** (0.0484)	-0.1812*** (0.0440)	-0.1908*** (0.0450)	-0.1794*** (0.0441)	-0.1774*** (0.0423)	-0.1772*** (0.0444)	0.0223 (0.1058)	-0.0736 (0.1396)	0.0108 (0.0933)	-0.0615 (0.1338)	0.0156 (0.0929)	-0.0595 (0.1355)
Lagged_DV	-0.0846*** (0.0117)	-0.0505*** (0.0136)	-0.0858*** (0.0117)	-0.0563*** (0.0134)	-0.0830*** (0.0116)	-0.0558*** (0.0132)	-0.0515** (0.0261)	-0.0017 (0.0263)	-0.0513** (0.0260)	-0.0020 (0.0266)	-0.0508* (0.0259)	-0.0033 (0.0262)
SalesGrowth			0.0201 (0.0139)	0.0344** (0.0144)	0.0165 (0.0141)	0.0291** (0.0144)			-0.0177 (0.0237)	-0.0108 (0.0334)	-0.0183 (0.0239)	-0.0102 (0.0342)
RDSales			0.0023 (0.0040)	0.0044 (0.0035)	0.0019 (0.0037)	0.0032 (0.0036)			-0.0043 (0.0035)	-0.0067 (0.0078)	-0.0046 (0.0036)	-0.0066 (0.0079)
CashFlowAt			-0.1155 (0.0769)	-0.2147** (0.1026)	-0.1257* (0.0760)	-0.2074** (0.1019)			-0.3839*** (0.1458)	-0.1882 (0.2276)	-0.3979*** (0.1469)	-0.2059 (0.2292)
DailyVola			-0.0020*** (0.0003)	-0.0004 (0.0003)	-0.0035*** (0.0004)	-0.0016*** (0.0004)			-0.0040*** (0.0007)	-0.0021*** (0.0006)	-0.0042*** (0.0009)	-0.0016** (0.0008)
Extended Controls			Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes			Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Industry FE	Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes	
Firm FE		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes		Yes
Year FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes			Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes		
Year-Quarter FE					Yes	Yes					Yes	Yes
N	12,770	12,770	12,213	12,213	12,213	12,213	3,280	3,280	3,190	3,190	3,190	3,190
R ²	0.249	0.076	0.253	0.084	0.261	0.085	0.235	0.065	0.264	0.083	0.263	0.079
Adj. R ²	0.247	-0.003	0.250	0.003	0.256	-0.001	0.226	-0.036	0.254	-0.019	0.241	-0.041

Notes: * $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$ (two-tailed). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms). R^2 includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- R^2).

Table 76: H21: Speech Uncertainty and SEC Comment Letter Count

	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)
	SEC_Letters_fwd					
UncAnsCEO	-0.0027 (0.0086)	-0.0030 (0.0085)	-0.0032 (0.0088)	-0.0028 (0.0087)	-0.0029 (0.0088)	-0.0026 (0.0087)
UncPreCEO	0.0153** (0.0078)	0.0090 (0.0082)	0.0137** (0.0078)	0.0079 (0.0082)	0.0134** (0.0078)	0.0073 (0.0082)
UncAnsMgr	-0.0102 (0.0111)	-0.0043 (0.0112)	-0.0086 (0.0113)	-0.0045 (0.0115)	-0.0109 (0.0114)	-0.0074 (0.0116)
UncPreMgr	-0.0183 (0.0095)	-0.0090 (0.0110)	-0.0197 (0.0095)	-0.0096 (0.0110)	-0.0195 (0.0095)	-0.0099 (0.0110)
InAssets	-0.0102*** (0.0022)	0.0187*** (0.0068)	-0.0083*** (0.0023)	0.0197*** (0.0072)	-0.0082*** (0.0023)	0.0202*** (0.0072)
TobinsQ	-0.0095*** (0.0019)	0.0030 (0.0025)	-0.0086*** (0.0020)	0.0031 (0.0027)	-0.0083*** (0.0020)	0.0039 (0.0027)
ROA	-0.0800*** (0.0242)	-0.0575** (0.0292)	-0.0433 (0.0312)	-0.0529 (0.0355)	-0.0392 (0.0313)	-0.0524 (0.0356)
Leverage	0.0337** (0.0140)	0.0476** (0.0225)	0.0272* (0.0140)	0.0473** (0.0231)	0.0262* (0.0140)	0.0473** (0.0232)
Capex	-0.0515 (0.0622)	-0.0944 (0.0917)	-0.0622 (0.0642)	-0.0714 (0.0916)	-0.0575 (0.0643)	-0.0654 (0.0920)
CashRatio	-0.0136 (0.0211)	-0.0636** (0.0294)	-0.0187 (0.0216)	-0.0709** (0.0299)	-0.0212 (0.0216)	-0.0734** (0.0299)
DivDummy	-0.0348*** (0.0067)	-0.0105 (0.0106)	-0.0316*** (0.0068)	-0.0109 (0.0108)	-0.0311*** (0.0069)	-0.0106 (0.0108)
sCFO	-0.0070 (0.0092)	-0.0095 (0.0070)	-0.0079 (0.0091)	-0.0101 (0.0068)	-0.0088 (0.0088)	-0.0108* (0.0065)
Lagged_DV	0.0037 (0.0054)	-0.0647*** (0.0054)	0.0039 (0.0055)	-0.0661*** (0.0056)	0.0049 (0.0055)	-0.0652*** (0.0056)
SalesGrowth			-0.0063 (0.0067)	-0.0082 (0.0070)	-0.0047 (0.0068)	-0.0062 (0.0070)
RDSales			0.0003 (0.0047)	0.0032 (0.0036)	0.0002 (0.0047)	0.0035 (0.0037)
CashFlowAt			-0.0104 (0.0360)	0.0343 (0.0417)	-0.0153 (0.0361)	0.0263 (0.0419)
DailyVola			0.0007*** (0.0002)	0.0003* (0.0002)	0.0007*** (0.0002)	0.0002 (0.0002)
Extended Controls			Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Industry FE	Yes		Yes		Yes	
Firm FE		Yes		Yes		Yes
Year FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes		
Year-Quarter FE					Yes	Yes
N	66,886	66,886	64,172	64,172	64,172	64,172
R ²	0.004	0.005	0.004	0.005	0.004	0.005
Adj. R ²	0.004	-0.022	0.004	-0.023	0.003	-0.024

Notes: * $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$ (one-tailed for IVs, $\beta > 0$; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms). R^2 includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- R^2).

Table 77: H21 Robustness: Orthogonal Speaker Partition

	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)
	SEC_Letters_fwd					
UncAnsCEO	-0.0105 (0.0060)	-0.0071 (0.0059)	-0.0104 (0.0061)	-0.0070 (0.0060)	-0.0113 (0.0061)	-0.0083 (0.0060)
UncAnsNoCEO	-0.0023 (0.0038)	-0.0010 (0.0038)	-0.0015 (0.0038)	-0.0006 (0.0039)	-0.0022 (0.0039)	-0.0014 (0.0039)
UncPreCEO	0.0079 (0.0066)	0.0077 (0.0067)	0.0055 (0.0067)	0.0058 (0.0068)	0.0053 (0.0067)	0.0052 (0.0069)
UncPreNoCEO	-0.0017 (0.0049)	0.0020 (0.0060)	-0.0021 (0.0050)	0.0019 (0.0060)	-0.0019 (0.0050)	0.0020 (0.0061)
InAssets	-0.0098*** (0.0022)	0.0205*** (0.0069)	-0.0077*** (0.0023)	0.0219*** (0.0072)	-0.0075*** (0.0023)	0.0227*** (0.0072)
TobinsQ	-0.0104*** (0.0019)	0.0025 (0.0026)	-0.0096*** (0.0020)	0.0024 (0.0027)	-0.0094*** (0.0020)	0.0030 (0.0028)
ROA	-0.0795*** (0.0243)	-0.0509* (0.0286)	-0.0490 (0.0313)	-0.0453 (0.0351)	-0.0434 (0.0314)	-0.0426 (0.0352)
Leverage	0.0392*** (0.0142)	0.0619*** (0.0232)	0.0327** (0.0142)	0.0601** (0.0238)	0.0316** (0.0141)	0.0599** (0.0239)
Capex	-0.0551 (0.0632)	-0.0927 (0.0905)	-0.0693 (0.0650)	-0.0677 (0.0908)	-0.0641 (0.0650)	-0.0562 (0.0910)
CashRatio	-0.0085 (0.0216)	-0.0536* (0.0300)	-0.0135 (0.0220)	-0.0599** (0.0303)	-0.0165 (0.0220)	-0.0631** (0.0304)
DivDummy	-0.0357*** (0.0069)	-0.0120 (0.0103)	-0.0321*** (0.0070)	-0.0125 (0.0105)	-0.0314*** (0.0070)	-0.0119 (0.0105)
sCFO	-0.0060 (0.0089)	-0.0098* (0.0052)	-0.0067 (0.0087)	-0.0104** (0.0049)	-0.0076 (0.0084)	-0.0110** (0.0046)
Lagged_DV	0.0038 (0.0056)	-0.0657*** (0.0056)	0.0039 (0.0057)	-0.0669*** (0.0057)	0.0049 (0.0057)	-0.0660*** (0.0058)
SalesGrowth			-0.0063 (0.0069)	-0.0085 (0.0074)	-0.0048 (0.0070)	-0.0066 (0.0074)
RDSales			0.0006 (0.0060)	0.0036 (0.0054)	0.0005 (0.0060)	0.0040 (0.0055)
CashFlowAt			0.0045 (0.0365)	0.0465 (0.0425)	-0.0001 (0.0365)	0.0387 (0.0426)
DailyVola			0.0007*** (0.0002)	0.0004** (0.0002)	0.0008*** (0.0002)	0.0003 (0.0002)
Extended Controls			Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Industry FE	Yes		Yes		Yes	
Firm FE		Yes		Yes		Yes
Year FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes		
Year-Quarter FE					Yes	Yes
N	62,704	62,704	60,199	60,199	60,199	60,199
R ²	0.004	0.005	0.005	0.005	0.005	0.005
Adj. R ²	0.004	-0.024	0.004	-0.024	0.003	-0.025

Notes: * $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$ (one-tailed for IVs, $\beta > 0$; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms). R^2 includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- R^2).

Table 78: H22: Speech Uncertainty and Equity Financing Constraints

	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)
		EquityDelayCon_lead		
UncAnsCEO	0.0058* (0.0042)	0.0039 (0.0041)	0.0059* (0.0042)	0.0041 (0.0041)
UncPreCEO	0.0030 (0.0028)	0.0025 (0.0038)	0.0027 (0.0027)	0.0028 (0.0039)
UncAnsMgr	-0.0038 (0.0049)	-0.0032 (0.0052)	-0.0089 (0.0048)	-0.0036 (0.0052)
UncPreMgr	-0.0044 (0.0029)	-0.0060 (0.0048)	-0.0075 (0.0029)	-0.0063 (0.0049)
InAssets	0.0010* (0.0006)	0.0026 (0.0026)	-0.0009** (0.0004)	0.0025 (0.0026)
TobinsQ	0.0006 (0.0007)	0.0006 (0.0009)	-0.0004 (0.0007)	0.0005 (0.0009)
ROA	-0.0119** (0.0059)	0.0075 (0.0088)	-0.0086 (0.0087)	0.0023 (0.0091)
Leverage	0.0052 (0.0043)	-0.0133 (0.0082)	0.0064 (0.0042)	-0.0129 (0.0083)
Capex	0.0145 (0.0144)	0.0048 (0.0227)	0.0067 (0.0154)	0.0006 (0.0231)
CashRatio	0.0215*** (0.0061)	0.0158* (0.0094)	0.0137** (0.0056)	0.0146 (0.0097)
DivDummy	0.0003 (0.0017)	0.0052 (0.0035)	0.0006 (0.0017)	0.0055 (0.0035)
sCFO	0.0029 (0.0021)	-0.0040** (0.0017)	0.0024 (0.0023)	-0.0039** (0.0016)
Lagged_DV	0.6600*** (0.0109)	0.1811*** (0.0154)	0.6641*** (0.0107)	0.1841*** (0.0154)
SalesGrowth			0.0048** (0.0023)	0.0013 (0.0020)
RDSales			0.0027** (0.0012)	0.0004 (0.0011)
CashFlowAt			0.0023 (0.0098)	0.0165 (0.0106)
DailyVola			-0.0001 (0.0000)	0.0001** (0.0000)
Extended Controls			Yes	Yes
Industry FE	Yes		Yes	
Firm FE		Yes		Yes
Year FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
N	8,621	8,621	8,564	8,564
R ²	0.491	0.041	0.491	0.043
Adj. R ²	0.489	-0.086	0.489	-0.085

Notes: * $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$ (one-tailed for IVs, $\beta > 0$; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms). R^2 includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- R^2).

Table 79: H22 Robustness: Orthogonal Speaker Partition

	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)
		EquityDelayCon_lead		
UncAnsCEO	0.0033 (0.0027)	0.0022 (0.0032)	0.0004 (0.0026)	0.0022 (0.0032)
UncAnsNoCEO	-0.0003 (0.0017)	0.0004 (0.0019)	-0.0023 (0.0016)	0.0004 (0.0019)
UncPreCEO	0.0010 (0.0023)	0.0007 (0.0032)	-0.0009 (0.0022)	0.0008 (0.0032)
UncPreNoCEO	-0.0026 (0.0013)	-0.0030 (0.0022)	-0.0040 (0.0013)	-0.0029 (0.0023)
lnAssets	0.0010 (0.0006)	0.0029 (0.0026)	-0.0010 *** (0.0004)	0.0028 (0.0026)
TobinsQ	0.0006 (0.0007)	0.0007 (0.0009)	-0.0004 (0.0007)	0.0005 (0.0009)
ROA	-0.0118 ** (0.0058)	0.0079 (0.0089)	-0.0077 (0.0088)	0.0026 (0.0092)
Leverage	0.0049 (0.0044)	-0.0144 * (0.0083)	0.0064 (0.0043)	-0.0140 * (0.0084)
Capex	0.0147 (0.0147)	0.0049 (0.0235)	0.0076 (0.0158)	0.0011 (0.0239)
CashRatio	0.0215 *** (0.0061)	0.0150 (0.0096)	0.0134 ** (0.0057)	0.0139 (0.0099)
DivDummy	0.0003 (0.0017)	0.0050 (0.0035)	0.0005 (0.0017)	0.0053 (0.0035)
sCFO	0.0031 (0.0020)	-0.0040 ** (0.0016)	0.0025 (0.0021)	-0.0039 ** (0.0016)
Lagged_DV	0.6540 *** (0.0109)	0.1799 *** (0.0157)	0.6580 *** (0.0108)	0.1829 *** (0.0157)
SalesGrowth			0.0049 ** (0.0024)	0.0017 (0.0021)
RDSales			0.0027 ** (0.0011)	0.0007 (0.0012)
CashFlowAt			0.0005 (0.0099)	0.0152 (0.0107)
DailyVola			-0.0001 (0.0000)	0.0001 (0.0000)
Extended Controls			Yes	Yes
Industry FE	Yes		Yes	
Firm FE		Yes		Yes
Year FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
N	8,376	8,376	8,320	8,320
R ²	0.486	0.041	0.486	0.043
Adj. R ²	0.484	-0.088	0.484	-0.087

Notes: * $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$ (one-tailed for IVs, $\beta > 0$; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms). R^2 includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- R^2).

Table 80: H23: Product-Market Competition and Uncertainty Language

	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)	(9)	(10)	(11)	(12)
	Industry FE						Firm FE					
	UncAnsMgr	UncAnsCEO	UncPreMgr	UncPreCEO	UncAnsNoCEO	UncPreNoCEO	UncAnsMgr	UncAnsCEO	UncPreMgr	UncPreCEO	UncAnsNoCEO	UncPreNoCEO
$z(\log(\text{TSIMM}))$	0.0090** (0.0048)	0.0054 (0.0055)	0.0297*** (0.0075)	0.0304*** (0.0074)	0.0132** (0.0062)	0.0089 (0.0124)	-0.0012 (0.0059)	-0.0061 (0.0090)	0.0058 (0.0091)	0.0302*** (0.0093)	0.0018 (0.0095)	-0.0239 (0.0171)
UncQue	0.0616** (0.0078)	0.0625*** (0.0093)	0.0483*** (0.0094)	0.0398*** (0.0100)	0.0696*** (0.0115)	0.0548*** (0.0192)	0.0420*** (0.0061)	0.0459*** (0.0078)	0.0149** (0.0062)	0.0084 (0.0073)	0.0453*** (0.0113)	0.0250* (0.0128)
NegCall	0.1109*** (0.0133)	0.0900*** (0.0153)	0.1553*** (0.0179)	0.2340*** (0.0201)	0.0928*** (0.0187)	0.0669* (0.0361)	0.0690*** (0.0097)	0.0648*** (0.0123)	0.1370*** (0.0120)	0.1698*** (0.0140)	0.0508*** (0.0166)	0.1069*** (0.0232)
lnAssets	-0.0207*** (0.0027)	-0.0177*** (0.0031)	-0.0374*** (0.0043)	-0.0335*** (0.0038)	-0.0349*** (0.0034)	-0.0549*** (0.0078)	0.0002 (0.0054)	0.0007 (0.0067)	0.0060 (0.0079)	0.0013 (0.0081)	0.0011 (0.0086)	0.0138 (0.0140)
TobinsQ	-0.0080*** (0.0024)	-0.0089*** (0.0026)	-0.0014 (0.0034)	-0.0007 (0.0037)	-0.0102*** (0.0029)	-0.0110* (0.0056)	0.0013 (0.0020)	0.0032 (0.0028)	0.0011 (0.0024)	-0.0017 (0.0025)	-0.0037 (0.0030)	-0.0016 (0.0040)
ROA	0.0808*** (0.0230)	0.0778*** (0.0278)	0.1163*** (0.0322)	0.0681** (0.0314)	0.1069*** (0.0313)	0.0952 (0.0595)	0.0601*** (0.0184)	0.0405* (0.0234)	0.0064 (0.0240)	0.0241 (0.0254)	0.0797** (0.0317)	-0.0610 (0.0420)
CashRatio	-0.0339 (0.0262)	0.0120 (0.0296)	0.0503 (0.0362)	-0.0803** (0.0360)	-0.0785** (0.0321)	0.0881 (0.0633)	0.0589*** (0.0222)	0.0524* (0.0268)	-0.0130 (0.0292)	0.0022 (0.0306)	0.0637 (0.0398)	-0.0776 (0.0533)
DivDummy	0.0110 (0.0078)	0.0107 (0.0088)	-0.0425*** (0.0119)	-0.0060 (0.0117)	0.0000 (0.0105)	-0.0772*** (0.0221)	-0.0068 (0.0073)	0.0020 (0.0101)	-0.0163* (0.0095)	-0.0166 (0.0106)	0.0135 (0.0111)	-0.0355* (0.0190)
FirmMat	0.0019*** (0.0006)	0.0014* (0.0008)	0.0021 (0.0018)	0.0014** (0.0007)	-0.0001 (0.0030)	0.0007 (0.0031)	0.0027*** (0.0003)	0.0028*** (0.0006)	0.0002 (0.0006)	0.0003 (0.0004)	-0.0030 (0.0020)	0.0003 (0.0011)
EarnVol	-0.0105 (0.0091)	-0.0181 (0.0126)	-0.0106 (0.0145)	-0.0210 (0.0152)	-0.0107 (0.0106)	-0.0156 (0.0209)	-0.0020 (0.0072)	-0.0079 (0.0131)	0.0088 (0.0073)	-0.0114 (0.0146)	-0.0031 (0.0086)	0.0222 (0.0175)
UncPreMgr	0.1943*** (0.0128)						0.1418*** (0.0104)					
UncPreCEO		0.2491*** (0.0138)						0.1687*** (0.0108)				
UncPreNoCEO					0.0489*** (0.0114)						0.0478*** (0.0115)	
Industry FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes						
Firm FE							Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Year FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
N	20,768	18,447	20,774	18,492	20,236	20,513	20,768	18,447	20,774	18,492	20,236	20,513
R^2	0.104	0.103	0.064	0.050	0.029	0.035	0.038	0.038	0.017	0.021	0.006	0.006
Adj. R^2	0.102	0.102	0.062	0.048	0.028	0.033	-0.045	-0.050	-0.067	-0.068	-0.081	-0.080

Notes: * $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$ (one-tailed for IVs, $\beta > 0$; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) clustered at firm level. Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms). Unit of observation: firm-fiscal-year. R^2 includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- R^2).

Table 81: H24: US Economic Policy Uncertainty and Call Language Uncertainty

	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)	(9)	(10)	(11)	(12)
	Industry + Cal. Year FE						Firm + Cal. Year FE					
	UncAnsMgr	UncPreMgr	UncAnsCEO	UncPreCEO	UncAnsNoCEO	UncPreNoCEO	UncAnsMgr	UncPreMgr	UncAnsCEO	UncPreCEO	UncAnsNoCEO	UncPreNoCEO
$\log(\text{US EPU})_t$	0.0141** (0.0064)	0.0065 (0.0062)	0.0117* (0.0072)	0.0211*** (0.0074)	0.0109* (0.0081)	0.0008 (0.0079)	0.0147** (0.0069)	0.0071 (0.0058)	0.0138** (0.0077)	0.0239*** (0.0076)	0.0098 (0.0084)	0.0006 (0.0070)
UncQue	0.0388*** (0.0032)	0.0115*** (0.0023)	0.0413*** (0.0035)	0.0164*** (0.0032)	0.0484*** (0.0062)	0.0115*** (0.0037)	0.0349*** (0.0029)	0.0084*** (0.0023)	0.0380*** (0.0031)	0.0095*** (0.0028)	0.0409*** (0.0059)	0.0103*** (0.0039)
NegCall	0.0707*** (0.0066)	0.0726*** (0.0059)	0.0670*** (0.0082)	0.1247*** (0.0089)	0.0618*** (0.0125)	0.0355*** (0.0078)	0.0600*** (0.0055)	0.0928*** (0.0058)	0.0621*** (0.0068)	0.1385*** (0.0079)	0.0376*** (0.0116)	0.0611*** (0.0085)
InAssets	-0.0153*** (0.0018)	-0.0128*** (0.0016)	-0.0137*** (0.0022)	-0.0143*** (0.0020)	-0.0297*** (0.0027)	-0.0143*** (0.0023)	-0.0004 (0.0045)	0.0028 (0.0046)	0.0011 (0.0063)	0.0038 (0.0063)	-0.0042 (0.0083)	0.0037 (0.0066)
TobinsQ	-0.0071*** (0.0016)	0.0011 (0.0012)	-0.0081*** (0.0018)	0.0007 (0.0019)	-0.0097*** (0.0025)	-0.0017 (0.0015)	0.0023 (0.0017)	0.0015 (0.0014)	0.0025 (0.0024)	0.0007 (0.0018)	0.0006 (0.0027)	-0.0017 (0.0021)
ROA	0.0607*** (0.0170)	0.0343*** (0.0121)	0.0837*** (0.0223)	0.0367** (0.0168)	0.0633*** (0.0238)	0.0229 (0.0169)	0.0508*** (0.0160)	0.0125 (0.0145)	0.0551*** (0.0193)	0.0467** (0.0191)	0.0314 (0.0252)	-0.0078 (0.0203)
CashRatio	-0.0120 (0.0174)	0.0325*** (0.0119)	0.0185 (0.0220)	-0.0079 (0.0187)	-0.0519** (0.0251)	0.0209 (0.0160)	0.0534*** (0.0149)	0.0061 (0.0161)	0.0604*** (0.0226)	0.0305 (0.0231)	0.0428 (0.0293)	-0.0196 (0.0247)
DivDummy	0.0074 (0.0053)	-0.0167*** (0.0042)	0.0104 (0.0064)	-0.0074 (0.0061)	0.0047 (0.0078)	-0.0165*** (0.0058)	-0.0079 (0.0066)	-0.0101* (0.0059)	-0.0034 (0.0089)	-0.0157* (0.0083)	0.0109 (0.0095)	-0.0130 (0.0092)
FirmMat	-0.0002 (0.0011)	0.0021*** (0.0007)	-0.0005 (0.0015)	0.0009 (0.0008)	0.0006 (0.0019)	0.0021** (0.0009)	0.0027* (0.0015)	0.0008 (0.0013)	0.0039** (0.0019)	-0.0011 (0.0012)	-0.0020 (0.0028)	0.0013 (0.0011)
EarnVol	-0.0060 (0.0075)	-0.0062 (0.0069)	-0.0002 (0.0106)	-0.0074 (0.0086)	-0.0168 (0.0112)	-0.0033 (0.0092)	-0.0029 (0.0076)	0.0021 (0.0067)	0.0149 (0.0111)	-0.0083 (0.0119)	-0.0160 (0.0122)	0.0134 (0.0113)
UncPreMgr	0.1223*** (0.0071)						0.1126*** (0.0059)					
UncPreCEO			0.1384*** (0.0070)						0.1043*** (0.0049)			
UncPreNoCEO					0.0563*** (0.0077)						0.0614*** (0.0071)	
Lagged_DV	0.3333*** (0.0084)	0.6755*** (0.0101)	0.2986*** (0.0091)	0.5176*** (0.0131)	0.1937*** (0.0068)	0.7610*** (0.0107)	0.1367*** (0.0069)	0.4185*** (0.0099)	0.1103*** (0.0071)	0.2626*** (0.0089)	0.0762*** (0.0064)	0.5359*** (0.0133)
Industry FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Firm FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Year FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
N	74,013	75,142	59,676	60,503	68,858	73,835	74,013	75,142	59,676	60,503	68,858	73,835
R^2	0.171	0.484	0.141	0.292	0.056	0.592	0.041	0.186	0.030	0.084	0.010	0.291
Adj. R^2	0.171	0.484	0.141	0.291	0.055	0.592	0.017	0.166	0.002	0.057	-0.016	0.273

Notes: * $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$ (one-tailed for IVs, $\beta > 0$; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) two-way clustered (firm, calendar quarter). Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms). Firms with fewer than 5 calls are excluded. R^2 includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- R^2).

Table 82: H24b: Global Economic Policy Uncertainty and Call Language Uncertainty

	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)	(9)	(10)	(11)	(12)
	Industry + Cal. Year FE						Firm + Cal. Year FE					
	UncAnsMgr	UncPreMgr	UncAnsCEO	UncPreCEO	UncAnsNoCEO	UncPreNoCEO	UncAnsMgr	UncPreMgr	UncAnsCEO	UncPreCEO	UncAnsNoCEO	UncPreNoCEO
$\log(\text{GEPU})_t$	0.0234*** (0.0099)	0.0131* (0.0093)	0.0178* (0.0109)	0.0271*** (0.0107)	0.0178* (0.0128)	0.0078 (0.0123)	0.0242** (0.0104)	0.0124* (0.0086)	0.0212** (0.0110)	0.0309*** (0.0108)	0.0166 (0.0132)	0.0053 (0.0108)
UncQue	0.0388*** (0.0032)	0.0115*** (0.0023)	0.0413*** (0.0035)	0.0164*** (0.0032)	0.0483*** (0.0062)	0.0114*** (0.0037)	0.0348*** (0.0029)	0.0084*** (0.0023)	0.0380*** (0.0031)	0.0095*** (0.0028)	0.0409*** (0.0059)	0.0103*** (0.0039)
NegCall	0.0704*** (0.0065)	0.0724*** (0.0058)	0.0669*** (0.0083)	0.1247*** (0.0089)	0.0617*** (0.0124)	0.0352*** (0.0077)	0.0597*** (0.0054)	0.0926*** (0.0058)	0.0619*** (0.0067)	0.1385*** (0.0063)	0.0374*** (0.0115)	0.0608*** (0.0085)
InAssets	-0.0153*** (0.0018)	-0.0127*** (0.0016)	-0.0136*** (0.0022)	-0.0143*** (0.0020)	-0.0297*** (0.0027)	-0.0143*** (0.0023)	-0.0005 (0.0045)	0.0027 (0.0046)	0.0011 (0.0063)	0.0037 (0.0063)	-0.0042 (0.0083)	0.0037 (0.0066)
TobinsQ	-0.0071*** (0.0016)	0.0011 (0.0012)	-0.0081*** (0.0018)	0.0008 (0.0019)	-0.0097*** (0.0025)	-0.0017 (0.0015)	0.0023 (0.0017)	0.0015 (0.0014)	0.0025 (0.0024)	0.0007 (0.0018)	0.0006 (0.0027)	-0.0017 (0.0021)
ROA	0.0606*** (0.0170)	0.0342*** (0.0122)	0.0836*** (0.0223)	0.0367** (0.0168)	0.0632*** (0.0238)	0.0228 (0.0169)	0.0504*** (0.0160)	0.0122 (0.0145)	0.0547*** (0.0193)	0.0462** (0.0191)	0.0311 (0.0252)	-0.0079 (0.0203)
CashRatio	-0.0120 (0.0174)	0.0325*** (0.0119)	0.0184 (0.0220)	-0.0080 (0.0188)	-0.0519** (0.0251)	0.0209 (0.0160)	0.0536*** (0.0149)	0.0062 (0.0161)	0.0605*** (0.0226)	0.0304 (0.0231)	0.0429 (0.0293)	-0.0195 (0.0247)
DivDummy	0.0074 (0.0053)	-0.0167*** (0.0042)	0.0104 (0.0064)	-0.0074 (0.0061)	0.0047 (0.0078)	-0.0165*** (0.0058)	-0.0079 (0.0066)	-0.0101* (0.0059)	-0.0034 (0.0089)	-0.0156* (0.0083)	0.0109 (0.0095)	-0.0130 (0.0092)
FirmMat	-0.0002 (0.0011)	0.0021*** (0.0007)	-0.0005 (0.0015)	0.0009 (0.0008)	0.0006 (0.0019)	0.0021** (0.0009)	0.0027* (0.0015)	0.0008 (0.0013)	0.0039** (0.0019)	-0.0011 (0.0012)	-0.0020 (0.0028)	0.0013 (0.0011)
EarnVol	-0.0060 (0.0075)	-0.0061 (0.0069)	-0.0002 (0.0106)	-0.0074 (0.0086)	-0.0168 (0.0112)	-0.0033 (0.0092)	-0.0029 (0.0076)	0.0021 (0.0067)	0.0150 (0.0111)	-0.0082 (0.0119)	-0.0160 (0.0122)	0.0134 (0.0113)
UncPreMgr	0.1223*** (0.0071)						0.1126*** (0.0059)					
UncPreCEO			0.1384*** (0.0070)						0.1043*** (0.0049)			
UncPreNoCEO					0.0563*** (0.0077)						0.0614*** (0.0071)	
Lagged_DV	0.3334*** (0.0084)	0.6755*** (0.0101)	0.2986*** (0.0091)	0.5176*** (0.0131)	0.1937*** (0.0068)	0.7610*** (0.0107)	0.1368*** (0.0069)	0.4185*** (0.0099)	0.1103*** (0.0071)	0.2626*** (0.0089)	0.0762*** (0.0064)	0.5359*** (0.0133)
Industry FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Firm FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Year FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
N	74,013	75,142	59,676	60,503	68,858	73,835	74,013	75,142	59,676	60,503	68,858	73,835
R^2	0.171	0.484	0.141	0.292	0.056	0.592	0.041	0.186	0.031	0.084	0.010	0.291
Adj. R^2	0.171	0.484	0.141	0.291	0.055	0.592	0.017	0.166	0.002	0.057	-0.016	0.273

Notes: * $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$ (one-tailed for IVs, $\beta > 0$; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) two-way clustered (firm, calendar quarter). Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms). Firms with fewer than 5 calls are excluded. R^2 includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- R^2).

Table 83: H25: Geopolitical Risk and Call Language Uncertainty

	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)	(9)	(10)	(11)	(12)
	Industry + Cal. Year FE						Firm + Cal. Year FE					
	UncAnsMgr	UncPreMgr	UncAnsCEO	UncPreCEO	UncAnsNoCEO	UncPreNoCEO	UncAnsMgr	UncPreMgr	UncAnsCEO	UncPreCEO	UncAnsNoCEO	UncPreNoCEO
$\log(\text{GPR})_t$	-0.0112 (0.0087)	0.0073 (0.0061)	-0.0059 (0.0102)	0.0147* (0.0095)	0.0028 (0.0129)	0.0044 (0.0139)	-0.0119 (0.0087)	0.0067 (0.0058)	-0.0058 (0.0100)	0.0118 (0.0093)	0.0035 (0.0126)	0.0076 (0.0128)
UncQue	0.0388*** (0.0033)	0.0115*** (0.0024)	0.0414*** (0.0036)	0.0165*** (0.0032)	0.0484*** (0.0062)	0.0115*** (0.0037)	0.0349*** (0.0030)	0.0084*** (0.0023)	0.0380*** (0.0032)	0.0096*** (0.0028)	0.0409*** (0.0059)	0.0103*** (0.0039)
NegCall	0.0714*** (0.0065)	0.0730*** (0.0059)	0.0677*** (0.0081)	0.1260*** (0.0090)	0.0625*** (0.0124)	0.0355*** (0.0078)	0.0611*** (0.0057)	0.0934*** (0.0059)	0.0631*** (0.0068)	0.1404*** (0.0082)	0.0384*** (0.0117)	0.0612*** (0.0085)
InAssets	-0.0153*** (0.0018)	-0.0127*** (0.0016)	-0.0136*** (0.0022)	-0.0143*** (0.0020)	-0.0296*** (0.0027)	-0.0143*** (0.0023)	-0.0004 (0.0045)	0.0028 (0.0046)	0.0011 (0.0063)	0.0039 (0.0063)	-0.0042 (0.0083)	0.0037 (0.0066)
TobinsQ	-0.0071*** (0.0016)	0.0011 (0.0012)	-0.0081*** (0.0018)	0.0008 (0.0019)	-0.0097*** (0.0025)	-0.0017 (0.0015)	0.0022 (0.0017)	0.0015 (0.0014)	0.0024 (0.0024)	0.0007 (0.0018)	0.0006 (0.0027)	-0.0017 (0.0021)
ROA	0.0609*** (0.0171)	0.0343*** (0.0121)	0.0838*** (0.0223)	0.0368*** (0.0168)	0.0634*** (0.0239)	0.0229 (0.0169)	0.0512*** (0.0161)	0.0125 (0.0145)	0.0553*** (0.0194)	0.0468** (0.0192)	0.0315 (0.0252)	-0.0079 (0.0202)
CashRatio	-0.0120 (0.0174)	0.0325*** (0.0119)	0.0185 (0.0220)	-0.0079 (0.0187)	-0.0519** (0.0251)	0.0209 (0.0160)	0.0527*** (0.0149)	0.0059 (0.0161)	0.0598*** (0.0227)	0.0295 (0.0229)	0.0425 (0.0293)	-0.0196 (0.0247)
DivDummy	0.0074 (0.0053)	-0.0167*** (0.0042)	0.0104 (0.0064)	-0.0073 (0.0061)	0.0047 (0.0078)	-0.0165*** (0.0058)	-0.0078 (0.0066)	-0.0101* (0.0059)	-0.0032 (0.0089)	-0.0154* (0.0083)	0.0110 (0.0095)	-0.0130 (0.0092)
FirmMat	-0.0002 (0.0011)	0.0021*** (0.0007)	-0.0005 (0.0015)	0.0009 (0.0008)	0.0006 (0.0019)	0.0021** (0.0009)	0.0027* (0.0015)	0.0008 (0.0013)	0.0039** (0.0019)	-0.0011 (0.0012)	-0.0019 (0.0028)	0.0013 (0.0011)
EarnVol	-0.0061 (0.0076)	-0.0062 (0.0069)	-0.0003 (0.0106)	-0.0076 (0.0086)	-0.0168 (0.0112)	-0.0033 (0.0092)	-0.0030 (0.0076)	0.0021 (0.0067)	0.0149 (0.0111)	-0.0084 (0.0118)	-0.0160 (0.0122)	0.0134 (0.0113)
UncPreMgr	0.1224*** (0.0071)						0.1127*** (0.0059)					
UncPreCEO			0.1385*** (0.0070)						0.1045*** (0.0048)			
UncPreNoCEO					0.0563*** (0.0077)						0.0614*** (0.0071)	
Lagged_DV	0.3332*** (0.0084)	0.6755*** (0.0101)	0.2986*** (0.0091)	0.5175*** (0.0131)	0.1937*** (0.0068)	0.7610*** (0.0107)	0.1366*** (0.0069)	0.4185*** (0.0099)	0.1103*** (0.0071)	0.2626*** (0.0089)	0.0761*** (0.0064)	0.5359*** (0.0133)
Industry FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Firm FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Year FE	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
N	74,013	75,142	59,676	60,503	68,858	73,835	74,013	75,142	59,676	60,503	68,858	73,835
R^2	0.171	0.484	0.141	0.292	0.056	0.592	0.041	0.186	0.030	0.084	0.010	0.291
Adj. R^2	0.171	0.484	0.141	0.291	0.055	0.592	0.017	0.166	0.001	0.057	-0.016	0.273

Notes: * $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$ (one-tailed for IVs, $\beta > 0$; two-tailed for controls). Significant coefficients in **bold**. Standard errors (in parentheses) two-way clustered (firm, calendar quarter). Main sample (excludes financial and utility firms). Firms with fewer than 5 calls are excluded. R^2 includes absorbed fixed effects (not within- R^2).